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No. 29

House of Representatives

The House met at 11 a.m. and was called to order by the Speaker pro tempore (Mr. EVANS of Colorado).

DESIGNATION OF THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following communication from the Speaker:

WASHINGTON, DC,
February 11, 2026.

I hereby appoint the Honorable GABE EVANS, to act as Speaker pro tempore on this day.

MIKE JOHNSON,
Speaker of the House of Representatives.

PRAYER

The Chaplain, the Reverend Margaret Grun Kibben, offered the following prayer:

Set Your law before us, O God, that the laws made here and the men and women who determine them may find alignment with Your will and obedience to Your precepts. And what does Your law require, but to love You with our whole heart, soul, and mind.

Beyond this, while we are not obliged to be of the same will or opinion with each other, we are commanded to show one another love. In our dealings and discussions, in our composure and our compassion toward each other, may we fulfill the law that is like unto the first: to love one another as we love ourselves. On these hang the success of this day, for in seeking Your desire for us, we will discover in the joy found in obedience to Your law.

It is in Your sovereign name we pray.
Amen.

THE JOURNAL

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Chair has examined the Journal of the last day's proceedings and announces to the House the approval thereof.

Pursuant to clause 1 of rule I, the Journal stands approved.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Will the gentleman from Massachusetts (Mr. MCGOVERN) come forward and lead the House in the Pledge of Allegiance.

Mr. MCGOVERN led the Pledge of Allegiance as follows:

I pledge allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF S. 1383, VETERANS ACCESSIBILITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE ACT OF 2025; PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF H.R. 2189, LAW-ENFORCEMENT INNOVATE TO DE-ESCALATE ACT; PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF H.R. 261, UNDERSEA CABLE PROTECTION ACT OF 2025; AND PROVIDING FOR CONSIDERATION OF H.R. 3617, SECURING AMERICA'S CRITICAL MINERALS SUPPLY ACT

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, by direction of the Committee on Rules, I call up House Resolution 1057 and ask for its immediate consideration.

The Clerk read the resolution, as follows:

H. RES. 1057

Resolved, That upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (S. 1383) to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access,

and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. An amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 119-19, modified by the amendment printed in the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution, shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on House Administration or their respective designees; and (2) one motion to commit.

SEC. 2. Upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (H.R. 2189) to modernize Federal firearms laws to account for advancements in technology and less-than-lethal weapons, and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. In lieu of the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on the Judiciary now printed in the bill, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 119-18 shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided among and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on the Judiciary or their respective designees and the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Ways and Means or their respective designees; and (2) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 3. Upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (H.R. 261) to amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit requiring an authorization for the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have previously been authorized by a Federal or State agency. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. The

□ This symbol represents the time of day during the House proceedings, e.g., □ 1407 is 2:07 p.m.

Matter set in this typeface indicates words inserted or appended, rather than spoken, by a Member of the House on the floor.



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amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Natural Resources now printed in the bill shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees; and (2) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 4. Upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (H.R. 3617) to amend the Department of Energy Organization Act to secure the supply of critical energy resources, including critical minerals and other materials, and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. The amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Energy and Commerce now printed in the bill shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any further amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Energy and Commerce or their respective designees; and (2) one motion to recommit.

SEC. 5. The requirement of clause 6(a) of rule XIII for a two-thirds vote to consider a report from the Committee on Rules on the same day it is presented to the House is waived with respect to any resolution reported through the legislative day of February 13, 2026, relating to a measure continuing appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026.

□ 1110

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Texas is recognized for 1 hour.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, for the purpose of debate only, I yield the customary 30 minutes to the gentleman from Massachusetts (Mr. MCGOVERN), pending which I yield myself such time as I may consume. During consideration of this resolution, all time yielded is for the purpose of debate only.

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Texas?

There was no objection.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Last night, the Rules Committee met and produced a rule providing for consideration of four pieces of legislation. The rule provides for consideration of S. 1383, the SAVE America Act, under a closed rule with 1 hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on House Administration or their respective designees and provides for one motion to commit.

The rule also provides for consideration of H.R. 2189, the Law-Enforce-

ment Innovate to De-Escalate Act, under a closed rule with 1 hour of debate equally divided among and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on the Judiciary and the Committee on Ways and Means or their respective designees and provides for one motion to recommit.

The rule also provides for consideration of H.R. 261, the Undersea Cable Protection Act of 2025, under a closed rule with 1 hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees and provides for one motion to recommit.

The rule also provides for consideration of H.R. 3617, the Securing America's Critical Mineral Supply Act, under a closed rule with 1 hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Energy and Commerce or their respective designees and provides for one motion to recommit.

Further, the rule provides same-day authority through Friday, February 13, for a rule providing for consideration of a continuing resolution related to the Department of Homeland Security funding.

Mr. Speaker, as the House of Representatives works to deliver on the critical issues our Nation faces, we urge our colleagues today to prioritize the passage of S. 1383, the Safeguard American Voter Eligibility Act, or the SAVE America Act, which builds upon the SAVE Act introduced in previous Congresses that requires States to obtain proof of citizenship for Federal elections, ensuring only U.S. citizens are voting in those elections. In addition, the SAVE America Act requires individuals to present a valid photo identification before voting.

Our Founders set forth our electoral processes 250 years ago based upon the simple and ultimate principle that only Americans should vote. However, in this age of progressive, suicidal empathy, basic concepts such as voter ID and proof of citizenship have been attacked as suppression.

Let's consider the facts.

Fact one: Under the previous administration, the Biden-Harris-Mayorkas administration, some 10 million or more illegal aliens poured into communities across our country, adding to an existing foreign-born population, which totals upward of over 50 million people or close to 16 percent.

Fact two: While only U.S. citizens are legally eligible to vote in Federal elections, Federal law actually interferes with and prevents States from using Federal data to check their voter rolls to ensure that only citizens are voting, such that we end up in the upside-down situation where a State like Arizona has two different sets of systems, one for State and local and one for Federal.

Fact three: This is a recipe for fraud and a recipe for having people vote who

shouldn't be voting. It undermines people's confidence in our electoral system. When combined with the fact that several jurisdictions offer driver's licenses and other benefits to illegal aliens and other foreign nationals, it provides opportunity for noncitizens to register to vote.

Fact four: Polling data is overwhelmingly in support of the SAVE America Act and its principles, that only American citizens should vote, and that we should use voter identification when we go to vote. Polling indicates that over 70 percent of Democrats across this country, over 90 percent of Republicans, and well over 70 percent of virtually every ethnicity and ethnic group in the country—Black Americans, Hispanic Americans, White Americans, men, women, rural, urban—overwhelmingly support voter identification and ensuring that only citizens vote.

Fact five: We passed the SAVE Act in the previous, preceding Congress. We passed the SAVE Act in this Congress focusing on citizenship. We now bring the SAVE America Act forward that adds voter identification, which is, again, overwhelmingly popular.

The SAVE Act passed on a bipartisan basis. Democrats joined with us in the previous Congress. Democrats joined with us in this Congress. In both instances, the House of Representatives affirmed that only U.S. citizens should vote in Federal elections.

Let's add voter ID to it. Let's pass the SAVE America Act. Let's send it over to the Senate and let the Senate move this legislation to the President's desk.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Texas for yielding me the customary 30 minutes, and I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, we have four bills in this rule today. All of them are completely closed—no amendments, no debate, completely closed. I feel like I am in Russia. Three of them are from the failed rule last night, which was the third failed rule in this Congress, the seventh under Speaker Johnson, and the tenth of the reigning Republican majority. That alone demonstrates Republicans' inability to govern.

Then we have the so-called SAVE America Act. The gentleman from Texas is going to spend today's debate trying to convince you that this is a commonsense, simple bill, but I want you to remember a very few important facts while he is talking.

First of all, it is already illegal for noncitizens to vote in Federal elections, period, full stop. If noncitizens are voting in Federal elections, they should be prosecuted. We don't disagree on that.

Second, nobody disputes the fact that voters should follow the law and indicate who they are. We agree on that, too. Nobody is debating that on the floor today.

What we are debating is whether we are going to believe the BS conspiracy theories cooked up by Donald Trump and MAGA Republicans about whether or not elections can be trusted in this country.

What we are debating is whether, in response to those lies, we are going to require Americans to go down to their county clerk, to take the train to city hall, or to drive down to the registrar's office and jump through bureaucratic hoops just to register to vote.

Who asked for more red tape? Did Jim Crow call?

I mean, that is what this bill is about. It is not about voter ID. It is about voter registration, and it is about voter suppression.

We always tell people to vote, make their voices heard, participate in our democracy, right? Those are supposed to be good things.

Why are Republicans passing a bill that makes it as hard as possible to vote? I will let them answer that question, but I guess it is about what I have come to expect from a party that no longer believes in democracy, though.

Yesterday, in the Rules Committee, I asked the chairman of the Committee on House Administration a simple question: Did Donald Trump win or lose the State of Minnesota in the last three Presidential elections? It is not a curve ball; not a difficult question.

Of course, anyone living in reality knows the answer to this—Donald Trump lost Minnesota three times—but not Donald Trump. He continues denying election results. He said just last Friday that because of voter fraud, he feels he won Minnesota.

The Republican chairman of the House Administration Committee, the congressional committee which regulates Federal election laws, couldn't give me a straight answer, couldn't answer that question. He couldn't tell me if he agreed with Donald Trump. He wouldn't say who won Minnesota. He went through all kinds of contortions to avoid answering the question.

I mean, this is a simple question. That is shocking, Mr. Speaker. I mean, you guys want America to trust you to write our election laws? Americans can't even trust you to tell us who won the election.

Oh, and then here is another thing: One of the changes that were made—by the way, this bill didn't go through committee process. I mean, this was kind of rushed to the floor. All kinds of major changes have been made in the last week, but here is one of the major changes: This bill, if passed, was supposed to take effect in the year 2027. There is a change in this bill. It takes place immediately, for this election.

I mean, how is that going to happen? We have elections beginning in a matter of a few weeks, and you are expecting every State to be able to comply with all these new rules and regulations, like, immediately?

This is about sowing chaos and confusion. My friends on the other side

know they are probably going to lose the next election, and they are going to lose big. Rather than live up to the reality or respect the voters, they are going to try to make up some conspiracy theory that the election was stolen or undocumented migrants came in and voted against them.

Here is the hard truth: If Republicans want to know why people are losing faith in our elections, they ought to look in the mirror. They ought to look in the mirror.

□ 1120

People are losing faith because Donald Trump, the election denier in chief, can't admit he lost. People are losing faith because Tulsi Gabbard and Kash Patel's FBI raided an election office in Fulton County, Georgia, based on recycled conspiracy theories. They seized 2020 election results, even though it was Donald Trump who asked the Georgia Secretary of State to find 11,780 ballots so that he can win, even though he lost, and that is on tape.

They are losing faith in our elections because they saw Pam Bondi trying to shake down Minnesota's State government, saying the administration would only withdraw ICE if Minnesota handed over their voter rolls to Trump's DOJ. They are losing faith because of bills like this, which force every State in America to give their voter rolls over to DHS Secretary Kristi Noem.

Let that sink in. She is probably one of the least trustworthy people in the country right now. I wouldn't trust Kristi Noem to tell me the correct time, and we are asking States to turn over their voting rolls to her. Give me a break.

We don't need any more lectures from Republicans about the sanctity of democracy or why people are losing faith in our democratic institutions. We know why, and we know what this bill is. This is Jim Crow 2.0. Republicans think that when fewer Americans vote, they win. It is as simple as that.

I am so sick of the other side just making things up. This widespread voter fraud conspiracy is all part of the same election denialism that goes right up to the Oval Office.

The other side has been making these claims for years now. We have heard about this for over a decade. They claim that massive numbers of noncitizens are voting, swaying elections, and that rampant voter fraud is changing results.

Every single one of those claims, Mr. Speaker, has been investigated again and again by Republican Governors and Republican Secretaries of State, by journalists, by academic researchers, and by President Trump himself, whose own voter fraud commission was disbanded because he couldn't find enough evidence to warrant the absurd allegations that he was making.

Every time these claims are investigated, they disappear like a mirage. This entire bill is fundamentally predi-

cated on a lie. In fact, when you crunch the numbers, you are more likely to be struck by lightning than to successfully impersonate someone at the polls. Enough already.

The SAVE America Act is a terrible bill that makes it harder for American citizens to participate in our democracy. That is it.

America does not want to be saved by a Republican Party that spent a year propping up Trump's tariffs, which have driven costs through the roof. We don't want to be saved by the people who continue covering up for pedophiles in the Epstein files. America certainly doesn't want to be saved by the same people who still can't get over losing the 2020 election so they are going to try to rig the next one.

Go save somebody else, but we don't want this garbage. We will fight like hell to stop you from making it harder for millions of Americans to register to vote.

We know why you are doing this. It is because you are afraid that you are going to lose in November. Well, too bad. Too bad. Either change your crappy policies or face the voters and deal with the consequences of your own actions. Those are the only two options in a democracy.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to refrain from engaging in personalities toward the President and to direct their remarks to the Chair.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, that was a whole lot of words to say my Democratic colleagues don't want only citizens to vote and don't like voter ID.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Georgia (Mr. CLYDE).

Mr. CLYDE. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of the SAVE America Act, which implements commonsense measures backed by the vast majority of Americans, across party lines, to secure our elections and ensure that it is easy to vote but hard to cheat.

As my great State of Georgia knows all too well, we must do more to deliver secure elections. The survival of our constitutional Republic relies on free, fair, and secure elections.

Thankfully, this legislation bolsters election integrity by requiring a government photo ID to vote, requiring proof of U.S. citizenship to register to vote, and directing States to remove noncitizens from existing voter rolls.

These are not controversial issues. In fact, leftwing CNN's own recent polling shows that 83 percent of Americans support voter ID, including the majority of Republicans and Democrats, as well as voters regardless of their race.

Who would oppose such a bill and why? Unsurprisingly, my Democrat colleagues oppose the SAVE America Act because it hurts the Democratic Party's ability to cheat in our elections.

Just think of all the things Americans need an ID for, yet face absolutely

no backlash from the Democratic Party. For example, to exercise another constitutional right, the Second Amendment, an individual must present a government-issued photo ID to purchase a firearm from a Federal firearms dealer. Yet, requiring identification to vote is somehow portrayed as controversial.

To underscore the Democrats' hypocrisy even further, in funding negotiations, CHUCK SCHUMER and House Minority Leader HAKEEM JEFFRIES are demanding that ICE agents show IDs to arrest illegal aliens. They support photo ID to enforce immigration laws but oppose photo ID to ensure our elections are secure. This is incredible hypocrisy.

In Proverbs 11:9, God says: "The hypocrite with his mouth destroys his neighbor." That is exactly what Democrats are trying to do: destroy this country with their hypocrisy over voter identification.

Mr. Speaker, I support this act.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, let me first correct the gentleman from Texas, who mischaracterized deliberately my remarks. I made it very clear in my opening, and I will read it again to him, that if noncitizens are voting in Federal elections, they should be prosecuted. We all believe it. He doesn't have to listen if he doesn't want to, but please don't mischaracterize what I said.

Mr. Speaker, I am looking over to the other side of the aisle and can't help but be stunned by the number of people over there who I remember coming on this floor and denying the election results in the year 2020 because they didn't like the results.

Mr. Speaker, I am going to urge that we defeat the previous question. If we do, I will offer an amendment to the rule to make in order amendment No. 10 to the SAVE America Act, which prohibits Members of Congress, the President, the Vice President, their spouses, and dependents from owning or trading stocks.

Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to insert the text of my amendment into the RECORD, along with extraneous material, immediately prior to the vote on the previous question.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, to discuss our proposal, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from New York (Mr. MORELLE), the sponsor of the amendment and the ranking member of the Committee on House Administration.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I thank my longtime friend, the distinguished ranking member of the Rules Committee, for his vigorous defense of our position and his encouragement that people vote against the so-called SAVE America Act.

Mr. Speaker, the way to enhance Americans' trust in government is by

holding ourselves to a higher standard, not by disenfranchising citizens seeking to participate in our democracy.

The vast majority of Americans believe that it is time to end the practice of Members of Congress and the President and Vice President from trading stocks, and that is what the Restore Trust in Government Act would do.

Speaker JOHNSON has refused to move any bill to ban Member stock trading. I offered this proposal as an amendment to the SAVE America Act, but it was rejected by the majority.

I also have a discharge petition on stock trading that has over 170 signatures, nearing the 218 signatures needed to pass the House. If we want Americans to trust us, to trust our government, we need to root out corruption, real corruption, not imaginary voter fraud.

We have an opportunity to do that right here and right now. That is what the Restore Trust in Government Act would do.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to recognize the importance of the moment and to defeat the previous question. Once we do, the House can finally pass a stock trading ban.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I am about to yield 2 minutes to my friend from Arizona, but I will just note that, as one of the lead sponsors of the legislation to deal with prohibiting Members of Congress from engaging in the act of trading in stocks, we are working on a bipartisan basis. We have legislation we are going to move. There will be a time to do that, and this is a complete substitute. In other words, this is fake.

It is a bunch of drama because my colleagues on the other side of the aisle do not want voter identification to be used to vote, and they do not want to guarantee that only citizens vote. It is that simple.

□ 1130

Mr. Speaker, we will deal with stock trading. I am one of the lead sponsors of that legislation. We will get it done but not as a substitute for what 80 percent of American people want, which is to guarantee only citizens vote and that they show up with a voter identification.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Arizona (Mr. BIGGS).

Mr. BIGGS of Arizona. Mr. Speaker, I thank my friend from Texas, Mr. ROY, for yielding 2 minutes to me.

Mr. Speaker, I will say this. This is really humorous to hear the machinations and the twisting and goings-on from our friends across the aisle. As they say, this is too much.

Mr. SCHUMER denigrated Black people and basically said they can't get the IDs. Kamala Harris said rural folks can't get IDs. It is just too hard. That is BS. They know it is BS. The American people know it is BS. It is exactly

why 85 percent of Americans say we need to do this.

Let me just say that I come from a State that is the most unique State in the country because we have been, for years, requiring proof of citizenship when a person registers for a State ballot. We have to do that in Arizona, and we have had no suppression. We are the only State that does it because the Supreme Court ruled that way. Somehow, we can't do it for Federal ballots?

Mr. Speaker, think about that. For an alderman or legislator in Arizona, we have to show proof of citizenship to register to vote. We can't do it for the President, though. How absurd is that?

We have had no problems. There has been no voter suppression. They want to make it an issue because they don't want that proof, and we need to have that proof. Every rational American knows it is not suppression. It is common sense. That is why we need to show ID when we vote. It is popular in Arizona. It is popular across the country.

We need to show our citizenship when we register to vote. That is what has to happen in Arizona. It will work across the country. There is not a doubt in my mind, and I urge passage of this bill.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Let's talk about common sense for a second. When the gentleman from Texas introduced this bill, the effective date was in 2027. All of a sudden, because, I think, a right-winger on their side did a tweet that caused all kinds of chaos, they moved for it to take effect immediately, notwithstanding the fact we have primaries beginning in some States in a matter of just a few weeks.

I would just point out to the gentleman who just spoke that we have this thing called a Real ID. For 20 years, we have been trying to implement it. We spent billions of dollars trying to implement it and still not everybody has it. It has taken 20 years. My colleagues are pushing all these new changes on States. They have to do it in a matter of a couple of weeks?

We all know what this is about. We all know what this is about. People see through this. This is not about protecting our democracy. It is not about preventing undocumented immigrants from voting. That is already illegal in this country. This is about sowing confusion and chaos because they know they are going to lose the next election. What an underhanded way to deal with elections in our democracy. What an insult to the American people.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from California (Ms. SIMON).

Ms. SIMON. Mr. Speaker, I thank the ranking member for yielding time.

Mr. Speaker, this bill doesn't secure elections. It shrinks the electorate. I find it so interesting that in real time we are having this conversation. When we talk about Black voters, we are going to talk about Black voters.

This bill was written so poorly it doesn't even take into consideration women of all races who changed their names when they got married. It is ridiculous.

It has been a Federal crime, we know, for noncitizens to vote since 1996. Georgia audited 8.2 million voter registrations and found 20 noncitizens, Mr. Speaker, 20. That is the emergency. That is the emergency that justifies blocking 21 million American citizens who don't have the papers to fill what this bill demands. We all know the history.

Darnella Cavaness, my grandmother from Malvern, Arkansas, had to face the poll tax. After Reconstruction, nobody wrote the word "race" into a single suppression statute. They wrote poll taxes. They wrote literacy tests, good character clauses. It was all race neutral on paper but devastating in practice.

The SAVE America Act sits in that tradition. I will say it again. The SAVE America Act sits in that tradition.

I have a 14-year-old daughter. I won't stand here and make voting harder for her when she decides to register to vote.

Mr. Speaker, my colleagues on the other side of the aisle don't get to shrink the franchise. I urge a strong "no" from all of our colleagues who believe in a democracy that we were all promised.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Alabama (Mr. PALMER).

Mr. PALMER. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in support of this rule and the SAVE America Act. This essential legislation would require, as we have said previously, proof of citizenship when registering to vote and the presentation of a valid ID when at the ballot box. Currently, only 13 States do not require any form of voter ID. Having this requirement should be the standard and not the exception.

My Democratic colleagues claim that requiring a photo ID to vote is too burdensome. Some say it is too difficult for rural Americans and will lead to voter suppression. I grew up in rural America.

The reality is that Americans use photo IDs every day to carry out basic tasks like opening a bank account, boarding a flight, checking into a hotel, renting a car, or applying for a business license.

Americans use photo IDs to buy alcohol, tobacco, or nicotine products. They use it to sign a lease or rental agreement. It is also used to get a marriage license, purchase firearms or ammunition, check in for jury duty, or enroll in a college or university. Purchasing insurance or donating blood requires a photo ID.

I hope that people who don't have a photo ID don't get sick because they need a photo ID to purchase things like Sudafed, NyQuil, and Mucinex D. I hope they don't have to pick up a pack-

age at the post office because we have to have a photo ID to pick up a package at the post office.

If we require a photo ID to prevent fraud in these areas I just mentioned, why are my colleagues so opposed to preventing fraud in elections? It is hard to argue that a photo ID is too much to ask for in voting when Americans already use it routinely for far less important activities.

Mr. Speaker, protecting election integrity should be a priority. I urge my colleagues to support this rule and the underlying SAVE America Act to secure our elections.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to how much time is remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Texas has 18½ minutes remaining. The gentleman from Massachusetts has 15½ minutes remaining.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include in the RECORD an article from "ABC News" titled: "Election Fact Check: Noncitizens Can't Vote, and Instances Are 'Vanishingly Rare.'"

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

[From ABC News, Oct. 28, 2024]

ELECTION FACT CHECK: NONCITIZENS CAN'T VOTE, AND INSTANCES ARE 'VANISHINGLY RARE'

(By Peter Charalambous)

Former President Donald Trump and Republican leaders across the country have for months characterized the alleged scourge of noncitizen voting as a pressing threat to a free and fair election, using heated rhetoric to suggest that widespread illegal voting could tilt the scales toward Democrats in November.

But a spate of GOP-led inquiries in the weeks leading up to Election Day tell a different story, one that experts have long insisted is true: Noncitizen voting is extraordinarily rare.

Recent audits of voter rolls in states including Georgia, Ohio, and Iowa uncovered instances of noncitizen voting that overall amounted to only a tiny fraction of the states' overall number of registered voters.

A comprehensive audit of Georgia's voter rolls—which include 8.2 million registered voters uncovered 20 noncitizens who registered to vote, including nine instances when noncitizens actually cast a ballot. A similar audit of Iowa's 2.3 million voters revealed 87 instances where individuals cast ballots and later self-reported as noncitizens.

In Ohio, the state's attorney general, Dave Yost, recently announced indictments against six alleged noncitizens who had voted in a national election, after Ohio Secretary of State Frank LaRose identified 597 alleged noncitizens who had registered to vote in the state. Each of the six defendants were lawful residents but lacked citizenship when they voted.

"Irregularities like this are rare, and this is a small number of cases," Yost said on Tuesday. "We should all be confident in the upcoming election, knowing that the laws are being enforced and will continue to be enforced."

The nationwide push to root out noncitizen voting comes as Trump has made noncitizen voting a key part of his campaign message, telling his supporters that undocumented immigrants are set to vote in record num-

bers during the upcoming presidential election.

"Our elections are bad," Trump said at the ABC News presidential debate in September. "And a lot of these illegal immigrants coming in, they're trying to get them to vote. They can't even speak English, they don't know even know what country they're in practically, and these people are trying to get them to vote, and that's why they're allowing them to come into our country."

But with noncitizen voting in national elections already illegal and rare, critics have pointed to Trump's rhetoric and the national focus on noncitizen voting as an attempt to intentionally sow distrust and lay the potential groundwork for litigation to challenge the results of the election.

"It amounts to a vanishingly rare phenomenon that is not going to impact the outcome of our elections in any real way, and where the people who actually are violating the law are held accountable," said Sean Morales-Doyle, a voting rights expert at the Brennan Center for Justice, a non-profit think tank. "Both domestic and foreign folks are spreading these lies in order to undermine faith in American elections—some of them with the hope of overturning the result if they're not happy about it."

Across a sample of 23.5 million votes cast in 42 jurisdictions during the 2016 election, election officials identified 30 incidents of suspected noncitizen voting that were referred for further investigation, comprising 0.0001% of the total votes cast, according to a 2017 Brennan Center study. When Georgia audited its voter rolls in 2022, election officials were unable to identify a single instance of a noncitizen casting a ballot during an election.

Noncitizens are prohibited from voting in federal elections by a 1996 law that penalizes offenders with heavy fines, up to one year in prison, and deportation, which Morales-Doyle says further disincentivizes the crime.

"The payoff is casting one ballot in one election," Morales-Doyle said. "It is just mind-boggling to think that someone who has decided to move themselves and their family to the United States and try to build a life here is going to risk all of that, risk their freedom and their presence in the United States, to cast one ballot in one election."

Despite instances of noncitizen voting being rare and steeply penalized, Trump has made baseless claims that Democrats are allowing illegal immigration to encourage voter fraud in the upcoming election—a claim echoed by Republican allies such as House Speaker Mike Johnson.

"I think that ultimately they hope to turn all these illegals into voters for their side. It sounds sinister, but there's no other explanation for what's happening down there," said Johnson, who last month unsuccessfully tried to pass the SAVE Act to require documented proof of citizenship to vote.

Election experts have expressed concerns about states using unreliable data to flag and purge ineligible voters, which can accidentally ensnare eligible voters—such as Alabama resident Roald Hazelhoff, who became a citizen two years ago.

As Hazelhoff—who immigrated from Holland in the 1970s before putting down roots in Alabama and raising three children—was preparing to cast his ballot in his first national election earlier this year, he received a letter from the Alabama secretary of state notifying him that he was ineligible to vote. "This is intimidating," Hazelhoff told ABC News about the letter, which referred him for potential criminal prosecution because he registered to vote despite being previously issued a noncitizen identification number decades ago.

"If it happens in Venezuela, then you might expect a little bit of that," he said. "It should not be happening here. It just shouldn't."

Over the last month, the Department of Justice successfully stopped Alabama and Virginia from removing suspected noncitizens from their voter rolls because the purges violate federal law prohibiting states from striking names from voter registrations within 90 days of an election. Federal judges in both states have ordered election officials to restore the voter registrations of thousands of voters, including Hazelhoff.

"The evidence is out there that there is a very small percentage of individuals and organizations that are trying to derail the democratic process, and this is an example of it," Hazelhoff said. "It's misguided but it's also dangerous and it's intimidating."

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include in the RECORD an article from NPR titled: "Despite grand claims, a new report shows noncitizen voting hasn't materialized."

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

[From NPR, July 30, 2025]

DESPITE GRAND CLAIMS, A NEW REPORT SHOWS NONCITIZEN VOTING HASN'T MATERIALIZED

(By Miles Parks)

After President Trump and many other Republicans warned that vast numbers of non-U.S. citizens would influence last year's election, states and law enforcement have devoted more resources than ever before to root out those ineligible voters.

More than six months into Trump's second term, they haven't found much.

New research out Wednesday tracking state government efforts across the country confirms what election experts have said all along: Noncitizen voting occasionally happens but in minuscule numbers, and not in any coordinated way.

"Noncitizens are not a large threat to our election system currently," said David Becker, the executive director of the Center for Election Innovation & Research (CEIR), which conducted the research. "Even states that are looking everywhere to try to amplify the numbers of noncitizens . . . when they actually look, they find a surprisingly, shockingly small number."

CEIR spent roughly four months reviewing states' public disclosures about noncitizen voting, stretching back years. The organization shared its findings with NPR exclusively.

The report shows a wide disparity in how states have investigated the issue and what data officials in those states choose to make public. Many states have released no information, even though it's illegal for noncitizens to vote in federal elections and all voting officials do some type of maintenance to their voter rolls.

Some states, such as Michigan and Georgia, have undertaken audits of their entire voter rolls, using resources from the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) to check for noncitizens. Michigan officials announced in April that a review found that "cases of noncitizens casting a ballot in Michigan elections are extremely rare." The review found more than a dozen noncitizens appear to have illegally voted in the 2024 general election. That's 0.00028 percent of the state's total votes.

"We want to have no evidence of people who aren't eligible voting in our elections,"

Michigan Secretary of State Jocelyn Benson, a Democrat who's now running for governor, said in an interview after the audit was completed. "But this is a serious issue and it has to be addressed with a scalpel, not a sledgehammer."

DHS recently expanded and simplified the tool the agency offers states for those sorts of citizenship checks, so it's likely more states will perform similar audits in the future, though questions remain about how accurate the tool's new features are when it comes to citizenship verification.

Many conservatives say expanded security measures are also needed since one noncitizen vote is too many. But the CEIR report also details how officials in numerous Republican-controlled states last summer leaned into the sort of baseless narratives that Trump and Elon Musk were pushing about noncitizen voting by releasing inflated numbers of "potential" noncitizen voters.

In each case, Becker said, "you start seeing as they proceed and as we get past the political season—as the candidate that they supported gets elected—the numbers go down."

In Texas, "1,930 potential noncitizen" voters last summer turned this year into investigations into more than 100 potential noncitizen voters.

In Alabama last August, the secretary of state removed more than 3,000 supposed noncitizens from the state's rolls, only to be ordered by a judge to stop that program when thousands of those people were found to be U.S. citizens.

"The vast majority of allegations of noncitizen registration or voting appear to arise from misunderstandings, mischaracterizations, or outright fabrications about complex voter data," the CEIR report finds.

The report also noted that 18 states, which span the political spectrum, have not publicly disclosed finding or removing any noncitizen voters on their rolls.

No state has found any coordinated effort to get noncitizens to vote in the 2024 election.

When UCLA election law professor Rick Hasen was presented with the CEIR findings, he said he wasn't "surprised in the slightest."

"It really is not a big problem, both because on the individual level, it would be hard to get noncitizens to agree to it," Hasen said. "And on the broader level, it's just not a very cost-effective way to try to I steal an election."

Election officials note there are safeguards to prevent noncitizens from registering to vote, but the biggest deterrent is the fact that immigrants without legal status generally don't want to risk deportation to cast one ballot—especially because the inherent paper trail of voting makes it very easy to get caught.

Separate research has found that when noncitizens do register to vote, it's often due to bureaucratic errors or a misunderstanding about eligibility, as opposed to intentional fraud.

Still, the noncitizen voting myth has persisted for more than 100 years in American elections. Hasen expects it to come up again in 2026, even if states don't find any data to support it.

"Most people who make claims that noncitizen voting is a big problem are doing so for political purposes," Hasen said. "It's a way of demonizing immigrants. It's a way of trying to claim that Democrats cheat. And no amount of evidence is going to stop people from making politically expedient claims."

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include in the

RECORD an article from the Cato Institute titled: "Noncitizens Don't Illegally Vote in Detectable Numbers."

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

[From the CATO Blog Institute, Nov. 25, 2020]

NONCITIZENS DON'T ILLEGALLY VOTE IN DETECTABLE NUMBERS
(By Alex Nowrasteh)

One of the most frequent and less serious criticisms that comes across my desk is that immigration is bad because non-citizens vote illegally in such large numbers that sway elections. A new report by James D. Agresti, pushed by some news outlets, argues that the number of noncitizens who illegally voted in 2020 substantially increased Biden's vote share but did not affect the outcome of the election. It has been illegal for non-citizens to vote for federal elected officials since 1996, so these noncitizen voters would all be breaking federal law. Is the Agresti paper reliable? Are large numbers of noncitizens voting in federal elections to such an extent that several states voted for Biden as a result?

No, but to understand why you have to follow how the Agresti paper arrived at its conclusion. The Agresti report relies on a peer-reviewed academic paper by political scientists Jesse T. Richman, Gulshan A. Chattha, and David C. Earnest that was published in 2014 that estimates the rate at which noncitizens voted for president in 2008. Their paper relies upon responses to the Cooperative Congressional Election Study (CCES) for the 2008 election that found a substantial proportion of noncitizens voted in that year. The Agresti paper combined two figures from the Richman, Chattha, and Earnest paper to get their primary estimate that 15.8 percent of non-citizens voted in 2008. Agresti then applies that 15.8 percent rate to the non-citizen population in swing states in 2020 to reach their conclusion.

The big problem, as explained in two succinct pieces, is that non-citizens voting illegally is a small subset of a small population of Americans measured in the CCES survey. In the CCES survey, as in any survey, a certain number of respondents click the wrong box. Thus, some respondents will incorrectly click that they are non-citizens by accident and that they voted. Or they will make any number of other errors. This general problem is called measurement error and it afflicts every survey. These errors are common in surveys, but if it surveys enough people and there isn't a tragic flaw in design that causes large numbers of people to make the same error, then it doesn't matter much for the final result.

The problem is that the authors focused on a small number of non-citizens in a very large survey that likely accidentally said they were noncitizens who voted when they were really citizens who voted. The CCES survey asked about 20,000 people how they voted and about 19,500 of them said that they were U.S. citizens. Since the CCES is about federal elections, it oversamples citizens who can vote and under sample non-citizens who can't vote. In fact, the number of reported non-citizens in the CCES survey who said they voted in a federal election is just about exactly the number who should have misidentified themselves as non-citizens in such a large survey.

This problem arises because the survey was not designed to sample non-citizens, and the non-citizen category in the citizenship question is included for completeness and to identify those respondents who might be

non-citizens. We expect that most of that group are in fact non-citizens (85 of 105), but the very low level of misclassification of citizens, who comprise 97.4 percent of the sample, means that we expect that 19 “non-citizen” respondents (16.5 percent of all reported non-citizens) are citizens who are misclassified. And, those misclassified people can readily account for the observed vote among those who reported that they are non-citizens.

Survey misuse, misdesign, and misinterpretation is a serious problem that we all witnessed right after the 2020 election. This strain of research appears to be another instance of that. There are likely many problems with America’s voting system and there is no doubt that a non-zero number of non-citizens illegally voted, but there is no good evidence that noncitizens voted illegally in large enough numbers to actually shift the outcome of elections or even change the number of electoral votes.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include in the RECORD another piece from the Cato Institute titled: “Trump’s Claims About Noncitizen Voting Are False. We Can Prove It.”

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

[From the CATO Commentary Institute®, Feb. 5, 2026]

TRUMP’S CLAIMS ABOUT NONCITIZENS VOTING ARE FALSE. WE CAN PROVE IT.

(By Stephen Richer)

This week, President Trump called on his party to nationalize American elections, an unconstitutional move that he said would be justified because of the danger of noncitizens casting ballots. “These people were brought to our country to vote, and they vote illegally,” he said.

No president has so baldly proposed to intervene in state elections, but the charge that noncitizens are illegally casting ballots is sadly commonplace. Elon Musk claims on X, without evidence, that significant numbers of illegal immigrants vote. Rudy Giuliani erroneously alleged that my home state, Arizona, had allowed “probably about 250,000” votes from noncitizens in 2020, despite the fact that Arizona has long required proof of citizenship to vote in state elections.

Election officials usually respond to these allegations by pointing out that there are almost no prosecutions of fraudulent noncitizen voters. Reuters has noted that even the pro-Trump Heritage Foundation’s database of election crimes listed only 24 instances of noncitizens voting in U.S. elections from 2003 to 2023. While these rebuttals are correct, they are incomplete: Just because something isn’t prosecuted doesn’t mean it doesn’t happen. Happily, there is new compelling evidence debunking the false claims. Recently, a number of states have undertaken investigations into noncitizen voting, cross-checking voter rolls with citizenship status, and found it virtually nonexistent.

When confronted with allegations on non-citizens voting in Utah, Lt. Gov. Deidre Henderson, the state’s top election official, initiated a months-long review of Utah’s approximately 2.1 million registered voters. She and her team found one “confirmed noncitizen.” Just one. And that one noncitizen, while registered, had never voted.

Idaho, a state of one million voters, ran similar tests in 2024, and they found 36 “very likely” registered noncitizens. That may seem like a lot until you view it in light of

claims that statewide elections are altered by such anomalies. Some, but not all, of those 36 people have previously voted, the secretary of state, Phil McGrane, said, but “out of the million-plus registered voters we started with, we’re down to 10 thousandths of a percent” of the overall count—not even close to affecting the outcome.

Louisiana’s investigation in 2025 netted some 390 noncitizen registrants, 79 of whom had voted in at least one election over the last several decades (out of 2.9 million registrants). Just a few weeks ago, Montana found 23 possible noncitizen registrants (out of approximately 785,000 people registered). And Georgia, in some ways the model for these investigations, found in its 2024 audit 20 registered noncitizens (out of 8.2 million registrations). In my four years in office in Maricopa County overseeing voter registration, I came across a total of two possible instances of noncitizens voting out of some 2.5 million registered voters.

Some politicians are trying to exploit even these small numbers. In Michigan, the Macomb County clerk, Anthony Forlini, who is running for the top election office in the state, the secretary of state, recently announced to great fanfare that he’d found 15 noncitizens on his county’s voter rolls of over 724,000 registered voters. The incumbent secretary of state, Jocelyn Benson, then tasked her team with investigating the 15 files. It found that three of the people were U.S. citizens, four were previously removed from voter rolls, four were under further investigation and four do seem to be noncitizens.

These investigations affirm what is simply common sense. People largely aren’t willing to risk their status in the United States—the land of economic opportunity—for the ability to cast one more vote out of hundreds of thousands or millions in a state and hundreds of millions in the country.

The investigations also suggest that many politicians and public interest groups, all of which have access to these reports, may not actually care that much about election security. The constant talk of noncitizen voting is more likely about scoring political points and bolstering fund-raising.

Playing politics with the idea of fraudulent voters and stolen elections comes at a real cost to American confidence in our elections. It’s an affront to our democracy and to all those who work to deliver free and fair elections. It’s also an ominous sign for where things may be heading this year.

For President Trump, the myth of noncitizens voting is part of the broader story he’s concocted to avoid accepting that he lost to Joe Biden in 2020. But it also appears to be about this fall’s election. Mr. Trump may well intend to send the F.B.I. to run elections in Fulton County, Ga., or the Department of Homeland Security to seize ballot tabulators from Los Angeles County.

I don’t think it’s likely he will do so. But I also wouldn’t have predicted that the F.B.I. would take hundreds of boxes of 2020 election materials from Fulton County, as it did last week. And I certainly wouldn’t have predicted that Republicans would attempt to derail the electoral count on Jan. 6, 2021.

Everyone—Democrats and Republicans—should use the new state-level proof that noncitizen voting is virtually nonexistent to push back against the real danger to our democracy: craven politicians using the issue to undermine our free and fair elections.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include in the RECORD an article from the American Immigration Council titled: “Unpacking Myths About Noncitizen Voting—How Heritage Foundation’s Own Data Proves It’s Not a Problem.”

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

[From the American Immigration Council, Aug. 1, 2024]

UNPACKING MYTHS ABOUT NONCITIZEN VOTING—HOW HERITAGE FOUNDATION’S OWN DATA PROVES IT’S NOT A PROBLEM

(By Aaron Reichlin-Melnick)

Over the last decade, many politicians have called for overhauling the United States’ election systems by mandating strict voter ID for both registering to vote and actual voting. Many have justified this stance by either claiming the U.S. election system is vulnerable to fraud, or that fraud is already a common occurrence. In May, House Speaker Mike Johnson even said that, despite a lack of evidence, he knows “intuitively” that “a lot of illegals are voting in federal elections.” Throughout the Republican National Convention in July, similar claims abounded.

However, a close examination of the evidence put forward by proponents of these strict limitations on voting shows just how extraordinarily rare noncitizen voting truly is—and how there is no burning need to impose new restrictions on access to voting.

The conservative Heritage Foundation has campaigned hard against “voter fraud,” it proudly championed legislation passed by the House in July which would mandate the use of photo ID for all voter registration. Importantly, it also maintains a database of 1,546 “proven instances of voter fraud,” where Heritage researchers have collected criminal cases which have been brought against people who have committed some kind of electoral fraud, either registering to vote or voting when ineligible.

It’s this database—created and maintained by Heritage itself—that helps reveal how there is no crisis of noncitizen voting.

A close review of the cases in Heritage’s database reveal that the organization has documented just 68 total cases of noncitizen voting going back to the earliest cases documented in the 1980s. That’s less than 5 percent of the cases in their database, total. The remaining cases all involve U.S. citizens.

What do those 68 cases tell us? First, it demonstrates that proven cases of noncitizen voting are incredibly rare. Even an organization engaged in a major effort to document voter fraud produced fewer than 70 proven cases of noncitizens who voted in elections in the last 40 years. Given that over one billion votes have been cast over that period in thousands of elections, the incidence of proven noncitizen voting is below 0.0001 percent.

This is in line with other analysis carried out following recent elections. For example, a 2017 Brennan Center analysis of 42 jurisdictions which tabulated 23.5 million votes in the 2016 election found that noncitizens were referred for investigation in just 30 cases—or 0.0001 percent of votes.

Second, the data also tells us that proven cases of undocumented immigrants voting in elections are even rarer. Just 10 undocumented immigrants in total appear in the Heritage database for unlawful voting. Further investigation outside the database has uncovered one other instance; an elderly Cuban man with a work permit but no permanent lawful status, who was encouraged to vote by a poll worker in 2016. Several of the other 10 cases involve a person living under an assumed name and identity of a U.S. citizen or obtaining citizenship through fraudulent documentation. In those circumstances, the person voted under the identity of U.S. citizen with valid evidence of

status—even though they were not the person they claimed to be.

Third, the data tells us that most cases of noncitizen voting involve lawful permanent residents—people with green cards who have been in the community for years, many who end up voting due to bad information given by government officials themselves.

The most common scenario in the cases included in Heritage's database includes a lawful permanent resident who was encouraged by a government official to vote or falsely told that they were eligible.

For example, following the 2016 election, prosecutors in North Carolina conducted an extensive audit and charged 19 people with voting without being a citizen. Nearly all were lawful permanent residents who had not intended to violate the law. One defendant had already passed his citizenship test but had been turned away from the oath ceremony because the room was full and falsely thought he was already a U.S. citizen. Another defendant was a 70-year-old woman from South Korea who was encouraged to vote by a fellow church member and who was never turned away at a poll center despite presenting her green card as ID. In nearly all of these cases, the person pled guilty to misdemeanor offenses and were fined less than \$1,000.

The lessons to take from Heritage's own database are that noncitizen voting is not a serious problem and that to the extent rare cases occur, they would be best addressed by better training government workers to recognize immigration documents and follow procedure. The majority of the proven cases in the Heritage database would never have happened but for government workers making mistakes, yet few of the policies proposed by Heritage would even resolve these issues.

Thus, given that only an infinitesimally small number of noncitizens erroneously vote each election, politicians should abandon a misguided effort to transform our electoral systems at high expense and extremely low benefit.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to include in the RECORD an excerpt from an academic article from the journal on Electoral Studies titled: "An exploration of Donald Trump's allegations of massive voter fraud in the 2016 election," which finds:

"... expansive voter fraud concerns espoused by Donald Trump and those aligned with him are not grounded in any observable features of the 2016 election."

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Massachusetts?

There was no objection.

[From the Electoral Studies]

AN EXPLORATION OF DONALD TRUMP'S ALLEGATIONS OF MASSIVE VOTER FRAUD IN THE 2016 GENERAL ELECTION

(By David Cottrell, Michael C. Herron, Sean J. Westwood)

ABSTRACT

As Republican candidate for president and later 45th President of the United States, Donald Trump has claimed repeatedly and vociferously that the 2016 General Election was tainted by massive voter fraud. Here we use aggregate election statistics to study Trump's claims and focus on non-citizen populations across the country, state-specific allegations directed at California, New Hampshire, and Virginia, and the timing of election results. Consistent with existing lit-

erature, we do not uncover any evidence supportive of Trump's assertions about systematic voter fraud in 2016. Our results imply neither that there was no fraud at all in the 2016 General Election nor that this election's administration was error-free. They do strongly suggest, however, that the expansive voter fraud concerns espoused by Donald Trump and those allied with him are not grounded in any observable features of the 2016 election.

In addition to winning the Electoral College in a landslide, I won the popular vote if you deduct the millions of people who voted illegally—Donald Trump, November 27, 2016

1. INTRODUCTION

Regular and fair elections are the keystones of democratic governance (Lipset, 1959; Katz, 1997). These mechanisms translate voter preferences and opinions into elected officials, who ultimately make policy. Electoral fraud distorts the relationship between constituents and representatives, and for this reason alone the threat of voter fraud is inherently serious. Moreover, elections perceived as unfair can decrease electoral legitimacy (Norris, 2014), reduce governmental credibility (Magaloni, 2010), and undermine perceptions of voter efficacy (Elklit and Reynolds, 2002).

Insofar as it was repeatedly tarred by allegations of widespread voter fraud, the 2016 American General Election exemplifies these concerns. Despite a dearth of evidence that fraudulently cast ballots play an important role in American elections (e.g., Levitt, 2007; Minnite, 2010; Goel et al., 2016), as the Republican nominee for president Donald Trump claimed that he was at risk of losing the presidential contest to Democratic rival Hillary Clinton because of systematic voter fraud. Later as president-elect, Trump asserted that Clinton had received "millions" of improper votes, and he blamed his loss of the popular vote on illegal activity. And finally, as the 45th President of the United States, Trump asserted that voting in New Hampshire was tainted by fraud and that, in the absence of illegal Massachusetts voters, Trump would have won the Granite State's four electoral votes and then-United States Senator Kelly Ayotte, who lost a close election to former New Hampshire governor Maggie Hassan, would have been reelected.

Trump's expansive claims merit attention because of the role that elections play in democratic politics and on account of Trump's status—45th President of the United States. Moreover, assertions of voter fraud are a significant source of political division and conflict in American politics (Hasen, 2012; Bentele and O'Brien, 2013; Hicks et al., 2014), and they are believed by a non-trivial segment of the voting population (Ansolabehere and Persily, 2008; Stewart et al., 2016). Lastly, simply because there was little voter fraud prior to November, 2016, does not imply perforce that Trump's claims are necessarily vacuous; it is always possible that 2016 was the first year in which systematic voter fraud was a meaningful factor in a presidential contest. These points motivated us in mid-2016 to develop an election fraud research project premised on the question, what could we academics say about election fraud in the aftermath of the then-upcoming presidential election? Our concern as of the summer of 2016 was that Trump might suffer a close loss in his bid for the presidency and react by leveling widespread accusations of voter fraud that, in principle, could explain his defeat at the polls.

Given the tenor of the Clinton-Trump presidential contest at the time of the Republican and Democratic party conventions, we anticipated post-election fraud allegations that centered on illegal voters, in particular

non-citizens. To prepare ourselves to scrutinize such allegations, we assembled a county-level dataset that included historical election returns, demographics, and economic indicators. We also contracted with the Associated Press so that we would be able to access their national database on county presidential election returns. Our plan was to begin work on fraud allegations on Election Day evening (November 8, 2016), and we were prepared for an intense post-election week or two.

Since its inception, our research project has evolved in reaction to two developments. First Trump did not lose the 2016 presidential election; this relieved us of the pressure to investigate fraud allegations made in the aftermath of a close Trump loss. Second, and seemingly in spite of his victory, Trump continued to invoke the specter of widespread voter fraud. This latter development has spurred on our project, the result of which is this article.

We would like to draw particular attention to our use of the term, "widespread," in the sense of what we are calling allegations of widespread voter fraud. Donald Trump, as candidate and then later as president, has not anchored his voter fraud claims on the likelihood of a person, here or there, voting illegally. Rather, Trump and key supporters have spoken literally of "millions" of illegal votes, as our introductory quote makes clear. With this as context, our research project, an attempt to introduce scientific rigor into a debate largely dominated by bombastic claims, is not aimed at ferreting out what one might argue are more minor instances of voter fraud. While all instances of voter fraud are troubling, not all frauds are pivotal and not all frauds are systematic and widespread. Our research focuses solely on the possibility of massive and systematic fraud because fraud of this type in principle had the potential to be pivotal to the 2016 presidential election and because this is precisely the type of fraud against which Trump and his supporters, both before and after November, 2016, have regularly inveighed.

One can think of the analysis that follows as the proverbial canary, one that is an appropriate yet far-from-final step on the path of testing for voter fraud in the 2016 General Election. Detailed, individual-level audits, conducted on random samples of voters across jurisdictions spanning the United States, might be the ideal method to test for instances of voter fraud. However, in the absence of such audits, our analysis of aggregate county voting represents a valuable start. As will be clear shortly, we leverage variation in election outcomes across thousands of counties and connect that variation to a litany of explanatory variables, including counts of non-citizens provided by the American Community Survey. In the absence of a very expensive—and possibly unfeasible—audit of voter lists in jurisdictions across the United States, we believe that our aggregate analysis provides a significant advance in testing claims of voter fraud.

One could argue that an alternative method for testing voter fraud allegations would be to leverage a large-scale survey that questions respondents about say, citizenship status and voting history. Such a survey would have the benefit of assessing the eligibility of voters individually as opposed to in the aggregate. However, unlike an audit, a survey in this vein would depend on the accuracy of the information volunteered by its respondents. This dependence is exemplified by Richman et al. (2014), who use the Cooperative Congressional Election Study to analyze the voting behavior of self-identified non-citizens; drawing on survey data, they estimate that 1.2 million non-citizens voted

in the 2008 General Election. Ansolabehere et al. (2015) show, however, that this estimate reflects respondent data errors. Our use of aggregate data in conjunction with a corresponding lack of dependence on surveys allow us to avoid the sort of response problems that confound Richman, Chattha and Earnest.

We consider three allegations of voter fraud in the 2016 General Election: participation across the United States by non-citizens who supported Hillary Clinton in her presidential bid; concerns about voting in three states, California, New Hampshire, and Virginia, with particular attention to the possibility that Massachusetts voters tampered en masse with the United States Senate election in New Hampshire; and, finally, a conspiracy of election officials who attempted to “rig” the presidential election against Trump. The voter fraud accusations that we examine here span both national (non-citizen voting) and state-specific (e.g., New Hampshire), and all are associated with Donald Trump.

Briefly, we find little evidence consistent with widespread and systematic fraud fomented by non-citizens. Our analysis of returns in California, New Hampshire, and Virginia likewise turns up no evidence of problems in the vein raised by Donald Trump. And, our closer look at New Hampshire also yields nothing concrete. Lastly, and keeping in mind that the concern about a “rigged” election is ambiguous—we operationalized this idea by considering patterns in the way that election returns were released starting on the evening of November 8, 2016—we find no suspicious patterns in result timing.

Our results do not imply that there was no fraud at all in the 2016 presidential contest; indeed, we already know that the rate of fraud in the 2016 presidential election was not literally zero. Nor do our results imply that the administration of the 2016 General Election was error-free. Nonetheless, they do strongly suggest that Trump’s voter fraud allegations are not grounded in any observable features of the 2016 presidential election.

This article proceeds as follows. In the next section, we provide additional details on the motivation for and development of the research project whose results are described here. We then consider the aforementioned three sources of voter fraud, and we present results on them in sequence. Our final section concludes with suggestions for future research and how the academic community might want to consider studying voter fraud in upcoming elections.

2. STUDYING VOTER FRAUD: MOTIVATION AND PROJECT DEVELOPMENT

Allegations of voter fraud in the 2016 General Election from the Trump camp were alarmingly common. Beyond those already mentioned, Donald Trump and officials allied with him have asserted that records of deceased individuals are regularly used in the commission of voter fraud and insinuated that some urban areas, specifically Chicago, Philadelphia, and St. Louis, are hotbeds of fraudulent voting.

As Goel et al. (2016) summarize, there are three general classes of voter fraud: impersonation (a voter casts a ballot while claiming to be someone else), double-voting (an individual votes more than once), and ineligible voting (an individual who is not supposed to have access to the franchise in a particular location casts a ballot). A voter casting a ballot out of her jurisdiction is an example of the third type of fraud; this form of fraud would also characterize a citizen felon, who has lost the right to vote due to a state law restricting ex-felon voting rights (Manza and Uggen. 2006), improperly casting a ballot.

Efforts to uncover evidence of widespread voter fraud in American elections have come up empty. Surveys like Levitt (2007) and Minnite (2010) find only a small number of cases of verified voter fraud. Focusing on double-voting and using a database of 129 million individuals records, Goel et al. (2016) conclude that the maximum double-voting rate is approximate 0.02 percent and that “many, if not all, of [such] double votes could be a result of measurement error in turnout records” (p.30). Christensen and Schultz (2014) conclude that, “if [voter fraud] occurs, [it] is an isolated and rare occurrence in modern U.S. elections” (p. 313).

This literature notwithstanding, it is challenging to prove that rampant voter fraud does not exist. Indeed, proving a negative is in general a strenuous task. Even though existing findings on voter fraud are clear in the sense of not uncovering evidence of widespread conspiracies, one could always argue that scholars are simply looking in the wrong places. Providing proof of American citizenship, for example, is not needed when registering to vote in federal elections; instead, to register an individual needs only to swear under penalty of perjury that he or she is a citizen. Hence, it is theoretically possible for non-citizens to vote in federal elections in the United States and in so doing risk potential jail time and even deportation. Given the likelihood of being pivotal in an election, it is hard to believe that any non-citizen would want to behave in this way. Still, it remains the case that non-citizen voting is possible.

We know of no systematic audit of voter rolls that checks the citizenship status of individuals who voted. And it is not obvious how such an audit would proceed, given that there is no national identification system in the United States. Not all voters possess documents—like passports and birth certificates—that are definitive in the sense of proving citizenship. Thus, what one might call direct evidence of fraud might be difficult to come by, even in the presence of actual non-citizen voting.

While we lack the ability to verify the citizenship statuses of individual voters, we can nonetheless attempt to leverage the best data available to test national claims about widespread voter fraud. With this in mind, our research design and concomitant data are indirect insofar as our design seeks to identify downstream consequences of fraud as opposed to identifying directly which illegal voters cast ballots in the 2016 General Election.

If, as we wrote earlier, Trump were to have lost a dose election in November, 2016, and responded with accusations of fraud, there would be little time for election officials and scholars to respond to what might be serious accusations of impropriety. It is hard to imagine that a truly comprehensive study of voter fraud in any presidential election could be carefully executed prior to deadlines imposed by institutions such as the Electoral College. States were required, for example, to have resolved issues surrounding appointment of their Electors no later than December 13, 2016, six days prior to Electoral meetings on December 19, 2016.

Given what seemed like a plausible scenario as of the summer of 2016, we designed our fraud project to be national in scope and, most importantly, not conditioned on a particular post-election fraud claim. In addition, our approach needed to be feasible given data typically available in the aftermath of a presidential election. We did not want to rely on comparisons between election returns and pre-election polls or exit polls because comparisons like this are inevitably confounded with questions about sampling frames and representativeness.

In light of these exigencies, in the summer and early fall of 2016 we assembled an extensive county-level data set on historical election returns and other county features. Our plan was, starting on the evening of November 8, 2016, and as returns began to trickle in, to seek a rationalization of the presidential election using tools typically applied by academics studying presidential elections. We would then ask, do we observe across the country large and systematic deviations from our rationalization in a way that is redolent of the forms of voter fraud that Trump was regularly citing during his then-presidential campaign? Did we observe post-election, for example, evidence at the county level that the presence of certain classes of non-citizens was associated with increased support for Clinton? If we were to observe nothing like this, we would be more confident—albeit not completely confident—that voter fraud in the fashion envisioned by Trump did not play a pivotal role in the 2016 presidential election.

As we noted in the introduction, our plan was interrupted by two events. First, Trump did not lose the 2016 presidential election. Second, and despite his Electoral College victory, Trump has continued to maintain that the election was affected by widespread fraud and in so doing has leveled some specific claims. With these two developments in mind, neither of which we expected as of the summer of 2016, our research design reflects both continuity and change. With respect to the former, below we report results from our exercise of looking nationwide for evidence of voter fraud associated with non-citizens and a “rigged” election. Conducting research in this vein was our plan since mid-2016, and it would be inappropriate to abrogate a research project on voter fraud because the anticipated loser of an election turned out to be the winner. And with respect to the latter, given the specificity of some of Donald Trump’s post-election claims about voter fraud, we decided to focus attention on these claims to check if there is evidence consistent with them. Overall, our research design represents a compromise between adhering to a pre-election plan and reacting to events that we could not have anticipated. We will return to this compromise in the conclusion, when we consider future efforts aimed at studying widespread voter fraud.

3. RESULTS

Our results are in three sections. First, we offer a county-level analysis that addresses Donald Trump’s claims about non-citizen voter fraud; allegations about non-citizens were promulgated pre-election, and we highlight the possibility of non-citizen voting in California, New Hampshire, and Virginia, three states which were mentioned explicitly by Trump post-election. Second, we continue our focus on states by analyzing a specific, post-election claim about New Hampshire. And third, we consider the timing of election results, and this reflects pre-election claims about a rigged election. What follows draws on many sources of data, all of which are listed in the appendix.

3.1. Non-citizen voting

Here we address the possibility of non-citizen voting in the 2016 presidential election. Counties are the smallest jurisdictions in the United States for which presidential election returns are tabulated nationally, and our non-citizen voting analysis is thus conducted at the county level. Among New England states, election results are tabulated by town, which in principle could push us in the direction of a town-level analysis (towns are in general smaller than counties). However, outside of election returns, the other variables we use in our non-citizen analysis are not nationally available below the level of county.

Counties are aggregate units that range in size from hundreds of residents to hundreds of thousands. This said, in an ideal world a study of non-citizen voting in the 2016 General Election might take the form of an individual-level audit where lists voters in this election are compared against lists of American citizens. We already mentioned this in the introduction and noted as well that we know of no publicly-available list of American citizens. This point notwithstanding, an individual-level study of non-citizen voting would avoid possible ecological fallacies that our aggregate analysis risks (e.g. Kramer, 1483). However, ballot secrecy makes it impossible to model vote choice at anything but the aggregate level. Accordingly, the majority of work on election outcomes relies on aggregate election data (e.g., Brians and Grofman 2001; Wand et al., 2001; Beber et al. 2012).

We drop counties not present in the Associated Press election returns database, meaning, the state of Alaska and Kalawao County, Hawaii. We also drop Oglala Lakota County, South Dakota, which experienced changes to its Census coding after 2010 and two Virginia localities, the city of Bedford and Bedford County, the latter of which incorporated the former prior to the 2016 General election. Of the 3142 counties and county equivalents in the United States, our non-citizen analysis covers 3,111, equivalent to a coverage rate of approximately 99 percent. To keep our language as straightforward as possible, henceforth we refer to counties and county equivalents simply as counties.

3.1.1. Modeling approach

Our non-citizen voting analysis is based on a series of linear regression models. These models consider differences between a 2016 election variable—i.e., Hillary Clinton's vote share—and a corresponding variable from a previous election—i.e., Barack Obama's vote share from the 2012 General Election. The reason we model differences, as opposed to levels, in our study of non-citizen voting in the 2016 presidential election is because, intuitively, the former represent features of the election that require explanation. Whether Clinton did well in a particular county in the United States may be noteworthy (if, in contrast, Obama did badly there) or not (Obama did well there, too). If we want to understand whether widespread fraud affected the 2016 presidential contest, we argue that we should study the difference between Clinton's and Obama's vote share, not simply Clinton's alone.

Formally, our regression study of non-citizen voting in 2016 is based on three dependent variables. These variables are as follows:

Difference in Democratic vote share: the difference between Clinton's share of the two-party vote in 2016 and Democratic presidential candidate Barack Obama's share of the two-party vote in 2012.

Difference in Democratic turnout: the difference between the number of votes received by Clinton in 2016 and the number of votes received by Democratic presidential candidate Barack Obama in 2012, divided by citizen voting age population.

Difference in Republican turnout: the difference between the number of votes received by Trump in 2016 and the number of votes received by Republican presidential candidate Mitt Romney in 2012, divided by citizen voting age population.

Of the three dependent variables above, most important is the Clinton-Obama vote share difference. Per Donald Trump, noncitizens planned to turn out in November, 2016, and cast votes for Clinton. As such, the first place we should look for evidence of widespread non-citizen voter fraud is in an elevated Clinton vote share, relative to Obama,

in counties that contain disproportionately many non-citizens, *ceteris paribus*.

In terms of our second dependent variable, Trump's hypothesis of non-citizen voter fraud posits that, on account of ineligible voters casting ballots, there should be a surge (normalized by county size) in Democratic turnout in heavily non-citizens areas in the United States. If this were to have happened, then Clinton should have received more votes than Obama in counties with disproportionately many non-citizens, *ceteris paribus*.

We estimate a third regression with Trump-Romney turnout differences (total Trump votes from 2016 minus total Romney votes in 2012, normalized by county size) on its left hand side because this regression leads to a placebo test. Trump's theory of non-citizen voters is that they supported Hillary Clinton, not simply that non-citizens turned out to vote. With this in mind, a natural placebo test is one that involves the presence of non-citizens and Trump-Romney turnout differences. If we find evidence that counties with many non-citizens had disproportionately many Trump votes compared to Romney votes, *ceteris paribus*, that would indeed be odd. However, it would not look like the sort of non-citizen voter fraud that Trump predicted.

Our placebo test is useful because of potential misspecification problems in our regression analyses. These analyses are national in scope, which we believe is crucial, and purport to model election returns (vote share differences and turnout differences) in counties that differ from one another in size, partisanship, and economic conditions. Moreover, counties may differ in the extent to which their voters are politically mobilized, and this is very hard, if not impossible, to measure over the entire United States. Key political units in the country—United States Congressional Districts and state legislative districts, for example—do not coincide with county boundaries. This leads to a well-known problem in the study of American election administration: the geographies (counties) with the best data availability on socioeconomic variables are not units (for example, Congressional Districts) with particularly good political data (Chen, 2017).

Each presidential election is unique in some fashion, and it is hard to imagine that we can capture all of the important dynamics of the 2016 presidential contest with a county-level model. Our placebo test provides leverage over this problem.

Our regression models of vote share and turnout differences are grounded in the maintained hypothesis that the 2012 General Election was not affected by extensive and systematic voter fraud. This is consistent with literature already cited, none of which identifies fraud as a major problem in American presidential contests. Our use of differences also implies that we are not explicitly interested in understanding, say, where Clinton received more or fewer votes in 2016. This is an important matter for scholars of American electoral politics, but it is not our focus. Rather, we want to know where Clinton received more or fewer votes than one might have otherwise expected, based on how Obama performed in 2012, and whether these so-called extra votes were cast in locations with many non-citizens.

In terms of independent variables that ostensibly explain county-level vote share and turnout differences, our regressions contain control measures that draw on existing literature on American presidential elections. These variable touch on the role of the economy and retrospective evaluations in presidential voting (e.g. Bartels and Zaller, 2001; Fair, 2002; Cho and Gimpel 2009), the role of race (e.g., Tate, 1991; Abrajano and Alvarez

2010; Stout, 2015), and moral issues, which can be closely tied to religion (e.g., Hillygus and Shields 2005). We include as well in our regressions a measure of foreign born citizens insofar as immigration was a prominent feature of the 2016 presidential campaign. Finally, our regression models include state fixed effects, which are intended to proxy for across-state variability in areas like election administration and generic partisanship. To the extent that United State Senate races affected turnout and vote choices in the 2016 presidential rate, our state fixed effects should pick these up.

Beyond these control variables, our three regressions include the fraction of a county that is composed of non-citizens. This is the key variable in our study of non-citizen voting, and the tests that follow below turn on whether various non-citizen coefficient estimates are different than zero. That is to say, we want to know if the presence of non-citizens in counties is associated with unusual election vote share or turnout differences, even in the presence of variables that are routinely used to study aggregate vote choice in American presidential elections.

Our regression models have differences on their left hand sides (e.g., Clinton vote share from 2016 minus Obama vote share from 2012) yet include variables which purport to explain presidential vote share. Our logic here is as follows. To the extent that economic conditions are correlated with presidential vote shares, such conditions will also explain differences in candidates. Donald Trump's populist economic message in 2016 was not identical to Mitt Romney's in 2012, this despite the fact that both Trump and Romney are Republicans. When a county-level economic variable is correlated with Clinton-Obama vote share differences, then, it thus likely follows that this variable reflects the extent to which Trump's and Romney's economic messages (and, implicitly, Clinton's and Obama's messages) resonated with different slices of the American electorate.

3.12. County changes between 2012 and 2016

To fix intuition, Fig. 1 displays raw differences between Clinton's 2016 vote share and Obama's 2012 vote share. In the pictured map, darker (lighter) counties are those where Clinton lost (gained) vote share relative to Obama in 2012.

Fig. 1 shows that Trump was very successful in the upper Midwest, where Democrats lost significant support in 2016: Minnesota is quite dark, for example, as are most of Wisconsin and most of Iowa. In addition, there is a band of Trump support (that is, anti-Clinton support) in New England that starts in Maine and heads southwest, maintaining some distance from the east coast of the United States. Moreover, Clinton did poorly compared to Obama in parts of the West, notably in Nevada but not in Utah, where it appears Romney (as opposed to Obama) had particular support from the state's large Mormon community.

Perhaps the most notable pattern displayed by the map in Fig. 1 is the difference between urban and rural locations, the former of which saw gains in Democratic support. In the Midwest, for example, Chicago is lightly shaded, as are Detroit, Milwaukee, and Minneapolis-St. Paul. In contrast, less-urban counties in the periphery shifted in a pro-Republican, anti-Clinton direction. While Fig. 1 seems to suggest that Trump managed to gain an advantage in 2016 by securing the votes of the electorate living outside of major city centers, this sort of a map tends to over-represent conditions in non-urban counties, which are geographically expansive and hence relatively visible but at the same time lightly populated.

Fig. 2 contains a map of the total number of votes received by Clinton minus the number of votes received by Obama, normalized

by county citizen voting age population. The figure shows that Clinton-Obama turnout differences varied in similar locations as the previously shown Clinton-Obama vote share differences. This is particularly true in regions of the United States with large Mormon, immigrant, and minority populations, for example, in Utah, California, Texas, and Chicago. Fig. 2 suggests that voters in 2016 were mobilized, as one might expect, at different levels by county.

3.13. Regression results

Table 1 contains results of estimating three regressions involving vote share and turnout differences. Our regressions are estimated with least squares and are weighted by the total two-party vote in 2016 (difference in vote share regression) and the total number of Clinton votes in 2016 (the two turnout regressions).

Before turning to the non-citizen variable in our regression models, we summarize Table 1's control variable results. The Clinton-Obama vote share of the table column shows that, *ceteris paribus*, counties with disproportionately high unemployment, low income, many men, many uneducated whites, fewer Mormons, fewer Jews, and fewer Muslims had less support for Clinton in 2016 than they did for Obama in 2012 (that is, more support for Trump in 2016 than they did for Romney in 2012). The Clinton-Obama turnout column in Table 1 is roughly similar. And, the Trump-Romney turnout column implies that, in those counties where Trump underperformed Romney, voters moved to Clinton and not to third party candidates. It is also the case that, *ceteris paribus*, counties with high unemployment rates, large groups of unemployed white males and large Hispanic populations showed greater support for Trump than Romney.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, the final thing I will say before I yield to my colleague here is that not too long ago former Governor RICK SCOTT claimed erroneously that there were hundreds of thousands of undocumented immigrants registered to vote in Florida. He launched this massive investigation and spent all kinds of money investigating it. It was essentially a witch hunt.

I would ask my colleagues if they know how many people were prosecuted in that or convicted of any crime. One person was prosecuted.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Maryland (Mr. OLSZEWSKI).

□ 1140

Mr. OLSZEWSKI. Mr. Speaker, I thank the ranking member, the gentleman from Massachusetts (Mr. MCGOVERN), for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in opposition to this bill. It is a solution in search of a problem, as the gentleman from Massachusetts just pointed out.

My colleague pointed out earlier some polling numbers. Let me put another polling number out there. Mr. Speaker, 90 percent of Americans support universal background checks. If that is the standard, let's pass a universal background check right now. Let's save lives from senseless gun violence.

Republicans say that this bill will stop noncitizens from voting, but as the ranking member from the Rules

Committee pointed out, nonpartisan studies have found that over 24 years and out of hundreds of millions of votes cast, there has been proof of this happening exactly 77 times.

To be clear, voter fraud should be punished to the fullest extent of the law. We welcome conversations to do that, but that is not what this bill does.

Indeed, if my colleagues were serious about election integrity, we would include protections for American voters who are overseas, like the brave men and women of our military. We would provide free automatic IDs. We would allow same-day voter registration for eligible voters, and we wouldn't force married women to navigate even more bureaucratic obstacles. We wouldn't force States to turn over their voter rolls, and wouldn't actively discourage voting by mail.

Mr. Speaker, I have a different challenge for my colleagues from the Republican side. They should join me in focusing on what Americans actually need: relief from the crushing cost of living crisis in this country. Let's stop pretending that this bill defends democracy and start helping the people we represent.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no" on this rule and on this bill.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I am proud that this administration is relieving the devastating costs on the American people by creating economic growth and undoing a lot of the damage of the previous administration. We are seeing that on a daily basis.

Mr. Speaker, the gentleman is simply incorrect with respect to the amount of evidence that has mounted over people who are voting and should not be. The record is replete. In one example, ICE arrested criminal illegal alien Ian Andre Roberts, who was serving as the Des Moines, Iowa, school district superintendent at the time of his arrest. After his arrest, it was found that Roberts was a registered voter in Maryland despite his illegal immigration status and long criminal record. It was a criminal record filled with narcotics trafficking, driving vehicles he shouldn't have been driving, unauthorized possession of a firearm, and other crimes.

Yet we act like this isn't occurring. I have dozens of other examples right here of arrests that have been occurring this year.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Georgia (Mr. JACK).

Mr. JACK. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to voice my support for this rule and to commend my colleague, the gentleman from Texas (Mr. ROY). There is no greater advocate for law and order and election integrity than Mr. ROY, and the incredible people of Texas are well-served by his leadership and stewardship of our Constitution.

Mr. Speaker, the rule before us enables us to debate and vote on one of

the most consequential pieces of legislation concerning election integrity in our country's history. S. 1383, the SAVE America Act, will require voters to present photo identification to vote in Federal elections and to provide proof of U.S. citizenship when registering to vote.

Public opinion overwhelmingly supports this legislation, and it is our duty to adhere to the will of the people by swiftly passing this bill and sending the SAVE America Act to President Trump's desk for signature.

Mr. Speaker, you know me to be a data-oriented individual, so let us review the numbers before us as we debate this legislation.

Mr. Speaker, 83 percent of Americans favor requiring a government-issued photo ID in order to cast a ballot. By party, 95 percent of Republicans favor requiring photo ID to vote, and 71 percent of Democrats, the party across the aisle, favor requiring photo ID to vote. Hardly anyone, except, apparently, my colleague, the gentleman from Massachusetts, opposes photo ID requirements before the ballot box.

Another national survey confirms the very same truth that 84 percent of Americans want mandatory voter identification in Federal elections. This includes 98 percent of Republicans who want voter ID requirements along with 67 percent of Democrats. Most importantly, 83 percent of Americans want proof of citizenship when registering to vote for the first time in our country.

Mr. Speaker, the Framers of our Constitution intended for this House of Representatives to be the most accountable to the will of the people, and the will of the people is clear. We must pass this bill today and enact the SAVE America Act.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, the gentleman from Texas (Mr. ROY) read a list, and I asked him to yield to me, but he didn't want to. What the gentleman was doing was cherry-picking cases basically to sow distrust in our elections, just like Donald Trump does.

If the gentleman wants to read a list, I will read a list.

Matt DePerno, a former Michigan Republican State attorney general candidate, was charged with conspiracy and undue possession of a voting machine.

Former Republican Michigan State Representative Daire Rendon was also charged with conspiracy to commit undue possession of a voting machine and false pretenses. What was Ms. Rendon's punishment for this? The Republican Party promoted her to be the chairwoman of the party in her congressional district.

A Republican county clerk in Colorado, Tina Peters, is in prison for a scheme to breach voting systems, fueled by 2020 election conspiracy theories.

A Republican official in Georgia was fined for illegally voting multiple times.

A former GOP lawmaker in Arizona pled guilty to attempted election fraud involving forged signatures.

In North Carolina, four people pled guilty on Monday to misdemeanors for their roles in absentee ballot fraud in rural North Carolina during the 2016 and 2018 elections to help Republican congressional candidates.

Let's not even get into Donald Trump actually being recorded—it is recorded—asking for 11,800 votes to basically change the results in Georgia during the 2020 election.

If my Republican friends want to talk about voter fraud, look in the mirror. Look in the mirror and maybe remember that old saying: "Physician, heal thyself."

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from Texas (Ms. JOHNSON).

Ms. JOHNSON of Texas. Mr. Speaker, the SAVE America Act makes it harder for Americans to vote. As a member of the Subcommittee on Elections, my responsibility is to protect access at the ballot box, not to restrict it.

That is why I offered several comments and amendments to preserve on-line voter registration, ensure due process when an eligible citizen is denied the right to vote, mandate that citizenship only needs to be proven once, and allow the use of an expired passport to register to vote.

My amendments sought to limit the harm that this bill would cause and ensure that every citizen had accessible and secure ways to register and cast a ballot. This seems normal to me. This isn't about ID. This is about access. This is about procedures that will minimize the inconvenience to the United States citizens to cast their ballots.

Despite these facts, Republicans on the Rules Committee unanimously blocked these amendments from even being considered. That tells you everything you need to know. This isn't about making it easier for Americans to vote. It isn't about so-called election integrity. It is about tilting the playing field.

Republicans are losing support because voters aren't buying their ideas. Instead of changing their policies, they are trying to silence the American people at the ballot box. It is not working for their rigged, gerrymandered districts. It is not working for this effort to try to preclude people from registering to vote.

If Republicans really cared about people registering to vote, they would have online voter registration. The majority would make it to where people didn't have to go to one registrar's office in the middle of a county only during working hours when they are working their own shifts and they are not able to get there. How are people expected to register to vote under these rules?

If my Republican colleagues really cared, they would open it up. They would make online registration the rule and the law of the land.

It is shameful. It is undemocratic. I urge my colleagues in this Chamber to vote "no" on this bill.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I note that a couple of things that are important for the American people to see is that this administration has driven unemployment down to historic lows. Economic growth is now back up to close to 4 percent, we believe, in the fourth quarter, and we get those numbers at the end of February.

We are seeing, importantly, a massive surge in employment among American citizens. That is among native-born American citizens. The fact is that my colleagues on the other side of the aisle don't care about that. They don't want to ensure that we are protecting American citizens. They don't want to have voter identification, and they don't want to ensure that only citizens vote in American elections.

That is what this is about. It is pretty simple.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Virginia (Mr. CLINE).

□ 1150

Mr. CLINE. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman for yielding time on this important bill.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of the SAVE America Act. I am proud to cosponsor this bill.

Our democratic process depends on free, fair, and secure elections. When Americans cast their ballots, they have to have full confidence that their voice carries equal weight and that our elections are protected from abuse. Yet, in recent years, alarming loopholes that allow voting without proper identification, lengthy time to vote before elections, or time to register when you show up to vote have weakened the confidence in elections in States like mine, the Commonwealth of Virginia, and undermined a core principle of our democracy.

The right to vote is one of the most important privileges of American citizenship. That privilege must be safeguarded. Allowing individuals to vote without verifying their identity diminishes the voices of lawful voters and opens the door to illegal immigrants influencing our elections. That is unacceptable.

Illegal immigrants are here in this country. They came in by over the millions in the last 4 years. They are in California being given driver's licenses and then using those licenses to register to vote. It is happening all across the country. It is happening in States like Massachusetts.

I have an article from the Boston Herald, from February 8, 2026, titled: "Massachusetts jury convicts illegal immigrant of identity theft, stealing benefits, voter fraud."

This is an example of the type of voter fraud that is going on right here in our backyard and right in the backyard of the gentleman from Massachu-

setts. I would argue that this legislation is even more necessary now than ever.

When you had a Colombian woman unlawfully residing in Boston who was convicted 2 days ago, following a 5-day jury trial in Federal court, of identity theft offenses, including receiving rental assistance, Social Security, and SNAP benefits, as well as voter fraud under stolen identity, voting in several Federal elections, including the 2024 Presidential election, this is a real problem in Massachusetts right now. I would argue that we need to pass this legislation to actually take action.

The time for delay is over. I hope we can pass this today. I hope the Senate will take it up immediately to protect the integrity of our elections and preserve confidence in our democratic processes for generations to come.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that the article referred to by the gentleman from Virginia be included in the RECORD.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. WEBER of Texas). Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Texas?

There was no objection.

[From the Boston Herald]

MASSACHUSETTS JURY CONVICTS ILLEGAL IMMIGRANT OF IDENTITY THEFT, STEALING BENEFITS, VOTER FRAUD

A federal jury in Massachusetts has convicted a Colombian woman of living illegally in Boston under a stolen identity for more than 20 years and receiving over \$400,000 in stolen benefits.

Lina Maria Orovio-Hernandez, 59, who has remained in federal custody since her initial indictment last February, has also been convicted of using the stolen identity to vote in the 2024 presidential election.

Authorities say the woman obtained a Massachusetts Real ID and eight other state IDs through the stolen identity, which she also used to apply for a U.S. passport.

Massachusetts U.S. Attorney Leah Foley describes the crimes as a "slap in the face to all those who come into this country legally and abide by our laws."

"Ms. Orovio-Hernandez has lived in this country illegally for two decades, during which time she repeatedly made false statements, stole, committed fraud and even voted illegally," Foley said in a statement on Friday. "The air of entitlement is astounding. This case is yet another example of our commitment to rooting out those who violate our immigration laws and steal from United States Citizens."

Orovio-Hernandez used the stolen identity to submit a fraudulent voter registration form in January 2023 and then cast a fraudulent ballot in the 2024 presidential election.

The Colombian national also received more than \$400,000 in federal benefits: \$259,589 in Section 8 rental assistance benefits from October 2011 through January 2025; \$101,257 in Social Security disability benefits from July 2014 through January 2025; and \$43,348 in Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits from April 2005 through January 2025.

After a five-day trial in federal court in Boston, a jury convicted Orovio-Hernandez of one count of false representation of a Social Security number; one count of making a false statement in an application for a United States passport; one count of aggravated identity theft; three counts of receiving stolen government money or property; and one count of fraudulent voting.

Shawn Rice, a federal special agent in charge with the Department of Housing and Urban Development, said Orovio-Hernandez's actions were "not a one-time mistake or accident."

"Orovio-Hernandez's calculated deception caused her to fraudulently receive over \$400,000 in federal benefits including more than \$250,000 in HUD rental assistance," Rice said in a statement. "These taxpayer funds were intended to provide housing assistance to our most at-risk populations—low-income, disabled, and elderly United States citizens."

The Department of Homeland Security used Orovio-Hernandez's case last year to advertise how it updated the so-called Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements program, meant to stop voter fraud.

"Illegal aliens have exploited outdated systems to defraud Americans & taint our elections," DHS stated in a social media post last spring, around the time of Orovio-Hernandez's indictment.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I love the fact that all these guys have are statistically insignificant anecdotes that they like to put forward here.

The gentleman from Texas talked about how wonderful the economy was. This is an article that just appeared today. The Bureau of Labor Statistics found that U.S. employers added 181,000 jobs last year, far fewer than the 1.46 million that were added in 2024.

You may be impressed by that, but I am not a cheap date when it comes to making sure people have jobs in this country.

The gentleman from Texas said that we don't want to protect elections. We do. We want to protect them from you. We want to protect them from Trump. We want to protect them from all of you who are trying to suppress the vote, who are constantly in denial over the results of our elections.

Last night, we had Republicans come before the Committee on Rules, and they couldn't even bring themselves to say who won the 2020 election. They couldn't even say that Donald Trump lost Minnesota. They are so afraid of being punished by this administration. It is pathetic.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from Virginia (Ms. McCLELLAN).

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to direct their remarks to the Chair.

Ms. McCLELLAN. Mr. Speaker, voting rights are sacred. Many members of my family fought tooth and nail to be able to exercise that sacred right.

History may not repeat itself, but it sure does rhyme.

My great-grandfather, at the turn of the 19th century, in the name of making sure that citizens voted and election integrity, had to take a literacy test and find three White men to vouch for his character. He got all the questions right. Because his name was on a list of people that the State of Alabama didn't want to register to vote,

the registrar said: "I need more questions because this nigger got them all right." He got all of them right, and he registered to vote. Yet, my father and my grandfather had to pay poll taxes to be able to vote in Tennessee.

All of this was done to make sure that local election officials could deny people they didn't want to vote the ability to vote. I took my oath of office on the Bible where my father kept his poll tax receipt, which is behind me. He kept it in there because it was a sacred right.

I swore to uphold, protect, and defend the Constitution of the United States, all of it. That includes the 24th Amendment, which banned poll taxes.

Yet, the SAVE America Act is a modern-day poll tax because every ID that you would have to use to register and to vote, with maybe one exception, costs money. The one that is free is a military ID.

For our military who are overseas or not able to get home to register in person, it is an added burden. For rural communities, it is an added burden. For people of color, it is an added burden. For the 21 million American citizens who don't have ready access to these documents, it is a burden.

The right to vote is sacred, and I will fight any effort to put more barriers in citizens' way to exercise it, and that is exactly what the SAVE America Act does. That is why I will oppose it.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to the time remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Texas has 12½ minutes remaining. The gentleman from Massachusetts has 6½ minutes remaining.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from South Carolina (Mrs. BIGGS), my good friend.

Mrs. BIGGS of South Carolina. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Texas (Mr. ROY), my friend and colleague, for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of the rule. The American people deserve elections that they can trust, and this rule moves us just one step closer to restoring that trust.

It is simple. Only American citizens should be voting in American elections. I can't believe we are even having to say that.

Right now, our system has real gaps, and the longer we ignore them, the more confidence we lose. Some of the left would rather keep those loopholes wide open than ensure the integrity of our elections.

We have already seen what happens when Washington refuses to act. We have seen the chaos at the border. We cannot let that chaos spill over into the ballot box. The SAVE America Act helps prevent that.

This bill delivers on one of President Trump's top priorities, and that is to secure our elections and to make sure only citizens vote. That is not controversial. That is the standard voters are demanding.

Let's do what is right. Let's pass this rule and move the bill forward.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I disagree very strongly with what was just said. I don't see Trump trying to preserve our elections. I have been witnessing him trying to undermine trust in our elections and to rig our elections.

Mr. Speaker, the bill before us is a prime example of how awful the process has been under this Republican majority. The SAVE America Act was introduced by the gentleman of Texas just 12 days ago, and it included significant changes from its original version, the SAVE Act.

After the SAVE America Act's initial introduction, the Committee on Rules posted a complete rewrite of it last Friday. Even after two sweeping rounds of edits, Republicans were not done changing their half-baked bill. Yesterday, they posted a manager's amendment, which makes more changes, including changing when the bill would take effect and which voter IDs would be acceptable. We have seen three totally different versions of this bill in a dozen days.

It is important to say that all of these changes were backroom deals. There were no hearings, no markups, no regular order. The chairman of the Committee on House Administration didn't even feign a desire to include rank-and-file members in the process. He actually requested a completely closed rule for this bill.

Mr. Speaker, bad process is not a rare occurrence around here. It is a fundamental feature of Republican governance. Last Congress, Republican leadership made history for running the most closed, unproductive, dysfunctional Congress in modern American history. This Congress, Republicans have only doubled down on this shameful record.

Eighty-four percent of measures that Republicans have sent to the House floor have been totally closed, no amendments, no discussion, no democracy, just take it or leave it. Republican leadership has blocked 82 percent of amendments submitted to the Committee on Rules, over 3,300 amendments blocked, including most Republican amendments, and over 60 percent of bipartisan amendments.

If you are a Democrat, forget it. I am not sure they even read what we submit.

This blockade on amendments is leading to some shameful records. For example, this Republican majority set a record for the fewest House votes cast in the first session of a 2-year Congress in over 35 years. Under Speaker JOHNSON, the Committee on Rules is where democracy goes to die.

With that in mind, Mr. Speaker, why should we trust Republicans to rewrite voting laws when they are setting records for blocking voting in the people's House? This Republican Congress is an insult to the American people and a disgrace to our democracy.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

□ 1200

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I would note that when the gentleman from Massachusetts tries to dismiss the supposed trivial or anecdotal or cherry-picked cases, there are so many that it would take me more time than I have to read through them all of prosecutions for voter fraud and individual instances of voter fraud.

We have one here of Angelica Maria Francesco in Alabama in 2024, an illegal alien charged by Federal authorities with nine criminal counts in connection with her fraudulent assumption of the identity of a U.S. citizen, including voter fraud.

We have Alford Nelson, as known as Alford Samuels, in Florida in 2024. Alford Nelson was known as Alford Samuels, among several other aliases. He was charged by the Florida Department of Law Enforcement in Broward County with two felony counts of voting as an unqualified elector. Nelson, illegal alien, unlawfully voted by mail.

I can keep on going on and on and keep going down the list. It is real. The only thing that we are putting forward is a common sense proposal to ensure that only citizens vote in American elections and that we provide voter ID at the polls.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Utah (Mr. KENNEDY).

Mr. KENNEDY of Utah. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to stand in support of the SAVE America Act.

Consider the simple realities of life. In this country, you are required to show an ID to drive a car, to board an airplane, or to cash a paycheck. These are routine requirements for everyday participation in our society. Yet, for the most fundamental act of a self-governing people, the right to vote, that same standard of verification is missing.

Let us be clear. Despite the rhetoric, this is not about creating hurdles at the polling place. It is about the integrity of the registration process. As Americans, our right to vote is sacred, but that right is only as strong as a system that protects it. When one single illegal vote is cast, a legal vote is diluted. When a foreign national influences an election, the voice of an American citizen is silenced. This isn't a hypothetical concern. It is a matter of protecting the value of everyone's choice.

The SAVE America Act is guided by one simple principle: Only Americans should decide American elections.

Across this country, we have seen noncitizens identified on voter rolls. This is a vulnerability we can no longer afford to ignore. By passing this act, we provide the public with the one thing our political system needs most: trust—trust that the process is secure; trust that the rules are followed; and trust that every legal vote counts.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to join me. Let us unify around the democratic principles that built this Republic. Let us pass the SAVE America Act

to keep our elections exclusively in the hands of the American people.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I would say to the gentleman from Texas I appreciate him reading that list, but the reason we know about that is because those people were caught. The list I read of Republican officials who were caught engaging in voter fraud, the reason we know about it because they were caught. The system is working. Stop trying to sow division and chaos into our electoral system.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Alabama (Mr. PALMER), my friend.

Mr. PALMER. Mr. Speaker, I point out that in 2005, 18 of the 21 members of a bipartisan Federal commission headed by former President Jimmy Carter and former Secretary of State James Baker came out in support of photo ID requirements more stringent than what Indiana had at that time. "Voters in nearly 100 democracies use a photo identification card without fear of infringement on their rights," the commission stated.

In regard to voter registration fraud, just last year, six people were indicted for fraudulent voter registration forms submitted ahead of last year's Presidential election.

The allegations of fraud appeared to be motivated by the defendants' desire to make money and to keep their jobs and was not an effort to influence the election, so said the Pennsylvania Attorney General Dave Sunday. It really doesn't matter what the motivation is. What matters is the result—fraudulent voter registrations.

Back in 2008, there was an organization called ACORN. There was an ACORN whistleblower who worked for both it and its Project Vote registration affiliate from 2005 until 2006. She said: It is ludicrous to say that fake registrations can't become fraudulent voters. She said: I assure you if you can get them on the rolls, you can get them to vote, especially using absentee ballots.

There were documents that were provided by the whistleblower that indicated that the goal of ACORN's New Mexico affiliate was that only 40 percent of its submitted registrations had to be valid.

I think fraudulent voter registration is a problem. I think requiring a valid photo ID, as President Jimmy Carter and former Secretary of State Jim Baker said, is totally a way to ensure integrity in our elections and is not a burden on the people.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I thank my friend from Alabama, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself 30 seconds.

Mr. Speaker, I ask the gentleman from Texas who wrote this bill: How the hell are States supposed to implement this new bill in a matter a few weeks? His original bill gave States

until 2027. We have primaries coming up in a matter of a couple of weeks. How the hell is this going to be implemented, Mr. Speaker? This is ridiculous. This is about sowing division and chaos in our elections. The bottom line is it is a rotten thing to do.

People want to participate in our democracy. They want to vote. I am going to tell you, I can't wait until the next election because they are going to vote you guys right out of office. The economy stinks under this administration. I mean, the rhetoric coming out of this White House is appalling. Enough.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, my colleagues on the other side of the aisle made a number of claims about this legislation. With respect to the gentleman's question, I would tell you that what we are talking about with respect to voter identification is simply a presentation of voter identification.

Thirty-six States already have voter identification requirements. To the extent that we are able to get this passed, as I hope we will and signed into law in the next month or two, we will have the ability that States can immediately be able to implement voter identification, present true voter ID. That is it, present it.

With respect to the other claims, claims about the implications for married women, the fact is that the SAVE America Act does not, as is alleged, disenfranchise voters but, rather, it provides a very specific process for anyone who changes his or her name to register to vote, including by signing an affidavit.

We believe the original form of the SAVE Act would have provided ample ability for States to have taken care of it, but we went ahead and added an additional provision to ensure that the affidavit process was there for the small fraction of the population it might have impacted. We wanted to ensure there was no chance of issues.

Questions were raised about our uniformed personnel, our men and women who serve this country overseas. We believe our previous version would have made it fine for them to be able to do what they needed to do to register to vote and vote, but we made a clarification to ensure that UOCAVA governs what happens with our men and women in uniform. We have made every attempt to work to ensure that this bill is doing exactly what it is intended to do, which is ensure that only citizens vote and that we present voter ID at the polls.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Georgia, (Mr. PALMER).

□ 1210

Mr. CLYDE. Mr. Speaker, I appreciate my good friend from Texas for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, the question I wanted to ask to my Democratic colleagues is

that since they have made it abundantly clear that Democrats strongly oppose photo identification in order to vote, now that is a First Amendment right, so am I correct in assuming that Democrats also strongly oppose a government-issued photo ID to exercise a person's Second Amendment right? So, therefore, no ID required to buy a firearm.

If they are going to be against voter ID to exercise a First Amendment right, then I would assume also that they would be against photo ID to exercise a Second Amendment right.

I have not seen any legislation from my Democrat colleagues to do that, so I really don't believe that. I think it is all a hoax.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I am not going to respond to the gentleman who characterized January 6 as a normal day of tourism here.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I would just like to offer, as I have done already, a number of examples, numerous other examples, of individuals committing fraud.

Laura Janeth Garza in Texas, a Mexican citizen, pled guilty to two felony charges of voter impersonation and ineligible voting. Garza stole the identity of her cousin, a U.S. citizen.

Another example is that of Mario Obdulio Orellana in Texas, a 57-year-old El Salvadoran national, who was indicted by the Department of Justice on Federal immigration and voter fraud violations.

Now, I could go down and give more and more examples. The fact is, yes, these are good examples in which we have been able to intervene and stop this voter fraud and identify the individuals and prosecute those individuals.

However, we know that there is significant additional fraud going on that we are not capturing and that we are not catching. There is a very simple and basic premise of those who have been in a prosecutorial function, which is that you only catch so many people. In this case, we have been going after some individuals, but we can certainly prevent any further abuse of our voter elections. Making sure that we have integrity in those elections is to make sure we have voter identification and ensure that only citizens are voting.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman for pointing out these anecdotal cases of voter fraud, and I appreciate the fact that he mentioned they were all caught, just like all the Republican officials that I read, and I have a volume more that I could read. They were caught, so it sounds like the system works.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I am prepared to close if the gentleman from Massachusetts is prepared to close.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I am prepared to close.

Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to how much time I have remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Massachusetts has 3 minutes remaining.

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

Mr. Speaker, let me state, again, for the gentleman from Texas, because he doesn't seem to understand me: Nobody should vote illegally.

If this is the rampant problem they say it is, then maybe he should call Pam Bondi and ask her why she has only secured one or two voter fraud convictions nationwide out of over 155 million votes cast in 2024.

Maybe he should explain to us why his solution to a small handful of voter fraud cases is to punish the 155 million American citizens who did vote by making it harder for them to vote the next time.

Again, Republicans keep insisting there is this massive voter fraud conspiracy. The onus is on them to prove their absurd claim. Every time they try, every time this is investigated by States, by commissions, and by prosecutors, the result is the same: no widespread voter fraud conspiracy. There have been billions of votes cast over decades and a teeny tiny percentage of fraud. That is not a crisis, and it certainly is not a justification to rewrite the rules of democracy. But that is what is happening with the Republican lies to erode the trust in our democracy. That is why this bill is so toxic.

Again, the SAVE America Act tells millions of Americans: You have to show up in person and jump through hoops just to register to vote. Mr. Speaker, you can file your taxes online, you can pay your bills online, and you can get your medical results online, but if this bill passes, you can't fully register to vote online. That is nuts.

You have to buy a passport, Mr. Speaker—that is \$130—or you have to buy a copy of your birth certificate. Good luck, because you might even have to pick that up in person. What if a person lives in a rural community and has to drive 100 miles round trip just to get to the clerk's office?

What if they can't afford to take the day off from work just to register to vote?

Who gets punished?

They are students, seniors, Americans with disabilities, and working parents who just can't leave a shift early to stand in line at a clerk's office window that closes at 5:00.

We know this isn't really about voter fraud. It is not about protecting our elections. This is a smokescreen. It is a distraction. If Republicans wanted to protect elections, they would be focused on real threats: cyberattacks,

foreign interference, disinformation, intimidation, and violence against election workers. That is where the real danger is. Yet this bill does nothing to address those things.

The SAVE America Act is about denying elections and sowing distress in our system. That is because, according to Donald Trump, it is only fair and square when he wins. When Democrats win, then it is fraud. That is their whole argument in a nutshell.

The most ironic thing of all is that Republican leaders are the ones who seem to commit voter fraud the most. A Republican county clerk in Colorado is in prison for a scheme to breach voting systems fueled by 2020 election conspiracy theories. A Republican official in Georgia was fined for illegally voting multiple times. There was a former GOP lawmaker in Arizona.

Mr. Speaker, this isn't about voter suppression. This is a lousy bill, and I urge my colleagues to vote "no."

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman from Massachusetts has expired.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to how much time I have remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Texas has 2½ minutes remaining.

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, the gentleman from Massachusetts said that we are just doing this legislation because we are afraid of losing this election.

The fact of the matter is we are not. We want to ensure that we win this election by getting the votes of American citizens and not noncitizens. It is pretty simple.

I would note that the gentleman dismisses as trivial, or as the process working, the examples that we have given in the RECORD of the countless times where individuals have engaged in voter fraud and they have been caught and prosecuted. I would also like to point out that they were caught after they voted. That is the problem.

The core issue here is a very simple one. We all agree Americans overwhelmingly believe by polls and by all indication that only American citizens should vote in American elections. We currently have a problem. We even have problems where noncitizens sometimes don't know they are doing something wrong.

We should be very clear: When you register to vote, you are a citizen. When you show up to vote, you present voter identification. That is all that we do.

Mr. Speaker, in a few minutes, I will offer an amendment to the rule. The amendment will make a technical correction to the manager's amendment to reflect the intent.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 45 seconds to the gentleman from Massachusetts (Mr. McGOVERN).

Mr. McGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I know mistakes happen, but just so everyone knows what is happening here:

You introduced a bill less than 2 weeks ago. Then you gutted that with a substitute amendment. Then you changed that version with a manager's amendment. Now you have to fix that amendment.

There was no hearing, no markup, and a slew of changes and fixes in a matter of days. It makes you wonder what other mistakes there are, all to make it harder for millions of people to vote.

I would just say to my colleagues: Slow down. Do this process right. You want to implement this bill in a matter of weeks when we have primary elections coming up in a matter of weeks? I mean, it should give everybody pause. This process of legislating here needs to improve.

AMENDMENT OFFERED BY MR. ROY

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to amend the pending resolution with an amendment that I have placed at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will report the amendment.

The Clerk read as follows:

In the first section of the resolution, insert "(as modified by the amendment specified in section 6 of this resolution)" after "accompanying this resolution".

Add at the end the following:

"SEC. 6. The amendment referred to in the first section of this resolution is as follows: 'Strike the instruction to page 31, line 4, and insert the following:

"Page 31, line 3, strike 'apply with respect' and all that follows through page 31, line 5, and insert 'take effect on the date of the enactment of this section, and shall apply with respect to elections for Federal office held on or after such date.'"

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Texas?

There was no objection.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The resolution is amended.

The material previously referred to by Mr. MCGOVERN is as follows:

AN AMENDMENT TO H. RES. 1057 OFFERED BY MR. MCGOVERN OF MASSACHUSETTS

Strike the first section to follow the resolving clause, insert the following, and redesignate the subsequent sections accordingly:

That upon adoption of this resolution it shall be in order to consider in the House the bill (S. 1383) to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access, and for other purposes. All points of order against consideration of the bill are waived. An amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 119-19, modified by the amendment printed in the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution, shall be considered as adopted. The bill, as amended, shall be considered as read. All points of order against provisions in the bill, as amended, are waived. The previous question shall be considered as ordered on the bill, as amended, and on any amendment thereto, to final passage without intervening motion except: (1) one hour of debate equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on House Administration or their respective designees; (2) the further amendment specified in section 2 of this resolution, if offered by Representative Morelle of New York or a des-

ignee, which shall be in order without intervention of any point of order, shall be considered as read, shall be separately debatable for 10 minutes equally divided and controlled by the proponent and an opponent, and shall not be subject to a demand for division of the question; and (3) one motion to commit.

SEC. 2. The amendment referred to in section 1 is as follows:

Page 1, strike line 1 and all that follows and insert the following:

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the "Restore Trust in Government Act".

SEC. 2. RESTRICTIONS ON TRADE AND OWNERSHIP OF COVERED INVESTMENTS.

(a) TABLE OF CONTENTS.—The table of contents for chapter 131 of title 5, United States Code, is amended by adding at the end the following:

SUBCHAPTER IV. RESTRICTIONS ON TRADE AND OWNERSHIP OF COVERED INVESTMENTS

13151. Definitions.

13152. Trade and ownership of covered investments.

13153. Penalties.

(b) RESTRICTIONS.—Chapter 131 of title 5, United States Code, is amended by adding at the end a new subchapter:

"SUBCHAPTER IV—RESTRICTIONS ON TRADE AND OWNERSHIP OF COVERED INVESTMENTS

"§ 13151. Definitions

"In this subchapter:

"(1) COMMODITY.—The term 'commodity'—

"(A) has the meaning given the term in section 1a of the Commodity Exchange Act (7 U.S.C. 1a); and

"(B) does not include a precious metal (as defined in section 1027.100 of title 31, Code of Federal Regulations).

"(2) COVERED INDIVIDUAL.—The term 'covered individual' means any of the following:

"(A) A Member of Congress, as defined in section 13101.

"(B) A dependent child (as defined in section 13101) or a spouse of a Member of Congress.

"(C) A trustee of a trust in which an individual described in subparagraph (A) or (B) has a beneficial interest in the principal or income of the trust as described in section 1403(b)(5) of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986.

"(D) The President, or the spouse or a dependent child (as defined in section 13101) of the President.

"(E) The Vice President, or the spouse or a dependent child (as defined in section 13101) of the Vice President.

"(3) COVERED INVESTMENT.—The term 'covered investment'—

"(A) means an investment in a security, a commodity, a future, or any comparable economic interest acquired through synthetic means, such as the use of a derivative, including an option, warrant, or other similar means; and

"(B) does not include—

"(i) a widely held investment fund described in section 13104(f)(8) that is diversified and publicly traded on a national or regional stock exchange;

"(ii) a United States Treasury bill, note, or bond;

"(iii) a State or municipal government bill, note, or bond;

"(iv) any compensation received by a spouse or a dependent child described in paragraph (2) from an employer of the spouse or dependent child;

"(v) an interest in a small business concern and, in the case of an investment in a family farm or ranch that qualifies as an interest in a small business concern, a future or com-

modity directly related to the farming activities and products of the farm or ranch;

"(vi) an interest in a limited liability company created for the sole purpose of purchasing or holding real estate that serves as the personal residences of the Member of Congress;

"(vii) any share of Settlement Common Stock issued under section 7(g)(1)(A) of the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act (43 U.S.C. 1606(g)(1)(A)); or

"(viii) any share of Settlement Common Stock, as defined in section 3 of the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act (43 U.S.C. 1602).

"(4) DIVERSIFIED.—The term 'diversified', with respect to an investment fund, means such fund does not have a stated policy of concentrating its investments in any industry, business, single country other than the United States, or bonds of a single State within the United States except for the State in which the Member of Congress resides.

"(5) FUTURE.—The term 'future' means a financial contract obligating the buyer to purchase an asset or the seller to sell an asset, such as a physical commodity or a financial investment, at a predetermined future date and price.

"(6) SECURITY.—The term 'security' has the meaning given the term in section 3(a) of the Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (15 U.S.C. 78c(a)).

"(7) SMALL BUSINESS CONCERN.—The term 'small business concern' has the meaning given that term under section 3 of the Small Business Act (15 U.S.C. 632).

"(8) SUPERVISING ETHICS OFFICE.—The term 'supervising ethics office' has the meaning given the term in section 13101.

"§ 13152. Trade and ownership of covered investments

"(a) CONDUCT DURING FEDERAL SERVICE.—Except as described in subsection (b)(1)(B) and subsections (e) through (g), no covered individual may, directly or indirectly, own or trade a covered investment.

"(b) COMPLIANCE.—

"(1) REQUIREMENT.—To comply with subsection (a)—

"(A) a covered individual may not purchase a covered investment; and

"(B) a covered individual shall divest of any covered investment by the effective date established in paragraph (2) at fair market value.

"(2) EFFECTIVE DATE.—The effective date is established as follows:

"(A) 180 days for an individual who is a covered individual on the date of enactment of the Restore Trust in Government Act.

"(B) 90 days within the date on which an individual becomes a covered individual if such date occurs after the date of enactment of the Restore Trust in Government Act.

"(c) CERTIFICATES OF DIVESTITURE.—

"(1) APPLICATION OF CERTIFICATE OF DIVESTITURE PROGRAM.—For purposes of section 1043 of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986—

"(A) this section shall be treated as a Federal conflict of interest statute;

"(B) any covered individual described in section 13151(2)(A) shall be treated as an eligible person described in section 1043(b)(1)(A) of such Code; and

"(C) any spouse or dependent child described in section 13151(2)(B) shall be treated as an eligible person described in section 1043(b)(1)(B) of such Code.

"(2) ISSUANCE OF CERTIFICATE OF DIVESTITURE.—

"(A) IN GENERAL.—Each supervising ethics office shall issue a certificate of divestiture to each covered individual required to divest under this subchapter upon submission of proof of compliance by such individual with the requirements to divest or any extensions granted by the supervising ethics office.

“(B) ELIGIBILITY.—Such certificate shall include an identification of each specific property eligible for the application of the certificate of divestiture program as determined by the supervising ethics office.

“(d) INCOME TAX.—A loss from a transaction or holding involving a covered financial instrument that is conducted in violation of this section may not be deducted from the amount of income tax owed by the covered individual.

“(e) OCCUPATIONAL EXCEPTION.—A spouse or dependent child of a covered individual as described in section 13151(2)(B) may trade any covered investment if such covered investment is not owned by a covered individual and if such trade is performed as a function of the primary occupation of the spouse or dependent child.

“(f) TRUSTS.—

“(1) QUALIFIED BLIND TRUST.—Any covered investment held in a qualified blind trust as defined in section 13104(f)(3) shall be divested in accordance with subsection (b)(1)(B) by the effective date established in subsection (b)(2).

“(2) FAMILY TRUST.—A supervising ethics office may grant an exemption for covered investments held in a family trust only if—

“(A) no covered individual—

“(i) is a grantor of the family trust;

“(ii) contributed any covered investment to the family trust; or

“(iii) has any authority over a trustee of the family trust, including the authority to appoint, replace, or direct the actions of such a trustee; and

“(B) the grantor of the family trust is or was a family member of the covered individual.

“(3) REQUESTS.—A covered individual seeking an exemption under paragraph (2) shall submit to the applicable supervising ethics office a request for the exemption, in writing, certifying that the conditions described in that paragraph are met.

“(g) ASSETS ACQUIRED IN SPECIAL CIRCUMSTANCES.—In the event that a covered individual acquires a covered investment after the date of enactment of the Restore Trust in Government Act other than by purchase (such as by marriage, inheritance, divorce settlement, or other circumstance), the covered individual shall have 90 days from the date on which such investment was acquired to divest such covered investment at fair market value.

“(h) EXTENSION.—A supervising ethics office may grant a covered individual an extension of time to comply with a divestment deadline under this subchapter if a covered investment cannot be divested by such deadline due to low liquidity, vesting schedules, or contractual restrictions.

“(i) INTERPRETATIVE GUIDANCE.—The supervising ethics office shall issue interpretive guidance on any relevant term not defined in this subchapter.

“13153. Penalties

“(a) IN GENERAL.—

“(1) PENALTIES.—Any covered individual who violates the restrictions on trading or ownership of covered investments in section 13152 shall, at the direction of the supervising ethics office—

“(A) pay a fee equal to ten percent of the value of the covered investment; and

“(B) disgorge the profits of any transaction that violates the provisions of this subchapter.

“(2) PAYMENT OF PENALTY TO TREASURY.—A penalty imposed under paragraph (1)(B) shall be payable into the Treasury of the United States.

“(b) PAYMENT RESTRICTIONS.—A Member of Congress may not pay any of the penalties under this section by using amounts from the following sources:

“(1) The Members’ Representational Allowance.

“(2) The Senators’ Official Personnel and Office Expense Account.

“(3) Any contribution (as defined in section 301(8) of the Federal Election Campaign Act of 1971 (52 U.S.C. 30101(8))) accepted as a candidate, and any other donation received as support for activities of the individual as a holder of Federal office.

“(c) PUBLICATION.—Each supervising ethics office shall publish on a publicly available website a description of—

“(1) each fine assessed by the supervising ethics office pursuant to this section;

“(2) the reason why each such fine was assessed; and

“(3) the result of each assessment”

Mr. ROY. Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time, and I move the previous question on the resolution, as amended.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on ordering the previous question.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 9 of rule XX, the Chair will reduce to 5 minutes the minimum time for any electronic vote on the question of adoption of the resolution.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 216, nays 214, not voting 2, as follows:

[Roll No. 61]

YEAS—216

Aderholt
Alford
Allen
Amodei (NV)
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Barr
Barrett
Baumgartner
Bean (FL)
Begich
Bentz
Bergman
Bice
Biggs (AZ)
Biggs (SC)
Bilirakis
Boebert
Bost
Brecheen
Bresnahan
Buchanan
Burchett
Burlison
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Ciscomani
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Collins
Comer
Crane
Crank
Crawford
Crenshaw
Davidson
De La Cruz
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds

Downing
Dunn (FL)
Edwards
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Evans (CO)
Ezell
Fallon
Fedorchak
Feenstra
Fine
Finstad
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Flood
Fong
Poxx
Franklin, Scott
Fry
Fulcher
Garbarino
Gill (TX)
Gimenez
Goldman (TX)
Gonzales, Tony
Gooden
Gosar
Graves
Griffith
Grothman
Guest
Guthrie
Hageman
Hamadeh (AZ)
Haridopolos
Harrigan
Harris (MD)
Harris (NC)
Harshbarger
Hern (OK)
Higgins (LA)
Hill (AR)
Hinson
Houchin
Hudson

Huizenga
Hunt
Hurd (CO)
Issa
Jack
Jackson (TX)
James
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kean
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kennedy (UT)
Kiggans (VA)
Kiley (CA)
Kim
Knott
Kustoff
LaHood
LaLota
Langworthy
Latta
Lawler
Lee (FL)
Letlow
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luna
Luttrell
Mace
Mackenzie
Malliotakis
Maloy
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCaul
McClain
McClintock
McCormick
McDowell
McGuire
Messmer
Meuser
Miller (IL)

Miller (OH)
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Mills
Moolenaar
Moore (AL)
Moore (NC)
Moore (UT)
Moore (WV)
Moran
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Nunn (IA)
Oberholte
Ogles
Onder
Owens
Palmer
Patronis
Pfluger
Reschenthaler
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)

Rose
Rouzer
Roy
Rulli
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Schmidt
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Self
Sessions
Shreve
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Strong

Stutzman
Taylor
Tenneny
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner (OH)
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Dyne
Van Epps
Van Orden
Wagner
Walberg
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Westerman
Wied
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yakym
Zinke

NAYS—214

Adams
Aguilar
Amo
Ansari
Auchincloss
Balint
Barragan
Beatty
Bell
Bera
Beyer
Bishop
Bonamici
Boyle (PA)
Brown
Brownley
Budzinski
Bynum
Carbajal
Carson
Carter (LA)
Casar
Case
Casten
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-
McCormick
Chu
Cisneros
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Conaway
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crockett
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis (IL)
Davis (NC)
Dean (PA)
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Deluzio
DeSaulnier
Dexter
Dingell
Doggett
Elfrith
Escobar
Espallat
Evans (PA)
Fields
Figures
Fletcher
Foster
Foushee
Frankel, Lois
Friedman
Frost
Garamendi
Garcia (CA)
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gillen

Golden (ME)
Goldman (NY)
Gomez
Gonzalez, V.
Goodlander
Gottheimer
Gray
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hoyle (OR)
Huffman
Ivey
Jackson (IL)
Jacobs
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Kamlager-Dove
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Kennedy (NY)
Khanna
Krishnamoorthi
Landsman
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latimer
Lee (NV)
Lee (PA)
Leger Fernandez
Levin
Liccardo
Lieu
Loifgren
Lynch
Magaziner
Mannion
Matsui
McBath
McBride
McClain Delaney
McClellan
McCollum
McDonald Rivet
McGarvey
McGovern
McIver
Meeks
Menefee
Menendez
Meng
Mfume
Min
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Morrison
Moskowitz
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Nadler
Neal
Neguse
Norcross

Ocasio-Cortez
Olszewski
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pelosi
Perez
Peters
Pettersen
Pingree
Pocan
Pou
Pressley
Quigley
Ramirez
Randall
Raskin
Riley (NY)
Rivas
Ross
Ruiz
Ryan
Salinas
Sánchez
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schneider
Scholten
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Simon
Smith (WA)
Sorensen
Soto
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Subramanyam
Suozi
Swalwell
Sykes
Takano
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Tran
Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velazquez
Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

NOT VOTING—2

Murphy

Perry

□ 1253

Messrs. CARSON and SCHNEIDER changed their vote from “yea” to “nay.”

So the previous question was ordered.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

Stated for:

Mr. PERRY. Mr. Speaker, had I been present, I would have voted YEA on Roll Call No. 61.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the resolution, as amended.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

RECORDED VOTE

Mr. MCGOVERN. Mr. Speaker, I demand a recorded vote.

A recorded vote was ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—ayes 216, noes 215, not voting 1, as follows:

[Roll No. 62]

AYES—216

Aderholt	Fine	LaLota
Alford	Finstad	Langworthy
Allen	Fischbach	Latta
Amodei (NV)	Fitzgerald	Lawler
Arrington	Fitzpatrick	Lee (FL)
Babin	Fleischmann	Letlow
Bacon	Flood	Loudermilk
Baird	Fong	Lucas
Balderson	Fox	Luna
Barr	Franklin, Scott	Luttrell
Barrett	Fry	Mace
Baumgartner	Fulcher	Mackenzie
Bean (FL)	Garbarino	Malliotakis
Begich	Gill (TX)	Maloy
Bentz	Jimenez	Mann
Bergman	Goldman (TX)	Mast
Bice	Gonzales, Tony	McCaul
Biggs (AZ)	Gooden	McClain
Biggs (SC)	Gosar	McClintock
Bilirakis	Graves	McCormick
Boebert	Griffith	McDowell
Bost	Grothman	McGuire
Brecheen	Guest	Messmer
Bresnahan	Guthrie	Meuser
Buchanan	Hageman	Miller (IL)
Burchett	Hamadeh (AZ)	Miller (OH)
Burlison	Haridopolos	Miller (WV)
Calvert	Harrigan	Miller-Meeks
Cammack	Harris (MD)	Mills
Carey	Harris (NC)	Moolenaar
Carter (GA)	Harshbarger	Moore (AL)
Carter (TX)	Hern (OK)	Moore (NC)
Ciscomani	Higgins (LA)	Moore (UT)
Cline	Hill (AR)	Moore (WV)
Cloud	Hinson	Moran
Clyde	Houchin	Nehls
Cole	Hudson	Newhouse
Collins	Huizenga	Norman
Comer	Hunt	Nunn (IA)
Crane	Hurd (CO)	Oberholte
Crank	Issa	Ogles
Crawford	Jack	Onder
Crenshaw	Jackson (TX)	Owens
Davidson	James	Palmer
De La Cruz	Johnson (LA)	Patronis
DesJarlais	Johnson (SD)	Perry
Diaz-Balart	Jordan	Pfluger
Donalds	Joyce (OH)	Reschenthaler
Downing	Joyce (PA)	Rogers (AL)
Dunn (FL)	Kean	Rogers (KY)
Edwards	Kelly (MS)	Rose
Ellzey	Kelly (PA)	Rouzer
Emmer	Kennedy (UT)	Roy
Estes	Kiggans (VA)	Rulli
Evans (CO)	Kiley (CA)	Rutherford
Ezell	Kim	Salazar
Fallon	Knott	Scalise
Fedorchak	Kustoff	Schmidt
Feenstra	LaHood	Schweikert

Scott, Austin
Self
Sessions
Shreve
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Stefanik
Steil

Adams
Aguilar
Amo
Ansari
Auchincloss
Balint
Barragán
Beatty
Bell
Bera
Beyer
Bishop
Bonamici
Boyle (PA)
Brown
Brownley
Budzinski
Bynum
Carbajal
Carson
Carter (LA)
Casar
Case
Casten
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-
McCormick
Chu
Cisneros
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Conaway
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crockett
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis (IL)
Davis (NC)
Dean (PA)
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Deluzio
DeSaulnier
Dexter
Dingell
Doggett
Elfreth
Escobar
Espallat
Evans (PA)
Fields
Figures
Fletcher
Foster
Foushee
Frankel, Lois
Friedman
Frost
Garamendi
Garcia (CA)
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gillen
Golden (ME)

Steube
Strong
Stutzman
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner (OH)
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Dyne
Van Epps

NOES—215

Goldman (NY)
Gomez
Gonzalez, V.
Goodlander
Gottheimer
Gray
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hoyle (OR)
Huffman
Ivey
Jackson (IL)
Jacobs
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Kamlager-Dove
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Kennedy (NY)
Khanna
Krishnamoorthi
Landsman
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latimer
Lee (NV)
Lee (PA)
Leger Fernandez
Levin
Liccardo
Lieu
Lofgren
Crow
Magaziner
Mannion
Massie
Matsui
McBath
McBride
McClain Delaney
McClellan
McCollum
McDonald Rivet
McGarvey
McGovern
McIver
Meeks
Menefee
Menendez
Meng
Mfume
Min
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Morrison
Moskowitz
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Nadler
Neal
Neguse
Norcross
Ocasio-Cortez

Van Orden
Wagner
Walberg
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Westerman
Wied
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yakym
Zinke

□ 1302

So the resolution, as amended, was agreed to.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

VETERANS ACCESSIBILITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE ACT OF 2025

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to House Resolution 1057, I call up the bill (S. 1383) to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access, and for other purposes, and ask for its immediate consideration.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. GOLDMAN of Texas). Pursuant to House Resolution 1057, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 119–19, modified by the amendment printed in House Report 119–493 (modified by the amendment specified in section 6 of H. Res. 1057), is adopted and the bill, as amended, is considered read.

The text of the bill, as amended, is as follows:

S. 1383

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the “Safeguard American Voter Eligibility Act” or the “SAVE America Act”.

SEC. 2. ENSURING ONLY CITIZENS ARE REGISTERED TO VOTE IN ELECTIONS FOR FEDERAL OFFICE.

(a) DEFINITION OF DOCUMENTARY PROOF OF UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP.—Section 3 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20502) is amended—

(1) by striking “As used” and inserting “(a) IN GENERAL.—As used”; and

(2) by adding at the end the following:

“(b) DOCUMENTARY PROOF OF UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP.—As used in this Act, the term ‘documentary proof of United States citizenship’ means, with respect to an applicant for voter registration, any of the following:

“(1) A form of identification issued consistent with the requirements of the REAL ID Act of 2005 that indicates the applicant is a citizen of the United States.

“(2) A valid United States passport.

“(3) The applicant’s official United States military identification card, together with a United States military record of service showing that the applicant’s place of birth was in the United States.

“(4) A valid government-issued photo identification card issued by a Federal, State or Tribal government showing that the applicant’s place of birth was in the United States.

“(5) A valid government-issued photo identification card issued by a Federal, State or Tribal government other than an identification described in paragraphs (1) through (4), but only if presented together with one or more of the following:

“(A) A certified birth certificate issued by a State, a unit of local government in a State, or a Tribal government which—

“(i) was issued by the State, unit of local government, or Tribal government in which the applicant was born;

“(ii) was filed with the office responsible for keeping vital records in the State;

“(iii) includes the full name, date of birth, and place of birth of the applicant;

NOT VOTING—1

Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

“(iv) lists the full names of one or both of the parents of the applicant;

“(v) has the signature of an individual who is authorized to sign birth certificates on behalf of the State, unit of local government, or Tribal government in which the applicant was born;

“(vi) includes the date that the certificate was filed with the office responsible for keeping vital records in the State; and

“(vii) has the seal of the State, unit of local government, or Tribal government that issued the birth certificate.

“(B) An extract from a United States hospital Record of Birth created at the time of the applicant's birth which indicates that the applicant's place of birth was in the United States.

“(C) A final adoption decree showing the applicant's name and that the applicant's place of birth was in the United States.

“(D) A Consular Report of Birth Abroad of a citizen of the United States or a certification of the applicant's Report of Birth of a United States citizen issued by the Secretary of State.

“(E) A Naturalization Certificate or Certificate of Citizenship issued by the Secretary of Homeland Security or any other document or method of proof of United States citizenship issued by the Federal government pursuant to the Immigration and Nationality Act.

“(F) An American Indian Card issued by the Department of Homeland Security with the classification ‘KIC’.”.

(b) APPLICATION OF REQUIREMENTS.—Section 4 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20503) is amended by striking subsection (b) and inserting the following:

“(b) REQUIRING APPLICANTS TO PRESENT DOCUMENTARY PROOF OF UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP.—Under any method of voter registration in a State, the State shall not accept and process an application to register to vote in an election for Federal office unless the applicant presents documentary proof of United States citizenship with the application.”.

(c) REGISTRATION WITH APPLICATION FOR MOTOR VEHICLE DRIVER'S LICENSE.—Section 5 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20504) is amended—

(1) in subsection (a)(1), by striking “Each State motor vehicle driver's license application” and inserting “Subject to the requirements under section 8(j), each State motor vehicle driver's license application”;

(2) in subsection (c)(1), by striking “Each State shall include” and inserting “Subject to the requirements under section 8(j), each State shall include”;

(3) in subsection (c)(2)(B)—

(A) in clause (i), by striking “and” at the end;

(B) in clause (ii), by adding “and” at the end; and

(C) by adding at the end the following new clause:

“(iii) verify that the applicant is a citizen of the United States”;

(4) in subsection (c)(2)(C)(i), by striking “(including citizenship)” and inserting “, including the requirement that the applicant provides documentary proof of United States citizenship”;

(5) in subsection (c)(2)(D)(iii), by striking “; and” and inserting the following: “, other than as evidence in a criminal proceeding or immigration proceeding brought against an applicant who knowingly attempts to register to vote and knowingly makes a false declaration under penalty of perjury that the applicant meets the eligibility requirements to register to vote in an election for Federal office; and”.

(d) REQUIRING DOCUMENTARY PROOF OF UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP WITH NATIONAL MAIL VOTER REGISTRATION FORM.—Section 6 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20505) is amended—

(1) in subsection (a)(1)—

(A) by striking “Each State shall accept and use” and inserting “Subject to the requirements under section 8(j), each State shall accept and use”;

(B) by striking “Federal Election Commission” and inserting “Election Assistance Commission”;

(2) in subsection (b), by adding at the end the following: “The chief State election official of a State shall take such steps as may be necessary to ensure that residents of the State are aware of the requirement to provide documentary proof of United States citizenship to register to vote in elections for Federal office in the State.”;

(3) in subsection (c)(1)—

(A) in subparagraph (A), by striking “and” at the end;

(B) in subparagraph (B) by striking the period at the end and inserting “; and”;

(C) by adding at the end the following new subparagraph:

“(C) the person did not provide documentary proof of United States citizenship when registering to vote.”; and

(4) by adding at the end the following new subsection:

“(e) ENSURING PROOF OF UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP.—

“(1) PRESENTING PROOF OF UNITED STATES CITIZENSHIP TO ELECTION OFFICIAL.—An applicant who submits the mail voter registration application form prescribed by the Election Assistance Commission pursuant to section 9(a)(2) or a form described in paragraph (1) or (2) of subsection (a) shall not be registered to vote in an election for Federal office unless—

“(A) the applicant presents documentary proof of United States citizenship in person to the office of the appropriate election official not later than the deadline provided by State law for the receipt of a completed voter registration application for the election; or

“(B) in the case of a State which permits an individual to register to vote in an election for Federal office at a polling place on the day of the election and on any day when voting, including early voting, is permitted for the election, the applicant presents documentary proof of United States citizenship to the appropriate election official at the polling place not later than the date of the election.

“(2) NOTIFICATION OF REQUIREMENT.—Upon receiving an otherwise completed mail voter registration application form prescribed by the Election Assistance Commission pursuant to section 9(a)(2) or a form described in paragraph (1) or (2) of subsection (a), the appropriate election official shall transmit a notice to the applicant of the requirement to present documentary proof of United States citizenship under this subsection, and shall include in the notice instructions to enable the applicant to meet the requirement.

“(3) ACCESSIBILITY.—Each State shall, in consultation with the Election Assistance Commission, ensure that reasonable accommodations are made to allow an individual with a disability who submits the mail voter registration application form prescribed by the Election Assistance Commission pursuant to section 9(a)(2) or a form described in paragraph (1) or (2) of subsection (a) to present documentary proof of United States citizenship to the appropriate election official.”.

(e) REQUIREMENTS FOR VOTER REGISTRATION AGENCIES.—Section 7 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20506) is amended—

(1) in subsection (a)—

(A) in paragraph (4)(A), by adding at the end the following new clause:

“(iv) Receipt of documentary proof of United States citizenship of each applicant to register to vote in elections for Federal office in the State.”; and

(B) in paragraph (6)—

(i) in subparagraph (A)(i)(I), by striking “(including citizenship)” and inserting “, including the requirement that the applicant provides documentary proof of United States citizenship”;

(ii) by redesignating subparagraphs (B) and (C) as subparagraphs (C) and (D), respectively; and

(iii) by inserting after subparagraph (A) the following new subparagraph:

“(B) ask the applicant the question, ‘Are you a citizen of the United States?’ and if the applicant answers in the affirmative require documentary proof of United States citizenship prior to providing the form under subparagraph (C).”;

(2) in subsection (c)(1), by inserting “who are citizens of the United States” after “for persons”.

(f) REQUIREMENTS WITH RESPECT TO ADMINISTRATION OF VOTER REGISTRATION.—Section 8 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20507) is amended—

(1) in subsection (a)—

(A) by striking “In the administration of voter registration” and inserting “Subject to the requirements of subsection (j), in the administration of voter registration”;

(B) in paragraph (3)—

(i) in subparagraph (B), by striking “or” at the end; and

(ii) by adding at the end the following new subparagraphs:

“(D) based on documentary proof or verified information that the registrant is not a United States citizen; or

“(E) the registration otherwise fails to comply with applicable State law”;

(2) by redesignating subsection (j) as subsection (l); and

(3) by inserting after subsection (i) the following new subsections:

“(j) ENSURING ONLY CITIZENS ARE REGISTERED TO VOTE.—

“(1) IN GENERAL.—Notwithstanding any other provision of this Act, a State may not register an individual to vote in elections for Federal office held in the State unless, at the time the individual applies to register to vote, the individual provides documentary proof of United States citizenship.

“(2) REQUIREMENT IN CASES OF NAME DISCREPANCIES IN DOCUMENTATION.—Notwithstanding any other provision of law, a State shall accept and process an application to register to vote in an election for Federal office if the applicant—

“(A) presents with the application documentation that would constitute documentary proof of United States citizenship, except that the name on the documentation is not the name of the applicant; and

“(B) provides, through a process established by the State (which shall be subject to any relevant guidance adopted by the Election Assistance Commission)—

“(i) additional documentation as necessary to establish that the name on the documentation is a previous name of the applicant; or

“(ii) an affidavit signed by the applicant attesting that the name on the documentation is a previous name of the applicant.

“(3) ADDITIONAL PROCESSES IN CERTAIN CASES.—

“(A) PROCESS FOR THOSE WITHOUT DOCUMENTARY PROOF.—

“(i) IN GENERAL.—Subject to any relevant guidance adopted by the Election Assistance Commission, each State shall establish a process under which an applicant who cannot provide documentary proof of United States citizenship under paragraph (1) may, if the applicant signs an attestation under penalty of perjury that the applicant is a citizen of the United States and eligible to vote in elections for Federal office, submit such other evidence to the appropriate State or local official demonstrating that the applicant is a citizen of the United States and such official shall make a determination as to whether the applicant has sufficiently established United States citizenship for purposes of registering to vote in elections for Federal office in the State.

“(ii) AFFIDAVIT REQUIREMENT.—If a State or local official makes a determination under clause (i) that an applicant has sufficiently established United States citizenship for purposes

of registering to vote in elections for Federal office in the State, such determination shall be accompanied by an affidavit developed under clause (iii) signed by the official swearing or affirming the applicant sufficiently established United States citizenship for purposes of registering to vote.

“(iii) DEVELOPMENT OF AFFIDAVIT BY THE ELECTION ASSISTANCE COMMISSION.—The Election Assistance Commission shall develop a uniform affidavit for use by State and local officials under clause (ii), which shall—

“(I) include an explanation of the minimum standards required for a State or local official to register an applicant who cannot provide documentary proof of United States citizenship to vote in elections for Federal office in the State; and

“(II) require the official to explain the basis for registering such applicant to vote in such elections.

“(B) PROCESS IN CASE OF CERTAIN DISCREPANCIES IN DOCUMENTATION.—Subject to any relevant guidance adopted by the Election Assistance Commission, each State shall establish a process under which an applicant can provide such additional documentation to the appropriate election official of the State as may be necessary to establish that the applicant is a citizen of the United States in the event of a discrepancy with respect to the applicant's documentary proof of United States citizenship.

“(4) STATE REQUIREMENTS.—Not later than 30 days after the date of the enactment of this subsection:

“(A) Each State shall take affirmative steps, on an ongoing basis, to ensure that only United States citizens are registered to vote under the provisions of this Act, and such affirmative steps shall include the establishment of a program described in subparagraphs (B) and (C).

“(B) Each State shall submit the complete, official list of individuals registered as eligible voters for Federal office in the State to the Department of Homeland Security for comparison through the Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements (“SAVE”) system for the purposes of identifying individuals who are not citizens of the United States and taking the necessary steps to remove such individuals who are not citizens from the official list, after notice is given to such individuals and such individuals are given the opportunity to provide documentary proof of United States citizenship, but a State with a memorandum of agreement for such purposes with the Department of Homeland Security on the date of the enactment of this subsection may comply with this subparagraph by carrying out such purposes under the memorandum.

“(C) Each State may utilize such other sources of data available to the State for the purposes of identifying individuals who are not citizens of the United States and removing such individuals from the official list of eligible voters for Federal office in the State, including (but not limited to) the following:

“(i) State agencies that supply State identification cards or driver's licenses where the agency confirms the United States citizenship status of applicants.

“(ii) Other sources, including databases and information provided pursuant to an agreement with the Commissioner of Social Security under section 205(r)(9) of the Social Security Act, which can be used to confirm United States citizenship status, except that any such information provided by the Commissioner may not be the sole grounds for the removal of an individual from the official list of eligible voters for elections for Federal office in a State.

“(5) AVAILABILITY OF INFORMATION.—

“(A) IN GENERAL.—At the request of a State election official (including a request related to a process established by a State under paragraph (3)(A) or (3)(B)), any head of a Federal department or agency possessing information relevant to determining the eligibility of an individual to vote in elections for Federal office shall, not

later than 24 hours after receipt of such request, provide the official with such information as may be necessary to enable the official to verify that an applicant for voter registration in elections for Federal office held in the State or a registrant on the official list of eligible voters in elections for Federal office held in the State is a citizen of the United States, which shall include providing the official with such batched information as may be requested by the official.

“(B) USE OF SAVE SYSTEM.—The Secretary of Homeland Security may respond to a request received under paragraph (1) by using the system for the verification of immigration status under the applicable provisions of section 1137 of the Social Security Act (42 U.S.C. 1320b-7), as established pursuant to section 121(c) of the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986 (Public Law 99-603).

“(C) SHARING OF INFORMATION.—The heads of Federal departments and agencies shall share information with each other with respect to an individual who is the subject of a request received under paragraph (A) in order to enable them to respond to the request.

“(D) INVESTIGATION FOR PURPOSES OF REMOVAL.—The Secretary of Homeland Security shall conduct an investigation to determine whether to initiate removal proceedings under section 239 of the Immigration and Nationality Act (8 U.S.C. 1229) if it is determined pursuant to subparagraph (A) or (B) that an alien (as such term is defined in section 101 of the Immigration and Nationality Act (8 U.S.C. 1101)) is unlawfully registered to vote in elections for Federal office.

“(E) PROHIBITING FEES.—The head of a Federal department or agency may not charge a fee for responding to a State's request under paragraph (A).

“(k) REMOVAL OF NONCITIZENS FROM REGISTRATION ROLLS.—A State shall remove an individual who is not a citizen of the United States from the official list of eligible voters for elections for Federal office held in the State at any time upon receipt of documentation or verified information that a registrant is not a United States citizen.”.

(g) CLARIFICATION OF AUTHORITY OF STATE TO REMOVE NONCITIZENS FROM OFFICIAL LIST OF ELIGIBLE VOTERS.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—Section 8(a)(4) of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20507(a)(4)) is amended—

(A) by striking “or” at the end of subparagraph (A);

(B) by adding “or” at the end of subparagraph (B); and

(C) by adding at the end the following new subparagraph:

“(C) documentary proof or verified information that the registrant is not a United States citizen;”.

(2) CONFORMING AMENDMENT.—Section 8(c)(2)(B)(i) of such Act (52 U.S.C. 20507(c)(2)(B)(i)) is amended by striking “(4)(A)” and inserting “(4)(A) or (C)”.

(h) REQUIREMENTS WITH RESPECT TO FEDERAL MAIL VOTER REGISTRATION FORM.—

(1) CONTENTS OF MAIL VOTER REGISTRATION FORM.—Section 9(b) of such Act (52 U.S.C. 20508(b)) is amended—

(A) in paragraph (2)(A), by striking “(including citizenship)” and inserting “(including an explanation of what is required to present documentary proof of United States citizenship)”;

(B) in paragraph (3), by striking “and” at the end;

(C) in paragraph (4), by striking the period at the end and inserting “; and”; and

(D) by adding at the end the following new paragraph:

“(5) shall include a section, for use only by a State or local election official, to record the type of document the applicant presented as documentary proof of United States citizenship, including the date of issuance, the date of expiration (if any), the office which issued the docu-

ment, and any unique identification number associated with the document.”.

(2) INFORMATION ON MAIL VOTER REGISTRATION FORM.—Section 9(b)(4) of such Act (52 U.S.C. 20508(b)(4)) is amended—

(A) by redesignating clauses (i) through (iii) as subparagraphs (A) through (C), respectively; and

(B) in subparagraph (C) (as so redesignated and as amended by paragraph (1)(C)), by striking “; and” and inserting the following: “, other than as evidence in a criminal proceeding or immigration proceeding brought against an applicant who attempts to register to vote and makes a false declaration under penalty of perjury that the applicant meets the eligibility requirements to register to vote in an election for Federal office; and”.

(i) PRIVATE RIGHT OF ACTION.—Section 11(b)(1) of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20510(b)(1)) is amended by striking “a violation of this Act” and inserting “a violation of this Act, including the act of an election official who registers an applicant to vote in an election for Federal office who fails to present documentary proof of United States citizenship.”.

(j) CRIMINAL PENALTIES.—Section 12(2) of such Act (52 U.S.C. 20511(2)) is amended—

(1) by striking “or” at the end of subparagraph (A);

(2) by redesignating subparagraph (B) as subparagraph (D); and

(3) by inserting after subparagraph (A) the following new subparagraphs:

“(B) in the case of an officer or employee of the executive branch, providing material assistance to a noncitizen in attempting to register to vote or vote in an election for Federal office;

“(C) registering an applicant to vote in an election for Federal office who fails to present documentary proof of United States citizenship; or”.

(k) SPECIAL RULE FOR STATES NOT REQUIRING VOTER REGISTRATION.—Section 4 of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20503), as amended by subsection (b), is amended by adding at the end the following:

“(c) SPECIAL RULE FOR STATES NOT REQUIRING VOTER REGISTRATION.—In the case of a State or jurisdiction that does not require voter registration as a requirement to vote in an election for Federal office on or after the date of the enactment of this subsection, the State or jurisdiction shall be deemed to meet the requirements of this Act if the State or jurisdiction establishes a system for confirming the citizenship of individuals voting in an election for Federal office prior to the first day for voting with respect to such election and provides such confirmation of citizenship status for each eligible voter to election officials at the polling places during the voting period.”.

(l) ELECTION ASSISTANCE COMMISSION GUIDANCE.—Not later than 10 days after the date of the enactment of this Act, the Election Assistance Commission shall adopt and transmit to the chief State election official of each State guidance with respect to the implementation of the requirements under the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20501 et seq.), as amended by this section.

(m) INAPPLICABILITY OF PAPERWORK REDUCTION ACT.—Subchapter I of chapter 35 of title 44 (commonly referred to as the “Paperwork Reduction Act”) shall not apply with respect to the development or modification of voter registration materials under the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20501 et seq.), as amended by this section, including the development or modification of any voter registration application forms.

(n) DUTY OF SECRETARY OF HOMELAND SECURITY TO NOTIFY ELECTION OFFICIALS OF NATURALIZATION.—Upon receiving information that an individual has become a naturalized citizen of the United States, the Secretary of Homeland Security shall promptly provide notice of such

information to the appropriate chief election official of the State in which such individual is domiciled.

(o) **RULE OF CONSTRUCTION REGARDING PROVISIONAL BALLOTS.**—Nothing in this section or in any amendment made by this section may be construed to supercede, restrict, or otherwise affect the ability of an individual to cast a provisional ballot in an election for Federal office or to have the ballot counted in the election if the individual is verified as a citizen of the United States pursuant to section 8(j) of the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (as added by subsection (f)).

(p) **RULE OF CONSTRUCTION REGARDING EFFECT ON STATE EXEMPTIONS FROM OTHER FEDERAL LAWS.**—Nothing in this section or in any amendment made by this section may be construed to affect the exemption of a State from any requirement of any Federal law other than the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 (52 U.S.C. 20501 et seq.).

(q) **EXCEPTION FOR ABSENT UNIFORMED SERVICES VOTERS.**—The requirements in this section shall not apply with respect to an applicant who is an absent uniformed services voter, as defined in section 107(1) of the Uniformed and Overseas Citizens Absentee Voting Act (52 U.S.C. 20310(1)).

(r) **EFFECTIVE DATE.**—This section and the amendments made by this section shall take effect on the date of the enactment of this section, and shall apply with respect to applications for voter registration which are submitted on or after such date.

SEC. 3. REQUIRING VOTERS TO PROVIDE PHOTO IDENTIFICATION.

(a) **REQUIREMENT TO PROVIDE PHOTO IDENTIFICATION AS CONDITION OF CASTING BALLOT.**—

(1) **IN GENERAL.**—Title III of the Help America Vote Act of 2002 (52 U.S.C. 21081 et seq.) is amended by inserting after section 303 the following new section:

“SEC. 303A. PHOTO IDENTIFICATION REQUIREMENTS.

“(a) **PROVISION OF IDENTIFICATION REQUIRED AS CONDITION OF CASTING BALLOT.**—

“(1) **INDIVIDUALS VOTING IN PERSON.**—

“(A) **REQUIREMENT TO PROVIDE IDENTIFICATION.**—Notwithstanding any other provision of law and except as provided in subparagraph (B), the appropriate State or local election official may not provide a ballot for an election for Federal office to an individual who desires to vote in person unless the individual presents to the official a valid physical photo identification.

“(B) **AVAILABILITY OF PROVISIONAL BALLOT.**—

“(i) **IN GENERAL.**—If an individual does not present the identification required under subparagraph (A), the individual shall be permitted to cast a provisional ballot with respect to the election under section 302(a), except that the appropriate State or local election official may not make a determination under section 302(a)(4) that the individual is eligible under State law to vote in the election unless, not later than 3 days after casting the provisional ballot, the individual presents to the official—

“(I) the identification required under subparagraph (A); or

“(II) an affidavit developed and made available to the individual by the State attesting that the individual does not possess the identification required under subparagraph (A) because the individual has a religious objection to being photographed.

“(ii) **NO EFFECT ON OTHER PROVISIONAL BALLOTING RULES.**—Nothing in clause (i) may be construed to apply to the casting of a provisional ballot pursuant to section 302(a) or any State law for reasons other than the failure to present the identification required under subparagraph (A).

“(2) **INDIVIDUALS VOTING OTHER THAN IN PERSON.**—

“(A) **IN GENERAL.**—Notwithstanding any other provision of law and except as provided in sub-

paragraph (B), the appropriate State or local election official may not accept any ballot for an election for Federal office provided by an individual who votes other than in person unless the individual submits with the ballot—

“(i) a copy of a valid photo identification; or

“(ii) the last four digits of the individual's Social Security number and an affidavit developed and made available to the individual by the State attesting that the individual is unable to obtain a copy of a valid photo identification after making reasonable efforts to obtain such a copy.

“(B) **EXCEPTIONS.**—Subparagraph (A) does not apply with respect to a ballot provided by—

“(i) an absent uniformed services voter, as defined in section 107(1) of the Uniformed and Overseas Citizens Absentee Voting Act (52 U.S.C. 20310(1)); or

“(ii) an individual provided the right to vote otherwise than in person under section 3(b)(2)(B)(ii) of the Voting Accessibility for the Elderly and Handicapped Act (52 U.S.C. 20102(b)(2)(B)(ii)).”

“(b) **PROVIDING PUBLIC ACCESS TO DIGITAL IMAGING DEVICES.**—With respect to each State, the appropriate State or local government official of the State shall ensure, to the extent practicable, public access to a digital imaging device, which shall include a printer, copier, image scanner, or multifunction machine, at State and local government buildings in the State, including courts, libraries, and police stations, for the purpose of allowing individuals to use such a device at no cost to the individual to make a copy of a valid photo identification.

“(c) **VALID PHOTO IDENTIFICATIONS DESCRIBED.**—For purposes of this section, a ‘valid photo identification’ means, with respect to an individual who seeks to vote in a State, any of the following:

“(1) A valid State-issued motor vehicle driver's license that includes a photo of the individual and an expiration date.

“(2) A valid State-issued identification card that includes a photo of the individual and an expiration date issued by a State motor vehicle authority.

“(3) A valid United States passport for the individual.

“(4) A valid military identification for the individual.

“(5) A valid identification document issued by a Tribal government that includes a photo of the individual and an expiration date.

“(d) **NOTIFICATION OF IDENTIFICATION REQUIREMENT TO APPLICANTS FOR VOTER REGISTRATION.**—

“(1) **IN GENERAL.**—Each State shall ensure that, at the time an individual applies to register to vote in elections for Federal office in the State, the appropriate State or local election official notifies the individual of the photo identification requirements of this section.

“(2) **SPECIAL RULE FOR INDIVIDUALS APPLYING TO REGISTER TO VOTE ONLINE.**—Each State shall ensure that, in the case of an individual who applies to register to vote in elections for Federal office in the State online, the online voter registration system notifies the individual of the photo identification requirements of this section before the individual completes the online registration process.

“(e) **EFFECTIVE DATE.**—This section shall take effect on the date of the enactment of this section, and shall apply with respect to elections for Federal office held on or after such date.”

(2) **CLERICAL AMENDMENT.**—The table of contents of such Act is amended by inserting after the item relating to section 303 the following new item:

“Sec. 303A. Photo identification requirements.”

(b) **CONFORMING AMENDMENT RELATING TO VOLUNTARY GUIDANCE BY ELECTION ASSISTANCE COMMISSION.**—Section 311(b) of such Act (52 U.S.C. 21101(b)) is amended—

(1) by striking “and” at the end of paragraph (2);

(2) by striking the period at the end of paragraph (3) and inserting “; and”; and

(3) by adding at the end the following new paragraph:

“(4) in the case of the recommendations with respect to section 303A, October 1, 2025.”

(c) **CONFORMING AMENDMENT RELATING TO ENFORCEMENT.**—Section 401 of such Act (52 U.S.C. 21111) is amended by striking “sections 301, 302, 303, and 304” and inserting “subtitle A of title III”.

(d) **EFFECTIVE DATE.**—This section and the amendments made by this section shall take effect on the date of the enactment of this section, and shall apply with respect to elections for Federal office held on or after such date.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The bill, as amended, is debatable for 1 hour equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on House Administration or their respective designees.

The gentleman from Wisconsin (Mr. STEIL) and the gentleman from New York (Mr. MORELLE) each will control 30 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Wisconsin.

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include additional material on the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Wisconsin?

There was no objection.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of S. 1383, the SAVE America Act. I thank my colleague, CHIP ROY, for his work on this bill, as well as my colleagues on the Committee on House Administration.

Today, Mr. Speaker, we have an opportunity to move forward with election integrity and to regain the trust of the American people in the way that we operate our elections.

The SAVE America Act has two key principles, both of which are common sense. The individuals who want to vote in U.S. elections should be U.S. citizens, and we should have a proof of citizenship when individuals register to vote. The second principle is that individuals when they vote show voter ID. Both of these are commonsense principles.

We know there are some on the other side of the aisle who want noncitizens to vote in our elections. In fact, we could just look at our Nation's Capital, which allows noncitizens to vote under current law in municipal elections.

I am of the view that U.S. elections should be for U.S. citizens only and that we should be proving that citizenship at the point in time that an individual registers to vote.

We should also be showing voter ID when we go to vote. This is a commonsense principle. The American people know that they need to show photo identification when they board an airplane, open a bank account, or buy a six-pack of beer.

I am often reminded of a debate we had at committee, and then I flew home to my home State of Wisconsin. I went to go buy a six-pack of beer. The clerk recognized me and said: Hi, BRYAN. I said: How are you doing? She said: I need to see your ID. I handed over my ID. She confirmed it and allowed me to buy the beer.

I think it is nuts that we protect our beer in this country more than our ballots in jurisdictions. This is our opportunity, Mr. Speaker, to change that, to instill significant election integrity.

Before I close, let me say that during this debate today, we are likely to hear all sorts of comments from my colleagues on the left. They will make arguments about disenfranchisement. They will use terms like “Jim Crow 2.0.” I remind everyone watching to reflect back on the same language that was used when Georgia instituted election integrity provisions in 2021.

We can actually look, because the State of Georgia has operated two significant elections since then, and voter participation remained high. The University of Georgia conducted a significant survey to determine how people experienced the election in the State of Georgia. What they found was that people had a positive experience in how that election was conducted across all key demographic groups. The survey found statistically zero percent of Blacks had a poor or negative voting experience in the State of Georgia.

Making sure that it is easy to vote and hard to cheat is a core principle. As we instill election integrity in our system, we will see more people participating because they will have faith in our elections.

Mr. Speaker, I encourage my colleagues to vote in favor of S. 1383, the SAVE America Act, and I reserve the balance of my time.

□ 1310

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

I stand here not just in strong opposition to this bill but in strong opposition to recent efforts by this administration to take over, literally take over American elections—but not just any American election, this American election, the one that is happening now. Ballots have already been mailed overseas to military voters for several State primaries.

I am opposed to this bill and any effort by the President of the United States to nationalize a Federal election for partisan purposes because I believe in this country. I ardently, fiercely believe that the United States, the shining city on a hill, represents the best humanity has to offer.

I believe the United States should, it must, stand in defense of and on behalf of every single American. Our Republic was founded on the simple yet revolutionary idea that our American government derives its power from the consent of the governed, from the votes of the people. Yet achieving that idea has

required struggle over generations and generations.

With the Reconstruction Amendments, since the 19th Amendment, America expanded its right to vote. Americans have defended this right against efforts to restrict access to the ballot, to pull back from history's progress.

Congress has repeatedly affirmed and defended the ability for every American to participate in our elections, including through the passage of the historic Voting Rights Act of 1965.

The principle of government with the consent of the governed is why we are all here today. The principle is what we swore an oath to defend, but this Republican majority has made a sharp turn away from that sacred principle.

This bill which we are considering today represents a betrayal of every representative principle of this country. Passage of this bill, support for it from within this Chamber would be a tacit endorsement of a broader ominous, dangerous agenda.

The SAVE America Act is not an isolated piece of policy. It is part of a concerted effort by the Republican Party's leadership and this administration, this President, to centralize partisan power over American elections, to diminish the authority of American States, to once again stoke fear and mistrust of immigrants and in our electoral system, all for the partisan gain of Speaker JOHNSON and the White House this November.

Just days ago, President Trump publicly called on Republicans to take over, to nationalize voting across the country. This is not hyperbole. This is not hysteria. These are his words.

It should not surprise anyone that the SAVE America Act would require States to provide sensitive personal voter data to Kristi Noem's Department of Homeland Security, to send your personal data directly to the Federal Government, to directly invade your privacy, your family's privacy.

Why does the President want to send your information to DHS? Why does he want to take over this election? Why would he advocate for Republican control of Federal elections, a direct affront to the United States' Constitution?

Because he knows that without such drastic action, Republicans will lose the midterm elections in 9 months.

Just look at recent election results in Virginia. I know the President has. Look at them in New Jersey. Look at them in Texas.

Americans know that everything in this country has gotten more expensive under this administration, so it should be no surprise that this bill would make voting more expensive. Passports, which millions of Americans don't have but would need to register to vote, cost \$130.

Beyond the cost, these Republican efforts to nationalize how we vote have nothing to do with safeguarding our elections. Instead, they threaten

the very fabric of American self-government.

Now, ensuring the integrity of elections is not only legitimate, it is American. But integrity is achieved through the rule of law, through adherence to our constitution, through trust in the American people, of the electorate.

The security of our elections is not advanced, however, by a Department of Justice under Attorney General Bondi that sends an extraordinarily extortionate letter to Minnesota officials.

She suggested violence by Federal agents in the Twin Cities would only end if Minnesota just turned over sensitive voter data to the Federal Government, violating your privacy, demanding your information at the barrel of a Border Patrol rifle, the same data the SAVE America Act would force every State in this Nation to surrender.

This letter, the President's rhetoric, their push for Americans' personal voter data, none of this can be divorced from the legislative push we see here today. We all know why.

The SAVE America Act is part of a comprehensive Republican strategy to cement power this year. Speaker JOHNSON wants to make it harder for Americans to vote and easier for Washington Republicans to control how elections are run.

Let us not forget that elections in this country are administered by clerks, by secretaries of State, and by commissions and bipartisan boards chosen by citizens in every single community in America. They are not run out of the oval office. They are not dictated by partisan interests.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to oppose the SAVE America Act. I implore them to reject efforts that would centralize control in the hands of Donald Trump, Pam Bondi, or Kristi Noem over how Americans vote, over who is allowed to vote.

Most of all, I urge this Chamber to reaffirm its commitment to the fundamental democratic principles that all eligible citizens should have the opportunity to participate in free, fair, and secure elections without unnecessary burdens and without partisan interference.

Mr. Speaker, I strongly urge defeat of this bill, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentlewoman from Illinois (Mrs. MILLER), a leader on this legislation and a member of the Committee on House Administration.

Mrs. MILLER of Illinois. Mr. Speaker, the SAVE America Act ensures that only American citizens vote in American elections. This should be the easiest “yes” vote this year.

The American people want the SAVE America Act. Mr. Speaker, 83 percent of adults support requiring a photo ID to vote, as do 73 percent of Democrat voters.

Democrat politicians standing here today oppose it, just as they have opposed every election integrity measure.

Democrats cannot win on their ideas because their agenda has made life harder for American families.

The Democratic Party knows that cheating is their only path to victory. Their goal is to replace the votes of American citizens with those of illegal aliens.

House Republicans are standing up for the American people here today.

Congress has a responsibility to protect the integrity of our elections. The SAVE America Act upholds that duty.

I urge my colleagues to listen to the American people and vote "yes." America is watching.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I would ask Mrs. MILLER: Do 80 percent of Americans want the Department of Homeland Security and ICE to have your personal, private information and data? I think not.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentlewoman from Alabama (Ms. SEWELL), a member of the House Administration Committee.

Ms. SEWELL. Mr. Speaker, I rise in strong opposition to Trump's voter suppression bill. In recent months, President Trump's attempts to interfere in the midterm elections have become more brazen and alarming day by day.

We have seen State legislators redraw maps to benefit Republicans. We have seen the FBI raid an election office and seize ballots in Georgia. Most recently, President Trump threatened a Federal takeover of our election in clear violation of the Constitution.

This week, Trump's efforts to rig the elections have made their way to Congress where Republicans are pushing this piece of legislation, which will block millions of voters from casting their ballots.

Let us be clear. This is not a voter ID bill. It is a voter suppression bill, plain and simple.

This bill is so extreme that even your driver's license would be insufficient to register to vote. Instead, Americans would be required to present their birth certificate or their passport.

The reality is that half of Americans do not have a passport. Get this: This bill also requires States to turn over personal identifiable information to the Department of Homeland Security, the same Department whose rogue agents are responsible for the deaths of two American citizens in Minnesota.

□ 1320

Here is the truth: Under this bill, tens of millions of eligible American voters will be blocked from casting their ballots. It is simply unacceptable and un-American.

The ability of voters to choose their leaders is foundational to our democracy. It is a freedom that generations of Americans have fought, bled, and marched for, many in my hometown of Selma, Alabama.

We know that it is so important that we safeguard these important truths. Our freedom is under assault. Make no

mistake, Republicans know that their policies are failing, that prices are going up, that jobs are going away, that healthcare is being slashed, and that the American people are struggling to make ends meet.

Republicans know that they cannot win on the merits, so rather than changing their policies, they are seeking to change the rules.

John Lewis was not bludgeoned on a bridge in my hometown for the Republicans and Donald Trump to take these freedoms away from us. This is a blatant power grab, and Democrats will not stand for it.

Vote "no" on this disastrous legislation.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Tennessee (Mr. BURCHETT) to speak on the bill.

Mr. BURCHETT. Mr. Speaker, the SAVE America Act will block illegal immigrants and noncitizens from voting.

Unfortunately, there is a lot of misinformation out there being spread by the media and my friends across the aisle. House Republicans and President Trump want to protect the ballot box and ensure integrity in our elections across this great country.

Only U.S. citizens should participate in the election process. The laws we create in Congress affect all Americans, and Americans should be the ones who select their leaders.

This SAVE America Act puts in place safeguards, Mr. Speaker, to prevent noncitizens from abusing our democratic process. United States citizens should be the people choosing our elected leaders, not illegal immigrants.

I am not a drinker. Everybody knows that. But I know if I go to Weigel's in Knoxville, Tennessee, down on the corner of Emory Road and Tazewell Pike, and I go in there to buy a six-pack or a can of Skoal or a scratch-off, then I have to produce an ID.

Mr. Speaker, when you purchase a firearm, when you board a plane, and when you open a bank account, if I put \$100 in the bank and right then ask for \$20 of it back, I have to show a dadgum ID.

Why can't you vote for an elected official without one, Mr. Speaker?

This legislation codifies President Trump's executive action to secure our voter registration process, which has been a key platform of President Trump this term.

Democrats are lying, Mr. Speaker, saying this bill prevents minorities from registering to vote. It protects their vote. It protects every American citizen's vote. It disgusts me, and, frankly, I find it racist to assume that minorities cannot obtain an ID.

We need to have the guts to stand up and protect our dadgum election, Mr. Speaker, and that means we need to pass the SAVE America Act.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I have great respect for the gentleman from Tennessee, but I do want to inform him

that actually current Federal law prevents noncitizens from voting in Federal elections, so he may want to look that up.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from California (Mrs. TORRES), who is a member of the Committee on House Administration.

Mrs. TORRES of California. Mr. Speaker, let's stop pretending the SAVE America Act is about election security because it is not. This bill is about power and silencing Americans. Republicans don't want voting. Thousands of Americans are protesting, demonstrating against the policies of this administration.

Republicans know that they will lose the midterms.

The President asked them to cancel the election, and guess what, Mr. Speaker, this bill is the next best thing to that. This is a show-your-papers mandate to disqualify Americans who oppose their evil agenda. Americans would have to appear in person and present a passport or birth certificate just to register, and again, every single time they update their registration, every time they move, if they get married, if they get divorced, blah, blah, blah.

Here is whom it will hurt: the more than 140 million Americans who don't have a passport, including Republicans, by the way.

As many as 69 million women who follow the traditional practice of changing their name after marriage do not have a birth certificate that matches their legal name. Republicans know this and want to use that misinformation to block them from voting.

This bill would eliminate the voter registration methods that over 90 percent of Americans rely on, including online, mail-in, and DMV registration.

In rural areas, Americans would be forced to drive 7 or 8 hours round trip just to show documents, and they would have to do it every single time they move.

When Kansas tried a similar law, 32,000 eligible citizens were blocked from registering. Zero noncitizens were found because election officials had already verified their eligibility.

Republicans call this voter ID. This is voter suppression. When they can't win on ideas, they try to win by blocking the ballot and taxing our right to vote.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no" on this attack on our democracy.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from Florida (Mrs. LUNA).

Mrs. LUNA. Mr. Speaker, my colleagues are spending a lot of time lecturing the American people on how this is going to require them to show their papers. Last time I checked, during COVID they demanded that if you simply wanted to go to a funeral, be with your loved one while they are dying, or get married, then you have to show your papers. In fact, in New York

City, Mr. Speaker, they were literally asking you for your COVID passport.

Yet the SAVE America Act, a commonsense piece of legislation that requires two things, voter ID, plus proof of citizenship, is being labeled by people in the Senate and people in this very Chamber as Jim Crow-era laws.

Let me remind the American people of history. It was the Democratic Party who championed the Jim Crow-era laws. And this is the farthest thing from it. In fact, Mr. Speaker, if you are doing that, then you are insulting over 70 percent of your voters, Democrats, who believe that voter ID is the best way to secure an election.

Then we have the argument that we have from BlueAnons saying that Trump is trying to steal the election, and orange man bad, and this is somehow going to fix the midterms. However, the fact is that if we are going to play that game, then you would want voter ID and you would want to secure the elections.

So please support this legislation.

I do not believe that Barack Obama in showing his voter ID was engaging in Jim Crow-era law or pushing that type of perspective. And for the same people who are advocating saying that Kristi Noem and ICE will demand your personal information and you will be under surveillance, might I remind them that they actually all authorized the reauthorization of FISA, unreformed, that violated our constitutional rights.

This is pretty simple. If you are not an American, Mr. Speaker, then you do not get to vote in our elections. This not a free-for-all country. A majority of Americans support this. A majority of the world has voter ID in place. It is not racist.

Mr. Speaker, I appreciate my colleagues and the House Administration Committee for doing this. I support all of my colleagues, and I urge them to vote for this piece of legislation.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from Texas (Ms. JOHNSON), who is a fellow member of the House Administration Committee.

Ms. JOHNSON of Texas. Mr. Speaker, many of my colleagues have said that this bill, the SAVE America Act, and the constant attempts by Republicans to clamp down on voter fraud solves a problem that doesn't exist. I couldn't disagree more.

The problem is that Republicans are losing at the ballot box. They are losing young voters, voters of color, and women. So there is a problem, that no one is buying into Republican ideas and policies and the only solution is for Republicans to engage in a coordinated effort to silence the American people.

They want to stop people from exercising their most fundamental constitutional right, the right to vote. The SAVE America Act doesn't save anything. Instead, it continues to restrict access to the ballot box, imposing a modern-day poll tax and a dangerous show-your-papers mandate.

Under this bill, Americans would be required to appear in person or by mail, just hoping that the elections clerk accepts their documentation, and present either a passport or a birth certificate to register to vote, and every single time they want to cast a ballot. A passport costs \$150, and a copy of a birth certificate could cost up to \$60. Many Americans simply can't afford to purchase these documents. Those requirements constitute a poll tax.

The reality is that one-half of Americans, more than 140 million citizens, don't have a valid passport, and as many as 69 million women who have taken their spouse's name do not have a birth certificate matching their legal name. Because this legislation has a requirement to show documents, this legislation would eliminate online voter registration.

I want to be very clear. This is how people give up. They quit trying to register to vote, and that results in them not voting, and their voices not being heard. That is the intent of what is going on here. None of this is about election integrity or protecting the ballot box.

When Republicans come to this floor to talk in front of the cameras, they say it is about this, but it is blatantly lying to the American people.

Our job in Congress is to make it easy for people to participate in our democracy, to make it easy for people to vote and not make it harder.

The bottom line is simple. The SAVE America Act and the countless number of other efforts Republicans are pushing will deny millions of Americans their right to vote.

□ 1330

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from New York (Ms. TENNEY), the founder and chair of the Election Integrity Caucus.

Ms. TENNEY. Mr. Speaker, I want to first address a comment by the ranking member, Mr. MORELLE. We both hail from New York. He is a dear friend, but I just want to point out something.

New York City Democrats actually put up a bill to allow noncitizens to vote in their elections. Our far-left leaning—and I think you can argue that very easily—Court of Appeals, New York's highest court, actually turned that down and said: No, only citizens can vote in our elections. That is New York State law, and that is our national law.

I just want to make sure that that was your response to Mr. BURCHETT to make sure you understood that we have addressed this in New York, and we have established that only citizens can vote. We want to make sure we secure the ballot and know that citizenship in this country has value.

There is nothing more profound or important for the preservation of our constitutional Republic and to keep the power in "we the people" than the sacred right to vote.

Democrats have continuously undermined election integrity, sowing the

seeds of mistrust with mail-in ballots, failing to provide ID, not proving that there is, indeed, one citizen, one vote.

This bill merely requires that you prove that you are a citizen and that we secure the ballot by knowing that there is one citizen, one vote.

As the cofounder and the chair of the Election Integrity Caucus, I would love to see every legal citizen vote in every election. I know I have as a proud American citizen.

Consider this situation: If you discovered that you had won the lottery, only to find out that a cartel member had perfectly replicated your winning lottery ticket and it was worth, let's just say, \$200 million, maybe even \$50 million, and you went to go turn in your ticket, but somebody else without a valid ID stole your identity and took your money, you would probably argue that we should have a valid voter ID.

I only wish that Americans would value their right to vote, as simple as it is, and to recognize that important act of voting as important to preserving our country, our Republic, and keeping power, again, in "we the people."

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentlewoman has expired.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield an additional 15 seconds to the gentlewoman from New York.

Ms. TENNEY. Mr. Speaker, a secure valid ID system is the only way to ensure one citizen/one vote.

I urge all of my colleagues to join the Election Integrity Caucus and stand for election integrity and make sure that every citizen eligible to vote votes in every election.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentlewoman from Wisconsin (Ms. MOORE).

Ms. MOORE of Wisconsin. Mr. Speaker, here we go again. Donald Trump lost the 2020 election. He is aggrieved about that, and so now he is peddling claims of fraud as a pretext to take over our elections and disenfranchise millions.

He tried to extort Minnesota into handing over their voter files. Fulton County was raided. He has sued Wisconsin and other States for their voter data. This bill would provide Kristi Noem access to all the voter files in every State and upend the authority and the independence of States and counties.

Why? It is so they can rig the elections and save Republicans. We have to reject the so-called SAVE America Act and save our free and fair elections and save our democracy.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. DESJARLAIS). Members are reminded to refrain from engaging in personalities toward the President.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Florida (Mr. FINE).

Mr. FINE. Mr. Speaker, sometimes in this room I feel like I am in the twilight zone. We are hearing that the world is going to end, but Americans

need to understand that this bill does two and only two things. By the way, these are things that we already do in Florida today, and we don't have issues with our elections.

Number one, it says you have to show a photo ID in order to vote. This is something that people overwhelmingly support because we have to do it in every aspect of our lives.

Second, it says you should have to prove you are a citizen in order to register.

Now, the argument that is made against these things is it is somehow racist to require them. What I find repulsive about that argument is it is racist to imply that minority communities somehow don't have the ability to go and get a photo ID, somehow don't have documentation to prove that they are an American. I have talked to my constituents about this, and they are aghast at the idea that anyone would make this claim.

Now, look, this is a real issue. In Florida, I worked on a bill when I was in the legislature where people would call who had been accidentally put on jury duty and say: Hey, I don't know how I got registered to vote, but I am not an American. We had to take them off jury duty. Democrats opposed our efforts even there to clean up the rolls.

There is nothing we have more important to do here than to make sure that Americans are confident in our elections and the results that they achieve, particularly with the kind of heated rhetoric that we say here.

Why do they oppose it? There is one simple reason: It is because they want to cheat. We pass this bill, we clean up our elections, and we make sure that Americans can have confidence in not only what we do here but in the elections that we are going to have this November.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I do want to say my distinguished colleague from Florida conveniently left out one part of what this bill does, which is to share your personal, private data with the Department of Homeland Security.

From this point forward, if this bill were to become law, every single person, when they register to vote, all their data will be sent to the Department of Homeland Security—not the department of elections, not some other department that has control over the election process—the Department of Homeland Security, which includes ICE, whose people have now killed American citizens on American streets.

If that is what Americans want—I am pretty sure Americans do not want that. Somehow the gentleman forgot to mention that that is what this bill does.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the distinguished gentleman from California (Mr. CORREA).

Mr. CORREA. Mr. Speaker, in California when you register to vote, you do so under penalty of perjury. Then

they cross-check your information to make sure that you are eligible. Then we have a very active district attorney in Orange County that says if you violated this under penalty of perjury, we are going down on you.

Instead, I would ask my friends, my colleagues on the other side of the aisle: Let's do everything we can to make sure that every eligible American actually votes.

Why would you take away the right of a veteran to vote, of a senior to vote, of somebody in the military to vote? Let's go the other way.

Democracy is stronger when we have stronger participation. Vote "no," and let's move on with democracy.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Tennessee (Mr. ROSE).

Mr. ROSE. Mr. Speaker, I rise in strong support of the SAVE America Act because nothing matters more than securing our elections. Our Republic depends on it.

Free, fair, and honest elections unmoored by fraud or suspicion are fundamental to our constitutional Republic. The right of citizens to have their votes properly counted without illegal dilution is vital to determining the rightful winner.

This legislation is straightforward. It requires proof of citizenship for voter registration and voter ID for Federal elections. It ensures only American citizens participate in American elections and provides States with tools to determine and verify the citizenship and maintain accurate voter rolls.

There is only one reason not to pass this, and we all know what that is. Some in this Chamber oppose anything that interferes with their effort to control elections and consolidate power.

Congressional Democrats sat silent as the Biden administration allowed millions of illegal immigrants into the United States. I fear the intention was to garner votes. However, my colleagues across the aisle now have an opportunity to prove me wrong by supporting this widely popular legislation.

The SAVE America Act reinforces that voting is a right only of citizens, not just anyone within our borders. Opposition to this act makes sense in that context, but that is precisely why we must pass it.

We have a duty to the American people to preserve their voice, protect their vote, and secure their sovereignty, and we must save the Republic from forces that would undermine our most sacred democratic institution. I urge my colleagues to pass the SAVE America Act.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I do think the only people in America who are confused about American citizens being the only people voting in Federal elections are my colleagues on the other side of the aisle. I think most Americans get that, which is why we see no evidence of the widespread fraud that they keep talk-

ing about, talking about a solution desperately in search of a problem.

I yield 1 minute to the distinguished gentleman from Georgia (Ms. WILLIAMS).

□ 1340

Ms. WILLIAMS of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, the SAVE America Act is back before the House today, and right along with it is yet another attempt at voter suppression. It is no coincidence that this is happening right before the midterm elections.

In January, the FBI raided the Fulton County election office, my home county, where I am a voter. That raid was a bold attempt to intimidate voters in the Fighting Fifth.

The SAVE America Act is just another part of a scheme by House Republicans and the Trump administration to take over our elections.

Atlanta's civil rights leaders, like my predecessor, the late Congressman John Lewis, faced one of the bloodiest battles over our right to vote.

The SAVE America Act will make it harder for millions of Americans to get registered to vote by requiring in-person registration at election offices—government offices with government hours. This is a burden for caregivers and any hardworking American with a 9-to-5 job.

The SAVE America Act is an unfunded mandate to silence voters. The goal of this bill is voter suppression, plain and simple.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no" on this terrible bill.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Louisiana (Mr. SCALISE), the House majority leader, to speak on the bill.

Mr. SCALISE. Mr. Speaker, "let the good times roll"; "laissez les bons temps rouler."

Mr. Speaker, I thank my friend from Wisconsin for yielding, and I thank CHIP ROY for bringing the SAVE America Act to the House floor.

This is a bill that is critically important to one of the most precious franchises in America, and that is the sacred right to vote, the right that so many gave their lives to preserve, to allow to pass on to our next generation.

The importance of that vote is even more underscored when you recognize that, yes, there have been times where people have stolen your vote, Mr. Speaker. That veteran who was talked about deserves the right to vote. If somebody votes illegally, Mr. Speaker, they are stealing that veteran's vote. They are stealing your vote. They are stealing everybody's votes if we allow people who aren't legally eligible to vote to participate in elections.

How can you best preserve that? One way is that, when you are registering to vote, you have to prove citizenship. It is in this bill. Another way is when you go to vote, you just have to show your ID.

This is not some convoluted idea, Mr. Speaker. You hear the other side talking about it as the end of the world.

Their own leaders have referred to it as "Jim Crow."

It is not the first time that they have used that phrase. They used that when the State of Georgia put an ID requirement on voting. They said it was going to be horrible and take away people's rights. It was going to disenfranchise minority voters, Mr. Speaker. That is what they said, but then what happened? We have actually got history to go look at.

After Georgia passed that law that was called every ridiculous name in the book, what we saw was record participation in elections. You actually had the University of Georgia that went and asked voters after that election, and a whopping zero percent, Mr. Speaker, of Black voters said they had a poor experience going to the ballot. Over 72 percent said they had an excellent experience at the ballot. Then, you could go further.

By the way, the American people get this. They understand that there are examples of voter fraud. I come from a State where our elections commissioner went to jail—yes, went to Federal prison—for stealing elections. We cleaned up our election system in our State. We have seen an increase in voter participation.

Why? Again, they would tell you if you actually increased the integrity of elections by requiring picture ID that somehow it is going to suppress votes, but the opposite happens, Mr. Speaker. What really does happen is that voters now have confidence in the sanctity of elections. More people will participate because they know that somebody is not going to be stealing their vote by showing up when they are not supposed to be there, just by requiring a picture ID.

Americans have been asked about this. An overwhelming 83 percent of Americans are in favor of requiring a photo ID to vote. That is not Republicans. That is all across the spectrum. Over 70 percent of Democrats support picture ID, 82 percent of Hispanic Americans support picture ID to vote, and 76 percent of Black Americans support a picture ID to vote.

If they still want to lie to people on the other side, Mr. Speaker, if they still want to try to scare people and talk about Jim Crow, then you might want to ask those same people why the Democratic Party at their convention just in 2024 required photo ID to get in. You couldn't get into the Democratic convention without showing a photo ID. If they want to call it Jim Crow, they need to look in the mirror, Mr. Speaker.

If you want to ensure the sanctity of the vote, the SAVE America Act does that. You will see higher participation because Americans across all spectrums—Black, White, Hispanic, Republican, Democrat, Independent—will know that there is a higher likelihood that nobody there is showing up illegally to steal your vote if you have the right to vote.

One person, one vote—that is the mantra that we all ought to embrace. The SAVE America Act gets us back to that great franchise of American democracy, and that is the right to vote.

Mr. Speaker, I urge everybody to pass this bill over to the Senate and then the Senate to get it to President Trump's desk so we can strengthen American democracy.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to the time remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from New York has 12¾ minutes remaining.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I will comment that we have heard repeatedly that one person who is a non-U.S. citizen voting is too many. I agree. We have laws to prevent it. How many people is it okay to deny, U.S. citizens, who want to participate in the right to vote? To me, that would be the greater evil.

We have 80 million Americans—voter-eligible U.S. citizens—who didn't vote in the last Presidential election. Isn't that astonishing? It is a big number, so it is hard to get your head around it. Eighty million Americans didn't participate.

I am not saying that is anyone's fault, but I am saying this: Our committee and our House should be focused on how we increase voter participation. How do we make it so that more people feel as though they should engage?

That is the only way we will get to the true promise of American democracy, when all 244 million Americans who are U.S. citizens participate in our elections. We should be doing everything we can to make it easy for those people. It is their God-given right, an inalienable right, as we often say.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentlewoman from Illinois (Mrs. RAMIREZ).

Mrs. RAMIREZ. Mr. Speaker, as I hear my colleagues on the other side of the aisle, what I hear is the same racist, misogynistic trash, different decade.

Republicans are invoking historical policies intended, let's be clear, to disenfranchise Americans, especially working people, women, students, indigenous people, and anyone who can't afford the burden of a new bill.

The SAVE America Act is yet another Republican attempt to intimidate and suppress the votes of anyone who threatens their extremist, white supremacist agenda.

Don't take my word for it. Just look for the threats that surround the polls, the gun-wielding masked men. It will become clear to you that Trump and Republicans want to control who votes so they can remain in power.

That is not democracy. That is destroying free, fair elections. It is just another page from the authoritarian playbook, and we must have the moral clarity in this place to stand against it, just like our ancestors did.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no" on this bill and to vote with moral clarity.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to the time remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Wisconsin has 14¾ minutes remaining.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Georgia (Mr. CARTER).

□ 1350

Mr. CARTER of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong and unapologetic support of the SAVE America Act, legislation that defends the integrity of our elections and makes one principle perfectly clear: U.S. elections are for U.S. citizens only.

This is not extreme. It is common sense. Citizenship matters. Sovereignty matters. Americans alone must decide America's future.

Yet radical Democrats have abandoned the standard. New York City has allowed noncitizens to vote in local elections. Washington, D.C., has done the same, granting political power to foreign nationals in the Capital of our Nation.

Georgia's own Senator JOHN OSSOFF, who once said that voter ID was right and appropriate, now supports his party reframing it as voter suppression.

The law didn't change. Public opinion didn't change. What changed was he and other Democrat politicians like him realized that illegal immigrants could no longer vote to keep Democrats in office.

They oppose this bill because it chips away at their voting base, plain and simple. For years, conservatives warned that this was the radical left's goal, and we were mocked for it.

That is exactly what Democrats are doing right now, fighting to allow illegal aliens to vote. This is not only grotesquely unjust, but it waters down the meaning of American citizenship.

Mr. Speaker, by passing this bill, we reaffirm a simple but sacred truth. American elections belong to Americans, no loopholes, no exceptions, no apologies.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Missouri (Mr. BELL).

Mr. BELL. Mr. Speaker, we are debating this bill because Donald Trump is still trying to overturn an election that he lost 6 years ago. Some in this body are helping him do it.

The SAVE America Act is built on the lie that the 2020 election was stolen. That lie has been investigated, litigated, audited, and debunked over and over again. Instead of accepting reality, the authors of this bill are using that lie as an excuse to take control of our elections. This is not on the level.

Let's be honest about where this is coming from. It is coming from the President himself. We are being asked to trust Donald Trump and his allies about elections while he is actively trying to subvert them. That is dangerous, and Congress should not be a willing partner in it.

Mr. Speaker, our democracy does not need a takeover. It needs truth, and this bill has none of it.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from North Carolina (Mr. HARRIS).

Mr. HARRIS of North Carolina. Mr. Speaker, what do airplanes, Costco, alcohol, tobacco, entering a nightclub, and opening a checking account all have in common? We have to show our ID.

We require identification for everyday activities. Why on Earth would we not require it for something as sacred as determining the future of this Republic?

When the SAVE America Act becomes the law of the land, three simple things will be true:

Number one, everyone who shows up to vote in a Federal election will have to show their photo ID.

Number two, States will only register American citizens to vote in Federal elections.

Number three, States will actually have to remove noncitizens from the voter rolls.

Every American—Republican, Democrat, or unaffiliated—wants to know that their vote counts and is not canceled out by someone who is here illegally. This bill ensures just that.

The right to vote is precious, and the SAVE Act restores confidence, strengthens integrity, and protects the voice of every lawful American citizen. I am confident my colleagues in the House will do the right thing and vote to secure our elections.

I now address my colleagues in the Senate.

Save America. Bring this bill to the Senate floor to debate. They should own their position in front of the American people. They must use every tool at their disposal, including the talking filibuster, to ensure that this bill makes it to the President Trump's desk.

Mr. Speaker, we cannot delay securing our elections and defending our Republic.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, one other thing States are required to do is States would be forced to give our personal information to the Department of Homeland Security and ICE. Mr. Speaker, that creates great, great concern for Members on this side of the aisle and I think the vast majority of American citizens.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Virginia (Mr. SUBRAMANYAM).

Mr. SUBRAMANYAM. Mr. Speaker, I rise in strong opposition to the so-called SAVE America Act.

The supporters of this bill claim that undocumented immigrants are overrunning our elections and voting in droves, but I will give an example of the reality.

We actually did a study in Virginia of all the election irregularities over 20 years. How many instances of noncitizens voting do my colleagues think we

found? We found zero. Another study found it was pretty much nonexistent between 1999 and 2023 in the United States. They are solving a problem that does not exist.

What this bill does do is it creates other problems that make it harder to vote. It undermines our democracy. It makes it harder for military voters who move a lot. It makes it harder for families impacted by natural disasters who lose documents. It makes it harder for the nearly 70 million women who have changed their name after marriage and have a birth certificate that no longer matches their voter IDs. It also makes it harder for the half of Americans who don't have passports.

The President claims that this is just an attempt to secure our elections. But let's be real. This is just another attempt to tilt the electoral deck in his favor.

If we want to make elections safer, we should stop threatening to nationalize elections. Stop threatening to have ICE at voting locations. Why don't we save America from this bill and vote "no."

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1½ minutes to the gentleman from Texas (Mr. ARRINGTON), the chairman of the Budget Committee.

Mr. ARRINGTON. Mr. Speaker, I thank my dear friend from Wisconsin for yielding time.

Mr. Speaker, there is not a better example of political expediency than my Democrat colleagues opposing a voter ID law on the grounds of States' rights.

First, the Constitution is clear. Rules for running elections have been delegated to the States. But in that same provision, the Constitution says Congress may at any time alter the process. I certainly think our Founding Fathers would support strengthening the integrity of our elections.

Democrats know this, Mr. Speaker. They must think the American people, though, have forgotten about their for the politicians act in the 117th Congress, where they basically codified a COVID-era and fraud-ridden election law. They included, ironically, prohibiting voter ID essentially. It also included ballot harvesting, promoting mass voting by mail, and taking taxpayer dollars to fund political campaigns.

Let's be clear. Democrats believe Congress has the power to ban voter ID but not the power to require it. This shouldn't be controversial. Requiring proof of citizenship to register and a valid voter ID is as common sense as it gets.

Mr. Speaker, American elections are for American citizens. I urge a "yes" vote on the SAVE America Act.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to how much time is remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from New York has 8½ minutes remaining.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I do want to just correct one thing. We certainly care about States' rights. We understand what the Constitution says. What I am really concerned about is people's rights.

Every American should understand this. I am going to say this again. The SAVE America Act requires States to surrender to DHS every American's entire information on the voter rolls. This is their private and personal voter information.

The SAVE America Act is a clear attempt to nationalize elections by involving Kristi Noem and the Department of Homeland Security, the rogue department, into our elections.

I would ask people to go up and down their streets. Knock on doors. Ask how many of their neighbors think that is a good idea.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2½ minutes to the gentlewoman from Massachusetts (Ms. CLARK), the Democratic whip.

Ms. CLARK of Massachusetts. Mr. Speaker, let's be clear here. Republicans aren't worried about noncitizens voting. They are afraid of actual American citizens voting. Why? It is because they are losing.

Among women they are losing by 10 points in the upcoming midterms because losing is what happens when my colleagues tell people they are going to tackle the high cost of living, and they turn around and hike their healthcare premiums. They hike grocery costs. Also, billionaires can weasel out of paying their fair share.

They are trying to say this is a voter ID bill. That is not what is happening here.

Let's just look at a typical mom. My colleagues on the other side of the aisle must know some working mothers.

The ones I hear from across my district and across this country are struggling to put food on the table for their kids. They work two jobs to try and make ends meet. They are trying to juggle getting their kids to school and maybe catch an occasional game. They fear they will never find childcare they can afford. They pray nobody in the family gets sick because they can't afford a doctor either.

□ 1400

Mr. Speaker, Republicans are going to say to those women that because they got married and changed their names, they have to go down to a clerk and prove that they are citizens, sign affidavits, and do this in person.

This is a minefield of red tape that the majority has put in front of women and American citizens and their right to vote.

Thanks to the gentlewoman from South Carolina (Ms. MACE), the so-called champion of women and safe places, this bill will now go into effect immediately, which means that primaries that are weeks from now, all of these people are going to be met with the fact that they didn't have time or know that they had to prove their citizenship.

Good luck voting, ladies.

As a kicker, the bill mandates that every State turn over their voter rolls to DHS and Kristi Noem.

Mr. Speaker, this bill is an outrage. This is election rigging. This is voter suppression.

The American people aren't going to stand for it, and nobody should vote for it.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1½ minutes to the gentlewoman from Wyoming (Ms. HAGEMAN).

Ms. HAGEMAN. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of S. 1383, the SAVE America Act, which I am proud to cosponsor and hope will pass the House floor today.

I also note that I think it is shockingly racist and sexist for my colleagues on the other side to believe that we are not smart enough to figure out how to get IDs. I can assure my colleagues that we are, even if we get married.

The SAVE America Act requires individuals to provide documented proof of U.S. citizenship along with a valid photo ID when registering to vote. This commonsense legislation strengthens election integrity through practical measures, including voter ID requirements and safeguards to prevent non-citizens from voting.

The SAVE America Act is particularly important as we continue to address the consequences of the Biden-Harris border crisis, which led to millions of individuals entering the country unlawfully.

Secure elections are fundamental to maintaining public confidence in our democratic process. The State of Wyoming has already taken steps to implement many of the reforms outlined in this bill, demonstrating that securing our elections must be a national priority.

I thank the bill's sponsors, Representative ROY and Senator LEE, as well as Chairman STEIL, for their leadership on this critical issue.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to join me in voting in favor of the SAVE America Act.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I appreciate the comments of the gentlewoman from Wyoming (Ms. HAGEMAN), but I guarantee that American women are smart, and we believe that. They will be smart enough to see that the legal hurdles and burdens being put in place in front of them by this legislation are not only unnecessary but incredibly burdensome and are an attempt to make their lives so much more difficult.

Mr. Speaker, I do just make a comment. Late last night, the Republicans offered a manager's amendment that would move up several of the effective dates in this bill, which was supposed to take effect in 2027. I think it bears noting that if this bill becomes law, it will now be effective immediately. This amendment was offered initially by our colleague, the gentlewoman from

South Carolina (Ms. MACE). Chairman STEIL took the mantle of it.

I am sure that the members of this committee know that Arkansas, Texas, Illinois, Mississippi, and North Carolina all have March primaries. In fact, many of the UOCAVA ballots for these primaries have already been mailed to Americans overseas. How are election administrators in these States even supposed to begin to comply with a new Federal law that takes effect in the middle of voting? This is, quite frankly, election malpractice. It shouldn't be before us.

Yesterday, the Committee on House Administration heard from a former executive director of North Carolina's voting who called this effective date unworkable. I think that sums it up well.

This is a mistake. It is a mistake in so many different ways.

Mr. Speaker, I just say one other thing because I have heard a lot about this now. There is not one person on this side of the aisle who thinks that non-U.S. citizens should be participating in American elections. Not one. Not one has said it, despite the repeated allegations that that is the case.

I do ask: Are congressional Republicans okay with masked Federal agents hiding their faces and hiding their badge numbers from the American public while forcing American citizens to turn over their addresses to Kristi Noem's Department of Homeland Security?

I suspect not.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to how much time is remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. FINE). The gentleman from Wisconsin has 8¾ minutes remaining.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from New Jersey (Mr. VAN DREW) to speak on the bill.

Mr. VAN DREW. Mr. Speaker, how is this even a serious debate? Think about what my colleagues on the other side are saying today.

They are saying that American minorities are not capable of showing an ID to vote. It is an insult. It is abusive. In reality, 76 percent of Black Americans support voter ID in poll after poll, and 82 percent of Latino Americans support voter ID in poll after poll.

What the left is saying is that they don't trust the American people to prove who they really are. Americans show an ID to board a plane. Americans show an ID to drive a car. Americans show an ID to open a bank account. Americans show an ID to enter Federal buildings and for a host of other reasons.

Of course we should expect it for American elections. It doesn't silence voters. It empowers voters. It only ensures that Americans are voting in American elections. For God's sake,

why would anybody be opposed to that? Think about it.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Florida (Mr. BEAN) to speak on the bill.

Mr. BEAN of Florida. Mr. Speaker, I thank the chairman for yielding me time.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today in support of the SAVE America Act, to show an ID before you cast your ballot.

Mr. Speaker, I have heard on the other side of the aisle in this very debate that it is already illegal to cast a ballot when you are not eligible to vote. It is already illegal. We don't need another law.

Mr. Speaker, it is already illegal for a minor to purchase alcohol. Yet the clerk says: Please show me your ID.

America is hungry for fair elections. I don't think it is too much to ask that we show an ID to restore election integrity. Let's give America what they want.

For all those who say that it is too much to ask to show an ID, I say that it is nonsense. One citizen, one vote is the foundation of our Republic.

Mr. Speaker, let me go ahead and do the math for you and everybody in this room. One illegal vote is one too many. Let's pass the SAVE America Act now, and let's save voter integrity and voter elections right now.

Let's do it, Mr. Speaker.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

Mr. Speaker, I note that it has been a vigorous debate, and I continue to argue that this bill, in the strongest terms, should not be passed.

I just note, particularly for Members who spoke here today, for instance, in my dear friend Chairman STEIL's district, 165,000 women in his district have a different name on their birth certificate than on their current photo ID, and 346,000 residents of Wisconsin's First District lack a passport. It would cost them nearly \$45 million for those people to purchase a passport.

For the gentlewoman from Illinois (Mrs. MILLER), 150,000 women in her district have a different name on their birth certificate, and 414,000 residents in her district lack a passport. It would cost them \$53 million.

For Mr. BURCHETT's district, 176,000 women have a different name on their birth certificate, and 390,000 residents don't have a passport, which would cost them \$50.8 million.

Mrs. LUNA has 170,000 women in her district who have different names on their birth certificates than on their photo IDs, and 319,000 of her residents lack a passport. It would cost \$41 million to purchase that for all of them.

Ms. TENNEY has 145,000 women in her district who have a different name on their birth certificate and 420,000 residents without a passport. It would cost them \$54 million.

Mr. Speaker, you have an estimated 170,000 women with a different name on

their birth certificate, and 397,000 residents lack a passport.

The list goes on and on. That is the impact of this.

□ 1410

Here is the truth, Mr. Speaker: President Trump wants to take over American elections this November to maintain his tenuous grip on power.

Republicans have a singular purpose in supporting the SAVE America Act: helping the President get what he wants. That is what they are always about: helping the President get what he wants, not the American people. Republicans are falling over each other to help Donald Trump nationalize the 2026 midterm elections.

Don't take my word for it. This is what the President is trying to do. He says it. He always says the quiet part out loud. He said: "We"—meaning the Republicans—"We want to take over. We should take over the voting in at least 15 places. The Republicans ought to nationalize the voting." That is what the President said.

That is why this bill forces States to surrender your personal, private information to the Department of Homeland Security, to the Department that has unleashed ICE brutality on the streets of America against American citizens.

The bill is so extreme that even a Republican Senator said this week that she opposes it, calling it Federal overreach.

In response, in just a moment, I will offer a motion to commit. This motion to commit would send this bill to committee with an instruction to strip the provision that gives your address, your personal information, to the Department of Homeland Security.

Mr. Speaker, I include in the RECORD the text of my amendment to the motion to commit.

Mr. Morelle of New York moves to commit the bill S. 1383 to the Committee on House Administration with instructions to report the same back to the House forthwith with the following amendment:

Page 15, strike line 17 and all that follows through page 16, line 9.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I warn Republicans that a vote against this motion to commit is a vote to send American citizens' data to the Department of Homeland Security. A vote against this MTC is a vote to put Kristi Noem and Donald Trump and ICE and the Department of Justice in charge of the midterm elections this fall.

Mr. Speaker, I urge all to vote "yes" on the motion to commit because Kristi Noem should not control our elections. Donald Trump should not control our elections. We, the American people, the people of the United States, control our elections.

Mr. Speaker, I urge defeat of the main motion and support of the motion to commit, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire how much time I have remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Wisconsin has 6¼ minutes remaining.

Mr. STEIL. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, let's bring this debate to its close. The questions before Members of the House of Representatives are very clear. One, do you think individuals should be U.S. citizens and prove that when they register to vote? Yes or no? Two, should individuals going to vote need to present voter ID upon arrival at the polls? Yes or no?

If you believe, like I do, in a commonsense proposal to make sure that only U.S. citizens are registering to vote and that people are who they say they are when they go to the polls, you should vote "yes."

The answer to this is easy. It is commonsense. It is why it is popular. Let's make sure we reinstall integrity in our elections.

For the record, let me just clear up a few misconceptions that our colleagues on the left have tried time and time again to bring.

First, are noncitizens voting in U.S. elections? We know what the Democratic playbook is. We only have to look here in our Nation's Capital, where noncitizens under current law are allowed to vote in municipal elections. We know our Democratic colleagues want noncitizens to vote in U.S. elections. It is why making sure that we are ensuring individuals who are registering to vote, in particular for Federal elections, are U.S. citizens.

My colleagues on the other side of the aisle bring up the married woman argument. As you may know, Mr. Speaker, I am engaged and going to be married in a few weeks from now. My fiancée is planning to change her name, move to the great State of Wisconsin, and register to vote. She and countless other individuals will have no problem registering under this bill. You can bring forward your identification. You can sign an attestation if you don't have the documentation.

We want to make sure that it is easy to vote and hard to cheat. We could look at our committee hearing that we had just this week where we brought in the secretary of state of Wyoming, which has strong election integrity provisions. We asked the gentleman on the record, the secretary of state. Wyoming has delivered and shown the American people that you can implement citizenship verification and photo identification without the problems, without the hyperbole that we continue to hear on the left.

We heard hyperbole as it relates to information being shared with DHS' SAVE database. They only offer the first part, that it goes to DHS. Why? Read the bill. It is actually to check if individuals who are on the voter rolls in States across the country are citizens of the United States. Our colleagues on the other side of the aisle don't want to check the voter rolls to determine if an individual is a citizen of the United States. It should leave you with a great question as to why they are concerned.

We should be checking and cleaning up the voter rolls and removing individuals who are not eligible to vote. Every citizen deserves the right to vote. One individual who is ineligible to vote is one too many because it casts out the vote of a legal United States citizen.

Finally, we hear arguments against voter ID. This is a core, commonsense principle. My colleague, Mr. BEAN, brought up the example that it is illegal for an underage individual to purchase a beer, but as you go to buy a beer, you get asked for your ID. As I said earlier, I think it is absolutely nuts that we protect our beer more than our ballots in jurisdictions across this country.

If you are like me and think that we should have voter ID, vote "yes" on the SAVE America Act. This is our opportunity, Mr. Speaker, to take a major step forward in election integrity, making sure that U.S. elections are for U.S. citizens only and making sure that people are who they say they are by checking voter ID when individuals go to vote. It is a commonsense proposal.

The American people will get to see where their Member stands, and I encourage every Member of this Chamber to vote "yes" on the SAVE America Act.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. All time for debate has expired.

Pursuant to House Resolution 1057, the previous question is ordered on the bill, as amended.

The question is on the third reading of the bill.

The bill was ordered to be read a third time, and was read the third time.

MOTION TO COMMIT

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, I have a motion to commit at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will report the motion to commit.

The Clerk read as follows:

Mr. Morelle of New York moves to commit the bill S. 1383 to the Committee on House Administration.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 2(b) of rule XIX, the previous question is ordered on the motion to commit.

The question is on the motion to commit.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the yeas appeared to have it.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question will be postponed.

□ 1100

SECURING AMERICA'S CRITICAL MINERALS SUPPLY ACT

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to House Resolution 1057, I call up the bill (H.R. 3617) to amend the Department of Energy Organization Act to secure the supply of critical energy resources, including critical minerals and other materials, and for other purposes, and ask for its immediate consideration in the House.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to House Resolution 1057, the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Energy and Commerce, printed in the bill, is adopted and the bill, as amended, is considered read.

The text of the bill, as amended, is as follows:

H.R. 3617

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the "Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act".

SEC. 2. AMENDMENT TO THE DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY ORGANIZATION ACT.

The Department of Energy Organization Act (42 U.S.C. 7101 et seq.) is amended—

(1) in section 2, by adding at the end the following:

"(d) As used in sections 102(20) and 203(a)(12), the term 'critical energy resource' means any energy resource—

"(1) that is essential to the energy sector and energy systems of the United States; and

"(2) the supply chain of which is vulnerable to disruption.";

(2) in section 102, by adding at the end the following:

"(20) To ensure there is an adequate and reliable supply of critical energy resources that are essential to the energy security of the United States."; and

(3) in section 203(a), by adding at the end the following:

"(12) Functions that relate to securing the supply of critical energy resources, including identifying and mitigating the effects of a disruption of such supply on—

"(A) the development and use of energy technologies; and

"(B) the operation of energy systems.".

SEC. 3. SECURING CRITICAL ENERGY RESOURCE SUPPLY CHAINS.

(a) IN GENERAL.—In carrying out the requirements of the Department of Energy Organization Act (42 U.S.C. 7101 et seq.), the Secretary of Energy, in consultation with the appropriate Federal agencies, representatives of the energy sector, States, and other stakeholders, shall—

(1) conduct ongoing assessments of—

(A) energy resource criticality, based on the importance of critical energy resources to the development of energy technologies and the supply of energy;

(B) the critical energy resource supply chain of the United States;

(C) the vulnerability of such supply chain;

(D) the diversity of domestic critical energy resource supply chains in the United States, including the extent to which such diversity is sufficient to prevent monopolistic behavior, a single point of failure, or market manipulation;

(E) capacity constraints on the domestic production of critical energy resources, including any such constraint caused by a shortage of material or labor;

(F) Federal regulations affecting the domestic production or importation of critical energy resources;

(G) how the energy security of the United States is affected by the reliance of the United States on importation of critical energy resources; and

(H) how adversarial nations seek to exploit critical energy resource markets to undermine investment in the United States, which may include the extent to which adversarial nations employ anti-competitive practices, price manipulation, or human rights abuses in critical energy resource production and exportation;

(2) facilitate development of strategies to strengthen critical energy resource supply chains in the United States, including by—

(A) diversifying the sources of the supply of critical energy resources; and

(B) increasing domestic production, separation, and processing of critical energy resources;

(3) develop substitutes and alternatives to critical energy resources; and

(4) improve technology that reuses and recycles critical energy resources.

(b) REPORT.—Not later than two years after the date of enactment of this Act, the Secretary of Energy shall submit to the Committee on Energy and Commerce of the House of Representatives and the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources of the Senate a report on the status of the assessments under subsection (a)(1), including a description of any regulation prescribed, guidance issued, or other action taken as a result of such an assessment.

(c) CRITICAL ENERGY RESOURCE DEFINED.—In this section, the term "critical energy resource" has the meaning given such term in section 2 of the Department of Energy Organization Act (42 U.S.C. 7101).

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The bill, as amended, shall be debatable for 1 hour, equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Energy and Commerce or their respective designees.

The gentleman from Texas (Mr. WEBER) and the gentleman from New Jersey (Mr. PALLONE) each will control 30 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Texas (Mr. WEBER).

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days to revise and extend their remarks on the legislation and to insert extraneous material on H.R. 3617.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Texas?

There was no objection.

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of H.R. 3617, the Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act, introduced by Representative JOHN JAMES, my colleague and member of the Energy and Commerce Committee from Michigan's 10th Congressional District.

Mr. Speaker, this legislation enhances the Department of Energy's ability to assess, to identify, as well as address vulnerabilities in the supply chain for energy resources that are absolutely essential to the economic and national security of these United States of America.

When the Department of Energy was organized in 1977, Mr. Speaker, the American people were suffering from

the energy security fallout of OPEC's oil embargoes. You may remember prices went up, gas lines formed, and our Nation's economy was threatened because adversarial nations took advantage of U.S. reliance on energy imports for their own interests, Mr. Speaker.

Ultimately, the answer to energy security concerns was advancing United States' production and unleashing American energy dominance. Now the United States is the premier oil-producing nation on this planet.

Today, we find ourselves, Mr. Speaker, in a similar disadvantaged position. An adversarial nation controls the access to key resources, as well as retains the ability to restrict American imports at will, threatening to bring the American economy to its knees. Instead of oil, it is critical minerals. It is rare earth elements, and it is energy resources that are essential to the daily lives of the hardworking Americans as well as a linchpin to the next-generation economy.

These resources, Mr. Speaker, are absolutely required in virtually everything we need to compete as well as defend our country from foreign threats: semiconductors, nuclear reactors, oil and gas infrastructure, the transmission system, and military weaponry, just to name a few.

Make no mistake about it, Communist China knows this and is taking advantage of it. The numbers are absolutely staggering. Communist China produces 60 percent of the world's rare earths and 90 percent of the respective processing capacity, along with 80 percent of the processing capacity for critical minerals, and the vast majority, the production, for at least 50 more critical minerals.

The Chinese wield this authority through export controls to disrupt supply chains as well as market manipulation tactics to ensure no investments flow into these job-creating industries.

Almost 50 years later, the answer to this problem lies in our ability to reshore essential energy production as well as refining facilities that can absolutely compete with our adversaries.

Importantly, Mr. Speaker, the Trump administration has prioritized opportunities to combat undue influence from those same adversaries. For instance, last week, the United States and the United Kingdom signed a memorandum of understanding on strengthening cooperation between the countries on critical minerals, supply chains, and working to develop their critical mineral accessibility away from China.

In addition, the Department of Energy's recent organizational realignment established the Office of Critical Minerals and Energy Innovation to fortify American supply chains that are essential to a reliable, affordable, and resilient energy industry.

H.R. 3617, Mr. Speaker, will absolutely enhance the work being done by the Trump Administration by

leveraging the expertise of the Department of Energy, to secure our supplies of critical energy resources.

We know what is at stake with the next-generation economy: cutting-edge technologies, like AI and advanced manufacturing, hold tremendous promise to lift up communities across the country with stable, good-paying jobs, while lowering costs for hardworking families.

Mr. Speaker, the Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act takes an important step towards solidifying the U.S. position as a global leader in economies and technologies of the future.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to support this legislation, and I reserve the balance of my time

Mr. PALLONE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, at a time when American families are struggling to make ends meet, as costs for healthcare, energy, housing, education, and groceries are skyrocketing, House Republicans are wasting floor time on a bill that does absolutely nothing to provide any relief.

To make matters worse, this bill does not help Americans address the critical mineral supply. It just props up polluting fossil fuels at the expense of cheaper and cleaner energy technologies.

Critical minerals are a critical component of many modern technologies, from our cell phones to solar panels to electric vehicles. The demand for these minerals will only increase as the world continues in transition to clean energy. We must strengthen our domestic production, processing, and recycling capabilities as well as cement relationships with our allies to access new critical mineral supplies.

Democrats were in the process of doing exactly this with the bipartisan infrastructure law that included \$3 billion for battery manufacturing and recycling, to build out a circular and sufficient supply chain that reuses critical minerals instead of letting them waste away in landfills. Instead of building on this important work, Republicans took a sledgehammer to these investments. Their big, ugly bill repealed vital clean energy tax credits and programs and canceled billions of dollars in projects that would have helped with critical mineral supply.

The Trump administration also shut down the Office of Manufacturing and Energy Supply Chains, the office Congress created to lead a lot of the clean energy and critical mineral supply chain work. The administration also canceled more than \$700 million in battery and manufacturing grants that that office had issued.

Now, this is extremely harmful to our economy and to families' monthly power bills because the rest of the world, particularly China, is making the necessary investments in the clean energy transition. In 2022 alone, China installed roughly as much solar capac-

ity as the rest of the world combined. China controls more than 70 percent of the world's battery manufacturing capacity.

Today we rely on imports of minerals such as cobalt, lithium, and graphite that are integral components of clean energy technology. China controls around 80 percent of the world's processing capacity for these critical minerals, posing serious national economic and energy security risks.

We should all be concerned about securing domestic critical mineral supply chains, but this bill does not solve the problem. In fact, it would only risk diluting resources away from critical mineral supply chains and toward fossil fuels.

The only mention of critical minerals in this bill starts and ends with its title. Instead, it focuses on critical energy resources, which is defined as any energy resource that is essential to the energy sector.

This overly broad language will inevitably result in additional resources spent on fossil fuels like coal and natural gas at the expense of actual critical mineral and clean energy supply chains.

□ 1430

With this bill, Republicans are handing the Trump administration yet another tool to prop up polluting fossil fuels at the expense of cheaper and cleaner energy technologies.

If Republicans truly want to be competitive with China, canceling clean energy projects that drive market demand is not the solution. Under Trump's watch, we have lost more than \$30 billion in American manufacturing investments.

Mr. Speaker, electricity prices are rising across the country, including in my State of New Jersey. Americans are going into debt to heat their homes this winter. President Trump has failed on his day one promise to bring down prices for American families. Instead, his big, ugly bill is projected to increase electricity prices by an additional 61 percent.

Now, Mr. Speaker, I hear from my constituents every day that affordability is their top concern. Yet, today we are here debating yet another Republican energy bill that would do nothing to lower prices for Americans. Frankly, I think it is a shame.

My concern is that with this bill, Republicans continue to ignore the affordability crisis while they give the Department of Energy new authority which they will use to give more support to their oil and gas buddies.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no," and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I yield 5 minutes to the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. JAMES).

Mr. JAMES. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman from Texas whose devastating good looks are only exceeded by his patriotism and sense of humor.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today to advance a transformative vision for our Nation's energy future through my bill, the Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act.

This legislation is a bold and necessary step to ensure that the United States leads the world in energy innovation, security, and independence. At a time when global supply chains are increasingly weaponized and controlled by foreign adversaries, America cannot afford complacency.

The Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act redefines the term "critical energy resource" to provide the Department of Energy with a clear and unmistakable mandate: Secure the minerals essential to powering our energy sector and lowering costs for Americans.

This first step ensures the Department remains squarely focused on protecting and strengthening our Nation's critical energy resources, while making sure Americans are able to put more money in their pockets.

Mr. Speaker, this bill could not come at a more important time. Today, China controls more than 90 percent of global rare earth refining capacity. Russia maintains roughly 44 percent of the world's uranium enrichment capacity and supplies a significant share of nuclear fuel imports to the United States. These are not just economic statistics; they are strategic vulnerabilities.

If we are serious about an all-of-the-above energy strategy, then we must secure the minerals that make those technologies possible.

Mr. Speaker, this is where Michigan comes into focus. Michigan's geology is rich with opportunity. The Upper Peninsula, in particular, holds significant deposits of copper, nickel, cobalt, and platinum group metals, minerals essential for defense technologies and next-generation energy systems. For more than a century, the Upper Peninsula helped power America's industrial rise. Today, it still possesses the potential to power America's energy future.

Researchers at Western Michigan University are actively working to map and evaluate Michigan's critical mineral potential, preserving and analyzing decades of geological data to better understand what resources lie beneath our soil. Their work demonstrates that Michigan is not just a part of the conversation. We are the solution, and we will continue to lead.

Mr. Speaker, strengthening domestic critical mineral production is not just about national security. It is about economic revival. By unlocking responsible—responsible—development of critical minerals in the Upper Peninsula, we can create good-paying jobs, attract investment back to Michigan, strengthen local supply chains, and bring new life to communities that have long contributed to America's prosperity. Boosting domestic mineral production means boosting Michigan's

economy, supporting miners, engineers, small businesses, and families across our State.

My legislation directs the Department of Energy to conduct ongoing assessments of supply chain vulnerabilities, develop strategies to strengthen domestic production, and invest in innovative technologies that expand American mineral independence. It equips our Nation to counter anti-competitive tactics and human rights abuses in global markets while ensuring our own energy systems are resilient, secure, and self-reliant.

This is about unleashing American energy. This is about reshoring and re-industrializing American manufacturing. This is about reducing dependence on foreign dictators and despots. For Michigan, it is about harnessing the full economic potential of both of our great and strong peninsulas.

The Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act is a cornerstone for building an energy-independent America, one powered by American workers, American resources, American ingenuity, and Michigan grit.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues on both sides of the aisle to join me in unleashing the full potential of America's energy might.

Mr. PALLONE. Mr. Speaker, I yield such time as she may consume to the gentlewoman from Florida (Ms. CASTOR), who is the ranking member of the Energy Subcommittee.

Ms. CASTOR of Florida. Mr. Speaker, I thank the ranking member for yielding the time.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in opposition to H.R. 3617. I wish we were here discussing how we could lower the cost of living. I wish in the Energy and Commerce Committee, where we are controlling the time, we could discuss a bill that will lower electricity prices for our neighbors back home. Or even as the title of this bill suggests, it is related to critical minerals, but when you read the bill, Mr. Speaker, the text of the bill, there is nothing related to critical minerals. It is kind of a sneaky little bill.

Actually, if we pass this bill, it is quite likely that energy bills and electricity bills are going to go up. It is likely that this will lead to higher costs across the entire economy. Electric bills are already sky-high.

American families last year were suffering from, on average, about 13 percent increases in their electric bills. They were much higher in many places across the country.

In Florida, they passed along a \$6 billion rate increase. They were calling it the largest rate increase and the highest rate increase in the history of the country.

What have we seen out of this administration?

We have seen just the sabotage of affordable, reliable, clean, and cheaper energy coming onto the grid, and now this.

This is an important topic. I have gained a little bit of knowledge not

just from the Energy and Commerce Committee, but I serve on the bipartisan Select Committee on the Strategic Competition Between the United States and the Chinese Communist Party. My colleague, Republican ROB WITTMAN, and I led a critical minerals working group in the last Congress.

It is clear the United States is way too reliant on China. Beijing has weaponized the critical mineral supply chain. That is why Democrats leaned into it and passed important policies in the bipartisan infrastructure law and the Inflation Reduction Act to spur domestic manufacturing and policies that enabled us to work with our partners and allies across the globe to counter China. We didn't do anything like threaten Greenland or insult Canada. We thought it was important to work together to counter all of the coercion from the Chinese Communist Party.

There have been major investments in domestic critical mineral supply chains, breaking the dependence on China. The United States energy sector relies on a broad portfolio of critical minerals, so we have to have a resilient supply chain for the advanced technologies and the innovation in energy generation, storage, and transmission.

The International Energy Agency estimates that mineral demand for clean energy technology will almost triple by 2030 and quadruple by 2024. Therefore, the development of diverse, resilient, and sustainable critical mineral supply chains, free from Chinese Communist Party influence, will be fundamental.

However, this bill just doesn't do it. As I said before, it is a sneaky, sneaky little bill.

It was introduced the last Congress. It hasn't gone anywhere because it doesn't solve any problem. It doesn't get to the heart of the matter.

Mr. Speaker, if you look at what they want to do, they say: We are going to amend the Department of Energy's mission to include securing the supply of critical energy resources—not minerals—and it directs the DOE to conduct ongoing assessments to develop strategies to strengthen critical energy resource supply chains—not minerals.

Again, this vague definition risks diverting resources away from critical minerals actually and towards—and here is where we will yank the curtain back on what this really is about. It is about everything that this administration has done to serve the fossil fuel industry, the dirty fuel industry, from canceling clean energy projects that would help lower electric bills that would bring cleaner and cheaper resources onto the grid, projects like offshore wind that is fully permitted and ready to go and provide resources we can rely on during winter storms.

This administration has canceled large-scale transmission projects to help bring the additional load we need onto the transmission system, just to make the grid more resilient in America as we suffer through these extreme weather events.

□ 1440

We cannot afford these diversions. We cannot afford the Republicans continuing to sabotage cleaner, cheaper energy in America. This kind of sneaky maneuver reminds me of what they have done on tariffs this entire Congress that we finally overcame.

Everyone kind of understands now that they are paying more at the grocery store because of the President's arbitrary tariffs. I know he likes to say: Oh, other countries are going to pay these tariffs, but all of the experts, everyone knows, prices are higher because of these import taxes.

In fact, tariffs are at their highest level in about 100 years. That is how high they are. The Budget Lab at Yale says on average households are paying probably \$1,700 more than they would have without these crazy tariffs that the President wields like a tool of retribution and fear.

That is not how you—you have got to keep the American people and their pocketbooks central rather than you are threatening Greenland. He has to have Greenland. He is going to insult Canada and put tariffs on Canada.

Thankfully, later this afternoon, we are going to debate and try to remove some of these arbitrary added taxes on the American people and lower the cost of living. That is why your shoes, your clothes, and, yes, electric equipment and metals are costing more right now. It is costing everybody way too much more.

Here is what they did here in the House of Representatives. They actually said: We are not going to be able to debate a removal of tariffs in the House of Representatives, the people's House. They were able to get away with it for a year, almost a year after the President's liberation day. They snuck it into a rule so we wouldn't have any debate on the high cost of living driven by these import taxes.

Well, last night, late last night in the House of Representatives—while you were probably watching ice skating in the Olympics—because three brave Republicans crossed over and joined all of the Democrats, we are going to have that debate.

We are going to have that vote because what is central to people's lives right now is their pocketbooks. They are just being hammered, not just by their electric bills, but also their grocery bills and everything they buy.

We have a responsibility in this House to look out for the people back home rather than serve the special interests. This Congress has been all about serving the special interests, and that includes the folks who really are pushing this bill.

It is not about critical minerals. If it were, then it would actually be in the text of the bill, but it is not. It is about, again, giving a gift to political supporters, the polluters who are running the show and the agencies that have all too much influence here in the Halls of Congress while electricity

prices are up well over 13 percent and 80 million Americans are struggling to pay their electric bills. I say Americans deserve a whole lot better. They deserve a whole lot better than what they are getting from this Congress.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to defeat this sneaky little bill, and let's get on to the debate on how we improve the cost of living and serve the people who sent us here.

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I yield 5 minutes to the gentleman from Alabama (Mr. PALMER).

Mr. PALMER. Mr. Speaker, I want to address some of the things my Democratic colleagues have said. They are really high on China. They look at China as a model for America. Apparently, they like how they do their economy. They like their energy production.

I would just like to point out, Statistical Review of World Energy reports that coal accounted for 58 percent of China's energy. Oil was at 20 percent, and natural gas was at 10 percent. Some of my colleagues struggle with math. I will just add that up for them. That is 88 percent of their energy production comes from hydrocarbon sources. That means that the remaining 12 percent came from hydroelectric, solar, or wind.

What is interesting about this is they make it seem as though China is just dominating the world in renewable energy production. That is approximately the same amount of renewable energy production as the United States. It doesn't sound like the model.

I also wanted to point out—because they keep talking about higher energy costs—the increase in energy costs has occurred in the States with the most stringent requirements for renewable energy: California, New York, New Jersey, Massachusetts, Connecticut. That is where energy costs have gone up the most. That is where people are struggling the most to pay their energy bills.

Mr. Speaker, I would like to speak in support of H.R. 3617, introduced by the gentleman from Michigan (Mr. JAMES), my friend and colleague. If the United States hasn't learned anything else from the war in Ukraine, it should be this, this is a fundamental principle: No nation, let alone America, should be reliant on adversarial nations for energy and refined materials, critical minerals, rare earth elements that would threaten our economy and threaten our national security, but that is where we find ourselves and where we put ourselves in terms of access to critical minerals, processed and refined critical minerals.

H.R. 3617 addresses this. It is a crucial challenge facing the United States today, how to decouple and derisk ourselves from China and other foreign adversaries and build resilient, secure, domestic energy and critical mineral supply chains?

Our country is blessed with an abundance of energy and critical mineral

resources that are a linchpin to our economy. They are a linchpin to our national security and a linchpin to the new and emerging energy technologies that we are trying to develop here.

Yet we are stuck under the thumb of Communist China, who exerts their dominance over energy supply chains, critical mineral supply chains to undermine U.S. interests. This is not a new issue, but one that has grown over the last several decades.

The United States used to be a leading producer and refiner of many critical minerals and rare earth elements. We developed the technology to refine rare earth elements, to produce magnets that are critical in our economy and to our national security.

By the late 1990s, most of that industry, especially refining, went overseas. This trend has led us to where we are today. The United States is now almost 100 percent import reliant on a dozen critical minerals and heavily reliant on imports for more than half of all critical minerals.

The challenge we face today is exacerbated by burdensome permitting processes and regulations, uncertainty in commodity pricing, and market manipulation by Communist China.

A few years ago, I launched the Western Hemisphere Prosperity and Security Alliance as a soft power alternative to China. The Western Hemisphere Prosperity and Security Alliance could help us shed our dependence on Communist China when it comes to these critical resources.

H.R. 3617 directs the Secretary of Energy to coordinate with industry and relevant stakeholders to identify ways to diversify domestic critical energy resources and supply chains.

As part of that assessment, the DOE Secretary will assess how Federal regulations may be affecting domestic production of critical energy resources and minerals and how adversarial nations seek to exploit those markets to undermine investment in the United States.

Solving this issue is paramount, and we must address it before we are too late. Critical minerals and their supply chains are vital. We cannot allow the prosperity of future generations to be dictated by adversarial nations.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to keep America at the forefront of the next generation's economy and support H.R. 3617.

Mr. PALLONE. Mr. Speaker, I yield such time as he may consume to the gentleman from Ohio (Mr. LANDSMAN), a member of our committee.

Mr. LANDSMAN. Mr. Speaker, America has become unaffordable for so many Americans. Many families, if not most families, are now struggling to pay their bills, including their electric bills. Congress should be focused entirely on lowering costs.

The bill does not do that, unfortunately. It is not about securing critical minerals. It gives the Department of Energy broad, open-ended, authority

that this administration has already used to roll back environmental protections, cancel energy projects, and drive costs up.

The bill would be a win for coal and natural gas, not American ratepayers. For this reason, at the appropriate time, I will offer a motion to recommit this bill back to committee. If the House rules permitted, I would have offered that motion with an important amendment.

My amendment is straightforward. The bill would not take effect until at least the Secretary of Energy certifies that the tariffs imposed after January 20 are not increasing costs and not disrupting the supply chain for critical minerals while, unfortunately, they, of course, are doing both those things.

Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to insert the text of this amendment into the RECORD immediately prior to the motion to recommit.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. CRAWFORD). Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Ohio?

There was no objection.

Mr. LANDSMAN. Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to support the motion to recommit.

□ 1450

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, it is a shame. Instead of trying to score political points, the Democrats should support our efforts to address supply chain vulnerabilities that Communist China actively exploits to the detriment of these American people that we serve.

Mr. Speaker, the intent of this bill is for the Department of Energy to take a holistic view of resources that are critical to the economic as well as the national security of the United States, regardless of the application.

Mr. Speaker, this bill establishes DOE's overarching responsibility for the security of the supply chains of the energy sector. When the Department of Energy was organized in 1977, energy security was a core concern as a result of the oil crisis in the seventies.

I was a teenager back then. I remember waiting in lines to get gasoline. Now, we face similar threats amidst the development of next-generation industries like AI as well as advanced manufacturing.

Mr. Speaker, after decades of degrowth policies that drove energy production and refining abroad, our adversaries have exploited vulnerabilities and left American families susceptible to actions from places like Communist China.

We have already seen Communist China take steps to limit exports of minerals, such as antimony, that are essential to defense manufacturing for things like radar systems.

Energy and Commerce Committee Republicans are focused on all critical energy resources, including critical minerals. Similarly, the Trump administration has announced substantial

funding opportunities for critical mineral development touching every part of the supply chain, including mapping, mining, refining, and even recycling.

This bill mirrors the administration's momentum on critical mineral policy and will further focus the Department of Energy on developing that very sector.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. PALLONE. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in strong opposition to H.R. 3617. I think it is important to provide a little perspective here. At a time when Americans are struggling to afford their electricity bills, we are wasting floor time debating a bill that will not even meaningfully improve our critical mineral supply chains.

In fact, this bill is just a retread from last Congress. That is right. The Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act, so-called, was included in House Republicans' polluters over people act last Congress, a bill that sold the American people out to corporate polluters.

Here we are again, debating the same old bill because Republicans have no new ideas. H.R. 3617 is merely a distraction from the fact that they have no real plans to address issues that are important to Americans, like their increasingly unaffordable electricity bills.

My Republican colleagues need to start taking the affordability crisis facing the American people seriously. Eighty million Americans are struggling to pay their utility bills. Electricity prices are rising more than twice as fast as inflation across the country. Families are having to choose between paying for housing, medicine, food, or keeping their lights on. It is just unacceptable.

As elected officials, we have a responsibility to address this issue. We must address this because hardworking Americans are in desperate need of relief.

Yet, to President Trump and his Republican accomplices, the affordability crisis is just a made-up scam. That is what the President says. I have said it before, but it is worth repeating: Republicans' big, ugly bill will raise electricity prices by a staggering 61 percent, and the American people are hurting because of President Trump's policies.

We should be focused on advancing bipartisan legislation to end this affordability crisis, not a bill that seeks to provide additional support for the fossil fuel industry under the guise of supporting critical minerals. Republicans would rather spend precious floor time on a bill to support their fossil fuel friends instead of supporting the American people.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time, and I urge opposition to the legislation.

Mr. WEBER of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

Mr. Speaker, H.R. 3617 is important. You can't make this stuff up, what they are saying across the aisle.

H.R. 3617 is important to securing our critical energy resource supply chains and eliminating our dependence on foreign adversaries like we have been talking about, Communist Red China.

This bill takes a holistic approach, Mr. Speaker, in ensuring vulnerable supply chains, impacting absolutely every single corner of the United States' energy sector, are addressed by the Department of Energy, and its passage is vital to their success.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to join me in supporting H.R. 3617 and vote "yes."

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. All time for debate has expired.

Pursuant to House Resolution 1057, the previous question is ordered on the bill, as amended.

The question is on the engrossment and third reading of the bill.

The bill was ordered to be engrossed and read a third time, and was read the third time.

MOTION TO RECOMMIT

Mr. LANDSMAN. Mr. Speaker, I have a motion to recommit at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will report the motion to recommit.

The Clerk read as follows:

Mr. Landsman of Ohio moves to recommit the bill H.R. 3617 to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

The material previously referred to by Mr. LANDSMAN is as follows:

Mr. Landsman moves to recommit the bill H.R. 3617 to the Committee on Energy and Commerce with instructions to report the same back to the House forthwith, with the following amendment:

Add at the end the following:

SEC. 4. CERTIFICATION.

This Act, and the amendments made by this Act, shall not take effect until the date on which the Secretary of Energy publishes a certification that tariffs issued after January 20, 2025, are not increasing costs and contributing to supply chain disruptions for critical energy resources.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 2(b) of rule XIX, the previous question is ordered on the motion to recommit.

The question is on the motion to recommit.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the yeas appeared to have it.

Mr. LANDSMAN. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question will be postponed.

RELATING TO A NATIONAL EMERGENCY BY THE PRESIDENT ON FEBRUARY 1, 2025

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to the order of the House of February 10,

2026, I call up the joint resolution (H.J. Res. 72) relating to a national emergency by the President on February 1, 2025, and ask for its immediate consideration in the House.

The Clerk read the title of the joint resolution.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to the order of the House of February 10, 2026, the joint resolution is considered read.

The text of the joint resolution is as follows:

H.J. RES. 72

Resolved by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled, That pursuant to section 202 of the National Emergencies Act (50 U.S.C. 1622), the national emergency declared by the finding of the President on February 1, 2025, Executive Order 14193 (25 Fed. Reg. 02406), is hereby terminated.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The joint resolution shall be debatable for 1 hour, equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Foreign Affairs or their respective designees.

The gentleman from Florida (Mr. MAST) and the gentleman from New York (Mr. MEEKS) each will control 30 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Florida.

□ 1500

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include extraneous material on the resolution under consideration.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Florida?

There was no objection.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, we are about to have a debate apparently for about an hour. We are going to have that debate for one reason and one reason alone. Democrats in the House and in the Senate as well, refuse to recognize that there is a crisis because of fentanyl entering the United States of America.

Whether on our northern border, on our southern border, through the Caribbean, or other places, they refuse to recognize that threat anywhere. Specific to the debate today, they would like to end an executive order relating to the crisis of fentanyl coming across our northern border.

Democrats don't recognize that there is a crisis and that it is killing thousands of Americans, tens of thousands of Americans, each and every year. They are trying to literally end that executive order that identifies the national emergency, an emergency that is literally agreed upon by our northern neighbor, Canada. Even Canada acknowledges that they have this as a national emergency.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I think I have heard that story before that this is all about drugs. If I recall correctly, the former President of Honduras probably put more drugs in the United States than Canada has combined. The President of the United States didn't say that was an emergency. He pardoned him. I have heard it before. It is all about drugs. That was the case.

What is the case and what is a fact is that in the last year, tariffs have cost American families nearly \$1,700. That cost is expected to increase in 2026. That is the case. Since these tariffs were imposed, U.S. exports to Canada have fallen by more than 21 percent.

When I go home, my constituents aren't telling me they have an extra \$1,700 to spare. They are asking me to lower grocery prices, lower the price of healthcare, and make life more affordable. That is what this is about. It is about the American people and making things affordable for them.

Today's vote is simple. It is very simple. Will my colleagues on the other side of the aisle vote to lower the cost of living for American families, or will they keep prices high out of loyalty to Donald J. Trump?

That is what this vote is. That is why we pressed for this vote today. That is why a day is a day, and we finally get our chance to have the Members of the House vote their conscience. Do they vote for the President and his ways, or do they vote for their people, their constituents?

Let's be clear about this so-called emergency Donald Trump declared on Canada and so many other countries where no emergency exists. For over 50 years, emergency authorities have been declared. What have they been? Yes, they have been for civil wars. Pandemics? I think that is an emergency. A massive human rights crisis could be an emergency.

Canada is none of those things. Canada isn't a threat. Canada is our friend. Canada is our ally. Canadians have fought alongside Americans, whether it was in World War II or the war in Afghanistan, where 165 Canadians gave their lives after our country was attacked. There is no national emergency. There is no national security threat underpinning these threats.

In an interview just last night, Donald J. Trump admitted he placed tariffs on Switzerland. Why? I will tell my colleagues why. It is simply because he didn't like the way their leader spoke to him. He put tariffs on Switzerland.

That is not a strategy. That is impulse. That is a person who is just trying to say that he is the king. Mr. Speaker, guess what. That impulse, who is going to pay the price for it? Who is going to pay the price for that impulse? I will tell my colleagues who. It is the American people.

Our morning coffee, our kids' chocolate, lifesaving medical devices, those are the Canadian goods that are being

hit by 35 percent tariffs. Americans are paying more for healthcare and their daily essentials during an affordability crisis, all because of a manufactured emergency and one person's ego.

The damage doesn't stop there. What about American products? They are being boycotted across Canada. Don't believe me? Just look at the President's social media posts from just 2 days ago where he said:

"Ontario won't even put the U.S. spirits, beverages, and other alcoholic products, on their shelves."

Tourism from Canada is down 30 percent. People in the hospitality industry—Las Vegas, my home State of New York, and the chairman's home State of Florida—are losing their jobs because Canadians do not want to come to the United States of America.

What are the people getting in return? I will tell my colleagues what they are getting. They are getting higher electricity costs during one of the coldest winters in modern history. They are getting higher food prices and higher costs for industrial goods and healthcare.

Mr. Speaker, this is heads, we lose; tails, we lose.

Tariffs are bad for American workers. They are bad for businesses. They are bad for working families. Instead of addressing the affordability crisis, which the President has called a hoax, Republicans have spent a year blocking this vote to protect Donald Trump, rather than doing their job to help the American people and what the American people did send us here to do, which is to lower costs. That ends today.

Every Member now has to go on record. Do they stand with the disastrous trade war or with their constituents who are demanding relief? It is time we end this so-called national emergency because the only emergency here is the economic one created by Donald J. Trump's tariffs.

I urge the adoption of the resolution and the termination of these unnecessary and harmful tariffs, which are just taxes on the American people.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

THE SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to refrain from engaging in personalities toward the President.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, there is a lot to correct from that diatribe I just heard. I am going to start to go through some of that.

Number one, who will pay the price? That was a question begged by my colleague. Who will pay the price? It is a very sad thing to have been asked this by my colleague.

It is important to remember what this resolution is. This resolution ends an emergency related to fentanyl. I would say to the gentleman over here that 5,000 people a year die in his State alone from fentanyl.

If he wants to beg the question of who is going to pay the price for him

trying to end an emergency that actually for the first time has Canada dealing with fentanyl because of the pressure being put on them, who is going to pay the price? It is going to be 5,000 more of his State's residents. That is who is going to pay the price.

I think the gentleman next to me mentioned as well, when he goes home, this is what he sees when he goes home. When he goes home each and every year, because they don't want to address fentanyl, they are going to see 5,000 less faces because they don't want to deal with fentanyl.

He said it himself. He sees no emergency. The "so-called emergency" were the exact words used, the so-called emergency. There is no emergency that exists, to quote my colleague. If 5,000 people were dying in my State every single year from one thing and one thing alone, I think that is an emergency. His people will pay the price.

Let's be clear again about what this resolution is and what it is not. It is not a debate about tariffs. We can talk about those, but that is not really what it is. This is Democrats trying to ignore that there is a fentanyl crisis. Again, they just ignored it. They just literally said it doesn't exist.

□ 1510

I will read again directly from the bill: "... the national emergency declared by the finding of the President on February 1, 2025, in Executive Order 14193 ... is hereby terminated."

That is their language. They are terminating the executive order, and it is an EO on the fentanyl crisis at the northern border.

It matters to talk about that it is the northern border. Why? That is because my Democratic colleagues don't believe that there is a crisis there, but my Democratic colleagues don't believe there is a fentanyl crisis under any circumstance. Any fentanyl that flows into the country, they don't see any of it as a national emergency.

We have yet to find a place where Democrats say that drugs are a national emergency. They made it clear that there is not one single circumstance where they see the deaths of millions of Americans due to fentanyl as a crisis. They don't see that anywhere.

Mr. Speaker, let's look again at my colleague's own State. This is a report. Last report, almost 5,000 deaths, or just under that.

Mr. Speaker, we can talk about the largest fentanyl lab found in Canada. Where was that found in Canada that was recently shut down because of the pressure that President Trump is putting on Canada? It was 30 miles from the New York border. They didn't close it down 2 years ago or 3 years ago. Why not? It was because Canada didn't have the pressure put on them to do so. That is not a coincidence.

Mr. Speaker, again, do you know who is going to pay the price for taking the pressure off of Canada? It is going to be

the constituents of my colleague, where 5,000 people a year die from fentanyl overdose. If I were him, I would think that is a pretty big emergency.

Mr. Speaker, I lost 2,500 brothers and sisters in Afghanistan over the course of 20 years. Our country took that extremely seriously for every single one of them. Mr. MEEKS' State is losing double that from fentanyl alone every single year, and he says that he sees no emergency. That is sad for the people of New York.

The administration is doing everything that they can to defeat fentanyl, while my Democratic colleagues are willing to do everything that they can to have those deaths continue. They don't support striking drug boats. We know that much. They don't support removing cartel leaders. We know that. Apparently, they don't support tariffing a country that acknowledges that they have a drug trafficking crisis but weren't doing anything to fix it.

I am going to suspect that my colleague over here doesn't know this as well: Last year, Justin Trudeau, former Prime Minister of Canada, himself addressed the fentanyl problem and said that it needed to be eradicated. That is the Prime Minister of Canada, or former Prime Minister.

It was so bad that Canada created a fentanyl czar, who admitted that they underestimated—Canada underestimated the toll of the fentanyl crisis and what it had taken, and they literally called it, according to the Canadian fentanyl czar, a national security threat.

The northern border, for whom this emergency exists, is acknowledging that there is an emergency, a national security threat, but I guess my colleagues think that they know better.

Mr. Speaker, take the Chinese-run fentanyl lab that I mentioned being shut down, or one of them being shut down, of many. There was over 800 pounds of fentanyl confiscated. Why is it being shut down now and not before? It is being shut down now because the administration had the stones to put economic pressure on them, but my colleagues want to take that pressure off because they don't worry about their people dying in their State.

It is simple. Whether you are a Republican or a Democrat, if you care about the U.S. Government responding to millions of Americans being killed by fentanyl, this is the policy that addresses that. Even our northern partner acknowledges that.

The truth is that Canada hasn't wanted to put effort into cracking down on drugs. They didn't want to close the Chinese fentanyl labs. They didn't want to increase their spending on border patrols, but they have to do it because President Trump is putting pressure on them.

Tariffs get more attention than strongly worded letters, and millions of Americans' lives are being saved because President Trump has declared

this national emergency and is actively forcing our neighbors, like Canada, to act. It is saving lives.

My colleague wants to make sure that that no longer happens because he doesn't see an emergency, even though 5,000 people from his State are dying every single year. That is pretty sad. That is where the price is paid.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, we have had some time from the last time that we were on this floor. If he were so serious about drugs, I asked the chairman previously: Why would the President of the United States pardon one of the biggest drug dealers who was killing Americans, Juan Orlando Hernandez. The last time, the gentleman said that he hadn't spoken to the President and didn't know why.

Mr. Speaker, if he is so interested in stopping drugs, maybe he could have and should have had a conversation.

Let me just tell you something about drugs, how much drugs are coming in from Canada, because that is what this is about. As a former special narcotics prosecutor—that is me—I know a little bit about that. Saying that you are going to focus and stop certain things from coming across the border of Canada, as if it is coming across in a cluster like it is an emergency, is just an out-and-out lie.

The fact of the matter is that if you look at the Federal prosecutions—this just came out not too long ago—for narcotics in the United States of America, it just came out that, under the Trump administration, Federal drug prosecutions fell to the lowest level in decades. It talked about that Federal drug prosecutions dropped 10 percent in 2025 as agents changed their focus to immigration, that the number of new cases being filed is the lowest in decades according to a Reuters analysis. High-priority drug investigations have stalled since Donald Trump took office. It doesn't sound like the President of the United States is really concerned about drug prosecutions.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1½ minutes to the gentleman from Massachusetts (Mr. NEAL), an individual who really knows about taxes and tariffs, the ranking member of the Ways and Means Committee.

Mr. NEAL. Mr. Speaker, I thank the ranking member for the time.

Mr. Speaker, I led the negotiation on USMCA, and 195 Republicans voted for USMCA and 197 Democrats voted for USMCA. It was a bipartisan effort.

Tariffs, as threatened or imposed, can have an outcome, but not when we look at Brazil and say that we don't like the result of the Presidential election and that we are going to impose 50 percent tariffs, or that we are going to close a bridge as it goes to Canada, like Canada is an enemy. I have not met anybody in America who was ever mad at Canada for anything. They have

been a great friend, great ally, and a great neighbor.

Let's have a tariff on NATO because of Greenland. Let's have a tariff on South Korea because of who they talk to in an international arena. Let's impose tariffs on our NATO allies or on European Union because we don't like this or that. We won't negotiate. We will just arbitrarily impose tariffs.

Mr. Speaker, do you know what the most ironic thing is in this debate? Heretofore, I have never met a Republican in Washington who was in favor of tariffs.

The party of Ronald Reagan embracing these tariffs is unheard of. The party of George Bush, Sr., embracing tariffs, part of their existence was to break down trade barriers everywhere. If you want to target a tariff based upon a particular product, gotcha. That is understood, but not the way that these tariffs are being imposed. The ranking member is on the right path.

□ 1520

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, before I yield to my colleague, Mr. ISSA, I would ask my colleague—I am happy to yield a moment—would you like to say 5,000 deaths in New York is an emergency?

Crickets.

Mr. Speaker, I yield to the gentleman from New York (Mr. MEEKS) for the purpose of a colloquy.

Would you like to respond: 5,000 deaths in New York is an emergency.

Mr. MEEKS. Have you found out yet why Mr. Hernández has been pardoned?

Mr. MAST. Do you want to answer?

Mr. MEEKS. I want to find out right now because I would prosecute him.

Mr. MAST. I gave you my speculation. It might have been making room for Maduro.

Mr. MEEKS. Have you had a conversation with the President about it?

Mr. MAST. We didn't have that talk, but he might be making room for Maduro.

Mr. MEEKS. Well, you should. If you consider—why aren't you prosecuting cases now?

Mr. MAST. I asked you a question. Would you like to say 5,000 deaths are an emergency in New York?

Mr. MEEKS. It would not be coming from Canada.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to direct their comments to the Chair.

Mr. MAST. Can we engage in a colloquy? Is that something we can do?

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Even in the colloquy, the comments are to be directed to the Chair.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, then, in this colloquy, I would present the opportunity again: Would my colleague like to deny or admit that 5,000 deaths in New York related to fentanyl is an emergency?

Mr. MEEKS. Did the fentanyl come from Canada?

Mr. MAST. Much of it did. Would you like to hear some stats?

I am sorry, Mr. Speaker. I guess you need to direct your—

Mr. MEEKS. What source is that?

Mr. MAST. You have to direct your remarks to the Speaker.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, what source is the gentleman talking about?

Mr. MAST. I would point to just Canada, number one. Canada, in the last year, had an additional 8,000 fentanyl-related arrests because they finally started cracking down on it. There was an increase of 80 percent that was seized at the U.S.-Canada border because of the actions taking place, so, yes, there were deaths going on in New York.

Mr. MEEKS. No, I think that is Canada is doing law enforcement on its side, and we are not doing now law enforcement on our side.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I am going to end this colloquy and reclaim my time.

Mr. MAST. I note for the record, again, ample opportunities have been given for my colleague, who represents New York, to just say 5,000 fentanyl-related deaths in New York is an emergency. Silence, crickets, no response, because the death of 5,000 of his constituents apparently means nothing to him.

Mr. Speaker, I yield such time as he may consume to the gentleman from California (Mr. ISSA).

Mr. ISSA. Mr. Speaker, I thank the chairman for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I am going to slightly drift off, but not really leave this point.

Fentanyl kills 5,000 in New York. It kills 100,000 in the U.S. It kills thousands in Canada and thousands in Mexico. Those numbers are staggering, but those numbers are a small part of the tragedy to families.

For every fentanyl death in our countries, there are families who are suffering. For every fentanyl death, there is somebody who goes to the hospital multiple times. For every fentanyl death, there are three or four people who are living homeless, drug addicted, and their families are suffering. For every death, there is, in fact, a broken relationship somewhere. That is not 100,000 in America. That is millions in America.

Mr. Speaker, I don't know of an American that you talk to about fentanyl who won't tell you that they know someone whose family, their health, or their child has been destroyed by fentanyl, many of them being destroyed as we speak.

There are about 1,900 miles of Mexican border between the United States and Mexico. I represent about 80 of those miles right there outside of San Diego. I have seen the border closed as best it possibly could in an amazing way. I have seen submarines still coming in the Pacific to try to circumvent it. I know we will never get to zero.

All the President has asked Canada to do is show the kind of effort they can afford as a First World country,

and that effort should be far greater at all of their borders than Mexico's, which is a relatively poor country. That effort should be shown. If it is shown, the President has made it clear that these tariffs will immediately go away.

This isn't a tariff that is just because you don't like someone. It is a tariff that says this behavior, this leverage, is being used for one purpose: to get you to live up to a standard that is in your own best interests.

By the way, the 5,500 miles of land border between the U.S. and Canada is our longest by far. The thousands of miles of sea border that Canada needs to also patrol is huge. This President stands with Canada to help them do it, to help in technical ways and every other way, but we cannot allow millions of Americans and countless other Canadians and Mexicans to continue to suffer without us having the real empathy to do something about it.

The chairman said: What about the 5,000? We got this answer: How do you know that they came from Canada? I am sorry, but every time we have a major bust on the Mexican border, my agents tell me that we are getting maybe 10 percent, maybe 20 percent in certain areas. We are never getting 80 or 90 percent. The reality is that those are indications of a small amount of what is getting in through Buffalo and other borders into the United States.

Although the gentleman from New York is from a fairly populous State, he is not from a State without a large rural border, one that you can simply walk across with impunity normally, which has been used to smuggle drugs successfully.

The point I make here today—and I thank the chairman for the time—is: Every life matters. If the President of the United States cares about his 5,000 or 500 or 5 or 1 enough to use the power of the executive office to get the right thing out of our neighbors to the north and the south, then I want to stand with him. I would never take away a tool being used to save even one life, much less hundreds of thousands of lives and millions of families.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I thank Representative ISSA for his remarks, and I believe there will be another Representative from California speaking on the other side. I will be curious if that Representative will acknowledge the thousands of deaths from fentanyl in California being an emergency.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, Canada plays virtually no role in the United States' fentanyl influx, especially compared to other countries targeted by the Trump administration. Canada contributes less than 1 percent to our southern neighbor's border of street fentanyl, less than 1 percent. That is not according to me, because I don't know where he gets his facts, but that is according to

the DEA, as well as the Canadian Government, 1 percent.

We do a lot of trade with Canada, and in Florida's 21st District, the chairman's district, exports to Canada support 1,650 jobs. Many of them will begin to lose their jobs. This is about affordability. This is about job creation and the economy. I wonder what he is going to say to those 1,650 people in Florida's 21st District.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentlewoman from California (Ms. SANCHEZ), a member of the Committee on Ways and Means.

Ms. SANCHEZ. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in support of this resolution rejecting President Trump's illegal tariffs on Canada—our friend, our neighbor, and our ally.

The truth of the matter is that the arguments on the other side of the aisle are to distract. The vast majority of fentanyl that comes into the United States comes from China and comes in via boats in our ports of entry.

They want to distract to take away from the real issue, which is that the Constitution is very clear that the power to levy tariffs and regulate trade belongs to the Congress, not to the President. Yet, too many in this body are willing to give up that authority because President Trump demands blind loyalty from them.

The fact is, we already have a trade agreement with Canada. President Trump negotiated it, and this body ratified it. There is a lawful review process that goes into effect next year to find ways to improve it.

That is how responsible governments handle trade disputes, by following the law, not through weird social media tantrums about bridges and hockey trophies or through childish threats to annex a sovereign nation and make it the 51st State.

His daily barrage against Canada does not make him look tough. It is certainly not strategic. It is just reckless. Frankly, it is bizarre.

We are now seeing the consequences of allowing the President's uninged behavior go unchecked. American families, small businesses, and farmers are paying the price for these endless trade wars.

Trump's tariff tantrums have cost households more than \$1,600 a year in higher prices. Families in the United States are paying more for groceries, cars, housing, utilities, the basic necessities. What about the deaths from families that are struggling from food insecurity? Do those not matter?

It is pushing our allies closer to our adversaries. Last month, Canada announced it was lowering its 100 percent tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles. Those tariffs were imposed in coordination with the United States during the leadership of the Biden administration.

□ 1530

That cooperation strengthened our position against China.

Now, because of this administration's chaotic trade policies, that progress is

unravelling. Rather than target the real bad actors, the President is picking fights with our friends. Instead of standing up for their constituents and defending Congress' constitutional authority over trade, most Republicans in this Chamber are surrendering it to the President choosing blind allegiance to him over the people that they are supposed to represent.

I commend the few Republicans who have the courage to break with the President and join with Democrats to force this vote. Reasserting our constitutional authority over trade should never have been a partisan issue.

I urge my colleagues to support this resolution. Let's restore sanity and stability to our American trade policy.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I would let my colleague know that just one—because he said Canada plays almost no role in fentanyl deaths—one 70-pound bust of fentanyl alone was enough to kill every single person in New York City. Again, my colleague is unwilling to acknowledge that this is about fentanyl, because that is literally what the executive order says, and unwilling to acknowledge that 5,000 deaths in his State is an emergency, certainly in 1 year.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Texas (Mr. ARRINGTON), the chair of the Budget Committee.

Mr. ARRINGTON. Mr. Speaker, the Democrats fought Republicans to require voter ID to protect the integrity of our elections, the cornerstone of our democratic Republic. Now they stand here today on the floor of the people's house, fighting the President in his effort to protect the lives of the American people against what is the most imminent threat and the number one cause of accidental deaths and drug overdoses.

We know where the drugs are coming from, pouring into our country and our communities, killing our friends, killing our families. I can't think of a greater security concern than this. The President has effectively and appropriately promoted and defended America's economic and security interests by the use of tariffs.

Today, Mr. Speaker, as a result, we have a lower trade deficit than we have had since 2009. By the way, the top 20 economies in the world that we do business with had twice the tariffs on our products, three times the tariffs when you measure agriculture products, and the deficit is going down. We have quadrupled revenue to strengthen America's balance sheet and pay down the tax on our children, which is the deficit. We have gone from 6.3 percent to 5.9, and exports are at an all-time high.

Now, what is the issue here? It is not about 301, unfair trade practices, although there are plenty of grievances against our northern neighbor in that regard. This isn't about USMCA. The USMCA products flowing from Canada to the United States are exempt.

Eighty-five percent of the products, we are not talking about that. It is not about 232.

This is about one particular authority that this Congress empowered our commander-in-chief with to deal with unusual threats outside of the U.S. that would impact our national security, our foreign policy, and our economy.

Now, I can't think of anything more unusual, and I can't think of a bigger threat than a chemical warfare waged against the United States of America. Any President worth his salt, any commander-in-chief, would be derelict in their duty if they didn't use every tool at their disposal to stop it.

For my President to expect our neighbor from the north to have the same vigilance and the same urgency as he has because of the American people's mandate to stop this madness and protect our children, God bless him. God bless him.

For my colleagues to run to the floor, to raise their hands, and to scream foul that this President is somehow using tariffs in a way that has nothing to do with our interest, to talk about food security, we could go down the list. We wouldn't have food insecurity if we didn't have a cost of living crisis where the fuse was lit by unbridled spending. We could go down the list. Yes, we are doing something about that. We are bringing interest rates down. We are bringing real wages up. We are also preserving food stamps so they are not being defrauded or being spent on people here illegally.

Mr. Chairman, I would love to keep debating all day long. God bless America, and go West Texas.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, may I inquire as to how much time is remaining.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from New York has 16 minutes remaining.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, the talk time is soon over because of what I am hearing from the other side. Basically what this is about is the American people having a chance to see where their Members are, whether they want to—they will judge ultimately—believe that this is an emergency from what they hear and know of the President or whether they are concerned about their cost of living, whether they are concerned about that hot chocolate, whether they are concerned about that coffee, or whether they are concerned about life-saving medical devices.

What this will do—which has been blocked for almost a year—is simply to have a vote on the House floor so that the American people can see because then ultimately, we will know which way is the right way for them.

We are here to represent the citizens of the United States of America, not a President. We soon will have a vote because that is what is going to happen, which is what I have been asking for for over a year. If you think this is an emergency, if you believe the Presi-

dent, you are going to vote that way. If you think this is going to be accountable to the American people, if you think that the American people will say that the cost of living, the cost of electricity, the cost of food every day they go to the market is of concern to them, they will be watching how you vote on this bill. They will be watching. Vote how you want. This is for the American people to see where you stand, with them or the President of the United States.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentlewoman from Oregon (Ms. SALINAS).

Ms. SALINAS. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to oppose President Trump's disastrous tariffs and shine a light on the real harm they are causing families and businesses in my district.

My district is home to some of the best wineries in the world, and Canada is our single largest foreign market. After Trump imposed his tariffs, Canada responded with their own tariffs that lasted for months. Many Canadians continue to boycott our products, all while our growers and producers pay the price. They are facing higher costs, shrinking export opportunities, and real economic pain for real families.

In October, wine sales to Canada were down 84 percent when compared to last year. If we fail to act, this Congress will be complicit in enabling President Trump to destroy the hard-fought relationships my community has brokered. Wineries in my district built their relationships across the border over decades, and in one day, President Trump destroyed them.

□ 1540

These tariffs hurt American farmers and American consumers alike. We must act and protect the American people from the volatile whims of the petulant President.

Mr. Speaker, I urge an "aye" vote.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, it is amazing to me we are talking about the deaths of thousands of Americans, tens of thousands of Americans, and somebody is talking about wine. We are talking about the lives of tens of thousands of Americans, and my colleagues are talking about wine. Let's get some perspective here.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Florida (Mr. FINE).

Mr. FINE. Mr. Speaker, we have heard the opposition to this take on two things: number one, that this has somehow raised the cost of living and that, somehow, the fentanyl crisis is not a national emergency. I would like to disassemble those two arguments.

A long time ago, long before I came to Washington, one of my first jobs was I taught economics. I would say to my colleagues that they need to get beyond Karl Marx's "The Communist Manifesto" to understand how the world actually works.

When Joe Biden was President, prices went up 5 percent a year. Under the

Trump trade regime that is supposedly making things so expensive for people, it has gone up one-half that amount, 2.7 percent. Obviously, tariffs are not the problem.

Economic results: The last quarter, our economic growth as a nation was 4.4 percent. The economy is booming. That is almost double what we saw the previous year under Joe Biden. His number started with a two.

These tariffs, rather than hurting America, have brought \$15 billion, that is just from Canada, that we can use to pay down our debt and pay down our deficit, again, as we have lower inflation and higher economic growth. It has worked. The chairman talked about the cost of 5,000 lives a year in New York, almost 100,000 nationwide, but those statistics are 1 year old.

Under President Trump's tariff regime where he has cracked down on it, last year, fentanyl deaths in this country dropped by 21 percent. That is 20,000 Americans who did not die because of a fentanyl overdose. That is 20,000 national emergencies diverted. That is 20,000 families that aren't destroyed, and that is 20,000 futures that still get to be in our country.

We should not be criticizing the President for what he has done, because the last thing I will say is this: When I taught economics, we had a concept called Pareto optimality. It is something where everything is good and nothing is bad, and that is exactly what is happening here.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, one thing that I will say, yes, the economy is booming. Mr. Speaker, if you are a billionaire, the economy is booming. However, when I go home and I talk to my constituents, what they tell me is that the price of beef has risen 16.4 percent over the last year. The price of coffee is up a whopping 19.8 percent. The price of lettuce is up 7.3 percent. Frozen fish is up 8.6 percent. So for them, it is not booming.

As I said, this is just about a vote. It is just about a vote. I wish we could have had this vote 1 year ago. If, in fact, they believe this is an emergency, I don't know why it was held up for 1 year and tried to be prevented again.

It is a vote. Let the American people know where you stand, Mr. Speaker. They see it with your vote.

Do you stand with them, Mr. Speaker, trying to fix the affordability crisis, or do you stand with Donald Trump and my Republican colleagues who are just taking care of those for whom the economy is booming, the billionaires of our country?

Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Rhode Island (Mr. MAGAZINER).

Mr. MAGAZINER. Mr. Speaker, President Trump's tariffs are raising costs on working people. Just like everything else that Donald Trump does, his tariffs are all about helping himself and his rich friends at the expense of everyday people.

The Big Tech companies and the Big Oil companies have been donating millions of dollars to Trump's ballroom and lavishing him with gifts like a golden iPhone.

Wouldn't you know it, Mr. Speaker, he exempted them from the tariffs.

Who is not exempt?

They are the small businesses, the farmers, the restaurants, and the small manufacturers who can't afford to go to Mar-a-Lago to ask for special deals. They are the builders who are paying thousands of dollars more for materials to build new homes, and they are everyday people who are stuck with higher costs, working themselves to the bone and who can't keep up with their bills.

In Donald Trump's America, the rich and connected are always taken care of, and everyone else struggles.

For what, Mr. Speaker?

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics' report that came out today, we lost more than 100,000 manufacturing jobs last year.

End these tariffs. Stop this madness, and lower costs for working people.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to refrain from engaging in personalities toward the President.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, my colleagues should educate themselves on what these tariffs are affecting. They are third-party goods coming in from countries like China. I don't think they are growing much coffee in Canada. They might want to look at the map and look at the temperatures and where these items grow.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Arizona (Mr. CRANE).

Mr. CRANE. Mr. Speaker, I thank Chairman MAST for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I rise today in opposition to this resolution which would terminate the President's national emergency in response to the flow of fentanyl across our northern border.

As an Arizonan, I am all too familiar with the destruction these weaponized opioids have caused, and I fully support President Trump's mission to rid our Nation of this poison.

Under the previous administration, fentanyl claimed the lives of approximately 73,000 Americans per year and became the leading cause of death among those aged 18 to 45. President Trump was elected in part to confront this catastrophic crisis.

Fentanyl affects constituents of every Member of this body, regardless of political affiliation. As someone who has met with individuals devastated by this deadly substance, maintaining our momentum to stop fentanyl must remain a top priority.

Over the past year, the Trump administration urged Canada to work in coordination with our law enforcement partners to help stem the flow of dangerous narcotics. Unfortunately, our neighbors to the north have failed to adequately respond, prompting the administration to use leverage to bring

them to the table. Now Democrats are on the House floor attempting to end the President's declaration, which would undermine efforts to prevent fentanyl-related deaths. It would be very unwise to tie the President's hands and remove this critical tool during an ongoing public health and national security crisis.

Mr. Speaker, I am grateful for the leadership of Chairman MAST, and I applaud the administration's commitment to preventing addiction and overdoses.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Texas (Mr. CASTRO), who is the ranking member of HFAC's Western Hemisphere Subcommittee.

Mr. CASTRO of Texas. Mr. Speaker, I rise in strong support of H.J. Res. 72, the resolution to terminate President Trump's tariffs on Canada.

Families in San Antonio and across this country are already struggling with the rising cost of living. The price of everything is going up: groceries, housing, childcare, and rent. When you go to the grocery store, Mr. Speaker, beef prices are up 16 percent, and coffee is up nearly 20 percent.

Instead of lowering costs, the President imposed tariffs on Canada, which is nothing more than a tax on American families, and started a trade war with one of our closest allies. Those tariffs don't just hurt American families. They threaten jobs in places like my hometown of San Antonio. Nearly one-half, 48 percent, of San Antonio's exports go to Canada, the highest share of any major city in the country.

Our economy is deeply tied to North American supply chains. Thousands of San Antonians work in aerospace, automotive manufacturing, energy, machinery, semiconductors, and medical devices, exactly the high-paying industries we want to be growing here in the United States.

These companies chose San Antonio because we are highly integrated into trade networks with Canada and Mexico. When tariffs go up, local businesses pay the price. When Canada retaliates, it becomes harder for our workers to sell their products abroad.

This trade war is making life more expensive, creating uncertainty and putting good jobs at risk, all while the world continues to move around us. Congress has constitutional authority over tariffs. We must use it here and now. Let's lower costs for American families, protect jobs in San Antonio and across America, and end this reckless trade war.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to support this resolution.

□ 1550

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Nebraska (Mr. SMITH).

Mr. SMITH of Nebraska. Mr. Speaker, Americans across the country agree, the unmitigated flow of fentanyl under the Biden administration now constitutes an emergency.

Let's discuss some facts. In 2023 alone, this crisis contributed to the deaths of 70,000 Americans—in just one year, 2023—a number that only worsened the following year, when the amount of fentanyl that crossed our border with Canada was actually enough to kill 9.5 million people, given that potential.

Given this context, it is no surprise that between 2024 and 2025, under President Trump, fentanyl seizures at the northern border nearly doubled. As the supply of fentanyl is so tied to trade through the movement of precursor chemicals, the President has utilized trade policy to spur progress.

While today's resolution is meant to debate the merits of the emergency created by the flow of fentanyl, our colleagues on the other side of the aisle will use this as a venue to debate trade policy. I have been watching.

I certainly welcome my Democratic colleagues' interest, relatively new interest, in the trade policy following what I would say was 4 years of neglect on trade policy under President Biden. However, if we are serious about engaging in real reform, I believe that my colleagues would not just resort to political maneuvers.

I am not a fan of tariffs. That is no secret. I am in favor, however, of robust engagement with our trading partners. Let me be very clear. In trade, there is no stagnation. If we are not gaining ground, I think we are losing ground, and data would show that.

During the Biden administration, the President and this body were way too passive on our trade agenda. Right now, President Trump obviously is taking a new aggressive approach in order to level the playing field and address supply chains that have put Americans at risk.

Beyond the gains made in addressing the fentanyl crisis and outside the scope of this emergency, the President's engagement has led to significant gains for fairness throughout the global trading system.

While Canada is one of our most important allies and trading partners, and a friend, there have been a number of irritants in our economic relationship. Under President Trump's leadership, we have seen this change, most recently when Canada removed its discriminatory digital services tax.

These productive—and I will say oftentimes uncomfortable—conversations must continue, though, as we strengthen and extend USMCA during this 2026 Joint Review.

The President has, at every turn, reaffirmed his commitment to use tariffs as a means to drive these conversations, and Congress has delegated a number of tariff authorities to the executive.

While we are ultimately debating the merits of the emergency, let me be clear: This approach will not change the President's tariff strategy, just the conditions. This body works best when engaging with the full context of the policy environment.

As we await the Supreme Court's decision on whether the tariffs lie within the authority of IEEPA, today's politically motivated vote, I believe, is premature. If my colleagues have full confidence there is no risk of fentanyl imports at the northern border, then they have more faith than I do.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The time of the gentleman has expired.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I yield an additional 15 seconds to the gentleman from Nebraska.

Mr. SMITH of Nebraska. Mr. Speaker, if this resolution is instead driven by a newfound tariff skepticism, I urge them to allow the Supreme Court to first make its decision.

To overlook the very basis of the emergency in the hope of removing tariffs for which the President has other authorities to pursue only increases uncertainty in the short term.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no" on the resolution.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Texas (Mr. DOGGETT), a member of the Ways and Means Committee.

Mr. DOGGETT. Mr. Speaker, President Trump's repeated bullying of Canada and its eloquent Prime Minister Carney is both embarrassing and alarming. Our country could not have a better neighbor or trading partner than Canada.

Declaring emergencies where none exist, Trump delights in these executive decrees for tariffs. He can act like a king, and he is enabled to be a king-like figure on this issue by Republicans, even though it is costing American families thousands of dollars.

There have been 76,000 American manufacturing jobs lost amidst Trump chaos. Small businesses are losing out if they don't have a lobbyist who can go to Mar-a-Lago and bargain with Trump.

This vote is about reaffirming "no king," no rule by decree from the President when he has no authority to do this, and recognizing that our Constitution places responsibility for trade and tariff taxes where it should be, right here in this Congress.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Members are reminded to refrain from engaging in personalities toward the President.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I have no additional speakers, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1 minute to the gentleman from Nevada (Mr. HORSFORD).

Mr. HORSFORD. Mr. Speaker, President Trump loves tariffs. He calls them beautiful. He says they protect American workers, but here is the cold, hard truth: The American people are paying them.

Just today, the nonpartisan Congressional Budget Office confirmed what families already feel—American consumers are paying 95 percent of these tariffs. They pay at the grocery store. They pay in higher energy bills. They

pay when small businesses shut their doors.

These blanket tariffs on Canada are a slap in the face to one of our closest trading allies. Canada is Nevada's top international visitor. Tourism in Las Vegas is already down 7.5 percent. Nationwide, Canadian travel is down 23 percent, a \$4 billion hit to our economy.

Today, though, thanks to Congressman MEEKS, House Democrats, and Republicans who are willing to stand up, Congress can take back its power. We can give the American people real relief today. The families sitting around their kitchen tables tonight deserve a government that will lower their costs and that will end these Trump tariff taxes.

Mr. Speaker, I urge this body to vote "yes" on this resolution.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield 1½ minutes to the gentleman from Arizona (Mr. STANTON).

Mr. STANTON. Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of H.J. Res. 72.

I thank Ranking Member MEEKS for his great leadership on this critical issue.

It is time to end Trump's illegal tariffs on Canada, his tariffs on United States' biggest trading partner, Mexico, and the so-called liberation day tariffs. Congress has the power of the purse, not the President. It is time that we take our power back from an executive who is out of control.

Trump's tariffs have been a massive tax on the American people, costing an average household \$1,000 per household just in the last year. These tariffs have led to slower job growth, a declining manufacturing industry, and less investment. They have hurt our farmers and increased food costs.

These tariffs have inflicted real damage on our relationship with Canada. Canada isn't just our neighbor. It has historically been one of our strongest military allies and biggest trading partners. Trump's constant insults, threats, and these punishing tariffs have turned one of our best friends away from us and toward the People's Republic of China.

Enough is enough. It is time that we end this. I urge my colleagues, Republicans and Democrats alike, send Trump a clear message that he can't unilaterally wage a trade war against one of our strongest allies and biggest trading partners.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time to close.

The American people are watching. This is very simple. Why did we take a year to get this vote? It is because Trump's tariffs are unpopular—the majority of Americans know it—and a majority of my colleagues on the other side of the aisle don't want to be on the record. Well, they are going to be on the record.

They know that more than 60 percent of Americans disapprove of these tariffs. They know that the foreign governments don't pay these tariffs. They know that American families do. The farmers feel it. Small businesses feel it. Moms and dads feel it every time they see the prices at the grocery store.

What this is, we can go back and forth, but the American people are watching. They are the ultimate judges. They can see. They can hear. They know our friend. They know how Canada and Canadians are friendly to us in the United States of America, closest partners. Many Canadians have given their lives for us.

The American people can watch. What this simply does, this resolution, we will see. If you think that there is a crisis with Canada, then vote.

Still, the Constitution says it is the House of Representatives and the United States Congress, it is within our authority. Don't punt. Don't just hide behind somebody else. That is what this will do. If you believe that this is an emergency, vote that way, if that is what you really believe.

However, if you go to the grocery stores, if you see the price of beef, if you look at the price of coffee, if you feel that the economy is suffering as a result of these tariffs, if you think the economy for the average, everyday American is as good as those billionaire friends that the President has, then you vote with the President.

□ 1600

Give up, but don't give up your authority as a Member of this House to vote. The first fight here was the power to vote on this issue, which was blocked for 1 year. I choose not to give up that power. Whether I agree or disagree, I want to vote on it. That was prevented for over a year.

Today, we will vote on it. I thank some of my colleagues on the other side who have had the courage to stand up and say: Let's vote. Let's vote on this, and let the American people know how we stand. Let's vote on this to see if we believe that tariffs cause an affordability issue. Let's vote on this if we believe that Canada is not our friend, if Canada is an adversary, and you feel we should block a bridge like the President is talking about now, a bridge that Canadians paid for right across, block it, make them the 51st State, and insult them. If that is what you want to do, do it.

If you want to stand to bring down prices, if you want the average, everyday American to be able to raise their children and live the American Dream, if you want to make sure that families can afford to pay their rent, can afford to buy food, can afford to have healthcare, then you vote "yes" for this resolution.

The jury is really the American people. They ultimately will vote. They ultimately will tell us what is in their best interests. I have confidence in the American people. That is why I wanted a vote on this bill.

I didn't want to play the funny rules that were being played and were attempted last night. Fortunately, some of my colleagues on the other side did not want to play that game anymore either.

Those rules and those games that were played to prevent a vote on the floor in the United States Congress are over. That is what this is about, so the American people can see what we stand for. Do we stand for just going blindly with the President of the United States, or do we stand for the American people and making sure that their cost of living is cheaper and affordable so they can simply send their kids to school and be able to put a good meal on the table and a roof over the heads of their families? That is what this vote is about.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. MAST. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

Mr. Speaker, I am the chairman of the House Foreign Affairs Committee. My colleague over here is the ranking member, the top Democrat. It is important that when we use our voice, when we speak, we speak accurately.

Number one, they refuse to speak about the fact that this bill is about ending an emergency relating to a fentanyl crisis. Number two, every single item that they like to talk about on tariffs and Canada are literally items that are exempt from tariffs in Canada.

It is very important, certainly as one of 435 in the House of Representatives, that you know what you are talking about. It is especially important as the number two person on the Foreign Affairs Committee that you know what you are talking about when you talk about tariffs.

There are not Canada beef tariffs, not Canada potash tariffs or dairy or food or grain or fertilizer. The list goes on and on. They mentioned coffee I don't know how many times.

The only things that there are tariffs on are things that are coming in from third-party countries into Canada and then coming into the United States of America. If it is grown in Canada, there is not a tariff on it. It is very important that my colleagues know that and recognize that and speak accurately in the positions that they are in.

Mr. Speaker, I will go back to what this is about.

My colleagues say there is no emergency. In fact, my colleague Mr. MEEKS said that if you think there is a crisis, if you think this is an emergency, then vote. Those were his words.

I think the only person on that side who might be able to change the mind of Democrats is my colleague, Mr. MEEKS, who is, again, unwilling to acknowledge that the death of 5,000 people in his State from fentanyl alone in 1 year is an emergency. He is unwilling to acknowledge it.

Mr. Speaker, I am going to take the remainder of my time here, about 1

minute, and give my colleague the opportunity one last time to correct the record for his New Yorkers.

Mr. Speaker, I yield to the gentleman from New York (Mr. MEEKS) for the purpose of a colloquy.

Mr. MEEKS. I will say that the American people are the judges. They don't need to hear anything else. The American people will judge.

Mr. MAST. Would my colleague like to say that 5,000 deaths aren't an emergency?

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The gentleman from Florida controls the time.

Mr. MAST. Would my colleague like to say that 5,000 deaths are an emergency? Five thousand deaths in his State in 1 year from fentanyl—preventable. The President is doing everything he can to stop it with drug boats, with the Caribbean, with the northern border, with the southern border. Crickets. You could hear a pin drop in here. Not a word from them.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. All time for debate has expired.

Pursuant to the order of the House of February 10, 2026, the previous question is ordered on the joint resolution.

The question is on the engrossment and third reading of the joint resolution.

The joint resolution was ordered to be engrossed and read a third time, and was read the third time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on passage of the joint resolution.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the yeas appeared to have it.

Mr. MEEKS. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question will be postponed.

MESSAGES FROM THE PRESIDENT

Messages in writing from the President of the United States were communicated to the House by Ms. Randall Holstead, one of his secretaries.

UNDERSEA CABLE PROTECTION ACT OF 2025

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, pursuant to House Resolution 1057, I call up the bill (H.R. 261) to amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit requiring an authorization for the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have previously been authorized by a Federal or State agency, and ask for its immediate consideration in the House.

The Clerk read the title of the bill.

The SPEAKER pro tempore (Mr. BABIN). Pursuant to House Resolution

1057, the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Natural Resources, printed in the bill, is adopted and the bill, as amended, is considered read.

The text of the bill, as amended, is as follows:

H.R. 261

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the “Undersea Cable Protection Act of 2025”.

SEC. 2. PROHIBITION ON PROHIBITING, OR REQUIRING PERMITS OR OTHER AUTHORIZATIONS FOR, UNDERSEA FIBER OPTIC CABLES AUTHORIZED BY A FEDERAL OR STATE AGENCY.

The National Marine Sanctuaries Act (16 U.S.C. 1431 et seq.) is amended by inserting after section 310 the following:

“SEC. 310A. PROHIBITION ON PROHIBITING, OR REQUIRING PERMITS OR OTHER AUTHORIZATIONS FOR, UNDERSEA FIBER OPTIC CABLES AUTHORIZED BY A FEDERAL OR STATE AGENCY.

“(a) *IN GENERAL.*—Notwithstanding any other provision of this Act, the Secretary may not prohibit, or require any permit, including any special use permit, or other authorization for, the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if a license, lease, or permit has been issued by a Federal or State agency, and is in effect, authorizing such installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery.

“(b) *INTERAGENCY COOPERATION.*—Nothing in this section shall be construed as altering existing requirements regarding interagency cooperation under section 304(d) in any Federal agency action described in that section and involving the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary.”.

SEC. 3. REMOVING RESTRICTIONS ON ACTIVITIES COVERED BY SANCTUARY SPECIAL USE PERMITS.

Section 310(c) of National Marine Sanctuaries Act (16 U.S.C. 1441(c)) is amended—

(1) in paragraph (1), by adding “and” at the end;

(2) by striking paragraphs (2) and (3); and

(3) by redesignating paragraph (4) as paragraph (2).

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The bill, as amended, shall be debatable for 1 hour equally divided and controlled by the chair and ranking minority member of the Committee on Natural Resources or their respective designees.

The gentleman from Arkansas (Mr. WESTERMAN) and the gentleman from California (Mr. HUFFMAN) each will control 30 minutes.

The Chair recognizes the gentleman from Arkansas (Mr. WESTERMAN).

□ 1610

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include extraneous material on H.R. 261.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Arkansas?

There was no objection.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in strong support of H.R. 261 sponsored by Congressman BUDDY CARTER of Georgia.

Undersea cables play a crucial role in the global economy. These cables are roughly 1 to 2 inches in diameter. Yet they crisscross the globe and carry approximately 95 percent of global internet traffic, facilitating trillions of dollars in global financial transactions.

The Undersea Cable Protection Act of 2025 eliminates the requirement for undersea cables to obtain a special use permit under the National Marine Sanctuaries Act as a condition to route these projects through a national marine sanctuary.

Undersea cables are and will continue to be subject to numerous environmental statutes including the National Environmental Policy Act, the Endangered Species Act, the Marine Mammal Protection Act, the Magnuson-Stevens Fishery Conservation and Management Act, the National Historic Preservation Act, and the Coastal Zone Management Act. These are just statutes in the Committee on Natural Resources' jurisdiction.

Many of these laws are implemented by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, or NOAA. We will hear from our friends on the other side of the aisle that this bill hinders NOAA's ability to conduct an environmental review of these projects. That is simply not true.

What is true, however, is that the specific use permit, which under current law only lasts 5 years, has caused national marine sanctuaries to effectively become no-go zones for undersea cables. This means reduced routes of diversity, consolidation of cable landing zones, and an increased threat to our national security.

Notably, this dynamic does not just cause stress on the physical infrastructure of these projects. Many of us are aware of the stories from around the world of undersea cables being severed with recent examples of this occurring in both Taiwan and the Baltic.

In the United States, as these cables have a limited number of landing areas, our adversaries would have the ability to cut off an increasing portion of communications, internet activity, and financial transactions by attacking just a few points.

Combine this looming threat with the increasing number of cables required in the coming years to keep pace with demand, and their growing role as critical infrastructure in our daily lives, and failure to support the continued development of these projects could pose a grave national security risk.

Removing the requirement for a special use permit advances the objectives of House Republicans and the administration to reduce regulatory burdens and encourage American competitiveness, an objective that President

Trump emphasized when he signed Executive Order 14267, Reducing Anti-competitive Regulatory Barriers.

Advancing this legislation will allow for the deployment of undersea cables while providing appropriate protection of our marine resources. I urge my colleagues to support the legislation.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. HUFFMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I think we have figured out the rhythm, the prime directive here for Republican governance these days.

First, they slashed the services that working families actually depend on. Then they turn around and hand the savings over to their billionaire friends. They do it time and again. It is rinse, lather, repeat.

What do we have on the floor this week? We have all guessed it. It is another corporate handout, this time to the biggest technical oligarchs in the world. These folks have shown that if a person has enough money and if they are willing to bend the knee, they can pretty much get anything they want these days under MAGA Republican governance.

Every time we have tried to add protections and regulations to their platforms that would keep users and children safe, they stop it. Every time we try to do something about the disinformation they allow to run rampant in order to appease the White House and cater to extremists, they stop it.

Now they have schmoozed their way into getting Republicans to add another huge giveaway to this long, favored list of theirs. That means millions of dollars in savings so that they can run cables through our national marine sanctuaries for free.

I have to ask: What is the endgame here? Where does it stop? Are we systematically privatizing every piece of America's national heritage for the richest and most powerful corporations in the world? That is exactly where H.R. 261 seems to be taking us.

It rigs the game so that, for example, family fishing operations, dive boat captains, whale watching guides, and the other businesses that operate in marine sanctuaries have to navigate regulations. They have to play by the rules and pay fees but not the Big Tech oligarchs. These conglomerates, worth hundreds of billions of dollars, get special treatment and exemptions.

Our national marine sanctuaries encompass over half a million square miles of America's most precious underwater ecosystems. They are economic engines generating billions in tourism revenue, sustaining entire coastal economies. They are living laboratories also where families snorkel with sea turtles, divers explore historic shipwrecks, and scientists unlock climate secrets.

This legislation would let tech moguls bulldoze right through these

waters with industrial-scale operations—massive drill rigs, heavy machinery, and construction fleets—all without the environmental review that everyone else would have to undergo.

The sponsors insist that these under-sea cables are just little needles in a haystack, and they will probably hold up a little segment of one of these cables to try to suggest these are just needles in a haystack. It is true that the fiber-optic lines themselves are thin, but the installation process is anything but delicate.

We are talking about seafloor excavation projects that can obliterate coral reefs and hurt marine mammals across vast swaths of the ocean. What could go wrong when these projects are happening on the seafloor?

We can look at what Meta tried to do off the Pacific Northwest coast. Their drilling operation collapsed, scattering pipes, toxic fluids, and heavy equipment across the seafloor like an underwater junkyard. Then the company just wrote a tiny check and left town. It was nowhere near the cost of the actual damage that was incurred, and the marine habitat there is still trashed.

My district is home to one of our Nation's iconic marine sanctuaries. I can say without hesitation that my constituents don't want to see these industrial activities rip through our sensitive kelp forests that support fisheries and tourism. No project in these places should happen without very careful study, without mitigation and, most importantly, without paying their fair share.

This bill would let tech executives treat these national treasures off our coasts like some kind of an industrial sacrifice zone without even paying a cent for the use of these resources.

The National Marine Sanctuaries Act is the only statute requiring compatibility with the conservation objectives of each sanctuary. If we strip that away, as this bill would do, we have created a regulatory sacrifice zone.

House Republicans can't even identify which licenses and permits would qualify in this bill in lieu of the special use permit process that would ordinarily apply.

Mr. Speaker, how can we look the American people in the eye and assure them that no environmental safeguards are going away when we don't even have that very basic information? For many in the majority, the truth is, the details just don't matter.

Meta and Amazon are what matter, and they want this legislation. The majority is willing to take it at face value and just pass this along, no questions asked. They will give the oligarchs what they want.

Democrats have proposed amendments to this legislation, commonsense protections. They have proposed a mandatory insurance coverage requirement, for example. They have also offered off-limits zones for very sensitive habitats and standard user fees like these oligarchs pay when they run one of these on land.

Our amendment would have allowed the basics of H.R. 261 to move forward, allowing an alternate process to the current special use permit, while preserving some of these basic operational guardrails to ensure the protection of these very special and fragile places.

□ 1620

The majority shot down every one of these proposals. This is not about efficiency. It is about preferential treatment for oligarchs like Meta and Amazon.

Consider this: When telecom companies want to access our national forests for one of these projects, they pay rent. When they cross national parks, they pay fees, but somehow marine sanctuaries are supposed to be free. That is nothing more than a corporate giveaway and a terrible precedent that won't stop with our marine sanctuaries.

The sponsors wrapped this handout in national security rhetoric. We have already heard some of it from the chairman. They claim that there is an urgent telecommunications crisis.

Mr. Speaker, it is important to remember that these are multibillion-dollar projects spanning years and thousands of miles. They make their maps public. Everyone knows where these projects are taking place. The cost of environmental assessments is pocket change for these operations, but it could mean the difference between healthy habitats and destroyed resources in our national marine sanctuaries.

Here is what really stinks about this bill: While working American families are facing an affordability crisis, our Republican friends prioritize special favors like this for the wealthiest corporations on the planet. These are companies that could easily afford to just follow the rules and just pay a fair market rate for access to these places.

This sets a terrible precedent. We are witnessing the wholesale commercialization of America's natural inheritance, one sweetheart deal at a time. Today, it is cables and sanctuaries. Tomorrow, it will be mining in a national monument. Next week, it will be drilling in national seashores. Where does this corporate favoritism end?

If my colleagues want to modernize telecommunications, we can do that the right way. Let's invest in broadband infrastructure. Let's address transmission issues. We can incentivize clean, local, renewable energy. We can end President Trump's crazy war on clean energy.

Sure, maybe we can have a few fiber optic cables running through marine sanctuaries, but let's do it through proper analysis and siting. Let's be careful in these very special places. We don't need this bill to enable any of these shared objectives to move forward. Let us not create sacrifice zones in America's national marine sanctuaries.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to reject this shameless corporate give-

away, and I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, I think it is important that we understand exactly what is going on here. If you look at this map, this is an example along the California coast. These pink areas are national marine sanctuaries. You have this one zone down here by Morro Bay and Grover Beach, where cables can actually leave the shore. You can see the concentration of all of the existing cables in this area.

Mr. Speaker, it is possible to put a cable across a marine sanctuary right now. There was a law or a rule passed in 2002, I believe, that set up this special use permit. The problem is that it gave a 5-year special use permit, and these are 25-year-plus projects when you put one of these cables in.

Mr. Speaker, NOAA had the assignment to come up with what the lease cost would be to put these cables across a marine sanctuary. In all of NOAA's infinite wisdom, they came up with a price tag of \$40,000 to \$100,000 per mile, subject to inflation.

Nobody has gotten one of these permits. Nobody has put a cable across because this rule by the Federal Government has disincentivized all of these companies from being able to run cables. It seems that the purpose of the rule in the first place was just to keep cables out of the marine sanctuaries.

Mr. Speaker, if somebody were to put a cable through a marine sanctuary, they would still have to go through the NEPA process. They would have to go through the entire regulatory process to get a permit to put the cable across the sanctuary. It is not like you are throwing away all environmental oversight and all environmental guidelines to be able to bury one of these cables, or not bury but run it along the ocean floor.

Again, they are 1 inch to 2 inches in diameter. If you just looked at 1 mile at, say, 4 inches in diameter, that strip of land at a rate of \$40,000 per mile would be the equivalent of a yearly rent of about \$1 million per acre every year.

The whole rule and the law was stacked against doing anything, and that is exactly what has happened. We want to open this up where American companies can invest in American fiber cables so that we can communicate across the ocean and we can get away from all of this consolidation in one area where it is easy to target.

Mr. Speaker, I yield 3 minutes to the gentleman from Georgia (Mr. CARTER), the lead sponsor of this legislation.

Mr. CARTER of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, I thank the gentleman for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of my bill, H.R. 261, the Undersea Cable Protection Act of 2025.

Undersea fiber optic cables carry roughly 95 percent of all intercontinental internet traffic and nearly all transoceanic digital communications.

Trillions of dollars in financial transactions—trillions—global trade data, cloud computing, and secure government communications depend on these cables every single day. They are critical infrastructure, just as essential as ports, as pipelines, and our power grids.

Yet despite their importance, the United States has allowed overregulation and duplicative permitting to stand in the way of deploying and maintaining this infrastructure, especially on the West Coast, where permitting delays and overlapping approvals have made it effectively impossible to lay new cables in certain areas for decades. The chairman just described what we are talking about here.

These projects weren't stopped because they failed environmental review. They were stopped because of bureaucracy. That is the problem that H.R. 261 is designed to fix. Today, even when an undersea cable project has already received full authorization from a Federal or State agency, it can still be forced through an additional duplicate permitting process with the Office of National Marine Sanctuaries.

That extra layer adds years of delay, drives up costs, and discourages investment without providing meaningful environmental protection. H.R. 261 clarifies that once a project has been lawfully approved at the State and Federal levels, it should not be required to obtain an additional permit for the same activity.

Let me be clear. This bill does not weaken environmental protections. All existing environmental laws, reviews, and interagency coordination requirements remain fully intact. This is about eliminating redundancy, not eliminating oversight.

This matters for States like Georgia. Georgia's economy depends on global connectivity from the Port of Savannah and our logistics and supply chain networks, to manufacturing defense contractors, data centers, and a growing technology sector. Reliable undersea cable infrastructure supports jobs. It supports trade and economic growth across the country.

There is also a serious national security component to this. Undersea cables carry sensitive government and military communications. Delays in installing, repairing, or maintaining this infrastructure create real vulnerability to our national security. Even today, our adversaries, like China, are actively targeting global communication networks, especially cutting undersea cables that connect us to our allies, like Japan, Korea, and Taiwan.

Secure, resilient connectivity is not optional. It is a strategic necessity. H.R. 261 is a solution that offers a balanced, commonsense solution. It cuts unnecessary red tape. It preserves environmental safeguards. It strengthens our economy. Most importantly, it protects America's national security.

I implore this Congress to pass this legislation to secure America's technological dominance and fortify our national security.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to support H.R. 261.

Mr. HUFFMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, it is a little bit rich to suggest that if this became law, we would lose no environmental protections. This bill eliminates the special use permit, under which the folks who protect our national marine sanctuaries make sure that there is proper siting, proper environmental review, proper mitigation, and proper accountability for when things go wrong, and things do go wrong.

The one example I can hold out is in Olympic Coast National Marine Sanctuary because that is something that went through the special use permit process. It was for one of these undersea cable landings. Things got very complicated.

Thankfully, the National Park Service was able to charge market rent for the rights to go through this area, and it turns out that that was a good thing because there were all sorts of complications. In fact, there are still all types of ongoing repair and monitoring areas where things weren't installed properly and where there was all sorts of damage that wasn't foreseen on the front end.

□ 1630

Having that fair market value paid in the first place and then retained by the Federal agency that may need to follow up and make sure that these special places are protected is very important.

Mr. WESTERMAN has suggested that the existing special use permit sets a fair market value that is just so prohibitive that none of these landings will ever happen in marine sanctuaries. The estimates from lobbyists are that without this bill, two 20-mile segments through a California sanctuary would cost these huge tech companies between \$2.8 million and \$7 million per year.

To put that in perspective, in the time that we have been arguing, these companies have made more than that. This is pocket change to these companies. They can afford to pay fair market value in order to go through our national marine sanctuaries.

As Mr. WESTERMAN I am sure would not disagree, if they were proposing to run these things through a national park in Hot Springs, Arkansas, for example, it is a good thing they would have to get a special permit to do that, that they would have to pay fair market value, and that the funds they pay would be available to that unit of the National Park System to make sure things were done right and to make sure that there was accountability and mitigation going forward. We are just asking for the same thing for our national marine sanctuaries.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield 2 minutes to the gentleman from Ohio (Mr. MILLER).

Mr. MILLER of Ohio. Mr. Speaker, I rise today in strong support of H.R. 261, the Undersea Cable Protection Act.

Undersea cables are the backbone of our modern economy. These cables are no bigger than a garden hose but support over \$10 trillion in international commerce on a daily basis.

Mr. Speaker, you would think that this clear significance would prompt us to make sure that it is easy to build these things, but no. The United States is one of the most difficult countries in the world to lay and operate undersea cables. This is a national security liability.

There is simply no reason to require a special use permit for an undersea cable because there is absolutely zero—and I say "zero"—environmental impact.

It is time for Congress to pay more attention to the critical infrastructure that surrounds us in this country. That is why I introduced the NEPTUNE Act, to make sure that the Navy maintains its undersea cable laying and repair capabilities. That is why I intend to vote for this legislation and urge my colleagues to do the same.

Mr. Speaker, I thank my friend BUDDY CARTER from the Committee on Natural Resources for leading this effort.

Mr. HUFFMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield 5 minutes to the gentleman from California (Mr. CARBAJAL), who is from the Central Coast.

Mr. CARBAJAL. Mr. Speaker, I thank the chair for yielding.

Mr. Speaker, I rise in firm opposition to H.R. 261, the Undersea Cable Protection Act of 2025.

On its face, this legislation may seem like a narrow procedural change of streamlining permitting for undersea fiber-optic cables. In reality, it strips away critical environmental and economic safeguards that we and the communities we represent depend on to help power our Nation's blue economy.

We know that four of the five national marine sanctuaries in California generate more than \$114 million a year and support over 1,800 jobs in commercial fishing alone.

H.R. 261 is a giveaway to megacorporations at the expense of the American taxpayer, the oceans, and the Great Lakes we have advocated to protect.

Some of the marine sanctuaries most at risk because of this legislation are iconic spots off the coast of California: Monterey Bay, Channel Islands, and the newly created Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary.

Nowhere is this more evident than in the Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary, a sanctuary that was decades in the making. First nominated by the Northern Chumash Tribal Council in 2015, the sanctuary became effective on November 30, 2024, after review by Congress and the State of California.

Through this legislation, my constituents and the Chumash Heritage

National Marine Sanctuary will lose big. Waiving the future fees on cables from industry would cost between \$2.7 million and \$7 million per every 20 miles each year. While there is a 2-year exception for the newly designated Chumash Heritage National Marine Sanctuary, current law requires operators and installers of deep-sea fiber-optic cables to obtain a permit from NOAA and pay fair market fees for use of these areas.

I and many others here today believe we need secure and reliable telecommunications infrastructure. I understand that the 5-year time limits on permits cause concern for companies looking for long-term certainty. However, I firmly believe that we can find a solution that protects these sanctuary resources and treats all stakeholders fairly.

We can find a win-win solution that supports innovation, continues to support our local economies, and ensures that the American taxpayer gets a fair return for use of our natural resources.

Mr. Speaker, that is why, at the appropriate time, I will offer a motion to recommit this bill back to committee. If the House rules permitted, I would have offered the motion with an important amendment to this bill.

My amendment is straightforward: Allow tech companies to have their alternative permitting pathway in sanctuaries but add in a few commonsense guardrails.

First, allow an alternative license or permit, but require that the project be compatible with the purpose of the sanctuary. That means protecting the sensitive areas of the seafloor and avoiding cultural and historic sites.

Second, require public comment as is currently the practice with special use permits.

Third, require these companies to carry liability insurance for the project. We don't want to see another disaster like we saw off the coast of Oregon, a Meta subsidiary dumping drilling fluid and drilling equipment on the seafloor, then leaving the taxpayers on the hook to clean up the mess. Yes, did I say taxpayers? Yes, they are the ones who paid.

Finally, my amendment would maintain the status quo and allow NOAA to collect a fair market fee for the use of these sanctuary resources, just like any other public land management agency does for cables that cross their protected lands.

These are all standard provisions for the use of public resources, and I hope we can bring back a little bit of common sense to this legislation.

Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent to insert the text of my amendment into the RECORD immediately prior to the vote on the motion to recommit.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from California?

There was no objection.

Mr. CARBAJAL. Mr. Speaker, I ask my colleagues to join me in voting for

the motion to recommit to protect our marine sanctuaries for future generations.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, the article featured behind me found that adversaries like Russia and China are taking disruptive action against undersea cables on a more frequent basis around the world. Here is an article just from yesterday talking about a Chinese cargo ship captain who has been charged with severing a natural gas pipeline and a communication cable in the Baltic Sea.

If we stick to the status quo, we are leaving ourselves more vulnerable to similar threats at our doorstep. Our adversaries are taking an increasingly aggressive posture in targeting critical infrastructure.

Congressman CARTER's legislation promotes route diversity, reduces threats to global communication systems, and ensures that the United States wins this global technology race. That is why it is important that we pass this legislation and that we give companies the certainty that they can build these communication lines and diversify where they are locating them so that we can protect our economic security and also our national security.

Mr. Speaker, I reserve the balance of my time.

Mr. HUFFMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself such time as I may consume.

Mr. Speaker, it is a very selective concern about national security, apparently, because right now, every one of these landings has a publicly available map. The whole world knows where everything is. If my friends were concerned about the national security exposure that that presents, you would think we would be working on some way to make that less of a publicly obvious piece of information. No, we are not hearing about that. We are hearing it raised as a bit of a pretext here to try to run these projects through national marine sanctuaries rent-free and environmental review-free. One of the speakers across the aisle actually said a few moments ago that there is no need for a special use permit, that it is ridiculous to require one because there is no environmental impact to these projects.

We have heard about what happened off the Oregon coast. Certainly, the people of the Oregon coast would differ mightily with the notion that there is no environmental impact. They are still cleaning up the mess, and taxpayers ultimately had to do it.

We also have the example from the Olympic Coast National Marine Sanctuary that I referred to earlier. This, of course, is a tough place to work on the seafloor. It is mud. It is sensitive habitat. Fishermen are active in the area. There are national security assets there. There is the Northwest Training and Testing Range, so it is a complicated place to do a project like this.

It is a good thing that NOAA was able to charge market fees when they approved a special use permit that took into account all of these complexities, because those fees ended up being very necessary.

□ 1640

This project had huge issues over the last 25 years. The sea plow that was used to trench across the sanctuary left a 3-meter wide gash across the sea floor that is still recovering. Tell me about no environmental impacts.

The installation company never did post-project monitoring. They left the project without checking that the cables were even buried to the correct depths. NOAA had to come back in with submersible equipment to monitor the cables. It is a good thing they had the resources to do that from those market fees because they found numerous locations where the cable was exposed, floating above the sea floor, putting the fiberoptic infrastructure itself at risk—if we care about national security and telecommunications integrity—and posing a danger to other sanctuary users and their gear. A fishing boat, for example, could have easily gotten snagged on some of these exposed, loose cables, taking down the entire network, destroying equipment, that a small business fishermen had invested in.

To this day the fiberoptic company has to enter that sanctuary regularly in order to repair and rebury the cables that were improperly installed. All of this would have been an even greater mess had this bill been law at the time, had NOAA been unable to put some conditions and some guardrails into the special use permit, had NOAA been unable to charge that fair market fee that has enabled it to follow up and clean up some of this mess.

That is what at risk if we pass a thoughtless corporate giveaway like this.

Mr. Speaker, I urge my colleagues to vote "no" on this legislation, and I yield back the balance of my time.

Mr. WESTERMAN. Mr. Speaker, I yield myself the balance of my time.

This legislation before us today accomplishes two objectives:

First, it eliminates the requirement for undersea cables to obtain a special use permit for operating within national marine sanctuaries. Again, undersea cable projects would still need to undergo review under the National Environmental Policy Act, the Endangered Species Act, the Marine Mammal Protection Act, the Magnuson-Stevens Act, the National Historic Preservation Act, and the Coastal Zone Management Act. None of that permitting is waived in this bill, and I would dare say anybody wanting to run one of these cables would say they are getting to do it and to avoid all environmental laws and protections. I don't think people running these cables want to do that.

Second, it removes the 5-year timeline for any special use permit

within any national marine sanctuary. Together, these reforms reduce regulatory burdens. They protect our national security, and they ensure that America can lead the way in deploying undersea cables while protecting our marine environments.

Mr. Speaker, I want to thank Congressman CARTER for his leadership on this issue. I urge my colleagues to support this legislation, and I yield back the balance of my time.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. All time for debate has expired.

Pursuant to House Resolution 1057, the previous question is ordered on the bill, as amended.

The question is on the engrossment and third reading of the bill.

The bill was ordered to be engrossed and read a third time, and was read the third time.

MOTION TO RECOMMIT

Mr. CARBAJAL. Mr. Speaker, I have a motion to recommit at the desk.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The Clerk will report the motion to recommit.

The Clerk read as follows:

Mr. Carbajal of California moves to recommit the bill H.R. 261 to the Committee on Natural Resources.

The material previously referred to by Mr. CARBAJAL is as follows:

Mr. Carbajal moves to recommit the bill H.R. 261 to the Committee on Natural Resources with instructions to report the same back to the House forthwith, with the following amendment:

Page 4, line 7, strike the closing quotation mark and the final period.

Page 4, after line 7, insert the following:

“(C) PUBLIC NOTICE REQUIRED.—The Secretary shall provide appropriate public notice for any license, lease, or permit issued by a Federal or State agency as described in subsection (a).

“(d) APPLICABILITY.—Subsection (a) shall only apply with respect to a license, lease, or permit issued by a Federal or State agency as described in that subsection if—

“(1) such license, lease, or permit requires that any activity conducted under such license, lease, or permit is—

“(A) compatible with the terms of designation of the applicable national marine sanctuary; and

“(B) conducted in a manner that does not destroy, cause the loss of, or injure any sanctuary resource; and

“(2) the issuing Federal or State agency requires the applicant for such license, lease, or permit, to be eligible to be issued such license, lease, or permit—

“(A) to carry general liability insurance; or

“(B)(i) post an equivalent bond against any claim arising out of an activity conducted under such license, lease, or permit; and

“(ii) agree to hold the United States harmless against such a claim.

“(e) FEES.—The Secretary may assess and collect fees for the conduct of any activity in a national marine sanctuary under a license, lease, or permit issued by a Federal or State agency as described in subsection (a) in accordance with the terms described in subsection 310(d).

“(f) STATE AGENCY DEFINED.—In this section, the term ‘State agency’ means an agency of a State such that all or part of the national marine sanctuary is within the territorial limits of such State or is superjacent

to the subsoil and seabed within the seaward boundary of such State, as that boundary is established under the Submerged Lands Act (43 U.S.C. 1301 et seq.).”.

Strike section 3.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 2(b) of rule XIX, the previous question is ordered on the motion to recommit.

The question is on the motion to recommit.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the yeas appeared to have it.

Mr. CARBAJAL. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, further proceedings on this question are postponed.

ADJUSTING IMPORTS OF PROCESSED CRITICAL MINERALS AND THEIR DERIVATIVE PRODUCTS INTO THE UNITED STATES—MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES (H. DOC. NO. 119-134)

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following message from the President of the United States; which was read and, together with the accompanying papers, referred to the Committee on Ways and Means and ordered to be printed:

To the Congress of the United States:

Consistent with applicable law, including section 232(c)(2) of the Trade Expansion Act of 1962, as amended (19 U.S.C. 1862(c)(2)) (section 232), I am providing notice of the reasons why I have decided to take action to adjust imports of processed critical minerals and their derivative products (PCMDPs) so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

On October 24, 2025, the Secretary of Commerce (Secretary), in accordance with section 232, transmitted to me a report on his investigation into the effects of imports of PCMDPs on the national security of the United States. Based on the facts considered in that investigation, the Secretary found and advised me of his opinion that PCMDPs are being imported into the United States in such quantities and under such circumstances as to threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In Proclamation 11001 of January 14, 2026 (Adjusting Imports of Processed Critical Minerals and Their Derivative Products Into The United States) (Proclamation), after considering the Secretary's report, the factors in section 232(d) (19 U.S.C. 1862(d)), and other relevant factors and information, I concurred with the Secretary's finding that PCMDPs are being imported into the United States in quantities and under circumstances that threaten to impair the national security of the United States. In my judgment, and in light of the Secretary's report, the fac-

tors in section 232(d), and other relevant factors and information, I determined that it is necessary and appropriate to direct negotiations of agreements to address the national security threat. In the Proclamation, I also noted that depending on the status or outcome of those negotiations, I may take other measures to adjust the imports of PCMDPs to address the national security threat.

I am enclosing a copy of the Proclamation that I have issued. The Proclamation further explains the circumstances underlying the threat to impair the national security of the United States posed by imports of PCMDPs, and the actions taken in the Proclamation to eliminate that threat.

DONALD J. TRUMP.

THE WHITE HOUSE, February 11, 2026.

ADJUSTING IMPORTS OF MEDIUM- AND HEAVY-DUTY VEHICLES, MEDIUM- AND HEAVY-DUTY VEHICLE PARTS, AND BUSES INTO THE UNITED STATES—MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES (H. DOC. NO. 119-135)

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following message from the President of the United States; which was read and, together with the accompanying papers, referred to the Committee on Ways and Means and ordered to be printed:

To the Congress of the United States:

Consistent with applicable law, including section 232(c)(2) of the Trade Expansion Act of 1962, as amended (19 U.S.C. 1862(c)(2)) (section 232), I am providing notice of the reasons why I have decided to take action to adjust imports of medium- and heavy-duty vehicles (MHDVs), and medium- and heavy-duty vehicle parts (MHDVPs), and buses so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In September 2025, the Secretary of Commerce (Secretary), in accordance with section 232, transmitted to me a report on his investigation into the effects of imports of MHDVs, MHDVPs, and buses on the national security of the United States. Based on the facts considered in that investigation, the Secretary found and advised me of his opinion that MHDVs, MHDVPs, and buses are being imported into the United States in such quantities and under such circumstances as to threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In Proclamation 10984 of October 17, 2025 (Adjusting Imports of Medium- and Heavy-Duty Vehicles, Medium- and Heavy-Duty Vehicle Parts, and Buses Into the United States) (Proclamation), after considering the Secretary's report, the factors in section 232(d) (19 U.S.C. 1862(d)), and other relevant factors and information, I concurred with the Secretary's finding that MHDVs, MHDVPs, and buses are being imported

into the United States in quantities and under circumstances that threaten to impair the national security of the United States. In my judgment, and in light of the Secretary's report, the factors in section 232(d), and other relevant factors and information, I determined that it is necessary and appropriate to impose tariffs on certain imports of MHDVs, MHDVPs, and buses.

I am enclosing a copy of the Proclamation that I have issued. The Proclamation further explains the circumstances underlying the threat to impair the national security of the United States posed by imports of MHDVs, MHDVPs, and buses and the actions taken in the Proclamation to eliminate that threat.

DONALD J. TRUMP.
THE WHITE HOUSE, February 11, 2026.

□ 1650

ADJUSTING IMPORTS OF SEMICONDUCTORS, SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING EQUIPMENT, AND THEIR DERIVATIVE PRODUCTS INTO THE UNITED STATES—MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES (H. DOC. NO. 119-136)

The SPEAKER pro tempore laid before the House the following message from the President of the United States; which was read and, together with the accompanying papers, referred to the Committee on Ways and Means and ordered to be printed:

To the Congress of the United States:

Consistent with applicable law, including section 232(c)(2) of the Trade Expansion Act of 1962, as amended (19 U.S.C. 1862(c)(2)) (section 232), I am providing notice of the reasons why I have decided to take action to adjust imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

On December 22, 2025, the Secretary of Commerce (Secretary), in accordance with section 232, transmitted to me a report on his investigation into the effects of imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products on the national security of the United States. Based on the facts considered in that investigation, the Secretary found and advised me of his opinion that semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products are being imported into the United States in such quantities and under such circumstances as to threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In Proclamation 11002 of January 14, 2026 (Adjusting Imports of Semiconductors, Semiconductor Manufacturing Equipment, and Their Derivative Products Into The United States) (Proclamation), after considering the Secretary's report, the factors in section

232(d) (19 U.S.C. 1862(d)), and other relevant factors and information, among other things, I concurred with the Secretary's finding that semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivatives are being imported into the United States in quantities and under circumstances that threaten to impair the national security of the United States. In my judgment, and in light of the Secretary's report, the factors in section 232(d), and other relevant factors and information, I determined that it is necessary and appropriate to direct negotiations of agreements to address the national security threat. In the Proclamation, I also noted that depending on the status or resolution of those negotiations, I may take other measures to adjust the imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivatives to address the national security threat. I also determined that it is necessary and appropriate to impose an immediate *ad valorem* duty rate on the import of certain advanced computing chips and certain derivative products to address the national security threat found in the Proclamation.

I am enclosing a copy of the Proclamation that I have issued. The Proclamation further explains the circumstances underlying the threat to impair the national security of the United States posed by imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products, and the actions taken in the Proclamation to eliminate that threat.

DONALD J. TRUMP.
THE WHITE HOUSE, February 11, 2026.

RECESS

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 12(a) of rule I, the Chair declares the House in recess subject to the call of the Chair.

Accordingly (at 4 o'clock and 55 minutes p.m.), the House stood in recess.

□ 1716

AFTER RECESS

The recess having expired, the House was called to order by the Speaker pro tempore (Mr. DESJARLAIS) at 5 o'clock and 16 minutes p.m.

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Proceedings will resume on questions previously postponed. Votes will be taken in the following order:

The motion to recommit on H.R. 3617;

Passage of H.R. 3617, if ordered;

Passage of H.J. Res. 72;

The motion to recommit on H.R. 261;

Passage of H.R. 261, if ordered;

The motion to commit on S. 1383; and

Passage of S. 1383, if ordered.

The first electronic vote will be conducted as a 15-minute vote. Pursuant to clause 9 of rule XX, remaining electronic votes will be conducted as 5-minute votes.

SECURING AMERICA'S CRITICAL MINERALS SUPPLY ACT

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on the motion to recommit on the bill (H.R. 3617) to amend the Department of Energy Organization Act to secure the supply of critical energy resources, including critical minerals and other materials, and for other purposes, offered by the gentleman from Ohio (Mr. LANDSMAN), on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the motion.

The Clerk redesignated the motion.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion to recommit.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 214, nays 215, not voting 3, as follows:

[Roll No. 63]

YEAS—214

Adams	Evans (PA)	Mannion
Aguilar	Fields	Matsui
Amo	Figures	McBath
Ansari	Fletcher	McBride
Auchincloss	Foster	McClain Delaney
Balint	Foushee	McClellan
Barragán	Frankel, Lois	McCollum
Beatty	Friedman	McDonald Rivet
Bell	Frost	McGarvey
Bera	Garamendi	McGovern
Beyer	Garcia (CA)	McIver
Bishop	Garcia (IL)	Meeks
Bonamici	Garcia (TX)	Menefee
Boyle (PA)	Gillen	Menendez
Brown	Golden (ME)	Meng
Brownley	Goldman (NY)	Mfume
Budzinski	Gomez	Min
Bynum	Gonzalez, V.	Moore (WI)
Carbajal	Goodlander	Morelle
Carson	Gottheimer	Morrison
Carter (LA)	Gray	Moskowitz
Casar	Green, Al (TX)	Moulton
Case	Grijalva	Mrvan
Casten	Harder (CA)	Mullin
Castor (FL)	Hayes	Nadler
Castro (TX)	Himes	Neal
Cherfilus-	Horsford	Neguse
McCormick	Houlahan	Norcross
Chu	Hoyer	Ocasio-Cortez
Cisneros	Hoyle (OR)	Olzewski
Clark (MA)	Huffman	Omar
Clarke (NY)	Ivey	Pallone
Cleaver	Jackson (IL)	Panetta
Clyburn	Jacobs	Pappas
Cohen	Jayapal	Pelosi
Conaway	Jeffries	Perez
Correa	Johnson (GA)	Peters
Costa	Johnson (TX)	Pettersen
Courtney	Kamlager-Dove	Pingree
Craig	Kaptur	Pocan
Crockett	Keating	Pou
Crow	Kelly (IL)	Pressley
Cuellar	Kennedy (NY)	Quigley
Davids (KS)	Khanna	Ramirez
Davis (IL)	Krishnamoorthi	Randall
Davis (NC)	Landsman	Raskin
Dean (PA)	Larsen (WA)	Riley (NY)
DeGette	Larson (CT)	Rivas
DeLauro	Latimer	Ross
DelBene	Lee (NV)	Ruiz
Deluzio	Lee (PA)	Ryan
DeSaulnier	Leger Fernandez	Salinas
Dexter	Levin	Sánchez
Dingell	Liccardo	Scanlon
Doggett	Lieu	Schakowsky
Elfreth	Lofgren	Schneider
Escobar	Lynch	Scholten
Espallat	Magaziner	Schrier

Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Simon
Smith (WA)
Sorensen
Soto
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Subramanyam
Suozzi

Swalwell
Sykes
Takano
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Tran

Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velázquez
Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

HUIZENGA changed their vote from “yea” to “nay.”

Messrs. MFUME, CARSON, BELL, and KEATING changed their vote from “nay” to “yea.”

So the motion to recommit was rejected.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the passage of the bill.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. PALLONE. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 223, nays 206, not voting 3, as follows:

[Roll No. 64]

YEAS—223

Adersholt
Alford
Allen
Amodei (NV)
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Barrett
Baumgartner
Bean (FL)
Begich
Bentz
Bergman
Bice
Biggs (AZ)
Biggs (SC)
Bilirakis
Boebert
Bost
Brecheen
Bresnahan
Buchanan
Burchett
Burlison
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Ciscomani
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Collins
Comer
Crane
Crank
Crawford
Crenshaw
Davidson
De La Cruz
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Downing
Dunn (FL)
Edwards
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Evans (CO)
Ezell
Fallon
Fedorchak
Feenstra
Fine
Finstad
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Flood
Fong
Foxy
Franklin, Scott
Fry
Fulcher
Garbarino
Gill (TX)

NOT VOTING—3

Barr Moore (WV) Murphy

□ 1759

Messrs. CRENSHAW, PATRONIS, FINE, WILSON of South Carolina, Ms. BOEBERT, Messrs. ISSA, DUNN of Florida, BRESNAHAN, Mmes. HOUCHIN, MILLER-MEEKS, and Mr.

Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Mills
Moolenaar
Moore (AL)
Moore (NC)
Moore (UT)
Moran
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Nunn (IA)
Obornolte
Ogles
Onder
Owens
Palmer
Patronis
Perry
Pfluger
Reschenthaler
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rouzer
Roy
Rulli
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Schmidt
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Self
Sessions
Shreve
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Staubert
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Strong
Stutzman
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner (OH)
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Dwyne
Van Epps
Van Orden
Wagner
Walberg
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Westerman
Wied
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yakym
Zinke

Aderholt
Alford
Allen
Amodei (NV)
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Barrett
Baumgartner
Bean (FL)
Begich
Bentz
Bergman
Bice
Biggs (AZ)
Biggs (SC)
Bilirakis
Boebert
Bost
Brecheen
Bresnahan
Buchanan
Burchett
Burlison
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Ciscomani
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Collins
Comer
Crane
Crank
Crawford
Crenshaw
Cuellar
Davidson
Davis (NC)
De La Cruz
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Downing
Dunn (FL)
Edwards
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Evans (CO)
Ezell
Fallon
Fedorchak
Feenstra
Fine
Finstad
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fleischmann
Flood

Fong
Foxy
Franklin, Scott
Fry
Fulcher
Garbarino
Gill (TX)
Gimenez
Golden (ME)
Goldman (TX)
Gonzales, Tony
Gonzalez, V.
Gooden
Gosar
Graves
Gray
Griffith
Grothman
Guest
Guthrie
Hageman
Hamadeh (AZ)
Haridopolos
Harrigan
Harris (MD)
Harris (NC)
Harshbarger
Hern (OK)
Higgins (LA)
Hinson
Houchin
Hudson
Huizenga
Hunt
Hurd (CO)
Issa
Jack
Jackson (TX)
James
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kean
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kennedy (UT)
Kiggans (VA)
Kiley (CA)
Kim
Knott
Kustoff
LaHood
LaLota
Langworthy
Latta
Lawler
Lee (FL)
Letlow
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luna
Luttrell
Mace
Mackenzie
Malliotakis
Malliottakis

Timmons
Turner (OH)
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Dwyne
Van Epps
Van Orden

Wagner
Walberg
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Westerman
Wied
Williams (TX)

NAYS—206

Adams
Aguilar
Amo
Ansari
Auchincloss
Balint
Barragan
Beatty
Bell
Bera
Beyer
Bishop
Bonamici
Boyle (PA)
Brown
Brownley
Budzinski
Bynum
Carbajal
Carson
Carter (LA)
Casar
Case
Casten
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus
McCormick
Chu
Cisneros
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Conaway
Courtney
Craig
Crockett
Crow
Davids (KS)
Davis (IL)
Dean (PA)
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Deluzio
DeSaulnier
Dexter
Dingell
Doggett
Elfreth
Escobar
Espallat
Evans (PA)
Fields
Figures
Fitzpatrick
Fletcher
Foster
Foushee
Frankel, Lois
Friedman
Frost
Garamendi
Garcia (CA)
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gillen
Goldman (NY)

Gomez
Goodlander
Gottheimer
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hoyle (OR)
Huffman
Ivey
Jackson (IL)
Jacobs
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Kamlager-Dove
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Kennedy (NY)
Khanna
Krishnamoorthi
Landsman
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latimer
Lee (NV)
Lee (PA)
Leger Fernandez
Levin
Liccardo
Lieu
Loifgren
Lynch
Magaziner
Mannion
Matsui
McBath
McBride
McClain Delaney
McClellan
McCollum
McDonald Rivet
McGarvey
McGovern
McIver
Meeks
Menefee
Menendez
Meng
Mfume
Min
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Morrison
Moskowitz
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Nadler
Neal
Neguse
Norcross
Ocasio-Cortez
Olszewski

Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yakym
Zinke
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pelosi
Peters
Pettersen
Pingree
Pocan
Pou
Pressley
Quigley
Ramirez
Randall
Raskin
Rass
Rivas
Ruiz
Ryan
Salinas
Sánchez
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schneider
Scholten
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Simon
Smith (WA)
Sorensen
Soto
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Subramanyam
Suozi
Swalwell
Sykes
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Tran
Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velázquez
Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

NOT VOTING—3

Barr Moore (WV) Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

□ 1805

So the bill was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

Mr. BARR. Mr. Speaker, had I been present, I would have voted NAY on Roll Call No. 63 and YEA on Roll Call No. 64.

RELATING TO A NATIONAL EMERGENCY BY THE PRESIDENT ON FEBRUARY 1, 2025

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on passage of the joint resolution (H.J. Res. 72) relating to a national emergency by the President on February 1, 2025, on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk read the title of the joint resolution.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the passage of the joint resolution.

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 219, nays 211, not voting 2, as follows:

[Roll No. 65]

YEAS—219

Adams	Foster	McGarvey
Aguiar	Foushee	McGovern
Amo	Frankel, Lois	McIver
Ansari	Friedman	Meeks
Auchincloss	Frost	Menefee
Bacon	Garamendi	Menendez
Balint	Garcia (CA)	Meng
Barragán	Garcia (IL)	Mfume
Beatty	Garcia (TX)	Min
Bell	Gillen	Moore (WI)
Bera	Goldman (NY)	Morelle
Beyer	Gomez	Morrison
Bishop	Gonzalez, V.	Moskowitz
Bonamici	Goodlander	Moulton
Boyle (PA)	Gottheimer	Mrvan
Brown	Gray	Mullin
Brownley	Green, Al (TX)	Nadler
Budzinski	Grijalva	Neal
Bynum	Harder (CA)	Neguse
Carbajal	Hayes	Newhouse
Carson	Himes	Norcross
Carter (LA)	Horsford	Ocasio-Cortez
Casar	Houlihan	Olshewski
Case	Hoyer	Omar
Casten	Hoyle (OR)	Pallone
Castor (FL)	Huffman	Panetta
Castro (TX)	Hurd (CO)	Pappas
Cherfilus-	Ivey	Pelosi
McCormick	Jackson (IL)	Perez
Chu	Jacobs	Peters
Cisneros	Jayapal	Pettersen
Clark (MA)	Jeffries	Pingree
Clarke (NY)	Johnson (GA)	Pocan
Cleaver	Johnson (TX)	Pou
Clyburn	Kamlager-Dove	Pressley
Cohen	Kaptur	Quigley
Conaway	Keating	Ramirez
Correa	Kelly (IL)	Randall
Costa	Kennedy (NY)	Raskin
Courtney	Khanna	Riley (NY)
Craig	Kiley (CA)	Rivas
Crockett	Krishnamoorthi	Ross
Crow	Landsman	Ruiz
Cuellar	Larsen (WA)	Ryan
Davids (KS)	Larson (CT)	Salinas
Davis (IL)	Latimer	Sánchez
Davis (NC)	Lee (NV)	Scanlon
Dean (PA)	Lee (PA)	Shakowsky
DeGette	Leger Fernandez	Schneider
DeLauro	Levin	Scholten
DelBene	Liccardo	Schrier
Deluzio	Lieu	Scott (VA)
DeSaulnier	Lofgren	Scott, David
Dexter	Lynch	Sewell
Dingell	Magaziner	Sherman
Doggett	Mannion	Simon
Elfreth	Massie	Smith (WA)
Escobar	Matsui	Sorensen
Espallat	McBath	Soto
Evans (PA)	McBride	Stansbury
Fields	McClain Delaney	Stanton
Figures	McClellan	Stevens
Fitzpatrick	McCollum	Strickland
Fletcher	McDonald Rivet	Subramanyam

Suoizzi
Swalwell
Sykes
Takano
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda

Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Tran
Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velázquez

Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

UNDERSEA CABLE PROTECTION ACT OF 2025

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on the motion to recommit on the bill (H.R. 261) to amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit requiring an authorization for the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have previously been authorized by a Federal or State agency, offered by the gentleman from California (Mr. CARBAJAL), on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the motion.

The Clerk redesignated the motion.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion to recommit.

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 214, nays 216, not voting 2, as follows:

[Roll No. 66]

YEAS—214

Adams	Espallat	Lynch
Aguiar	Evans (PA)	Magaziner
Amo	Fields	Mannion
Ansari	Figures	Matsui
Auchincloss	Fletcher	McBath
Balint	Foster	McBride
Barragán	Foushee	McClain Delaney
Beatty	Frankel, Lois	McClellan
Bell	Friedman	McCollum
Bera	Frost	McDonald Rivet
Beyer	Garamendi	McGarvey
Bishop	Garcia (CA)	McGovern
Bonamici	Garcia (IL)	McIver
Boyle (PA)	Garcia (TX)	Meeks
Brown	Gillen	Menefee
Brownley	Golden (ME)	Menendez
Budzinski	Goldman (NY)	Meng
Bynum	Gomez	Mfume
Carbajal	Gonzalez, V.	Min
Carson	Goodlander	Moore (WI)
Carter (LA)	Gottheimer	Morelle
Casar	Gray	Morrison
Case	Green, Al (TX)	Moskowitz
Casten	Grijalva	Moulton
Castor (FL)	Harder (CA)	Mrvan
Castro (TX)	Hayes	Mullin
Cherfilus-	Himes	Nadler
McCormick	Horsford	Neal
Chu	Houlihan	Neguse
Cisneros	Hoyer	Norcross
Clark (MA)	Hoyle (OR)	Ocasio-Cortez
Clarke (NY)	Huffman	Olshewski
Cleaver	Ivey	Omar
Clyburn	Jackson (IL)	Pallone
Cohen	Jacobs	Panetta
Conaway	Jayapal	Pappas
Correa	Jeffries	Pelosi
Costa	Johnson (GA)	Perez
Courtney	Johnson (TX)	Peters
Craig	Kamlager-Dove	Pettersen
Crockett	Kaptur	Pingree
Crow	Keating	Pocan
Cuellar	Kelly (IL)	Pou
Davids (KS)	Kennedy (NY)	Pressley
Davis (IL)	Khanna	Quigley
Davis (NC)	Krishnamoorthi	Ramirez
Dean (PA)	Landsman	Randall
DeGette	Larsen (WA)	Raskin
DeLauro	Larson (CT)	Riley (NY)
DelBene	Latimer	Rivas
Deluzio	Lee (NV)	Ross
DeSaulnier	Lee (PA)	Ruiz
Dexter	Leger Fernandez	Ryan
Dingell	Levin	Salinas
Doggett	Liccardo	Sánchez
Elfreth	Lieu	Scanlon
Escobar	Lofgren	Schakowsky

NOT VOTING—2

Moore (WV) Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

□ 1817

Mr. FRY changed his vote from “yea” to “nay.”

So the joint resolution was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

Schneider
Scholten
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Simon
Smith (WA)
Sorensen
Soto
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland

Subramanyam
Suozzi
Swalwell
Sykes
Takano
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan

Tran
Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velázquez
Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

NAYS—216

Aderholt
Alford
Allen
Amodei (NV)
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Barr
Barrett
Baumgartner
Bean (FL)
Begich
Bentz
Bergman
Bice
Biggs (AZ)
Biggs (SC)
Bilirakis
Boebert
Bost
Brecheen
Bresnahan
Buchanan
Burchett
Burlison
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Ciscomani
Cline
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Collins
Comer
Crane
Crank
Crawford
Crenshaw
Davidson
De La Cruz
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Downing
Dunn (FL)
Edwards
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Evans (CO)
Ezell
Fallon
Fedorchak
Feenstra
Fine
Finstad
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fitzpatrick
Fleischmann
Flood
Fong
Fox
Franklin, Scott
Fry
Fulcher
Garbarino

Gill (TX)
Gimenez
Goldman (TX)
Gonzales, Tony
Gooden
Gosar
Graves
Griffith
Grothman
Guest
Guthrie
Hageman
Hamadeh (AZ)
Haridopolos
Harrigan
Harris (MD)
Harris (NC)
Harshbarger
Hern (OK)
Higgins (LA)
Hill (AR)
Hinson
Houchin
Hudson
Huizenga
Hunt
Hurd (CO)
Issa
Jack
Jackson (TX)
James
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kean
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kennedy (UT)
Kiggans (VA)
Kiley (CA)
Kim
Knott
Kustoff
LaHood
LaLota
Langworthy
Latta
Lawler
Lee (FL)
Letlow
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luna
Luttrell
Mace
Mackenzie
Malliotakis
Maloy
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCaull
McClain
McClintock
McCormick
McDowell
McGuire
Messmer
Meuser
Miller (IL)

Miller (OH)
Miller (WV)
Miller-Meeks
Mills
Moolenaar
Moore (AL)
Moore (NC)
Moore (UT)
Moran
Nehls
Newhouse
Norman
Nunn (IA)
Oberholte
Ogles
Orr
Owens
Palmer
Patronis
Perry
Pfluger
Reschenthaler
Rogers (AL)
Rogers (KY)
Rose
Rouzer
Roy
Rulli
Rutherford
Salazar
Scalise
Schmidt
Schweikert
Scott, Austin
Self
Sessions
Shreve
Simpson
Smith (MO)
Smith (NE)
Smith (NJ)
Smucker
Spartz
Stauber
Stefanik
Steil
Steube
Strong
Stutzman
Taylor
Tenney
Thompson (PA)
Tiffany
Timmons
Turner (OH)
Valadao
Van Drew
Van Dwyne
Van Epps
Van Orden
Wagner
Walberg
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Westerman
Wied
Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yakym
Zinke

NOT VOTING—2

Moore (WV) Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

□ 1823

So the motion to recommit was rejected.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the passage of the bill.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. HUFFMAN. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 218, nays 212, not voting 2, as follows:

[Roll No. 67]

YEAS—218

Aderholt
Alford
Amodei (NV)
Arrington
Babin
Bacon
Baird
Balderson
Barr
Barrett
Baumgartner
Bean (FL)
Begich
Bentz
Bergman
Bice
Biggs (AZ)
Biggs (SC)
Bilirakis
Boebert
Bost
Brecheen
Bresnahan
Buchanan
Burchett
Burlison
Calvert
Cammack
Carey
Carter (GA)
Carter (TX)
Ciscomani
Cloud
Clyde
Cole
Collins
Comer
Crane
Crank
Crawford
Crenshaw
Davidson
De La Cruz
DesJarlais
Diaz-Balart
Donalds
Downing
Dunn (FL)
Edwards
Ellzey
Emmer
Estes
Evans (CO)
Ezell
Fallon
Fedorchak
Feenstra
Fine
Finstad
Fischbach
Fitzgerald
Fleischmann
Flood
Fong
Fox
Franklin, Scott
Fry
Fulcher
Garbarino

Gill (TX)
Gimenez
Goldman (TX)
Gonzales, Tony
Gooden
Gosar
Gottheimer
Graves
Gray
Griffith
Grothman
Guest
Guthrie
Hageman
Hamadeh (AZ)
Haridopolos
Harrigan
Harris (MD)
Harris (NC)
Harshbarger
Hern (OK)
Higgins (LA)
Hill (AR)
Hinson
Houchin
Huizenga
Hunt
Hurd (CO)
Issa
Jack
Jackson (TX)
James
Johnson (LA)
Johnson (SD)
Jordan
Joyce (OH)
Joyce (PA)
Kean
Kelly (MS)
Kelly (PA)
Kennedy (UT)
Kiggans (VA)
Kiley (CA)
Kim
Knott
Kustoff
LaHood
LaLota
Langworthy
Latta
Lawler
Lee (FL)
Letlow
Loudermilk
Lucas
Luna
Luttrell
Mace
Mackenzie
Malliotakis
Maloy
Mann
Massie
Mast
McCaull
McClain
McClintock
McCormick
McDowell
McGuire

Williams (TX)
Wilson (SC)

Adams
Aguilar
Amo
Ansari
Auchincloss
Balint
Barragán
Beatty
Bell
Bera
Beyer
Bishop
Bonamici
Boyle (PA)
Brown
Brownley
Budzinski
Bynum
Carbajal
Carson
Carter (LA)
Casar
Case
Casten
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-
McCormick
Chu
Cisneros
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Conaway
Correa
Courtney
Craig
Crockett
Crow
Cuellar
Davids (KS)
Davis (IL)
Davis (NC)
Dean (PA)
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Deluzio
DeSaulnier
Dexter
Dingell
Doggett
Elfreth
Escobar
Espallat
Evans (PA)
Fields
Figures
Fitzpatrick
Fletcher
Foster
Foushee
Frankel, Lois
Friedman
Frost
Garamendi
Garcia (CA)
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gillen

Wittman
Womack

NAYS—212

Golden (ME)
Goldman (NY)
Gomez
Gonzalez, V.
Goodlander
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Himes
Horsford
Houlahan
Hoyer
Hoyle (OR)
Huffman
Ivey
Jackson (IL)
Jacobs
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Kamlager-Dove
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Kennedy (NY)
Khanna
Krishnamoorthi
Landsman
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latimer
Lee (NV)
Lee (PA)
Leger Fernandez
Levin
Liccardo
Lieu
Loftgren
Lynch
Magaziner
Mannion
Matsui
McBath
McBride
McClain Delaney
McClellan
McCollum
McDonald Rivet
McGarvey
McGovern
McIver
Meeks
Menefee
Menendez
Meng
Mfume
Min
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Morrison
Moskowitz
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Nadler
Neal
Neguse
Norcross
Ocasio-Cortez
Olszewski

Yakym
Zinke
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pelosi
Perez
Peters
Pettersen
Pingree
Pocan
Pou
Pressley
Quigley
Ramirez
Randall
Raskin
Riley (NY)
Rivas
Ross
Ruiz
Ryan
Salinas
Sánchez
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schneider
Scholten
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Simon
Smith (WA)
Sorensen
Soto
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Subramanyam
Suozzi
Swalwell
Sykes
Takano
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Tran
Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velázquez
Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

NOT VOTING—2

Allen Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

□ 1829

So the bill was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

The title of the bill was amended so as to read: “A bill to amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit the Secretary of Commerce from prohibiting, or requiring any permit or other authorization for, the installation, continued presence, operation,

maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have been authorized by a Federal or State agency.”.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

Stated for:

Mr. ALLEN. Mr. Speaker, had I been present, I would have voted YEA on Roll Call No. 67.

VETERANS ACCESSIBILITY ADVISORY COMMITTEE ACT OF 2025

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Pursuant to clause 8 of rule XX, the unfinished business is the vote on the motion to commit on the bill (S. 1383) to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access, and for other purposes, offered by the gentleman from New York (Mr. MORELLE), on which the yeas and nays were ordered.

The Clerk will redesignate the motion.

The Clerk redesignated the motion.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the motion to commit.

This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 214, nays 217, not voting 1, as follows:

[Roll No. 68]

YEAS—214

Adams	Dingell	Latimer
Aguilar	Doggett	Lee (NV)
Amo	Elfreh	Lee (PA)
Ansari	Escobar	Leger Fernandez
Auchincloss	Espallat	Levin
Balint	Evans (PA)	Liccardo
Barragan	Fields	Lieu
Beatty	Figures	Lofgren
Bell	Fletcher	Lynch
Bera	Foster	Magaziner
Beyer	Foushee	Mannion
Bishop	Frankel, Lois	Matsui
Bonamici	Friedman	McBath
Boyle (PA)	Frost	McBride
Brown	Garamendi	McClain Delaney
Brownley	Garcia (CA)	McClellan
Budzinski	Garcia (IL)	McCollum
Bynum	Garcia (TX)	McDonald Rivet
Carbajal	Gillen	McGarvey
Carson	Golden (ME)	McGovern
Carter (LA)	Goldman (NY)	McIver
Casas	Gomez	Meeks
Case	Gonzalez, V.	Menefee
Casten	Goodlander	Menendez
Castor (FL)	Gottheimer	Meng
Castro (TX)	Gray	Mfume
Cherfilus-	Green, Al (TX)	Min
McCormick	Grijalva	Moore (WI)
Chu	Harder (CA)	Morelle
Cisneros	Hayes	Morrison
Clark (MA)	Himes	Moskowitz
Clarke (NY)	Horsford	Moulton
Cleaver	Houlihan	Mrvan
Clyburn	Hoyer	Mullin
Cohen	Hoyle (OR)	Nadler
Conaway	Huffman	Neal
Correa	Ivey	Neguse
Costa	Jackson (IL)	Norcross
Courtney	Jacobs	Ocasio-Cortez
Craig	Jayapal	Olsewski
Crockett	Jeffries	Omar
Crow	Johnson (GA)	Pallone
Cuellar	Johnson (TX)	Panetta
Davids (KS)	Kamlager-Dove	Pappas
Davis (IL)	Kaptur	Pelosi
Davis (NC)	Keating	Perez
Dean (PA)	Kelly (IL)	Peters
DeGette	Kennedy (NY)	Pettersen
DeLauro	Khanna	Pingree
DelBene	Krishnamoorthi	Pocan
Deluzio	Landsman	Pou
DeSaulnier	Larsen (WA)	Pressley
Dexter	Larson (CT)	Quigley

Ramirez	Simon	Tonko
Randall	Smith (WA)	Torres (CA)
Raskin	Sorensen	Torres (NY)
Riley (NY)	Soto	Trahan
Rivas	Stansbury	Tran
Ross	Stanton	Underwood
Ruiz	Stevens	Vargas
Ryan	Strickland	Vasquez
Salinas	Subramanyam	Veasey
Salanchez	Suozi	Velazquez
Scanlon	Swailwell	Vindman
Schakowsky	Sykes	Walkinshaw
Schneider	Takano	Wasserman
Scholten	Thanedar	Schultz
Schrier	Thompson (CA)	Waters
Scott (VA)	Thompson (MS)	Watson Coleman
Scott, David	Titus	Whitesides
Sewell	Tlaib	Williams (GA)
Sherman	Tokuda	Wilson (FL)

NAYS—217

Aderholt	Miller-Meeks
Alford	Mills
Allen	Moolenaar
Amodei (NV)	Gooden
Arrington	Gosar
Babin	Graves
Bacon	Griffith
Baird	Grothman
Balderson	Guest
Barr	Guthrie
Barrett	Hageman
Baumgartner	Hamadeh (AZ)
Bean (FL)	Haridopolos
Begich	Harrigan
Bentz	Harris (MD)
Bergman	Harris (NC)
Bice	Harshbarger
Biggs (AZ)	Hern (OK)
Biggs (SC)	Higgins (LA)
Bilirakis	Hill (AR)
Boebert	Hinson
Bost	Houchin
Brecheen	Hudson
Bresnahan	Huizenga
Buchanan	Hunt
Burchett	Hurd (CO)
Burlison	Issa
Calvert	Jack
Cammack	Jackson (TX)
Carey	James
Carter (GA)	Johnson (LA)
Carter (TX)	Johnson (SD)
Ciscomani	Jordan
Cline	Joyce (OH)
Cloud	Joyce (PA)
Clyde	Kean
Cole	Kelly (MS)
Collins	Kelly (PA)
Comer	Kennedy (UT)
Crane	Kiggans (VA)
Crank	Kiley (CA)
Crawford	Kim
Crenshaw	Knott
Davidson	Kustoff
De La Cruz	LaHood
DesJarlais	LaLota
Diaz-Balart	Langworthy
Donalds	Latta
Downing	Lawler
Dunn (FL)	Lee (FL)
Edwards	Letlow
Ellzey	Loudermilk
Emmer	Lucas
Estes	Luna
Evans (CO)	Luttrell
Ezell	Mace
Fallon	Mackenzie
Fedorchak	Malliotakis
Feenstra	Maloy
Fine	Mann
Finstad	Massie
Fischbach	Mast
Fitzgerald	McCaul
Fitzpatrick	McClain
Fleischmann	McClintock
Flood	McCormick
Fong	McDowell
Fox	McGuire
Franklin, Scott	Messmer
Fry	Meuser
Fulcher	Miller (IL)
Garbarino	Miller (OH)
Gill (TX)	Miller (WV)

NOT VOTING—1

Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

□ 1835

So the motion to commit was rejected.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. The question is on the passage of the bill.

The question was taken; and the Speaker pro tempore announced that the ayes appeared to have it.

Mr. MORELLE. Mr. Speaker, on that I demand the yeas and nays.

The yeas and nays were ordered.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. This is a 5-minute vote.

The vote was taken by electronic device, and there were—yeas 218, nays 213, not voting 1, as follows:

[Roll No. 69]

YEAS—218

Aderholt	Fong	Massie
Alford	Fox	Mast
Allen	Franklin, Scott	McCaul
Amodei (NV)	Fry	McClain
Arrington	Fulcher	McClintock
Babin	Garbarino	McCormick
Bacon	Gill (TX)	McDowell
Baird	Jimenez	McGuire
Balderson	Goldman (TX)	Messmer
Barr	Gonzales, Tony	Meuser
Barrett	Gooden	Miller (IL)
Baumgartner	Gosar	Miller (OH)
Bean (FL)	Graves	Miller (WV)
Begich	Griffith	Miller-Meeks
Bentz	Grothman	Mills
Bergman	Guest	Moolenaar
Bice	Guthrie	Moore (AL)
Biggs (AZ)	Hageman	Moore (NC)
Biggs (SC)	Hamadeh (AZ)	Moore (UT)
Bilirakis	Haridopolos	Moore (WV)
Boebert	Harrigan	Moran
Bost	Harris (MD)	Nehls
Brecheen	Harris (NC)	Newhouse
Bresnahan	Harshbarger	Norman
Buchanan	Hern (OK)	Nunn (IA)
Burchett	Higgins (LA)	Obernolte
Burlison	Hill (AR)	Ogles
Calvert	Hinson	Onder
Cammack	Houchin	Owens
Carey	Hudson	Palmer
Carter (GA)	Huizenga	Patronis
Carter (TX)	Hunt	Perry
Ciscomani	Hurd (CO)	Pfuger
Cline	Issa	Reschenthaler
Cloud	Jack	Rogers (AL)
Clyde	Jackson (TX)	Rogers (KY)
Cole	James	Rose
Collins	Johnson (LA)	Rouzer
Comer	Johnson (SD)	Roy
Crane	Jordan	Rulli
Crank	Joyce (OH)	Rutherford
Crawford	Joyce (PA)	Salazar
Crenshaw	Kean	Scalise
Cuellar	Kelly (MS)	Schmidt
Davidson	Kelly (PA)	Schweikert
De La Cruz	Kennedy (UT)	Scott, Austin
DesJarlais	Kiggans (VA)	Self
Diaz-Balart	Kiley (CA)	Sessions
Donalds	Kim	Shreve
Downing	Knott	Simpson
Edwards	Kustoff	Smith (MO)
Ellzey	LaHood	Smith (NE)
Emmer	LaLota	Smith (NJ)
Estes	Langworthy	Smucker
Evans (CO)	Latta	Spartz
Ezell	Lawler	Staub
Fallon	Lee (FL)	Stefanik
Fedorchak	Letlow	Steube
Feenstra	Loudermilk	Strong
Fine	Lucas	Stutzman
Finstad	Luna	Taylor
Fischbach	Luttrell	Tenney
Fitzgerald	Mace	Thompson (PA)
Fitzpatrick	Mackenzie	Tiffany
Fleischmann	Malliotakis	Timmons
Flood	Maloy	Turner (OH)
	Mann	

Valadao
Van Drew
Van Duyne
Van Epps
Van Orden
Wagner

Walberg
Weber (TX)
Webster (FL)
Westerman
Wied
Williams (TX)

Wilson (SC)
Wittman
Womack
Yakym
Zinke

NAYS—213

Adams
Aguilar
Amo
Ansari
Auchincloss
Balint
Barragán
Beatty
Bell
Bera
Beyer
Bishop
Bonamici
Boyle (PA)
Brown
Brownley
Budzinski
Bynum
Carbajal
Carson
Carter (LA)
Casar
Case
Casten
Castor (FL)
Castro (TX)
Cherfilus-
McCormick
Chu
Cisneros
Clark (MA)
Clarke (NY)
Cleaver
Clyburn
Cohen
Conaway
Correa
Costa
Courtney
Craig
Crockett
Crow
Davids (KS)
Davis (IL)
Davis (NC)
Dean (PA)
DeGette
DeLauro
DelBene
Deluzio
DeSaulnier
Dexter
Dingell
Doggett
Elfreth
Escobar
Espallat
Evans (PA)
Fields
Figures
Fletcher
Foster
Foushee
Frankel, Lois
Friedman
Frost
Garamendi
Garcia (CA)
Garcia (IL)
Garcia (TX)
Gillen
Golden (ME)

Goldman (NY)
Gomez
Gonzalez, V.
Goodlander
Gottheimer
Gray
Green, Al (TX)
Grijalva
Harder (CA)
Hayes
Himes
Horsford
Houlihan
Hoyer
Hoyle (OR)
Huffman
Ivey
Jackson (IL)
Jacobs
Jayapal
Jeffries
Johnson (GA)
Johnson (TX)
Kamlager-Dove
Kaptur
Keating
Kelly (IL)
Kennedy (NY)
Khanna
Krishnamoorthi
Landsman
Larsen (WA)
Larson (CT)
Latimer
Lee (NV)
Lee (PA)
Leger Fernandez
Levin
Liccardo
Lieu
Lofgren
Lynch
Magaziner
Mannion
Matsui
McBath
McBride
McClain Delaney
McClellan
McCollum
McDonald Rivet
McGarvey
McGovern
McIver
Meeke
Menefee
Menendez
Meng
Mfume
Min
Moore (WI)
Morelle
Morrison
Moskowitz
Moulton
Mrvan
Mullin
Nadler
Neal
Neguse
Norcross
Ocasio-Cortez

Olszewski
Omar
Pallone
Panetta
Pappas
Pelosi
Perez
Peters
Pettersen
Pingree
Pocan
Pou
Pressley
Quigley
Ramirez
Randall
Raskin
Riley (NY)
Rivas
Ross
Ruiz
Ryan
Salinas
Sánchez
Scanlon
Schakowsky
Schneider
Scholten
Schrier
Scott (VA)
Scott, David
Sewell
Sherman
Simon
Smith (WA)
Sorensen
Soto
Stansbury
Stanton
Stevens
Strickland
Subramanyam
Suozi
Swalwell
Sykes
Takano
Thanedar
Thompson (CA)
Thompson (MS)
Titus
Tlaib
Tokuda
Tonko
Torres (CA)
Torres (NY)
Trahan
Tran
Underwood
Vargas
Vasquez
Veasey
Velázquez
Vindman
Walkinshaw
Wasserman
Schultz
Waters
Watson Coleman
Whitesides
Williams (GA)
Wilson (FL)

NOT VOTING—1

Murphy

ANNOUNCEMENT BY THE SPEAKER PRO TEMPORE

The SPEAKER pro tempore (during the vote). There are 2 minutes remaining.

□ 1843

So the bill was passed.

The result of the vote was announced as above recorded.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

AUTHORIZING THE USE OF EMANCIPATION HALL IN THE CAPITOL VISITOR CENTER FOR A CEREMONY AS PART OF THE COMMEMORATION OF THE DAYS OF REMEMBRANCE OF VICTIMS OF THE HOLOCAUST

Mrs. MILLER of Illinois. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that the Committee on House Administration be discharged from further consideration of H. Con. Res. 72, and ask for its immediate consideration in the House.

The Clerk read the title of the concurrent resolution.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Illinois?

There was no objection.

The text of the concurrent resolution is as follows:

H. CON. RES. 72

Resolved by the House of Representatives (the Senate concurring),

SECTION 1. USE OF EMANCIPATION HALL FOR A CEREMONY AS PART OF THE COMMEMORATION OF THE DAYS OF REMEMBRANCE OF VICTIMS OF THE HOLOCAUST.

(a) AUTHORIZATION.—Emancipation Hall in the Capitol Visitor Center is authorized to be used on April 14, 2026, for a ceremony as part of the commemoration of the days of remembrance of victims of the Holocaust.

(b) PREPARATIONS.—Physical preparations for the ceremony described in subsection (a) shall be carried out in accordance with such conditions as the Architect of the Capitol may prescribe.

The concurrent resolution was agreed to.

A motion to reconsider was laid on the table.

HOUR OF MEETING ON TOMORROW

Mrs. MILLER of Illinois. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that when the House adjourns today, it adjourn to meet at 9 a.m. tomorrow.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Illinois?

There was no objection.

PERMISSION FOR MEMBER TO BE CONSIDERED AS FIRST SPONSOR OF H.R. 3370 AND H.R. 1742

Ms. HOULAHAN. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that I may hereafter be considered to be the first sponsor of H.R. 3370, PROTECT Firefighters Act, and H.R. 1742, Access to Reproductive Care for Servicemembers Act, bills originally introduced by Representative Sherrill of New Jersey, for the purpose of adding cosponsors and requesting reprintings pursuant to clause 7 of rule XII.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Pennsylvania?

There was no objection.

GOVERNOR KEMP APPOINTS NEW JUDGES TO SUPERIOR AND STATE COURTS IN GEORGIA

(Mr. CARTER of Georgia asked and was given permission to address the

House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. CARTER of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize the newly appointed Georgia State and Superior Court judges. These judges are all accomplished attorneys and legal professionals who are stepping into vital roles within Georgia's judicial system.

Among those appointed is a native of Brunswick, Georgia, in my district, Steven Blackerby.

Mr. Blackerby, who was a partner at Brown Readdick, will now serve the Superior Court of the Brunswick Judicial Circuit. Mr. Blackerby earned his bachelor of arts in English from Emory University and his juris doctor with honors from the University of Georgia School of Law, where he served on the editorial board of the "Journal of Intellectual Property Law." He was also a member of both the Federalist Society and the Student Bar Association.

Mr. Blackerby has devoted more than two decades of his career to a wide range of legal matters, with expertise in representing local governments and serving as city attorney for multiple municipalities.

Mr. Blackerby's experience is notable, and he will certainly excel in this new position.

RECOGNIZING YONKERS-EAST YONKERS ROTARY CLUB

(Mr. LATIMER asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. LATIMER. Mr. Speaker, I recognize the community service provided by the men and women of the Yonkers-East Yonkers Rotary Club. Every day, they live out their voluntary efforts of the Rotary Four-Plus-One Test, ensuring truth, fairness, good will, benefit, and fun in their activities under the banner of service above self.

Recently, the club raised needed funds for their community service projects, completing a 25-hour-plus marathon filibuster, assisting families in need.

The club is led by President Alan Gray, President-elect Anne Murphy, Vice President Jeffrey Landsman, Immediate Past President George John, and other key officers: Greg Arcaro, Christian Fassetta, Philippe Charles, Matt Koppe, Alix Schnee, and many more.

From the floor of the House of Representatives, we salute the Rotary Club of Yonkers-East Yonkers, and I wish them continued success in all of their good works.

RECOGNIZING BAILEY LITTLE

(Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to celebrate Bailey Little, a 2023 Bellefonte High School graduate.

Bailey recently received an American degree from the Future Farmers of America. Bailey is the first Bellefonte FFA member in nearly two decades to receive an American degree. She has been an active FFA member since her freshman year.

The American degree is the highest FFA honor and is given to members for their dedication to their chapter, leadership, and community involvement.

To receive an American degree, members must receive their State FFA degree, be an active member of their chapter for at least 3 years, and take part in various agricultural education programs.

Bailey's FFA projects included raising beef cattle, dairy cows, goats, poultry, and rabbits. Along with raising livestock, Bailey is a small business owner, selling Western jewelry and clothing. Additionally, Bailey and her fiancé raise beef cattle in Centre County.

Mr. Speaker, Bailey should be proud of her accomplishments, and it is a great example for FFA members in our community. I congratulate Bailey on receiving the American degree.

□ 1850

MAKING IT HARDER FOR U.S. CITIZENS TO VOTE

(Mr. LANDSMAN asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. LANDSMAN. Mr. Speaker, I rise today because the House just voted on the SAVE America Act, which will make it harder for tens of millions of Americans to vote, not noncitizens. Noncitizens can't vote. They can't register to vote. If they do, they will be deported.

American citizens are being denied their right to vote by requiring, in this bill, all kinds of paperwork to register, all kinds of paperwork to vote.

Three examples: For married women, there are 70 million women with an ID that does not match their birth certificate. It will be harder for them to register to vote. Seniors, especially those who have been voting by mail, it will be harder for them to vote. College students and those who serve our country abroad would have to come home in order to register to vote.

This is a terrible, un-American, undemocratic, honestly insane bill that the Senate should not take up.

HONORING SARAH ROOT

(Mr. FEENSTRA asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. FEENSTRA. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Sarah Root and express the relief of our community that justice has been delivered to her killer.

In 2016, 21-year-old Sarah Root was driving home from her graduation

when an illegal immigrant, who was drunk, driving at three times the legal limit, struck and killed her. Her killer posted bail and vanished from the country, leaving Sarah's family without answers for nearly 10 years.

Sarah should be 31 today. In her memory, I fought to pass Sarah's Law, included in the first bill signed by President Trump.

Her bill is now law, and on February 3, justice finally came for her killer. He was extradited, convicted, and sentenced to more than 20 years in prison.

As a father of two girls, I cannot fathom the pain Michelle and Scott have endured the past 10 years. Sarah's Law is a promise to them and every American family that we will not ignore these tragedies, and we will act to prevent them.

RECOGNIZING BRADLEY SOLYAN

(Ms. LOIS FRANKEL of Florida asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend her remarks.)

Ms. LOIS FRANKEL of Florida. Mr. Speaker, I rise today with great gratitude for my chief of staff, Bradley Solyan, who is departing my office after 12 years of extraordinary service to the people of Palm Beach County and our country.

Brad really has quite a story. He came to Washington having been a teacher in south Florida, and then he joined my office as an intern. He became the legislative correspondent, policy adviser, legislative director, and, ultimately, chief of staff—what a role model for perseverance and dedication.

He has led with vision, patience, and a steady hand. No matter the challenge, he has always been calm, with clarity and focus. Best of all, he comes to the office every day with a very big smile, and he lifts us all.

Mr. Speaker, I am going to miss Brad dearly. I wish him great success, and I ask everybody to join me in wishing Brad great success on his new journey.

HONORING YVONNE FEDDERSON

(Mr. BIGGS of Arizona asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. BIGGS of Arizona. Mr. Speaker, I rise in honor of Yvonne Feddersen, co-founder of Childhelp, a national organization dedicated to the prevention and treatment of child abuse.

Yvonne lived an amazing, divinely inspired life.

In 1959, Yvonne was in her mid-twenties and in the midst of a successful acting career. She and Sara O'Meara, who became a close friend and cofounder of Childhelp, were on a USO tour in Japan when they found 11 Japanese-American orphans kicked out of their orphanage. Yvonne and Sara responded, finding them shelter and long-term care.

What started as an effort to help these 11 children turned into a lifelong calling. Yvonne and Sara went on to open orphanages in Japan and Vietnam, saving tens of thousands of children.

In the mid-1970s, at the behest of Nancy Reagan, they opened their first iteration of Childhelp in California. They have since created a nationwide network of assistance, including a 24/7 hotline, treatment centers, abuse prevention programs, and awareness campaigns. We are honored that they chose to headquarter Childhelp in Arizona.

On January 23 of this year, at the age of 90, God called Yvonne home. I count it as a tremendous blessing to have known Yvonne and witnessed the profound impact she had on the lives of our most vulnerable, on our community, our State, and our Nation. Her legacy will endure.

HONORING FIREFIGHTER HOWARD BENNETT

(Mr. NORCROSS asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. NORCROSS. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize Howard Bennett, a Camden City, New Jersey, firefighter who tragically lost his life on the job last week.

He served his community for 26 years, and he will forever be remembered as husband to Fran, father to David and Jenna, a brother, a friend, and a protector.

When it came to the fire boat, Howard's knowledge was second to none. He treated it like an extension of himself, ensuring that it was always ready for action.

His fellow firefighters will remember him for his resourcefulness. When others thought something couldn't be fixed, Howard found a way to make it work.

He was a trusted mentor to young firefighters, always willing to help, simply because that is who he was.

Firefighter Howard Bennett served with integrity, humility, and heart. Today, I honor his service and extend my deepest condolences to his loved ones. May he rest in peace.

HOUSING FOR THE 21ST CENTURY

(Mr. MEUSER asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. MEUSER. Mr. Speaker, I rise in support of the Housing for the 21st Century Act, introduced by Chairman HILL and Subcommittee on Housing and Insurance Chairman FLOOD, which passed the House with overwhelming bipartisan support.

Housing affordability is a supply problem, and for too long, Federal policy has made it slow and expensive to build new homes.

President Trump and Secretary Scott Turner advanced housing reforms that

cut blue tape, expanded supply, lowered the price of lumber, and brought mortgage rates below 6 percent.

This legislation builds on that progress by removing Federal barriers so homes can be built faster and economically at scale without new Federal spending.

Today, it can cost over \$100,000 before a shovel ever hits the dirt to build a new home, and builders often cannot build a home for less than \$250,000. This bill modernizes housing laws, improves coordination between HUD and USDA, expands manufactured housing in rural communities, reduces barriers for veterans, and increases access to small-dollar mortgages.

Mr. Speaker, I was very pleased to support this important legislation.

□ 1900

RECOGNIZING BLACK CHAMBER OF COMMERCE OF SUMMIT COUNTY

(Mrs. SYKES asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mrs. SYKES. Mr. Speaker, today I rise to recognize the Black Chamber of Commerce of Summit County and co-founders Robert DeJournett and Misty Beasley as Ohio's 13th Congressional District Champions of the Week.

One year ago I had the honor of attending its kick-off event in Akron, and I was truly inspired to see so many people support this catalyst for change.

After an economic study was commissioned, it was determined that Akron's Black population, who represents nearly one-third of the region—yet, the report highlighted through the Elevate Akron report that there was purposeful, intentional, and systemic exclusion from economic growth and job opportunities for Black people in the region.

Left unaddressed, this gap has threatened innovation and prosperity not just for Black Akronites but for the entire region.

Mr. DeJournett and Ms. Beasley created the Black Chamber of Commerce of Summit County to reverse that trend, enabling Black businessowners to take their rightful place in the economic ecosystem with the right support, connections, and capital to allow Black businesses to survive and thrive.

In the first year, the chamber has counseled dozens of small businesses on finances and website development, helped them compete for natural resources, and connected local leaders to maximize growth.

Congratulations to Robert DeJournett, Misty Beasley, and the entire membership of the Black Chamber of Commerce of Summit County on a successful first year and being named the 13th Congressional District champion of the week.

RECOGNIZING MIKE MACDONALD AND MARIA TAYLOR

(Mr. McCORMICK asked and was given permission to address the House

for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. McCORMICK. Mr. Speaker, I rise in recognition of the Seattle Seahawks Head Coach Mike Macdonald and NBC sportscaster Maria Taylor.

On Sunday, these two graduates from Centennial High School in Roswell, Georgia, which just happens to be in my district, became Super Bowl stars. Mike and Maria also attended the University of Georgia together where they began their respective careers as a football coach and a sports broadcaster.

On Sunday, Mike coached his team to a convincing 29–13 victory, and Maria made history as the first Black woman to ever host the Super Bowl postgame ceremony. These achievements were a testament to their hard work, character, and outstanding education they received at Centennial.

Congratulations to Mike and Maria, and I thank them for making Roswell proud. Go Knights and go Dawgs.

RECOGNIZING RICHARD KIRK MCPIKE

(Mr. TAKANO asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. TAKANO. Mr. Speaker, I rise with a profound sense of pride and a touch of sadness. After 13 years of service to this body as a chief of staff, Richard Kirk McPike is leaving my office.

Kirk has been the leader of my team since 2012, setting up the office, building LGBTQI+ political infrastructure, helping me earn the Veterans' Affairs' Committee gavel and so much more.

Kirk's proudest accomplishments are not counted in the bills passed or titles held. They are measured in the many people he has led and mentored, from interns to senior staffers. One of his greatest talents is knowing when to let go of great staff, understanding they sometimes need to grow beyond my office. Today, it is my time to do the same.

I will miss my friend Kirk. I will miss his counsel, but I know he will serve the Commonwealth of Virginia as a delegate with the same intelligence and decency he brought to this House. I wish him Godspeed and good luck.

RECOGNIZING SONDRALAPOINTE

(Mr. CASTEN asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. CASTEN. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize Sandra LaPointe, a seventh grade teacher at Westview Hills Middle School in Willowbrook, Illinois.

I recently had the pleasure of surprising Mrs. LaPointe during her social studies class to honor her with our constituent spotlight award. We started making these awards after the last election to try and uplift people who

are bringing hope and joy and making us feel good about being Americans because, goodness knows, we need these voices right now.

There is not a person in this Chamber who doesn't owe a debt to the great teachers they had along the way who taught them things, but more importantly, who taught them how to learn, made them excited to learn, who challenged them to ask questions about the world because as James Baldwin said: No society progresses without those kind of teachers around them.

Mrs. LaPointe's nomination came from a former student who said: "Mrs. LaPointe's class was the one I looked forward to the most each day. Her spunky personality always brought out the best in all of the students."

From your students and from your Congressman: Thank you, Mrs. LaPointe. You make us all better.

HONORING JAMES R. WILLIS

(Ms. BROWN asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Ms. BROWN. Mr. Speaker, I rise during Black History Month to honor an extraordinary constituent, Mr. JAMES R. Willis, a marine, an attorney, and a true Cleveland legend.

In 1944, Mr. Willis joined the Montford Point Marines, one of nearly 20,000 Black men who volunteered to serve immediately after President Roosevelt integrated the military.

Despite facing racism and segregation, he served his country honorably, and in 2011, the Montford Point Marines were awarded the Congressional Gold Medal in recognition of their service.

After the war, Mr. Willis built a legal career that has left a lasting mark. For more than 70 years, Mr. Willis has practiced criminal law, becoming a legendary courtroom advocate, a national leader, and a mentor across generations.

He argued four cases before the Supreme Court on protections against unlawful search and seizure, helping to strengthen the rights of all Americans.

Even today, at the age of 100, he continues his lifework. On behalf of a grateful district, I thank Mr. Willis for a lifetime of courage, service, and dedication to justice.

HONORING BLACK LEADERS FROM WEST MICHIGAN

(Ms. SCHOLTEN asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend her remarks.)

Ms. SCHOLTEN. Mr. Speaker, during Black History Month, we honor leaders who shaped our country, and I rise today to recognize extraordinary Black leaders from west Michigan, whose impacts continue to guide our community.

Ingrid Scott-Weekly transformed Grand Rapids by expanding equal opportunity in city government and helping build institutions that still protect fairness and inclusion today.

Reuben Smartt, one of the first African Americans to serve in the United States Marine Corps, went on to dedicate his life to mentoring young people as an educator, coach, and community leader.

Dr. Faite Mack broke barriers as a founding faculty member at Grand Valley State University, shaping generations of educators and extending his work globally to ensure children have access to education.

Roger Wilkins, a civil rights leader and Pulitzer Prize-winning journalist, led national conversations on justice and equality at the highest levels of government and media.

Helen Claytor advanced civil rights and opportunity for women and families helping establish institutions that continue to promote equity in Grand Rapids and beyond.

These leaders remind us that progress is driven by those willing to serve, to teach, and to lead. Their legacy lives on in west Michigan and across our great Nation. I am proud to honor these contributions during Black History Month.

HOUSING IS A HUMAN RIGHT

(Ms. TLAIB asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Ms. TLAIB. Mr. Speaker, we all know that right now the housing crisis is real for so many of our families across the country, and I know many of us in this Chamber, especially those on the left, have always said housing is a human right.

To address this crisis, we know that we need action at every level of government, but many local communities need additional assistance and capacity. That is why I am so incredibly grateful that the House passed the Housing Our Communities Act, part of the Housing for the 21st Century Act legislative package.

The Housing Our Communities Act directs the HUD Secretary to establish a competitive grant program to support a wide range of affordable housing planning and implementation activities.

For example, grants can support officials in crafting their housing plans, updating their zoning codes, or increasing capacity to conduct housing inspections so that new developments are completed faster and much more efficiently.

This bill provides civil servants and policymakers with the support they need to make affordable housing a reality for so many of our communities.

I urge my colleagues in the Senate to pass this legislation immediately and begin to address the housing crisis that is devastating our country.

□ 1910

Mr. PANETTA. Mr. Speaker, I recognize the 40th anniversary of the Saka Nakodar massacre where four unarmed Sikh students, Ravinder Singh, Jhilman Singh, Harminder Singh, and Balbir Singh Multani, were shot and killed while peacefully protesting the desecration of the sacred Scripture of Sikhs.

The killing, which took place in the Punjab region of India on February 4, 1986, was absolutely abhorrent, but the investigation was definitely deplorable.

The victims' bodies were disposed of in secret. No perpetrator was ever brought to justice, and reports, commissions, and other inquiries on the massacre received absolutely no action.

The Saka Nakodar massacre continues to be a dark day for Sikhs in Punjab but also for Sikhs right here in America.

That is why I recognize the Saka Nakodar massacre and the justice that awaits not just for the four students and their families but for the Sikh communities at home and abroad.

HONORING THE LIFE OF ARON JOHNSON

(Mr. DAVIS of North Carolina asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend his remarks.)

Mr. DAVIS of North Carolina. Mr. Speaker, I rise to honor the life of a son of eastern North Carolina, Aron Johnson. At just 30 years old, Aron was more than an organizer. He was a bridge builder who believed that our rural communities deserved a seat at every table.

He was a dreamer of big dreams and a fighter of hard fights who proved that we don't need a long life to make a big difference. While he left us far too soon, his legacy of empowerment lives on in many communities across our State.

My heartfelt condolences go out to his mother, Mary, and his family as we celebrate a young leader who gave his all to so many.

ENDING THE TRUMP TARIFF ON CANADA

(Ms. KAPTUR asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute and to revise and extend her remarks.)

Ms. KAPTUR. Mr. Speaker, I was privileged to join colleagues from both sides of the aisle this week in the House vote that was overwhelming in bipartisan fashion to end the damaging Trump tariff regime on Canada. The Senate had already taken the same action three times before the House measure was even brought up.

Canada is our neighbor, our ally, and our friend. They have fought at our side in every war for nearly two centuries.

Our Great Lakes region and its economy is the third largest in the world. It is like no other with its industrial and agricultural bounty, blessed for generations by the largest body of freshwater on Earth. Ours is the longest U.S. coastline with numerous ports, energy resources, cultural endowments, and unrivaled natural beauty.

The American and Canadian economies are totally intertwined. Robust supply chains on both sides of our northern border make, grow, and transport everything from autos to lumber to soil to energy to food and even to hockey teams.

This damaging trade war with Canada has caused prices to rise, led to more job losses, disrupted trade, and caused tourism to drop 31 percent. These are no victories.

Mr. Speaker, I just wish to say that I voted to end this upside-down trade mess today. Let's strengthen our economy and make life affordable again.

HONORING FORMER FORT WORTH COUNCIL MEMBER GYNA BIVENS

(Mr. VEASEY asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mr. VEASEY. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the life and legacy of my good friend, former Fort Worth city council member and mayor pro tem, Gyna Bivens, who was a beloved member of our community who lost her life on February 9 at the age of 71 to pancreatic cancer.

Gyna was born in Fort Worth, and she was a proud graduate of Dunbar High School and later went on to graduate from the University of North Texas. She majored in journalism and communications and did an amazing job.

Before she was on the city council, she had a background on some of our local radio stations and television stations. A lot of people in the community proudly remember her from Soul730 KKDA-AM. She will also be known for that amazing voice that she had.

Then God gave her a calling, and she decided that she wanted to be in politics. She ran for our city council, and she served with distinction from 2013 until 2025. She fought for housing. I know that she was very proud of her work along East Rosedale with Cavile Place and Hughes House. She worked very hard to make sure that we received funding for that. She also worked very hard in transportation and made lots of great improvements along a major corridor in District 5 which was along Lancaster Avenue.

She was a woman of deep, deep faith. Her father was a very prominent minister in the Fort Worth area.

Mr. Speaker, I want everyone to pray for her family. Her mom, her sisters, and her brother are still with us. Gyna is always going to be known for her hard work and just everything that she has done throughout her career and her brave battle against cancer.

We are going to keep that family lifted up in prayer. We will always remember Gyna for the amazing achievements that she made while she was here on Earth.

God bless her and her entire family.

RECOGNIZING ROSE TAULTON, VOLUNTEER OF THE YEAR

(Mrs. GRIJALVA asked and was given permission to address the House for 1 minute.)

Mrs. GRIJALVA. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize an extraordinary southern Arizonan, Rose Taulton, recently named Volunteer of the Year by Southern Arizona Volunteer Management Association.

Rose is truly the heart of volunteerism in Tucson. In 2025 alone, she logged more than 1,000 hours of service, positively impacting over 5,000 people across our community.

There are few people I see more often at community events than Rose. Whether it is helping organize the annual Tucson Juneteenth Festival or volunteering at a neighborhood food bank, she is always there, quietly, consistently, and with joy.

From mentoring youth and distributing books to supporting families facing food insecurity, Rose shows up, not for recognition but because she believes in the power of community.

Southern Arizona is stronger because of people like Rose. Her determination, compassion, and service embody the very best of us.

Mr. Speaker, I thank Rose for everything she does for Tucson. We are grateful beyond words. I congratulate her on her new grandbaby.

HONORING MR. HAJI DUKURAY, A TRUE SON OF THE BRONX

(Under the Speaker's announced policy of January 3, 2025, Mr. TORRES of New York was recognized for 60 minutes as the designee of the minority leader.)

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor a true son of the Bronx and a shining example of the American Dream: Mr. Haji Dukuray.

In 1988, Haji arrived from The Gambia with little more than hope and determination. He built a life rooted in faith, family, and unwavering service. A devoted husband, father of four, proud grandfather, and tireless community advocate, he has served in leadership at the Bronx Islamic Cultural Center and dedicated decades to lifting others up. For him, serving the community has always been a sacred moral obligation.

Then came unimaginable tragedy. In January of 2022, the Twin Parks North West fire stole 17 lives, including five cherished members of Haji's own family. Yet in his darkest hour, Haji chose hope over despair. He united grieving families, clergy, and leaders to seek justice and foster healing.

Haji Dukuray embodies resilience. His life teaches us that even amid profound loss, community and service can mend broken hearts and strengthen us all.

The Bronx is stronger because of him. I thank Haji for his service.

□ 1920

HONORING CHERYL MARIE DEWITT

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Cheryl Marie DeWitt, known to all as Ms. Dee, a true Bronx treasure and champion of our children.

Born to a young, single mother and raised by loving foster parents, Ms. Dee learned early that caring adults can change a child's life forever. Inspired by that gift, she has dedicated her life to giving the same opportunity to others.

For more than 20 years, as executive director of the Williamsbridge NAACP Early Childhood Education Center, she has provided nurturing, high-quality care to Bronx families facing hardship, never wavering through every challenge.

A proud CSA member since 1994 and the Bronx borough chair for center-based directors, plus an active leader in the NAACP Williamsbridge branch, Ms. Dee fights tirelessly for early education, equity, and community strength.

Ms. Dee shows us that service starts with compassion. Her life proves the love we receive can become the love we give. I thank Ms. Dee. May her work continue shaping brighter futures for generations.

HONORING JOHNNIE GOFF

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to celebrate Dr. Johnnie Ruth Goff, a tireless educator, visionary leader, and true pillar of the North Bronx community.

Born in Georgetown, South Carolina, Dr. Goff poured more than three decades of her life into our public schools as a teacher and administrator. She lived the conviction that education unlocks opportunity for every child, regardless of their ZIP Code or circumstance.

Beyond the classroom, her legacy shines through innovative programs like "Feed the Body, Feed the Mind," launched in 1998. With her beloved Food Ranger character, she taught generations that good nutrition fuels sharp minds and stronger futures.

As founder of the JADE Multi Family Circle Center and a dedicated activist, she created internships, mentoring, tutoring, and service opportunities that opened doors for our youth. Guided by faith and compassion, she turned concern into action, supporting families, serving on boards, and building solutions where others saw only challenges.

Dr. Goff reminds us that one person's unwavering dedication can transform a community and inspire generations.

I thank Dr. Johnnie Ruth Goff for her extraordinary service and enduring legacy.

HONORING NILKA MARTELL

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor a true champion of the Bronx, Nilka Martell.

A proud Puerto Rican daughter of our borough, Nilka turned her lifelong love for her community into action. Since 2011, as founder and director of Loving The Bronx, she has built a powerful grassroots movement that puts residents at the heart of the fight for justice—social, environmental, and economic.

She chairs the Bronx River Alliance, leads Friends of Pelham Bay Park, and serves on the Bronx Council for Environmental Quality, always amplifying local voices in decisions that determine our air, our parks, and our health.

Nilka delivers real wins: Securing over \$10 million to rebuild Virginia Park and Hugh J. Grant Circle, and boldly leading the charge to cap the Cross Bronx Expressway—reducing deadly pollution, healing neighborhoods divided by Robert Moses, and creating new green spaces for our children.

Nilka Martell shows us what is possible when community leadership meets unwavering determination. She is building a healthier, more connected, more just Bronx for all of us. I thank Nilka.

HONORING BOB BENDER

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, today I rise to honor a true pillar of the Northwest Bronx, Bob Bender.

For more than 20 years, Bob has served with unwavering dedication on Community Board 8. For 13 of those years, he chaired the Parks Committee, turning vision into action. In 2007, when veterans raised the alarm about the crumbling Memorial Grove in Van Cortlandt Park, Bob didn't hesitate. He secured the grant, rallied support, and restored it as a dignified place of remembrance.

But his work went deeper. He brought naturalists and schoolchildren together to study and safeguard the park's natural treasures. He championed the forgotten history of enslaved people who once labored on the Van Cortlandt estate, ensuring their story is now permanently honored and displayed in the Van Cortlandt Museum for generations to learn from.

Long before the board, Bob was always giving back—feeding and clothing the homeless, coaching Little League, showing up when the community needed him most. Today, he still volunteers in the park, week after week, and fights tirelessly for a Hudson River greenway.

A proud Bronx native, devoted husband, and loving father, Bob Bender reminds us that our borough is built and sustained by people who never stop giving. I thank Bob.

HONORING CLINTON A. MYKE

□ 1930

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, today I rise to celebrate a remarkable son of the Bronx, Mr. Clinton A. Myke.

Born and raised here in Community Board 12, educated in our neighborhood schools, and now raising his own family in the same street he loves, Clinton is a Bronxite in every sense of the word.

For 25 years he served with honor and distinction in the Department of Correction, rising to the rank of captain through sheer integrity, discipline, and unwavering commitment to public service.

But retirement never dimmed his passion. Instead, he turned his energy toward his community, joining Bronx Community Board 12 and devoting the past decade to making it better. Today, as proud chair of that board, he amplifies local voices, strengthens participation, and fights every day so that our neighborhoods thrive.

Clinton Myke embodies selfless leadership. Because of him, the Bronx is stronger, more connected, and more hopeful. It is my honor to recognize this true public servant. I thank Clinton, and may he continue to lead us forward.

HONORING TOMAS RAMOS

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor a true son of the Bronx, Tomas Ramos, a first generation Dominican American whose life embodies resilience, justice, and an unbreakable community spirit.

Born in Washington Heights amid the crack epidemic, Tomas faced displacement, poverty, and the devastating grip of mass incarceration and the war on drugs. Yet he transformed personal hardship into powerful purpose. He has dedicated himself to uplifting our youth, championing small businesses, advancing restorative justice, and expanding access to healthcare, food security, and real opportunity for all.

When the COVID-19 pandemic struck and too many were left behind, Tomas acted without hesitation. He mobilized donations to expand ICU capacity, delivered critical PPE to overburdened hospitals, and stood firmly for the Bronx when it needed him most.

From that crisis emerged the Oyate Group, a nonprofit powerhouse he founded to educate, resource, and build sustainable solutions that break cycles of generational poverty. Through innovative programs in youth development, gun violence prevention, and community empowerment, Tomas has become a blessing and a beacon for the underserved neighborhoods of the Bronx and beyond.

Because of Tomas Ramos, our community stands stronger, more connected, and more hopeful. He reminds us every day that dignity is not a privilege, it is a fundamental right. I thank Tomas for his tireless leadership and his heart for the people of the Bronx. We in the Bronx are proud to call him one of our own.

RECOGNIZING CHAUNCY YOUNG

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, for more than 20 years, Chauncy Young has poured his heart into our Bronx, building bridges between education, justice, and environmental equity.

He began in Highbridge, empowering neighbors through mindfulness, meditation, and self-care at the Community Collaborative. Since 2016, as the director of the New Settlement Parent Action Committee, he has led the Healing-Centered Schools Working Group, bringing trauma-informed, healing approaches into classrooms so that our students and teachers can thrive, not simply survive.

Yet Chauncy's vision stretches beyond school walls. Since founding the Harlem River Coalition in 2009, he has coordinated tireless efforts alongside residents, organizations, and officials to reclaim our waterfront, clean our river, and weave an interconnected greenway system that will one day let every Bronx family walk, bike, and breathe beside the water.

A proud Highbridge resident, devoted husband, and father, Chauncy doesn't just advocate for green spaces. He explores them with his own family, turning his work into lived joy.

Because of Chauncy Young, our borough is greener, healthier, and more hopeful for the next generation.

Mr. Speaker, I thank Chauncy for his unwavering devotion to the Bronx we all call home.

CELEBRATING REVEREND JOHN UDO-OKON

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, today, I rise to celebrate a true beacon of hope in the south Bronx, Reverend John Udo-Okon.

In one of our Nation's toughest neighborhoods, marked by deep poverty, hunger, and hardship, Reverend Udo-Okon has turned faith into action. As senior pastor of Word of Life Christian Fellowship International, he leads one of the Bronx's largest food pantries, serving thousands every month.

Through weekly distributions, hot meals, and unwavering support, he ensures seniors, veterans, working families, and children never go hungry or feel forgotten.

During the darkest days of COVID-19, when fear gripped our communities, he opened his church doors as a lifeline, distributing food, promoting vaccinations, and standing strong even after his own family battled the virus.

His compassion extends further: advocating for justice, offering guidance to those drowning in debt, and fighting for the right to help those who need it most.

Reverend Udo-Okon embodies the power of service, resilience, and love. The Bronx is stronger, more connected, and more resilient because of him.

Mr. Speaker, I am proud to honor this extraordinary leader today.

HONORING SHIRLEY FEARON

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise to honor a true daugh-

ter of the Bronx, a leader whose life has lifted generations: Shirley Fearon.

Born and raised right here in our borough, Shirley embodies the heart and resilience of the northeast Bronx.

A lifelong educator, she dedicated her career to our children, teaching in general and special education, believing deeply that every young person deserves the chance to succeed.

Her passion for learning didn't stop at the classroom door. It spread throughout our neighborhoods, inspiring countless lives.

Shirley's commitment to service runs deep. As president of her NAACP chapter, a dedicated district leader for the 83rd Assembly District, and a proud member of Alpha Kappa Alpha Sorority, she has championed justice, empowerment, and civic engagement for decades.

Perhaps her most transformative legacy is the state-of-the-art Northeast Bronx YMCA, a facility she fought for tirelessly over many years as the co-chair of the Northeast Bronx Community Coalition. When it opened in 2021, it became a vital beacon, a place for youth programs, fitness, community gatherings, and hope.

After 70 years without such a resource in her neighborhood, Shirley helped make it a reality. Guided by faith, family, and the timeless truth that to whom much is given, much is required, she has strengthened our community as a devoted parishioner, mother, and grandmother.

Shirley Fearon's unwavering dedication reminds us what true leadership looks like: persistent, compassionate, and rooted in service. Because of her, the Bronx is stronger, brighter, and more united.

Mr. Speaker, I thank Shirley for showing us the way. The northeast Bronx and all of us are forever grateful.

HONORING REVEREND DR. GLORIA BRADSHAW-BRANNIGAN

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise to honor a remarkable public servant whose life exemplifies faith, dedication, and selfless service: Reverend Dr. Gloria Bradshaw-Brannigan.

A Bronx native and the youngest daughter of the late Reverend Robert Bradshaw and Mrs. Janie Bradshaw, Reverend Bradshaw carries forward a powerful family legacy of ministry. As senior pastor of Mt. Bethel Baptist Church, she leads a congregation with deep roots, serving Harlem's community for 84 years before relocating in 2015 to continue its vital outreach in the Bronx.

Under her guidance, the church remains a beacon of hope, providing spiritual guidance, practical support, and unwavering love to countless residents.

Yet, her calling knows no borders. Reverend Dr. Bradshaw has carried the Gospel internationally, preaching at the Exodus Christian center in Uganda, touching lives far beyond our borough.

Her credentials reflect a lifetime of disciplined study and commitment: a

master's degree in Biblical studies from Alliance Theological Seminary, completion of a CBI doctoral program, and ordination since February 1995.

These accomplishments are not mere titles. They fuel her passionate vision for God's kingdom and for the flourishing of every person she serves.

Mr. Speaker, in Reverend Dr. Gloria Bradshaw-Brannigan, we see what true community leadership looks like: rooted in faith, driven by compassion, and tireless in action.

The Bronx is stronger, more hopeful, and more faith-driven because of her work. She stands as an inspiring example for anyone who aspires to serve both their neighbors and their God.

Let us celebrate and emulate her extraordinary contributions. The future is brighter because of leaders like her.

HONORING ALONZO DE CASTRO

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise to honor the extraordinary life and enduring legacy of Alonzo de Castro, a true pillar of the Bronx and a devoted public servant who has embodied the very best of American ideals.

Born in 1926 on Tortola in the British Virgin Islands, 1 of 13 children, Mr. de Castro arrived in New York City in 1946 after serving honorably in the United States Army.

Like countless immigrants before and since, he arrived with determination and built a life of dignity through hard work and service. He began his career at the Veterans Administration and rose through the ranks of the U.S. Postal Service, eventually becoming a director of 13 postal stations in Manhattan, a testament to his reliability, leadership, and commitment to excellence.

□ 1940

Mr. Speaker, in 1965 he chose the Bronx as his home and poured his heart into its civic life. He served as a State committeeman, district leader, and dedicated staff member to a former assemblyman.

He helped found the East of Laconia Community Association, which has proudly awarded over 200 scholarships to deserving Bronx students, opening doors to brighter futures.

Through St. Luke's Episcopal Church, he raised vital funds for education and community needs, always putting people first.

His vision and persistence helped lay the foundation for the Northeast Bronx YMCA, a transformative community resource dedicated in 2021.

As co-chair of the Northeast Bronx Community Coalition, he championed this long-awaited center, ensuring generations of residents would have access to programs that built strength, opportunity, and connection.

Mr. Speaker, Alonzo de Castro, affectionately known as Uncle Al, symbolizes the promise of America: Service, sacrifice, perseverance, and unbreakable community spirit. His legacy lives on in every young person who earned a

scholarship, every family strengthened by the YMCA, and every corridor of the northeast Bronx lifted by his tireless efforts.

The Bronx is forever grateful for this remarkable man who has shown us what it means to give back. May we all strive to follow his inspiring footsteps.

HONORING JULIO PABON

Mr. TORRES of New York. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Julio Pabon, a visionary, a fighter, and the heartbeat of the South Bronx for over five decades.

Born in Puerto Rico and raised in our resilient borough, Julio never waited for change. He built it. He founded the Coalition in Defense of Puerto Rican and Hispanic Rights, the South Bronx Community Association, the South Bronx Congress, and Discovery for Justice, turning voices into power.

A pioneer in bilingual media, he launched "La Hora Deportiva," one of the first Spanish-English sports talk shows. He created Latino Sports, establishing the prestigious Latino MVP award, now embraced by Major League Baseball, to celebrate Latino excellence when it was far too often overlooked.

In a place too often defined by struggle, Julio chose to define the South Bronx by its potential. His legacy of vision, perseverance, and fierce cultural pride will inspire us always, and we thank him.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

HONORING DEPUTY SHERIFF DERRICK BONHAM

(Under the Speaker's announced policy of January 3, 2025, Mr. KUSTOFF of Tennessee was recognized for 60 minutes as the designee of the majority leader.)

GENERAL LEAVE

Mr. KUSTOFF. Mr. Speaker, I ask unanimous consent that all Members may have 5 legislative days in which to revise and extend their remarks and include extraneous material on the topic of this Special Order.

The SPEAKER pro tempore. Is there objection to the request of the gentleman from Tennessee?

There was no objection.

Mr. KUSTOFF. Mr. Speaker, tonight I rise to honor Derrick Bonham of the Weakley County, Tennessee, Sheriff's Office, who was tragically killed in the line of duty.

On January 30, just after 3 a.m., Deputy Bonham responded to a shots-fired call in Martin, Tennessee. This is nothing new. Derrick Bonham had always answered these calls without hesitation and whenever he was needed.

When Deputy Bonham arrived on the scene to assess the situation, he was violently ambushed and fatally wounded. Indeed, Derrick Bonham's death has been felt across Weakley County and across West Tennessee, in fact, the entire State of Tennessee.

In the days that followed, thousands lined the streets in a sea of blue to honor his sacrifice. Law enforcement officers from across the region stood alongside families and neighbors in West Tennessee to show their respect and support for a brave man and a brave family.

That tribute reflected the trust that Derrick Bonham earned and also the impact that he had among his law enforcement comrades.

After the shooting, Mr. Speaker, I spoke with Weakley County Sheriff, Terry McDade. Sheriff McDade told me Deputy Bonham—and I am going to read this exactly the way he told me: "Deputy Bonham was the guy that all sheriffs want to hire. He was a good, even-keeled law enforcement officer who lived his life in a Godly way."

Mr. Speaker, Derrick Bonham lived a life defined by devotion to service. He took pride in his work and in what it meant to wear that uniform.

We all know that law enforcement in our Nation is a dangerous profession. Every time an officer reports for duty, they put their lives on the line for all of us. We are deeply grateful for the men and women in law enforcement who put that uniform on each and every day to serve their neighbors, often without recognition.

Deputy Bonham was a loving husband to his wife, Nicole; and a devoted father to three children: Harper, Hayden, and Hudson.

He was an Army veteran who served our Nation and later became a deputy who served his country and his neighbors. Indeed, Derrick Bonham understood that public service is a calling, one that demands courage and a willingness to put others first.

Roberta and I continue to keep the Bonham family and the Weakley County Sheriff's Office in our prayers. Deputy Derrick Bonham's legacy will live on through the lives that he touched, the men and women with whom he worked, and the example that he set for the Weakley County community.

Mr. Speaker, I yield back the balance of my time.

MATH IS SUCH AN ANATHEMA

(Under the Speaker's announced policy of January 3, 2025, Mr. SCHWEIKERT of Arizona was recognized for 30 minutes.)

Mr. SCHWEIKERT. Mr. Speaker, give me a moment here to get set up. Sometimes, we are just scrambling because we had a whole speech lined up. We were going to do something just simple and pleasant for everyone. We were going to walk through Medicare financing for a while, and they wouldn't give me 3 hours or 4 hours to do it, so you are stuck with me for a half an hour.

Then, earlier today, CBO actually did their update. Okay. Let's see if I can make this make sense.

When I come behind these microphones, I am trying to explain sort of a unified theory that, so often, the political class behind these microphones say: We can do this.

Okay. That may be wonderful, but you have to understand that it all works together: our demographics, our tax system, the fact of the matter is this incentive for this to grow, this incentive here, and the adoption of technology. I need people to start thinking about the interaction that there is not a simple solution to a country that, right now, is functionally borrowing about \$74,000 every second so far this fiscal year.

Sorry. Let me rephrase. Over the last 12 months. If you do just fiscal year, it is higher.

A few hours ago, the CBO put out a report. Look, the report is actually like this. I just cheated. I just grabbed the executive summary because I didn't need the whole binder out here.

It is going to take me 3 days or 4 days to read through everything, but I have some of the highlights for you—this is important—and then it is going to tie into what we are spending.

Your country is an insurance company with an army. That is both funny and it happens to be mathematically true. In about 33 months, over half of the Federal spending will go to those who are 65 and up. Actually, in 33 months, I will be one of them.

It is demographics. We have gone about 30 years or 40 years with dramatically fewer children than we expected. I have done a series of presentations here on the floor where I have shown that we actually have the same number of 18-year-olds as we had 20 years ago, but double the number of those who are 65 and up.

Is that Republican or Democrat? Look, there is policies that have been engaged in by Democrats that helped to create this, but the fact of the matter is that these are people. It is our reality. We have our obligations on Medicare, on Social Security, and some that will be dual eligible because they are poor and retired, and we have some things that are terrifying.

In 6½ years, the Medicare trust fund is empty. Your hospital will take an 11 percent cut. Medicare Advantage programs will actually take something much larger. It is just the way the Medicare part A trust fund works.

In 6½ years, the Social Security trust fund is empty. No one stole your money. We just don't have enough workers. It was a Pay-As-You-Go system. It is math. The fact of the matter is that, yes, the money has been loaned to the Treasury. Treasury actually pays interest on that money, so that twice a year, there is actually a fairly large dividend given to the trust fund. It is demographics. We had the baby boomers.

In 6½ years, if we followed the law, there is a 24 percent cut coming to Social Security recipients, which will double the poverty of seniors in America. Our math is that it will double the number of baby boomers who are homeless. It is absolutely immoral, but we are not allowed to talk about it except for idiots like me who get up and say

week after week: Please, my brothers and sisters here, there are things that we can do.

The Democrats say that we will just tax rich people. Then you show that the math is nothing like that. It doesn't work.

Here is the CBO report. In here, it makes it absolutely clear, and I have been telling you for 1 year, but the scorekeepers have finally caught up with my Joint Economic Committee economists. Remember, I chair the Joint Economic Committee. I chair Oversight Subcommittee in the Ways and Means Committee, so I am blessed. I have a freaky smart staff.

In 2032, the trust funds are empty. In 2033, the first year where they are completely empty, if you said that we are just going to pay for everything out of the general fund, okay, we can do that.

My estimates come in at about \$638 billion in 2033 just to make up the shortfall of the Social Security trust fund being gone and the Medicare trust fund being gone. That is, what, 60 percent of today's defense budget.

Why is math such an anathema to this place?

Let's walk through a couple of other things here. I have only had time to produce a couple of boards from the new CBO report, and then we will try to tie these into what else is going on.

This year, we are basically going to spend 3.3 percent of the entire economy on interest—interest. Once again, this interest number is just the interest to publicly sold debt.

Remember how I was just talking about the debt? That we borrow the Social Security money, and then the trust fund gets IOUs from the Treasury, and we pay it interest? Then when the Social Security needs money—which they do every month—because the tax receipts come in from your FICA taxes and there is a shortfall, so they cash that in every month?

If you add up all of the money and interest paid from the trust funds, I think this year is going to look more like \$1.2 trillion in interest. Why that is important: What is the number one spend in America? The number one spend of your Federal Government is Social Security. It is going to come in at about \$1.6 trillion this year.

Interest is your number two. It is going to come in at about \$1.2 trillion.

Medicare is going to come in at about \$1.1 trillion this year, maybe a little more.

Medicaid and ACA, ObamaCare subsidies, are going to come in at \$900 billion.

Those are your top four.

Number five is the defense. The thing that is actually in the United States Constitution is actually number five in hierarchy of spending.

One of the things that CBO was trying to point out is that their estimate is for 9 budget years—so 9 budget years is 2036 from now—that we will go from \$1 trillion of interest to \$2.1 trillion of interest. In 2036, so 9 budget years from

now, the annual deficit will be about \$3.1 trillion. Structural deficit is \$1 trillion, and \$2.1 trillion will just be interest. The majority of future deficits are actually interest.

Interest and healthcare are the primary drivers of U.S. sovereign debt. Will the bond market continue to finance this?

What happens when one of your greatest solutions is: Can we actually have honest conversations about healthcare costs? Are we willing to legalize the very technologies and the methodologies of helping our brothers and sisters stay healthier and, therefore, use dramatically less healthcare?

I have been coming behind this mike for over a decade with presentation after presentation of technologies, new pharmaceuticals, and new methodologies to crash the price of healthcare. I get the crap kicked out of me because armies of lobbyists don't like it when we talk about changing their business model.

Remember, several months ago, I came here to the floor and showed that we came up with a math experiment of, in America, how many duplicative MRI scans, ultrasounds, X-rays, and CTs are there? The top end was looking like \$36 billion in a single year.

Why wouldn't you do something crazy? You get an MRI, attach it to this crazy supercomputer that you put in your pocket, and then when you go to your next doctor, you put it up, and it is up on their screens, and you don't get another one.

Now it turns out that you get some folks who make money on the duplicative scans. They get very angry, but \$35 billion over 10 years, \$350 billion, and that is just one of dozens of things. Why is it so hard? Are we that afraid of the lobbyists? Are we that afraid of trying to explain to the folks at home that we don't have a choice?

In 6½ years—let's say it again—the Medicare trust fund is empty. If you want to extend the life of the trust fund, let's have a revolution on the actual cost of delivering healthcare.

There are a couple of other things that are highlights in the CBO report. They estimate that in 10 years, we will have 5.3 million fewer people in America. That is mostly from reduction in immigration and the fact that our fertility rates continue to fall, but think of this.

That missing 5.3 million people is \$500 billion over that timeframe in lost tax receipts. When I use the term “demographics” on our debt, it is a function. Our debt is a function of the fact that our society has gotten older. We have substantially fewer children. We are going to have fewer workers, and there are actually whole charts I have here that actually talk about it.

Look, they are hard charts. This one is absolutely inappropriately designed to use on the floor, but it is trying to explain what happens in a society when we have substantially fewer young

workers in our society and substantially more of those who are now 65 and older.

□ 2000

It is just life, but we have to be prepared for what it means when the majority of Federal spending will be going to those 65 and up in just a couple of years.

Are we prepared for this? Of course, we are not. So many folks still have a mind frame that is decades out of date with what we are demographically. This is happening over the entire industrialized world, but in our society here, if I can raise wages and productivity of those who are in the workforce, I have resources to cover the promised benefits, because we made a deal. We have a societal deal that we are going to cover Medicare and Social Security.

Something I want to touch on—and I didn't bring the chart on this. There are a lot of folks who think that Medicare itself is paid for by your payroll tax. It is actually about 38 percent of that. As a medical enrollee, you pay—the total cost, depending if you are in Medicare Advantage, which is—what?—55 percent of the population. The others are maybe in part A, part A and part B.

Fifteen percent is sort of paid by the enrollee. Thirty-eight-some percent is paid by the FICA tax, so today's workers paying for today's retirees. The rest is borrowed out of the general fund.

You have to understand that a huge portion of our debt is actually paying for the healthcare.

Sorry. My 3-year-old is trying to call me. Yes, I have a 3-year-old and a 10-year-old, so you know I am optimistic.

When we talk about Medicare financing, most folks don't understand it is one of the key drivers of our debt.

Let's actually walk through something. Several months ago, we gathered all the MedPAC reports, all the other reports on Medicare Advantage. It is Medicare part C. I love a capitated model. A properly designed capitated model, which is Medicare Advantage, is designed so you have sort of a gatekeeper. That may be the insurance company or that may be the group of doctors. Their mission needs to be helping you be healthier.

We do this in my State's Medicaid system. We call it AHCCCS in Arizona. I actually, at one point, did the budgets for that.

The concept behind this is to align the incentives. The incentives aren't to keep trying to find the highest reimbursement to charge things to the healthcare system. It is the incentive that we are going to help our brothers and sisters be healthier.

If you are the insurer, you make a profit because you lower utilization because you had your enrollees, your patients, your members, get healthier. That is not what has been happening in Medicare Advantage if you read the actual auditing reports.

We actually did a piece of legislation several months ago that said instead of having this world where there is the risk scoring and—if you see, there are actually now criminal investigations going on at the Department of Justice because of people being scored as being much sicker, needing much more, and they are actually not sick. There are multiple criminal investigations going on at the Department of Justice.

I keep approaching the Medicare Advantage companies, saying to work with us. Could we get rid of the way we do risk scoring, the way we do these star ratings, where you use those things to pump up your compensation, and actually do it from enrolling? Let's get the actual models right. We will build a shock absorber if someone gets really sick. We will share the risk.

Then, the incentive is to help the population get healthier and healthier because we have technology. We have wearables. We have GLP-1. We have other things you can do to help our brothers and sisters get healthier.

We have lots of data right now, when we are starting to see math showing, in 2025, almost \$84 billion of new risk model implementation basically saying this is excess spending. If you look at the MedPAC report, it is almost coming in at a couple of hundred billion dollars a year.

We run around here saying waste and fraud, but this technically might not be fraud because it is the design of the system.

When ObamaCare was passed 18 years ago, it actually had a series of things in there that created many of these incentives to game the system.

Now, the administration is talking about saying we are just going to do a cap. I want to try to sell this concept, saying why don't we align the incentives, both the government incentives as the payer and the patient incentives to the doctor, so we are all doing the same thing. We are lowering the expense by creating a healthier population.

The fact of the matter is, if you look at the MedPAC reports—and I know they get mocked, but no one else seems to produce the actual data—it is almost \$2 trillion a year. Remember, the MedPAC report comes in and says, Medicare Advantage, when you do the risk adjustment, it comes in at 120 percent of fee-for-service. That is a 25 percent gap. In the original design, in 2005, the Medicare part C was supposed to come in at 95 percent.

I know it is geeky, but this is a stunning amount of money. We will spend hours here arguing about millions of dollars. These are billions and billions, and over 10 years, it is in the trillions.

Why is it so hard for this place to want to take on the things that actually would affect the crushing debt that CBO just told you is coming screaming at you?

Remember, the CBO report here basically says in this 9-year budget window, 10-year budget window, your

country goes over 120 percent debt to GDP, surpassing World War II.

Are we going to fix it by little incremental things, or are we going to do it by a major reconciliation bill that actually takes on big issues, complex issues, real math? Or will we just continue to pander and not tell the truth about the scale of what is coming at us?

Medicare Advantage overpayments, we believe, this last year, just the overpayment portion, was \$84 billion. You start to see a chart like this. Add it up, I actually have a trillion dollars here for you. Align the incentives, and I can get you another few hundred billion dollars of alignment incentives by changing utilization, by helping our brothers and sisters be healthier. Turns out that is real money.

I have lots of charts here, but I want to actually go—I am going to skip around a little bit—to contributions to the proposed Medicare Advantage payment update. If there happens to be a lobbyist out there representing Medicare Advantage, come talk to me. This is what I think CMS is actually proposing to you, saying we are going to change the compensation. We are going to change your risk scoring. You are basically getting zero movement.

This is what you get by not working with us in aligning the incentives, where you can make a profit by fixing the incentives within the system or you can basically get a cramdown. Which one do you want to do? Do you want to prove that you are a free market manager, that a free market system actually can deliver healthcare and do it better, faster, more efficiently, and more morally because you give a darn about your patients?

Or we can basically say we are just going to pay you less, and then you figure out how you are going to put that through the system. This is the proposal coming at you. You didn't want to talk to me about trying to fix the incentives in Medicare Advantage, so now you are going to get this.

I will argue, come talk to us about our piece of legislation. It has been out there for several months. You have had chances. We have had multiple Ph.D. economists score it. We have a preliminary score from CBO, saying it is probably about \$1.84 trillion in savings over 10 years, making it the single largest savings bill in U.S. history.

I am in a 50/50 district, and I am doing bills like this because I can do math.

□ 2010

Mr. Speaker, instead of me walking through all this, did you see the job growth numbers today? They are actually pretty good. Did you see the punch line in the job growth numbers?

The U.S. economy added approximately 140,000 jobs; the market added 181,000. It is absolutely terrific. A dominance of the new jobs that were created are in healthcare. The majority of spending in healthcare comes

through government. Does anyone see the circular problem of what we are talking about? If my growth in the employment base is healthcare, and over here those jobs are financed through government spending, and that government spending is substantially borrowed, that is not a virtuous cycle.

We have a structural problem. Remember, today your government is going to borrow 6 to \$7 billion. This was supposed to be a year with the tariff receipts and with everything else we were supposed to really start to pay down the deficit. The problem is interest, healthcare costs have exceeded our models. We are still probably heading to a 1.9, \$2 trillion borrow.

It turns out now CBO is catching up with the numbers I have been bringing behind this microphone for the last year. If we do not start to take this seriously, Mr. Speaker, we will have made the decision that the bond mar-

ket, not as in Congress, not the White House, will run this country.

Remember, we have to bring about 10 to \$11 trillion of debt to market this year for refinancing, and we are going to issue probably \$2 trillion of new debt.

When the United States sells a 10-year bond and Greece sells a 10-year bond today, Greece has a lower interest rate than the United States. When the debt markets think Greece is more creditworthy than the United States—I don't know how to make it more simple. Why is it so hard to tell the truth about the math?

Mr. Speaker, there is a way to stabilize this. We are not going to pay it off. The demographic headwinds make that almost impossible, but you can stabilize the debt. You just have to do complex big boy things to do it.

One of the reasons I am leaving Congress is I am tired of smashing my head over and over here on blunt objects as

people just stare back at you and say, DAVID, I would have to try to explain that. DAVID, you are not allowed to use the words “Social Security” and “Medicare.” It will upset people. What will upset people is when these trust funds run out and they are seeing their benefits cut because we were too intellectually vacuous to step up and tell the truth even though we have known this for decades.

Mr. Speaker, I am actually going to drink more coffee and do more reading. I yield back the balance of my time.

ADJOURNMENT

Mr. SCHWEIKERT. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn.

The motion was agreed to; accordingly (at 8 o'clock and 14 minutes p.m.), under its previous order, the House adjourned until tomorrow, Thursday, February 12, 2026, at 9 a.m.

EXPENDITURE REPORTS CONCERNING OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL

Reports concerning the foreign currencies and U.S. dollars utilized for Official Foreign Travel during the second, third, and fourth quarters of 2025, pursuant to Public Law 95–384, are as follows:

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, DELEGATION TO THE PHILIPPINES, VIETNAM, AND SINGAPORE, EXPENDED BETWEEN MAY 23 AND JUNE 1, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. John Moolenaar	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		4,511.34		11,544.71				16,056.05
Hon. Greg Stanton	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		4,511.34		11,731.60				16,242.94
Hon. Seth Moulton	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		1,897.68		19,011.13				20,908.81
Joe Bauer	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		4,511.34		11,884.21				16,395.55
Maseh Zarif	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		4,511.34		11,999.21				16,510.55
Alyssa Pettus	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		4,511.34		11,999.21				16,510.55
Benjamin Frohman	5/23	6/1	PH, SG, VN		4,511.34		12,197.21				16,708.55
James Langenderfer	5/29	6/1	SG		2,667		19,111.31				21,778.31
Ally Schwartz	5/29	6/1	SG		2,375		10,998				13,373
Hon. Brian Mast	5/29	6/1	SG		2,667		11,214.31				13,881.31
Hon. Gus M. Bilirakis	5/29	6/1	SG		2,375		13,345.29				15,720.29
Committee total					39,049.72		145,036.19				184,085.91

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.

² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

HON. JOHN R. MOOLENAAR, Feb. 4, 2026.

(AMENDED) REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON AGRICULTURE, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN JULY 1 AND SEPT. 30, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. Don Davis	7/24	7/27	Mexico		1,128.00						1,128.00
	7/27	7/30	Argentina		1,011.00		745.51				1,756.51
Hon. Jahana Hayes	8/3	8/8	Italy		6,426.00						6,426.00
	8/8	8/12	Greece		1,871.00						1,871.00
Hon. John Mannion	9/27	9/29	Ireland		2,009.00		2,472.01				4,481.01
Committee total					12,445.00		3,217.52				15,662.52

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.

² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

HON. GLENN THOMPSON, Jan. 29, 2026.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON AGRICULTURE, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²

HOUSE COMMITTEES

Please Note: If there were no expenditures during the calendar quarter noted above, please check the box at right to so indicate and return. ☒

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.

² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

FOR HOUSE STAFF SIGNERS
Please check the box at right to indicate that you are authorized by the
Member to submit these Foreign Travel documents and to use the Member's
signature on file with the Clerk, ☒

JACKSON BLODGETT, Jan. 29, 2026.
On Behalf Of: CHAIRMAN GLENN “GT” THOMPSON.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON APPROPRIATIONS, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. Mario Diaz-Balart	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Mario Diaz-Balart	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		783.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Hon. Mario Diaz-Balart	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Juan Ciscomani	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Juan Ciscomani	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Hon. Juan Ciscomani	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Scott Franklin	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Scott Franklin	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Hon. Scott Franklin	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Riley Moore	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Riley Moore	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Hon. Riley Moore	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Hon. Norma Torres	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		322.07	(³)	35.56		60.28		417.91
Hon. Norma Torres	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Hon. Norma Torres	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		322.07	(³)	35.56		60.28		417.91
Susan Adams	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Susan Adams	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Susan Adams	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		353.96	(³)	35.56		60.28		449.80
Alexia Sikora	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		322.07	(³)	35.56		60.28		417.91
Alexia Sikora	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Alexia Sikora	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		322.07	(³)	35.56		60.28		417.91
Laurie Mignone	12/4	12/5	Cape Verde		322.07	(³)	35.56		60.28		417.91
Laurie Mignone	12/5	12/7	Nigeria		738.69	(³)	2,964.17		828.39		4,531.25
Laurie Mignone	12/7	12/8	Cape Verde		322.07	(³)	35.56		60.28		417.91
Committee total					11,381.53		24,282.32		7,591.59		43,255.46

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.

² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

³ Military air transportation.

FOR HOUSE STAFF SIGNERS
Please check the box at right to indicate that you are authorized by the
Member to submit these Foreign Travel documents and to use the Member's
signature on file with the Clerk, ☒

BRENAN TJELMELAND, Jan. 30, 2026.
On Behalf Of: REP. TOM COLE.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON ENERGY AND COMMERCE, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
HOUSE COMMITTEES											
Please Note: If there were no expenditures during the calendar quarter noted above, please check the box at right to so indicate and return. ☐											

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.

² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

CHAIRMAN BRETT GUTHRIE, Jan. 7, 2026.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON OVERSIGHT AND ACCOUNTABILITY, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. William Timmons	10/2	10/4	Finland		406.18						406.18
Hon. Subas Subramanyam	10/2	10/4	Finland		406.18						406.18
Hon. Paul Gosar	10/2	10/4	Finland		406.18						406.18
Ashlee Vinyard	10/2	10/4	Finland		406.18						406.18
Kaity Wolfe	10/2	10/4	Finland		406.18						406.18
Graham Harwood	10/2	10/4	Finland		406.18						406.18
Committee total					2437.08						2437.08

HON. JAMES COMER, Jan. 22, 2026.

(AMENDED) REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON ON RULES, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN JULY 1 AND SEPT. 30, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. Virginia Foxx	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,220.00						1,220.00
Hon. J. McGovern	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,220.00						1,220.00

(AMENDED) REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON ON RULES, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN JULY 1 AND SEPT. 30, 2025—Continued

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. Michelle Fischbach	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,220.00						1,220.00
Eric Shepard	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,172.00						1,172.00
Hunter Bradshaw	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,172.00						1,172.00
Hon. MG Scanlon	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		³				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,172.00						1,172.00
Hon. T. Leger Fernandez	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,220.00						1,220.00
Hon. N. Langworthy	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,220.00						1,220.00
Hon. Austin Scott	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,220.00						1,220.00
Steven Waskiewicz	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,172.00						1,172.00
Don Sisson	9/19	9/21	Spain		427.25		(³)				427.25
	9/21	9/22	France		322.00						322.00
	9/22	9/24	England		1,196.00						1,196.00
	9/24	9/26	Scotland		1,172.00						1,172.00
Committee totals					34,198.50						34,198.50

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.
² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.
³ Military air transportation.

HON. VIRGINIA FOXX, Feb. 4, 2026.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON RULES, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
HOUSE COMMITTEES											
Please Note: If there were no expenditures during the calendar quarter noted above, please check the box at right to so indicate and return. ☐											

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.
² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

HON. VIRGINIA FOXX, Feb. 4, 2026.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON SCIENCE, SPACE, AND TECHNOLOGY, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
HOUSE COMMITTEES											
Please Note: If there were no expenditures during the calendar quarter noted above, please check the box at right to so indicate and return. ☐											

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.
² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

HON. BRIAN BABIN, Jan. 29, 2026.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMITTEE ON WAYS AND MEANS, HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²
Hon. Jimmy Panetta	11/21	11/23	Dominican Republic		455.80	(³)					455.80
	11/29	12/1	Honduras		731.56	(³)					731.56
Committee total					1,187.36						1,187.36

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.
² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.
³ Military air transportation.

FOR HOUSE STAFF SIGNERS
Please check the box at right to indicate that you are authorized by the Member to submit these Foreign Travel documents and to use the Member's signature on file with the Clerk. ☒

ALEXANDRA ERWIN HOPKINS, Feb. 2, 2026.
On Behalf Of: CHAIRMAN JASON SMITH.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, JOINT COMMITTEE ON TAXATION, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²

HOUSE COMMITTEES

Please Note: If there were no expenditures during the calendar quarter noted above, please check the box at right to so indicate and return. ☐

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.
² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

FOR HOUSE STAFF SIGNERS
Please check the box at right to indicate that you are authorized by the Member to submit these Foreign Travel documents and to use the Member's signature on file with the Clerk. ☐

TAYLOR ROSE, Feb. 2026.
On Behalf Of: CHAIRMAN MIKE CRAPO.

REPORT OF EXPENDITURES FOR OFFICIAL FOREIGN TRAVEL, COMMISSION ON SECURITY AND COOPERATION IN EUROPE, EXPENDED BETWEEN OCT. 1 AND DEC. 31, 2025

Name of Member or employee	Date		Country	Per diem ¹		Transportation		Other purposes		Total	
	Arrival	Departure		Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²	Foreign currency	U.S. dollar equivalent or U.S. currency ²

HOUSE COMMITTEES

Please Note: If there were no expenditures during the calendar quarter noted above, please check the box at right to so indicate and return. ☐

¹ Per diem constitutes lodging and meals.
² If foreign currency is used, enter U.S. dollar equivalent; if U.S. currency is used, enter amount expended.

HON. JOE WILSON, Jan. 22, 2026.

EXECUTIVE COMMUNICATIONS, ETC.

Under clause 2 of rule XIV, executive communications were taken from the Speaker's table and referred as follows:

EC-2859. A letter from the Associate Director, Regulatory Policy and Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting the Agency's final rule — Air Plan Approval; AK; Updates to Materials Incorporated by Reference [EPA-R10-OAR-2025-3357; FRL-13106-01-R10] received February 6, 2026, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC-2860. A letter from the Associate Director, Regulatory Policy and Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting the Agency's final rule — Air Plan Approval; Connecticut; Revised Format for Materials Incorporated by Reference [EPA-R01-OAR-2025-2895; FRL-13084-01-R1] received February 6, 2026, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC-2861. A letter from the Associate Director, Regulatory Policy and Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting the Agency's final rule — Air Plan Revisions; California; Heavy-Duty Vehicle Inspection and Maintenance Program [EPA-R09-OAR-2025-0061; FRL-12606-02-R9] received February 6, 2026, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC-2862. A letter from the Associate Director, Regulatory Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting the Agency's final rule — Approval and Promulgation of Air Quality Implementation Plans; Nevada; Regional Haze State Implementation Plan for the Second Implementation Period [EPA-R09-OAR-2025-0101; FRL-12600-02-R9] received February 6, 2026, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC-2863. A letter from the Associate Director, Regulatory Policy and Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting the Agency's Major final rule — Hazardous and Solid Waste Management System: Disposal of Coal Combustion Re-

siduals From Electric Utilities; CCR Management Unit Deadline Extension Rule [EPA-HQ-OLEM-2020-0107; FRL-7814.2-05-OLEM] (RIN: 2050-AH36) received February 6, 2026, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 801(a)(1)(A); Public Law 104-121, Sec. 251; (110 Stat. 868); to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

EC-2864. A letter from the Senior Bureau Official, Bureau of Legislative Affairs, Department of State, transmitting Department Report Number: 007052, Data Mining Activities by Federal Agencies, pursuant to 42 U.S.C. 2000ee-3(c)(1); Public Law 110-53, Sec. 804(c)(1); (121 Stat. 362); to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

EC-2865. A letter from the Attorney Advisor, Office of the General Counsel, Department of Transportation, transmitting a notification of a nomination, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 3349(a); Public Law 105-277, Sec. 151(b); (112 Stat. 2681-614); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2866. A letter from the Attorney Advisor, Office of the General Counsel, Department of Transportation, transmitting a notification of a designation of acting officer and action on nomination, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 3349(a); Public Law 105-277, Sec. 151(b); (112 Stat. 2681-614); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2867. A letter from the Attorney Advisor, Office of the General Counsel, Department of Transportation, transmitting a notification of a nomination and discontinuation of service in acting role, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 3349(a); Public Law 105-277, Sec. 151(b); (112 Stat. 2681-614); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2868. A letter from the Attorney Advisor, Office of the General Counsel, Department of Transportation, transmitting a notification of a nomination, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 3349(a); Public Law 105-277, Sec. 151(b); (112 Stat. 2681-614); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2869. A letter from the Attorney Advisor, Office of the General Counsel, Department of Transportation, transmitting a notification of an action on nomination and discontinuation of service in acting role, pursuant to 5 U.S.C. 3349(a); Public Law 105-277, Sec. 151(b); (112 Stat. 2681-614); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2870. A letter from the Acting Deputy Assistant Secretary for Budget and Pro-

grams, Department of Transportation, transmitting the Department's Agency Financial Report for FY 2025, as well as the Secretary's FY 2025 State of Assurance to the President regarding the Federal Managers Financial Integrity Act, pursuant to 31 U.S.C. 3515(a)(1); Public Law 101-576, Sec. 303(a)(1) (as amended by Public Law 107-289, Sec. 2(a)); (116 Stat. 2049) and 31 U.S.C. 1115(b); Public Law 111-352, Sec. 3; (124 Stat. 3868); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2871. A letter from the Chief Executive Officer, Peace Corps, transmitting the Fiscal Year (FY) 2025 Agency Financial Report, the FY 2025 Annual Performance Report, along with the FY 2026-2030 Strategic Plan, pursuant to 31 U.S.C. 3515(a)(1); Public Law 101-576, Sec. 303(a)(1) (as amended by Public Law 107-289, Sec. 2(a)); (116 Stat. 2049) and 31 U.S.C. 1115(b); Public Law 111-352, Sec. 3; (124 Stat. 3868); to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

EC-2872. A letter from the Secretary, Department of Veterans Affairs, transmitting a draft bill, the Veterans Health, Benefits, and Administration Programs Act of 2026; to the Committee on Veterans' Affairs.

EC-2873. A letter from the Board Chairman and CEO, Farm Credit Administration, transmitting the Administration's Fiscal Year 2027 Proposed Budget and Performance Plan, pursuant to 31 U.S.C. 1115(b); Public Law 111-352, Sec. 3; (124 Stat. 3868); jointly to the Committees on Agriculture and Oversight and Government Reform.

REPORTS OF COMMITTEES ON PUBLIC BILLS AND RESOLUTIONS

Under clause 2 of rule XIII, reports of committees were delivered to the Clerk for printing and reference to the proper calendar, as follows:

Mr. ROY: Committee on Rules. H. Res. 1057. A resolution providing for consideration of the bill (S. 1383) to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access, and for other purposes; providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 2189) to modernize Federal firearms laws to account for advancements in technology and less-than-lethal weapons, and for other purposes; providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 261) to

amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit requiring an authorization for the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have previously been authorized by a Federal or State agency; providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 3617) to amend the Department of Energy Organization Act to secure the supply of critical energy resources, including critical minerals and other materials, and for other purposes; and waiving a requirement of clause 6(a) of rule XIII with respect to consideration of certain resolutions reported from the Committee on Rules (Rept. 119-493). Referred to the House Calendar.

Mr. WALBERG: Committee on Education and Workforce. H.R. 3495. A bill to amend the Fair Labor Standards Act of 1938 to clarify the definition of employee as it relates to direct sellers and real estate agents, and for other purposes; with an amendment (Rept. 119-494). Referred to the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union.

Mr. WALBERG: Committee on Education and Workforce. H.R. 6472. A bill to amend the Higher Education Act of 1965 to provide for in-state tuition rates for certain residents of Guam, the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, American Samoa, and the United States Virgin Islands, and for other purposes; with an amendment (Rept. 119-495). Referred to the Committee of the Whole House on the state of the Union.

PUBLIC BILLS AND RESOLUTIONS

Under clause 2 of rule XII, public bills and resolutions of the following titles were introduced and severally referred, as follows:

By Ms. DELAURO (for herself, Mr. CASE, Mr. PETERS, Mr. HOYER, Ms. MCCOLLUM, Mr. MORELLE, Ms. SEWELL, Mrs. WATSON COLEMAN, Mr. COURTNEY, Mrs. TORRES of California, Mr. MRVAN, Ms. ESCOBAR, Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania, Ms. PINGREE, Ms. LOIS FRANKEL of Florida, Mr. QUIGLEY, Mr. LARSEN of Washington, and Mr. HIMES):

H.R. 7481. A bill making appropriations for the Department of Homeland Security for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Appropriations, and in addition to the Committee on the Budget, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. SMITH of New Jersey (for himself and Mr. DOGGETT):

H.R. 7482. A bill to authorize the Secretary of Health and Human Services to fund prize competitions to accelerate innovation in the prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of Lyme disease, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Ms. ANSARI (for herself and Mr. GARCIA of California):

H.R. 7483. A bill to prohibit certain senior Federal officers or acting officers from carrying out the duties of other Federal positions, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

By Mr. BARR:

H.R. 7484. A bill to amend the Electronic Fund Transfer Act to adjust certain thresholds for inflation; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. BARR:

H.R. 7485. A bill to permit visiting dignitaries and service members from Taiwan to

display the flag of the Republic of China; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs, and in addition to the Committee on Armed Services, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. BEYER (for himself and Mr. BUCHANAN):

H.R. 7486. A bill to amend title XI of the Social Security Act to provide for support to facility-based providers through contracts with quality improvement organizations; to the Committee on Ways and Means.

By Ms. BOEBERT (for herself and Mr. GRAY):

H.R. 7487. A bill to amend the Reclamation Project Act of 1939 to encourage non-Federal hydropower development with respect to Bureau of Reclamation projects; to the Committee on Natural Resources.

By Mr. BRESNAHAN (for himself and Mrs. MCCLAIN DELANEY):

H.R. 7488. A bill to create an Office of the Chief Economist at the Commodity Futures Trading Commission; to the Committee on Agriculture.

By Mr. CARTER of Texas:

H.R. 7489. A bill to authorize the construction of a community-based outpatient clinic in Georgetown, Texas, as a major medical facility project of the Department of Veterans Affairs for fiscal year 2027, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Veterans' Affairs.

By Mr. COLE (for himself, Mr. LARSEN of Washington, Ms. LEGER FERNANDEZ, and Mr. ISSA):

H.R. 7490. A bill to allow the U.S. Marshals Service to assist in certain Tribal criminal matters, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania (for herself, Mr. JEFFRIES, Ms. LEE of Florida, and Mr. BACON):

H.R. 7491. A bill to regulate monitoring of electronic communications between an incarcerated person in a Bureau of Prisons facility and that person's attorney or other legal representative, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mrs. DINGELL (for herself, Ms. STEVENS, Ms. TLAIB, Mr. THANEDAR, Ms. SCHOLTEN, Ms. McDONALD RIVET, and Ms. KAPTUR):

H.R. 7492. A bill to prohibit Federal interference with the opening and operation of the Gordie Howe International Bridge; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs, and in addition to the Committees on Ways and Means, and Homeland Security, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. DOGGETT:

H.R. 7493. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to modify the rules relating to inverted corporations; to the Committee on Ways and Means.

By Ms. ELFRETH (for herself, Mr. EVANS of Colorado, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHY, Mrs. MCCLAIN DELANEY, Ms. NORTON, Ms. SALINAS, and Mr. SCHMIDT):

H.R. 7494. A bill to authorize the Attorney General to make grants to establish a national training and technical assistance center to provide for the ongoing promotion and adoption of a lethality assessment programs to reduce domestic violence-related homicides, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. FITZGERALD (for himself, Mr. STEIL, Mr. VAN ORDEN, Mr. GROTHMAN, Mr. TIFFANY, and Mr. WIED):

H.R. 7495. A bill to authorize the establishment of memorials to the Wisconsin infantry

officers and enlisted men who fought in the Battle of Antietam and the Second Battle of Bull Run, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Natural Resources.

By Mr. HARDER of California:

H.R. 7496. A bill to provide for the designation of areas as Health Investment Zones to reduce health disparities and improve health outcomes in such areas, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce, and in addition to the Committees on Ways and Means, and Education and Workforce, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mrs. HAYES (for herself, Ms.

BROWN, Ms. NORTON, Mrs. DINGELL, Mr. MOULTON, Mr. THANEDAR, Mr. FROST, Ms. SEWELL, Mr. TAKANO, Ms. STANSBURY, Mr. LYNCH, Mr. FIELDS, Ms. LOFGREN, Ms. SALINAS, Mrs. MCIVER, Ms. PINGREE, Mrs. GRIJALVA, Mr. CARSON, Ms. WILSON of Florida, Ms. ROSS, and Mr. GARCIA of Illinois):

H.R. 7497. A bill to amend the SUPPORT for Patients and Communities Act to improve trauma support services and mental health care for children and youth in educational settings, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Education and Workforce.

By Mrs. HINSON (for herself, Ms. BONAMICI, Mr. MACKENZIE, Mr. PAPPAS, Ms. STEFANIK, and Mr. POCAN):

H.R. 7498. A bill to establish and expand child care programs for parents who work nontraditional hours, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Education and Workforce.

By Ms. KELLY of Illinois (for herself,

Mr. JOHNSON of Georgia, Mr. DAVIS of Illinois, Ms. TLAIB, Mr. CLEAVER, Mr. LIEU, Mrs. CHERFILUS-McCORMICK, Mrs. MCIVER, Mr. GOLDMAN of New York, Ms. CROCKETT, Mrs. FOUSHEE, Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania, Mr. DESAULNIER, Mr. QUIGLEY, Mr. NADLER, Ms. ROSS, Mr. CISNEROS, Mr. MOULTON, Mr. BELL, Ms. SEWELL, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHY, Ms. SALINAS, Mr. SMITH of Washington, Mr. SOTO, Mr. CARSON, Ms. NORTON, Ms. BROWN, Ms. CASTOR of Florida, Ms. GARCIA of Texas, Mr. CARBAJAL, Ms. SIMON, and Mr. FROST):

H.R. 7499. A bill to amend the Consumer Product Safety Act to remove the exclusion of pistols, revolvers, and other firearms from the definition of consumer product in order to permit the issuance of safety standards for such articles by the Consumer Product Safety Commission; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Ms. KELLY of Illinois (for herself,

Mrs. BEATTY, Ms. BROWN, Mr. CARBAJAL, Mr. DAVIS of Illinois, Mr. JOHNSON of Georgia, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHY, Ms. NORTON, Ms. CASTOR of Florida, Ms. GARCIA of Texas, Ms. SIMON, Ms. SALINAS, Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania, Mr. FROST, Mr. GOLDMAN of New York, and Mr. KENNEDY of New York):

H.R. 7500. A bill to direct the Federal Trade Commission to conduct a study and submit to Congress a report on unfair or deceptive acts or practices that may be prevalent in the advertising or marketing of firearms and to issue regulations to prohibit unfair or deceptive acts or practices related to the advertising or marketing of firearms, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Mr. KENNEDY of New York (for himself and Mr. LANGWORTHY):

H.R. 7501. A bill to direct the Administrator of the Federal Aviation Administration to issue certain regulations eliminating

public charters from being eligible for on-demand eligibility under part 380 of title 14, Code of Federal Regulations, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure.

By Mr. LANGWORTHY (for himself, Mr. VICENTE GONZALEZ of Texas, Mr. WEBER of Texas, Mr. JACKSON of Illinois, Mr. EVANS of Colorado, Mr. DAVIS of North Carolina, Mr. CRENSHAW, Mr. VEASEY, Mr. CUELLAR, and Mr. PFLUGER):

H.R. 7502. A bill to prohibit a person from making a misleading recycled content claim in advertising, marketing, selling, or offering for sale a product to a consumer, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

By Mr. LAWLER (for himself and Mr. GOTTHEIMER):

H.R. 7503. A bill to expand the eligibility of properties for the Good Neighbor Next Door Sales Program for members of the Armed Forces, firefighters, and law enforcement officials, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. LAWLER (for himself and Mr. GOTTHEIMER):

H.R. 7504. A bill to require the Government Accountability Office to study and recommend a definition for workforce housing; to the Committee on Financial Services, and in addition to the Committee on Ways and Means, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Ms. MCBRIDE (for herself and Mrs. LUNA):

H.R. 7505. A bill to amend the Family and Medical Leave Act of 1993 to allow all leave to be taken on an intermittent schedule; to the Committee on Education and Workforce, and in addition to the Committees on Oversight and Government Reform, and House Administration, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. MCCAUL (for himself, Mr. KEATING, Mr. LAWLER, Ms. KAPTUR, Mr. QUIGLEY, and Mr. GOTTHEIMER):

H.R. 7506. A bill to impose sanctions with respect to foreign persons dealing in crude oil or petroleum products of Russian Federation origin; to the Committee on Foreign Affairs.

By Mrs. MCCLAIN DELANEY (for herself, Mr. SUBRAMANYAM, Ms. NORTON, Mr. OLSZEWSKI, Mr. WALKINSHAW, Ms. ELFRETH, Mr. IVEY, Mr. MOULTON, Mr. VINDMAN, and Mr. LYNCH):

H.R. 7507. A bill to require the Comptroller General of the United States to conduct a study of the impact of Federal reductions in force on State and local governments, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

By Mr. MIN (for himself, Ms. NORTON, Ms. DEXTER, and Mr. TONKO):

H.R. 7508. A bill to modify reporting value categories for financial disclosure reports required under chapter 131 of title 5, United States Code; to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform, and in addition to the Committees on House Administration, and the Judiciary, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. MORAN:

H.R. 7509. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to deny certain tax credits and deductions to businesses that use foreign adversary-controlled technology, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Ways and Means.

By Mr. NEHLS (for himself and Mr. GILL of Texas):

H.R. 7510. A bill to prohibit certain foreign governments from acquiring intellectual property rights of research conducted by United States universities, faculty, staff, or students, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Education and Workforce.

By Mr. NUNN of Iowa (for himself, Mr. FEENSTRA, Mrs. HINSON, and Mrs. MILLER-MEEKS):

H.R. 7511. A bill to designate the clinic of the Department of Veterans Affairs in Des Moines, Iowa, as the "Staff Sergeant Edgar Torres-Tovar VA Clinic" and to designate the community-based outpatient clinic of the Department in Marshalltown, Iowa, as the "Staff Sergeant William Nathaniel Howard VA Clinic"; to the Committee on Veterans' Affairs.

By Mr. OGLES:

H.R. 7512. A bill to amend the Homeland Security Act of 2002 to extend the authorization of the Countering Weapons of Mass Destruction Office of the Department of Homeland Security, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Homeland Security, and in addition to the Committee on Energy and Commerce, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Ms. PRESSLEY (for herself, Mr. GREEN of Texas, and Ms. TLAIB):

H.R. 7513. A bill to require the global systemically important bank holding companies to provide annual reports to the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Ms. SALINAS (for herself, Mr. MOOLENAAR, Ms. TOKUDA, and Mr. MOYLAN):

H.R. 7514. A bill to authorize rural health facilities to use certain Federal agricultural credit assistance for the purpose of refinancing debt obligations, updating necessary services, technology, and equipment, and supporting ancillary needs; to the Committee on Agriculture.

By Ms. STRICKLAND:

H.R. 7515. A bill to direct the Secretary of the Interior to convey to the Nisqually Indian Tribe the Clear Creek Hatchery infrastructure; to the Committee on Natural Resources.

By Mr. SUBRAMANYAM (for himself, Mr. NUNN of Iowa, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHY, Mr. MOOLENAAR, Mr. GOTTHEIMER, Mrs. KIM, Mr. MCGOVERN, Mr. FITZPATRICK, Mr. BEYER, and Ms. NORTON):

H.R. 7516. A bill to require the Secretary of the Treasury to instruct the United States Executive Directors at the international financial institutions to advocate for opposition to projects that make use of forced labor; to the Committee on Financial Services.

By Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania (for himself, Mr. FITZPATRICK, Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania, Mr. PERRY, and Mr. DELUZZIO):

H.R. 7517. A bill to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 10 East Main Street in Mahaffey, Pennsylvania, as the "Robert Allen Bishop, Sr. Post Office Building"; to the Committee on Oversight and Government Reform.

By Ms. TOKUDA (for herself, Mr. HERNANDEZ, and Mr. CASE):

H.R. 7518. A bill to amend the Food, Agriculture, Conservation, and Trade Act of 1990 to ensure adequate staffing and resources for the Institute of Tropical Forestry and the Institute of Pacific Islands Forestry; to the Committee on Agriculture.

By Mr. TORRES of New York (for himself and Mr. LATIMER):

H.R. 7519. A bill to require the District Commanders of the Corps of Engineers to provide to offices of Members of Congress annual briefings on projects funded or led by the Corps of Engineers in watersheds within such district, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure.

By Ms. JAYAPAL (for herself, Mr. TAKANO, Ms. JACOBS, Mr. AMO, Ms. ANSARI, Ms. BALINT, Ms. BARRAGAN, Mr. BELL, Ms. BONAMICI, Ms. BROWNLEY, Mr. CARBAJAL, Mr. CARSON, Mr. CASAR, Mr. CASTEN, Ms. CHU, Mr. CISNEROS, Ms. CLARKE of New York, Mr. DAVIS of Illinois, Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania, Ms. DEGETTE, Ms. DELBENE, Mr. DESAULNIER, Ms. DEXTER, Mrs. DINGELL, Mr. DOGGETT, Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania, Mrs. FLETCHER, Mrs. FOUSHEE, Mr. FROST, Mr. GARAMENDI, Ms. GARCIA of Texas, Mr. GARCIA of California, Mr. GARCIA of Illinois, Mr. GOLDMAN of New York, Mr. GOMEZ, Mr. GREEN of Texas, Mrs. GRIJALVA, Mr. IVEY, Mr. JOHNSON of Georgia, Ms. KAMLAGER-DOVE, Mr. KEATING, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHY, Mr. LARSON of Connecticut, Ms. LEE of Pennsylvania, Ms. LEGER FERNANDEZ, Mr. LIEU, Ms. LOFGREN, Mr. LYNCH, Ms. MATSUI, Ms. MCBRIDE, Mrs. MCCLAIN DELANEY, Ms. MCLELLAN, Ms. MCCOLLUM, Mr. MCGARVEY, Mr. MCGOVERN, Mrs. MCIVER, Mr. MENENDEZ, Ms. MENG, Ms. MOORE of Wisconsin, Mr. MOULTON, Mr. MULLIN, Mr. NADLER, Ms. NORTON, Ms. OCASIO-CORTEZ, Ms. OMAR, Mr. PANETTA, Mr. PETERS, Ms. PINGREE, Mr. POCAN, Ms. PRESSLEY, Mr. QUIGLEY, Mrs. RAMIREZ, Ms. RANDALL, Mr. RASKIN, Ms. RIVAS, Ms. ROSS, Ms. SALINAS, Ms. SANCHEZ, Ms. SCANLON, Ms. SCHAKOWSKY, Ms. SIMON, Mr. SMITH of Washington, Ms. STANSBURY, Mr. THANEDAR, Ms. TITUS, Ms. TLAIB, Ms. TOKUDA, Mr. TONKO, Mr. TORRES of New York, Mrs. TRAHAN, Mr. VARGAS, Ms. VELÁZQUEZ, Mr. WALKINSHAW, Mrs. WATSON COLEMAN, Ms. WILSON of Florida, and Ms. BROWN):

H. Res. 1058. A resolution recognizing that it is the duty of the Federal Government to develop and implement a Transgender Bill of Rights to protect and codify the rights of transgender and nonbinary people under the law and ensure their access to medical care, shelter, safety, and economic security; to the Committee on the Judiciary, and in addition to the Committees on Education and Workforce, Energy and Commerce, Financial Services, Oversight and Government Reform, Armed Services, Veterans' Affairs, and House Administration, for a period to be subsequently determined by the Speaker, in each case for consideration of such provisions as fall within the jurisdiction of the committee concerned.

By Mr. LARSON of Connecticut (for himself, Mr. NEAL, Mr. DOGGETT, Mr. THOMPSON of California, Mr. DAVIS of Illinois, Ms. SANCHEZ, Ms. SEWELL, Ms. DELBENE, Ms. CHU, Ms. MOORE of Wisconsin, Mr. BOYLE of Pennsylvania, Mr. BEYER, Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania, Mr. SCHNEIDER, Mr. PANETTA, Mr. GOMEZ, Mr. HORSFORD, Ms. PLASKETT, and Mr. SUOZZI):

H. Res. 1059. A resolution of inquiry requesting the President of the United States to furnish certain information to the House of Representatives relating to the Department of Government Efficiency's access to and usage of NUMIDENT and other personally identifiable information in the possession of the Social Security Administration; to the Committee on Ways and Means.

By Mr. TONKO (for himself, Mr. BILIRAKIS, Ms. MATSUI, Mr. NORMAN, Mrs. TRAHAN, Mr. AUCHINCLOSS, Mr. MCGARVEY, Ms. DAVIDS of Kansas, Mr. WILSON of South Carolina, Mrs. BIGGS of South Carolina, and Mr. LATIMER):

H. Res. 1060. A resolution expressing support for the designation of April 5, 2026, as "Barth Syndrome Awareness Day"; to the Committee on Energy and Commerce.

CONSTITUTIONAL AUTHORITY STATEMENT

Pursuant to clause 7 of rule XII of the Rules of the House of Representatives, the following statements are submitted regarding the specific powers granted to Congress in the Constitution to enact the accompanying bill or joint resolution.

By Ms. DeLAURO:

H.R. 7481.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Clause 7 of section 9 of article I of the Constitution.

By Mr. SMITH of New Jersey:

H.R. 7482.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the US Constitution

By Ms. ANSARI:

H.R. 7483.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section VIII

By Mr. BARR:

H.R. 7484.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8 of the United States Constitution.

By Mr. BARR:

H.R. 7485.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. BEYER:

H.R. 7486.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8

By Ms. BOEBERT:

H.R. 7487.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

The Congress shall have Power To lay and collect Taxes, Duties, Imposts and Excises, to pay the Debts and provide for the common Defence and general Welfare of the United States; but all Duties, Imposts and Excises shall be uniform throughout the United States;

By Mr. BRESNAHAN:

H.R. 7488.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Section 8 of Article 1 of the Constitution.

By Mr. CARTER of Texas:

H.R. 7489.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 1 of the Constitution of the United States.

By Mr. COLE:

H.R. 7490.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18

By Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania:

H.R. 7491.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8

By Mrs. DINGELL:

H.R. 7492.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

The Constitutional authority of Congress to enact legislation provided by Article 1, Section 8 of the United States Constitution.

By Mr. DOGGETT:

H.R. 7493.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Clause 1 of Section 8 of Article I of the United States Constitution

By Ms. ELFRETH:

H.R. 7494.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Necessary and Proper Clause (Art. 1, Sec. 8, Cl. 18)

By Mr. FITZGERALD:

H.R. 7495.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section VIII of the United States Constitution

By Mr. HARDER of California:

H.R. 7496.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I Section VIII

By Mrs. HAYES:

H.R. 7497.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18, "To make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the foregoing Powers, and all other Powers vested by this Constitution in the Government of the United States, or in any Department or Officer thereof."

By Mrs. HINSON:

H.R. 7498.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 1

By Ms. KELLY of Illinois:

H.R. 7499.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Clause 18 of section 8 of article 1 of the Constitution

By Ms. KELLY of Illinois:

H.R. 7500.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the Constitution.

By Mr. KENNEDY of New York:

H.R. 7501.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Clause 3, Section 8, Title 1 of the Constitution

By Mr. LANGWORTHY:

H.R. 7502.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Clause 3 of Section 8 of Article 1 of the Constitution

By Mr. LAWLER:

H.R. 7503.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I of the U.S. Constitution, Section 8 Clause 18

By Mr. LAWLER:

H.R. 7504.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I of the U.S. Constitution, Section 8 Clause 18

By Ms. MCBRIDE:

H.R. 7505.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. MCCAUL:

H.R. 7506.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8 of the Constitution

By Mrs. MCCLAIN DELANEY:

H.R. 7507.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, clause 1

By Mr. MIN:

H.R. 7508.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clause 18.

By Mr. MORAN:

H.R. 7509.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8

By Mr. NEHLS:

H.R. 7510.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8, Clause 3

By Mr. NUNN of Iowa:

H.R. 7511.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8 of the United States Constitution

To make all Laws which shall be necessary and proper for carrying into Execution the foregoing Powers, and all other Powers vested by this Constitution in the Government of the United States, or in any Department or Officer thereof.

By Mr. OGLES:

H.R. 7512.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section VII

By Ms. PRESSLEY:

H.R. 7513.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Art. 1 Sec. 8 Clause 18

By Ms. SALINAS:

H.R. 7514.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Pursuant to Article I, Section 8, Clause 3

Ms. STRICKLAND:

H.R. 7515.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution

By Mr. SUBRAMANYAM:

H.R. 7516.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8

By Mr. THOMPSON of Pennsylvania:

H.R. 7517.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, Section 8 of the U.S. Constitution.

By Ms. TOKUDA:

H.R. 7518.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article I, Section 8, Clauses 1 and 18 of the United States Constitution

By Mr. TORRES of New York:

H.R. 7519.

Congress has the power to enact this legislation pursuant to the following:

Article 1, section 8

ADDITIONAL SPONSORS

Under clause 7 of rule XII, sponsors were added to public bills and resolutions, as follows:

H.R. 116: Mr. PFLUGER and Mr. SELF.

- H.R. 161: Mr. PFLUGER and Mr. PALMER.
H.R. 244: Mr. OGLES.
H.R. 491: Ms. PINGREE.
H.R. 492: Mr. GREEN of Texas and Ms. PIN-GREE.
H.R. 516: Mr. BACON.
H.R. 539: Mr. LIEU and Mr. TONKO.
H.R. 630: Mr. MENENDEZ.
H.R. 924: Mr. VINDMAN.
H.R. 935: Mr. TORRES of New York.
H.R. 1007: Mr. SMITH of Nebraska.
H.R. 1061: Mr. NEGUSE, Mr. SCHNEIDER, and Ms. WATERS.
H.R. 1065: Mr. AUCHINCLOSS.
H.R. 1094: Mr. CARTER of Texas.
H.R. 1157: Mr. WITTMAN.
H.R. 1266: Mr. IVEY.
H.R. 1340: Mr. BARRETT and Mr. HORSFORD.
H.R. 1529: Mr. SCHMIDT, Mr. NORCROSS, and Mr. AMODEI of Nevada.
H.R. 1538: Mr. SOTO.
H.R. 1548: Mr. ALFORD.
H.R. 1707: Mr. LAWLER.
H.R. 1810: Mr. VEASEY, Ms. WILSON of Florida, Ms. ELFRETH, Ms. VELÁZQUEZ, Mrs. SYKES, and Mr. NORCROSS.
H.R. 1970: Ms. KING-HINDS.
H.R. 1993: Ms. MORRISON.
H.R. 2089: Mrs. BEATTY and Mr. GROTHMAN.
H.R. 2130: Mr. DOWNING.
H.R. 2200: Mrs. RADEWAGEN.
H.R. 2368: Ms. PETTERSEN.
H.R. 2467: Ms. SIMON.
H.R. 2487: Ms. PRESSLEY.
H.R. 2547: Mr. SCHNEIDER.
H.R. 2555: Mr. HUDSON.
H.R. 2560: Mr. POCAN.
H.R. 2627: Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 2660: Mrs. HINSON.
H.R. 2752: Mr. DESJARLAIS.
H.R. 2998: Mr. GARBARINO.
H.R. 3054: Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 3067: Mr. SORENSEN.
H.R. 3101: Ms. CROCKETT.
H.R. 3102: Mr. BISHOP.
H.R. 3105: Ms. LEE of Nevada.
H.R. 3115: Mr. VINDMAN.
H.R. 3144: Ms. SALAZAR.
H.R. 3151: Mr. SCHMIDT.
H.R. 3164: Mr. KELLY of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 3165: Ms. NORTON.
H.R. 3226: Mr. GREEN of Texas and Mr. SHERMAN.
H.R. 3243: Mr. DOGGETT.
H.R. 3261: Mr. SCOTT of Virginia.
H.R. 3276: Mr. VINDMAN.
H.R. 3491: Mrs. WAGNER.
H.R. 3526: Mr. SCHMIDT.
H.R. 3604: Ms. LOIS FRANKEL of Florida.
H.R. 3732: Mrs. LUNA and Mr. DESAULNIER.
H.R. 3747: Mr. MULLIN.
H.R. 3773: Ms. RANDALL.
H.R. 3922: Mr. KENNEDY of Utah.
H.R. 3930: Mrs. McIVER.
H.R. 3946: Mr. YAKYM.
H.R. 4348: Mr. LEVIN.
H.R. 4382: Mr. THANEDAR and Mr. WILSON of South Carolina.
H.R. 4393: Mr. NUNN of Iowa and Ms. MCCOLLUM.
H.R. 4443: Mr. LATIMER and Mrs. FLETCHER.
H.R. 4463: Mr. McDOWELL.
H.R. 4509: Mr. MORELLE.
H.R. 4518: Mrs. KIGGANS of Virginia.
H.R. 4525: Ms. JOHNSON of Texas and Ms. LOIS FRANKEL of Florida.
H.R. 4620: Mr. COLLINS.
H.R. 4662: Mr. OBERNOLTE.
H.R. 4751: Ms. LOIS FRANKEL of Florida.
H.R. 4763: Mr. LIEU.
H.R. 4782: Mr. HERNÁNDEZ.
H.R. 4966: Ms. DEAN of Pennsylvania.
H.R. 4994: Mr. FOSTER.
H.R. 5141: Mr. VINDMAN.
H.R. 5206: Ms. TLAIB.
H.R. 5343: Mr. JOYCE of Pennsylvania, Mr. COHEN, Ms. MALOY, and Ms. HOULAHAN.
H.R. 5434: Mr. VEASEY and Ms. PRESSLEY.
H.R. 5438: Mr. BEGICH.
H.R. 5517: Mr. FINSTAD.
H.R. 5536: Mr. MCGOVERN and Mr. LAWLER.
H.R. 5620: Mr. FIELDS.
H.R. 5621: Mr. DOGGETT, Ms. NORTON, and Ms. HOULAHAN.
H.R. 5801: Mr. BACON.
H.R. 5936: Ms. LOFGREN.
H.R. 5940: Ms. TITUS.
H.R. 6128: Mr. WEBER of Texas.
H.R. 6137: Mr. FINE.
H.R. 6181: Mr. VEASEY.
H.R. 6222: Mr. ELLZEY, Mr. MCCORMICK, Mr. HUNT, and Mr. WALKINSHAW.
H.R. 6275: Ms. LEE of Nevada.
H.R. 6303: Ms. TLAIB.
H.R. 6403: Mr. VINDMAN.
H.R. 6419: Mr. COHEN.
H.R. 6446: Ms. VAN DUYN.
H.R. 6472: Mr. CARBAJAL.
H.R. 6509: Mr. MORAN and Ms. ROSS.
H.R. 6518: Mr. SCHMIDT and Mr. MILLER of Ohio.
H.R. 6566: Mr. McDOWELL.
H.R. 6574: Mr. SOTO, Mr. PETERS, and Mrs. HAYES.
H.R. 6666: Mrs. KIGGANS of Virginia.
H.R. 6766: Mr. GOMEZ.
H.R. 6809: Mr. DAVIS of North Carolina and Mr. FITZPATRICK.
H.R. 6840: Mr. LEVIN and Mr. MOULTON.
H.R. 6960: Ms. WATERS.
H.R. 7014: Ms. JOHNSON of Texas.
H.R. 7037: Mr. BARR and Mr. BILIRAKIS.
H.R. 7062: Mr. PETERS.
H.R. 7091: Mr. CRENSHAW.
H.R. 7115: Mr. GILL of Texas.
H.R. 7146: Mr. ADERHOLT and Ms. SALAZAR.
H.R. 7163: Mr. VINDMAN and Mr. MANNION.
H.R. 7184: Ms. VAN DUYN.
H.R. 7185: Mr. COLLINS.
H.R. 7212: Mr. VINDMAN and Mr. BAIRD.
H.R. 7272: Mr. PFLUGER.
H.R. 7284: Ms. DEGETTE.
H.R. 7286: Mr. VAN EPPS.
H.R. 7300: Mr. SCOTT FRANKLIN of Florida, Mr. GOLDMAN of Texas, and Mr. NORMAN.
H.R. 7306: Mr. SMUCKER.
H.R. 7322: Mr. PANETTA, Mr. SCHNEIDER, Ms. MATSUI, Mr. LYNCH, and Mr. IVEY.
H.R. 7335: Ms. JOHNSON of Texas and Mrs. FLETCHER.
H.R. 7345: Mr. MENENDEZ.
H.R. 7346: Mr. MENENDEZ.
H.R. 7349: Mr. PANETTA.
H.R. 7363: Mr. MFUME.
H.R. 7365: Mr. MCGUIRE.
H.R. 7368: Mr. STEUBE.
H.R. 7380: Mr. BOYLE of Pennsylvania, Mr. WALKINSHAW, and Mr. LAWLER.
H.R. 7384: Ms. KAMLAGER-DOVE.
H.R. 7391: Mr. TORRES of New York, Ms. PEREZ, and Mr. BISHOP.
H.R. 7392: Mr. MOULTON and Mr. VEASEY.
H.R. 7398: Mr. OBERNOLTE.
H.R. 7415: Mr. SHREVE.
H.R. 7428: Ms. NORTON.
H.R. 7429: Ms. NORTON.
H.R. 7438: Mr. BILIRAKIS, Mr. KRISHNAMOORTHY, Ms. WASSERMAN SCHULTZ, and Mr. SMITH of New Jersey.
H.R. 7441: Ms. BROWN and Mr. GARCIA of California.
H.R. 7459: Mr. SMITH of New Jersey.
H.R. 7480: Mr. SCOTT of Virginia and Mr. EVANS of Pennsylvania.
H.J. Res. 12: Ms. LETLOW.
H.J. Res. 122: Mr. VINDMAN.
H. Con. Res. 8: Mr. MANN and Mr. ROSE.
H. Res. 930: Mr. BARR, Mr. RASKIN, and Ms. VAN DUYN.
H. Res. 971: Mr. SHREVE, Mr. MOULTON, and Mr. MACKENZIE.
H. Res. 993: Mr. MOULTON.



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Senate

The Senate met at 2 p.m. and was called to order by the President pro tempore (Mr. GRASSLEY).

PRAYER

The Chaplain, Dr. Barry C. Black, offered the following prayer:

Let us pray.

Eternal Savior, we need You every hour. We not only need You during crisis moments but also in the solitary minutes of daily living.

Our lawmakers need You. As they open their hearts to You, fill them with power, mercy, and grace for their task. Show them Your will for our times, and give them the wisdom to say: Speak Lord, for we are listening.

May the inspiration they receive from You keep their hearts pure and their words true and their deeds kind.

Lord, do for them more than they can ask or imagine.

We pray in Your glorious Name. Amen.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

The President pro tempore led the Pledge of Allegiance, as follows:

I pledge allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, and to the Republic for which it stands, one nation under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

RESERVATION OF LEADER TIME

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. BANKS). Under the previous order, the leadership time is reserved.

CONCLUSION OF MORNING BUSINESS

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Morning business is closed.

LEGISLATIVE SESSION

DEPARTMENT OF HOMELAND SECURITY APPROPRIATIONS ACT, 2026—Motion to Proceed

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Under the previous order, the Senate will resume consideration of the motion to proceed to H.R. 7147, which the clerk will report.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

Motion to proceed to Calendar No. 311, H.R. 7147, a bill making further consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Iowa.

LITHUANIA

Mr. GRASSLEY. Mr. President, I am here to speak about a country that loves freedom, and they are also a friend of the United States and have had a good relationship with the United States.

It happens that, on February 16, 1918, the Act of Independence of Lithuania was signed by the Council of Lithuania. This act proclaimed independence from the Russian Empire and the restoration of the historic State of Lithuania to be governed, as we would expect, with democratic principles.

Some people may be thinking: Isn't Lithuania a former Soviet Republic?

No, Lithuanians and their statehood go back to the 13th century, but the modern Republic of Lithuania has existed since 1918.

The United States has maintained continuous diplomatic relations with Lithuania way back since 1922. In fact, the Republic of Lithuania has occupied the same building here in Washington, DC, for over 100 years.

The United States made crystal clear, at the time—1940, that is—and ever since, that it would not recognize the Soviet annexation of Lithuania, Latvia, and Estonia, those three countries that sometimes we refer to as the

Baltic States. And I am proud of the fact that the United States has made that crystal clear. I am sure that many people thought this stance was somewhat silly and didn't recognize the reality of what it meant to be under Soviet domination.

In the depths of the Cold War, the notion of Lithuania restoring its de facto independence seemed very, very far-fetched. But, today, Lithuania is free and prosperous and one of the most pro-American countries in the world. Lithuania is a close U.S. ally and a beacon of Western values on the frontlines of freedom.

This example of freedom and economic opportunity on its border rankles the Soviet-like Russia, as we know it today. You can tell by the rhetoric coming from the Putin regime. For instance, the Putin regime sometimes suggests that the vote of the Soviet Duma recognizing Lithuania's independence from the Soviet Union was not legal.

Of course, if you know the history that I have just explained, that is an absurd position, because the Soviet occupation of Lithuania itself was never legal, and the United States never recognized it as being legal.

Lithuania, today, is a good friend of the United States and a model North Atlantic Treaty Organization ally.

I congratulate the people of Lithuania on their independence day and thank them for their friendship.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. THUNE. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

RECOGNITION OF THE MAJORITY LEADER

The majority leader is recognized.

• This "bullet" symbol identifies statements or insertions which are not spoken by a Member of the Senate on the floor.



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GOVERNMENT FUNDING

Mr. THUNE. Mr. President, on Friday, funding for the Department of Homeland Security will expire. When we passed a short 2-week stopgap for the Department, at the Democrats' insistence, many of us said it would not be long enough. I made that case repeatedly.

Standing here today, I regret to say that we have been proven right. The renegotiation the Democrats demanded with the Trump administration, last month, is, unsurprisingly, taking some time.

Democrats have had more than a week to coalesce around a set of demands. It was just this past weekend that they put those demands into writing.

On Monday, just 2 days later, the administration countered, and I expect Democrats will shortly receive detailed text for further consideration—a quick turn, I might add, after a long wait—by any measure, a good-faith engagement from our friends at the White House.

Do I think the parties are on a path that could culminate in a deal? Yes.

Will they need more time to get there? Absolutely.

So I hope our Democrat friends will remain at the table and give talks more time to mature. The alternate path should interest no one, and that is a needless shutdown that will see funding lapse for our Coast Guard, for our cyber security, for airport security, and for disaster response.

We have been able to pass 11 of the 12 full-year appropriations bills into law this year, and, as I said, I am hoping we can get that 12th bill done soon. We have made considerable progress this past year restoring the regular-order appropriations process.

And thanks in no small part to a more open process, this year's appropriations bill delivered significant wins for the American people.

Today, I want to take a moment to talk about some of the healthcare wins for Americans in the most recent appropriations package. This most recent package included a number of Member-driven priorities to bring down the cost of prescription drugs, increase access to care, improve healthcare quality, and support treatment of diseases that affect literally millions of Americans. And I want to thank Chairmen CRAPO and CASSIDY for their leadership in crafting this package and for literally years of hard work on these issues of great importance to the American people.

One of the top issues for the American people is the cost of prescription drugs. It is a problem not just in my home State of South Dakota but around country. And the status quo is challenging for patients and for independent pharmacies that often serve small towns and rural communities. But under the Republican majority, Congress has taken concrete actions to drive down costs at the pharmacy counter. That starts with pharmacy

benefit manager—or PBM—reform. The recent appropriations package included provisions from two bills to address PBM practices that can drive up the cost that consumers pay for prescriptions.

Policies from Senators CASSIDY and MARSHALL's bill, the Pharmacy Benefit Manager Reform Act, will increase accountability and transparency for PBMs. And when a PBM gets a discount or rebate from a drugmaker, this bill ensures that those savings are incorporated into the health plans that many working Americans rely on to afford their healthcare and prescriptions.

We also included in the appropriations package provisions from the PBM Price Transparency and Accountability Act authored by Senator CRAPO and supported by nearly all of the Republican members of the Finance Committee, which removes incentives for pharmacy benefit managers to promote higher priced medications at the expense of seniors. This bill also reinforces requirements that protect independent pharmacies and ensure that they can continue serving their communities.

In addition to these commonsense policies, we also took action to improve access to generic drugs, which are often a more affordable option for millions of Americans seeking relief for different health conditions. Senators PAUL, HUSTED, and LEE worked together on the Increasing Transparency in Generic Drug Applications Act, which streamlines the approval for generic alternatives to brand-name drugs, which will help ensure that these safe and less expensive alternatives reach the market more quickly.

And that is not the only thing we did to help accelerate access to medications. Senator MULLIN's bill, the Mikaela Naylor Give Kids a Chance Act will drive development for pediatric cancer drugs. Sadly, Mikaela Naylor lost her battle with cancer this past October. For 5 years, Mikaela sought treatment around the country, and she was a tireless advocate for other children with cancer. And this law is a fitting tribute to Mikaela's fight.

We also addressed access to treatment for children with significant healthcare needs and rare diseases. Senator GRASSLEY's Accelerating Kids' Access to Care Act simplifies the process for children on Medicaid and the Children's Health Insurance Program with complex medical conditions to get care outside their home State. Unfortunately, regulatory hurdles have too often stood in the way of parents' efforts to get their children essential care, wherever it may be located. By removing redtape, Senator GRASSLEY's bill will help ensure that vulnerable children can get the expert care they need when they need it.

Then there is Senator CAPITO's Innovation in Pediatric Drugs Act, which closes the research gap between rare

disease treatments for adults and children by ensuring that drugmakers conduct pediatric studies on drugs for rare diseases.

I am also proud of what we have done to improve access to care. In the Working Families Tax Cuts, we took measures to support rural hospitals. And the appropriations package also includes support for patients to receive care at home. That starts with extending telehealth waivers that have become a critical lifeline for so many patients living far from a healthcare provider, like patients in rural areas. It also includes Senator TIM SCOTT's provision on the Acute Hospital at Home Waiver Program, which helps continue a successful program that helps Americans get the acute care they need without having to be admitted to the hospital.

There is a lot more I could talk about when it comes to healthcare wins for the American people. There are Senator COLLINS' provisions to support type 1 diabetes research and help family members acting as caregivers; Senator MARSHALL's Fair Billing Act, which will help ensure that patients are billed appropriately based on where they receive care and will empower them against unfair facility fees; Senator CRAPO's work on coverage for multicancer early detection screening; and Senator BOOZMAN's work to support organ donors and moms with preemie babies.

Our most recent appropriations package contains numerous healthcare policies that will benefit the American people. It will help bring down healthcare costs, improve access to quality and affordable healthcare, and ensure that the United States remains a leader in healthcare innovation, and it will help ensure that innovations can reach the Americans who need them, especially children.

We passed 11 full-year appropriations bills by engaging Members of both parties, and every one of these healthcare wins is a result of that work. And when I say "wins," I don't mean for the Senators and Congressmen who wrote these bills. These are wins for the American people to help them live healthier, happier, and longer lives.

I yield the floor.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. THUNE. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

ORDER OF PROCEDURE

Mr. THUNE. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the following Senators be permitted to speak for the following number of minutes and, finally, that Senator SCOTT of Florida or his designee be recognized to make a motion to proceed to Calendar No. 315, H.J. Res. 142: Senator SCHUMER for 15 minutes, Senator DURBIN for 15 minutes, Senator SCHATZ for 10 minutes,

Senator BOOKER for 10 minutes, Senator MURPHY for 10 minutes, Senator WARNER for 5 minutes, Senator VAN HOLLEN for 10 minutes, Senator ALSOBROOKS for 5 minutes, Senator KAINE for 10 minutes, Senator WYDEN for 5 minutes, Senator HOEVEN for 10 minutes, Senator KENNEDY for 20 minutes, and Senator SCOTT of Florida for 5 minutes.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

RECOGNITION OF THE MINORITY LEADER

The Democratic leader is recognized.

TRUMP ADMINISTRATION

Mr. SCHUMER. Mr. President, yesterday, something happened in America that should send a chill down the spine of every American. A grand jury rejected the Justice Department's attempt to indict six Democratic lawmakers over a video they posted telling military members not to follow illegal orders.

The President of the United States tried to use prosecutors to silence the free speech of sitting elected lawmakers because he didn't like what they said. That is a line no President—no President—in modern American history has ever crossed.

The video in question broke no laws. It simply urged members of our military to refuse unlawful orders, to honor the Constitution above any individual. What these Members of Congress said was not radical. It is embedded in the oath every servicemember takes. The only "crime" committed here was refusing to bend the knee to Donald Trump. And when this administration tried to dress up retaliation as prosecution, a grand jury of Americans rejected it.

Today, I just want to say how proud and grateful I am for my colleagues Senators SLOTKIN and KELLY, as well as Representatives CROW, DELUZIO, GOODLANDER, and HOULAHAN. The entire Democratic caucus is proud of them—proud of their courage, their poise, their loyalty to our democracy and to our Constitution. Senate Democrats will not let this witch hunt go unanswered. The American people deserve to know whether prosecutorial power was misused—abused—for political ends.

And I say to my Republican colleagues: If the executive branch can merely attempt to prosecute Members of the legislative branch for simply exercising free speech, that is not a Democratic problem or a Republican problem; it is a constitutional crisis. If Republicans believe in the Constitution, if they believe in separation of powers, now is the moment—if there ever was one—to prove it.

Yesterday, the Constitution held because ordinary citizens in a grand jury upheld it. They upheld it when this administration refused and when Senate Republicans remained silent.

But we should not confuse failure with intent. Yes, this indictment failed, but the mere fact that it was even attempted is alarming. This in-

dictment was a test—a test of whether Federal prosecutors could be weaponized to become political henchmen, a test of whether dissent could be smeared as criminality, a test of whether fear could suffocate freedom. That test should make our bones tremble.

Today, it was six Democrats. Tomorrow, it could be anyone—because if a President believes that he can even attempt to jail Senators over speech he dislikes, then the First Amendment is no longer a basic right. It becomes a privilege, one that some Americans get to have and others don't, depending on their political views.

And what would that mean for every journalist, every protester, every citizen who dares to dissent? It would mean more jailings, more investigations, more masked agents beating up unarmed, peaceful protesters in the streets. It is happening already, and if we don't halt it, it is going to get a lot worse.

The First Amendment is not optional. It doesn't depend on your political views, and it is not subject to the personal sensitivities of any President.

Finally, the failure of this indictment does not erase what it represents: a President willing to test whether the criminal justice system can be weaponized against his political democracy—something that, if he succeeded, would stab a dagger through the heart of this democracy and all it represents. The Founders wrote our Constitution precisely to prevent the kind of abuses Donald Trump and his Justice Department are doing. Thank God—thank God—that, today, the Constitution held firm. But we cannot always assume that that will be the case if we aren't willing to defend it.

So I am proud of Senators KELLY and SLOTKIN. I am proud of Representatives CROW, DELUZIO, GOODLANDER, and HOULAHAN. They stood by their oath. Now, this Chamber must stand by ours.

It is a very good thing that these indictments failed, but these indictments go way beyond six Members of Congress recording one video. Donald Trump has declared war on free speech in America—the wellspring of our democracy, free speech—and he is using the vast powers of the Federal Government to go after anyone who tries to stand up to him.

To my Republican colleagues: Silence in moments like this is not neutrality. It is permission. It is submission. It is acquiescing to the possibility that our democracy may be dying.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Illinois.

Mr. DURBIN. Mr. President, let me associate myself with the remarks of the minority leader, Senator SCHUMER.

What happened yesterday in the courts of the District of Columbia was, on one side of the equation, frightening and, on another side, encouraging—frightening that any administration would think that they can quash the

free speech of Members of Congress, that they can be indicting people and charging them with crimes for simply speaking out as an elected Member of Congress.

Like Senator SCHUMER said, there is no precedent that I can think of in American history. There has never been a President who used the Department of Justice to quiet Congress in this way. We have gone through many events in the history of the United States that are earth-shattering—the Civil War being the worst—but we have never seen this happen.

The fact that the grand jury of residents in the District of Columbia stood up and rejected this indictment of two Senators and several Members of the House is proof positive that people still understand the basic values of our Constitution. And one of them is our freedom of expression, freedom to speak, freedom to express our point of view. They stood up yesterday in an extraordinary fashion.

Why did it ever reach this point that the U.S. attorney for the District of Columbia tried to quiet Members of Congress because of the objection of the administration to what they were saying? This was a test. I hope it was the last test. We shouldn't be so naive as to believe it is. It is up to us, Democrats and Republicans—for the good of the Congress and the value of the Constitution—to stand behind those Members who are exercising their rights as elected Members of Congress.

Mr. President, 2 weeks ago, in another event which is worth noting, the FBI descended on Fulton County, GA, to seize hundreds of thousands of ballots from the 2020 Presidential election. Reports indicate President Trump personally ordered the Director of National Intelligence TULSI GABBARD, a prominent 2020 election denier, to go to Georgia for the raid. The President then spoke directly to the FBI agents who conducted the raid.

To state the obvious, it is completely, completely inappropriate for the President and the Director of National Intelligence to be personally involved in a domestic criminal investigation, but Attorney General Pam Bondi has allowed the President to weaponize her Department and Federal law enforcement to pursue his personal and political goals.

Why did they target Fulton County? It is notorious because this jurisdiction has been at the center of President Trump's false and baseless claims concerning so-called fraud in the 2020 election, an election he still refuses to acknowledge and concede. I remember well that recorded conversation on the telephone between the President of the United States Donald Trump and the Georgia secretary of state. It was in early 2021. And President Trump directed the Georgia secretary of state to "find" the 11,780 votes he needed to swing the election his way. He said it. Those were his words, his voice.

And I remember when he incited a mob of his most ardent supporters to

storm this very Capitol, this very Senate Chamber, to subvert the will of the people and overturn the results of a free and fair election.

He failed. But now his endgame for 2026 has become clear. He is working to rewrite the rules of the game and to rig the system to ensure that he maintains his grip on power, beyond the reach of the American people in a free and fair election.

Don't believe me? Think about the past. Last year, in the spirit of this order to Georgia officials to find 11,780 votes, President Trump demanded that the State of Texas find him five more congressional seats before voters headed to the polls this coming November. Donald Trump demanded Republicans in the Texas Legislature gerrymander five red seats in a redistricting scheme so that he could cut his losses—literally—and hold onto the House after the upcoming midterm. In the meantime, the administration has deployed thousands of immigration enforcement agents to cities like Minneapolis and Chicago, cities in States that did not vote for President Trump.

I never thought I would witness an America where masked Federal agents in military tactical gear violently arrest innocent Americans because of the color of their skin—the so-called Kavanaugh stops—an America where citizens like Chicagoan Marimar Martinez can be shot five times by Federal agents with impunity and be branded falsely as a domestic terrorist.

Thankfully, unlike Renee Good, Alex Pretti, and Silverio Villegas Gonzales, Ms. Martinez survived and testified 2 weeks ago.

DHA has directed immigration agents to crash down the doors of our private homes to arrest people without any judicial warrant, in blatant disregard of the clear language of the Fourth Amendment.

In the wake of this immigration enforcement surge and the ensuing chaos, Attorney General Bondi had the nerve—the nerve—in a letter to Minnesota Governor Tim Walz, to offer him a reprieve. All he had to do was to turn over the voter files of his State. Thankfully, he refused. An attorney from the State described it as a “ransom note” from the Attorney General.

If you are Donald Trump, you want these voter rolls to push unwarranted purges and disenfranchise voters—especially voters who are unlikely to support you in the next election. In fact, the Justice Department has now sued dozens of States for their voter rolls.

All of this is textbook authoritarianism, vintage fascism, and I fear the President of the United States is working to rig the system to ensure the Republicans never lose another election. Has that thought crossed their minds? Listen to what Trump ally Steve Bannon said last week:

We're gonna have ICE surround the [polling places]. . . . We'll never again allow an election to be stolen.

You heard that right. Donald Trump and his allies want to deploy militarized agents to polling locations to intimidate and deter Americans from actually voting.

In deploying ICE and attempting to deploy the National Guard, Trump has already established a precedent for a paramilitary force that answers only to him patrolling our streets.

Last week, Trump said the quiet part out loud. Here is what he said:

The Republicans should say, “We want to take over. We should take over the voting in at least . . . 15 places.” The Republicans ought to nationalize . . . voting.

Those are the words of Donald Trump.

Article I of the Constitution and decades of Supreme Court precedent make it clear that the President cannot take over the administration of elections from the States.

I am old enough to remember when Republicans actually cared about the Constitution and the concept of federalism.

Imagine for a moment if Barack Obama or Joe Biden had called for nationalizing elections and told Federal agents they can raid private homes without judicial warrants of approval.

The President's aims are clear: He wants to make the case for the Big Lie that the 2020 election was stolen from him so he can assuage his fragile ego and justify directly interfering in the 2026 and 2028 elections.

Republican Senators won't speak up, but the American people at the polls will. In the streets of Minneapolis and Chicago and in the Halls of the U.S. Capitol, we hear their voices. We will do everything in our power to save our democracy from a President with such disdain for our Constitution and our democracy.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Hawaii.

Mr. SCHATZ. Mr. President, where is the redline? You know, a lot of us wake up every day trying to figure out, exactly how bad is it? Is this the moment that Republican Members of the U.S. Senate are going to stand up for not our rights but their rights and not just U.S. Senators but everyone who put us in office?

Last night, there was a failed indictment of two U.S. Senators, and the indictment—we don't know what they were charged with, but it was about a 90-second video in which they reiterated the guidance from the Uniform Code of Military Justice.

By the way, even if you don't like what they said; even if you thought it was unwise, what they said; even if you thought it was provocative, what they said, it was not illegal. They have a perfect right under the Constitution, the First Amendment, to express themselves. That is not illegal. That is not seditious. That is not worthy of a court-martial. That is literally them doing their jobs. You can criticize them in the manner in which they do

their jobs, but you may not incarcerate them.

In addition to the First Amendment, they have specific constitutional rights for Members of Congress under the speech and debate clause. In other words, if you are doing something as a U.S. Senator—and they very clearly were—you have additional protections. Why does that matter? Not because we are overly concerned with 100 of the most privileged people on the planet but because this place represents U.S. citizens who put us all into office, and then we get to say what we want.

So I ask my colleagues, where is the redline? Apparently not this one. Why?

I have had several interactions with my Republican colleagues, and it basically comes down to “Well, the system held. This was a failed indictment.”

So here is my question for my Republican colleagues: What if it is successful? What if Pam Bondi instructs Jeanine Pirro to try again and again and again until they perp-walk ELISSA SLOTKIN and MARK KELLY and incarcerate them? Is that your redline?

It is not obvious to me that anybody has even contemplated where exactly the line is. For me, it has been crossed. For me, it has been crossed. But I just ask my colleagues, do you even have a line? Is there some Rubicon that, if they cross it, you will say “My God, I don't want to speed-run this place into turning into Belarus”?

It is not that important to have this job if what it means is we are collapsing American-style democracy on purpose. And whatever irritation I have with another Member from another party at what they said or did, that is not illegal, and they should not be incarcerated.

The fact that they failed in their attempt to incarcerate a U.S. Senator should not obviate our outrage. They tried to incarcerate two of us.

I am not entirely sure that the U.S. Senate can survive this if we do not have Republicans standing up for our most basic principles.

Tomorrow night, very likely, a bunch of people are going to go to the Munich Security Conference, and on a bipartisan basis, they are going to say: American-style democracy is still intact. Look at this bipartisan coalition. We still want to be part of the world. We still want to be engaged with Europe. We still want to protect democracies.

They are going to say nothing about the fact that the President tried to jail one of us.

So spare me the high-minded panel discussions and bilats and press availabilities about the United States as the indispensable Nation when we are dispensing with our most sacred constitutional obligations.

You know, now it was a long time ago, but it feels like yesterday that I was first sworn in right in that corner. I don't remember exactly, but you swear an oath to the Constitution and laws of the United States of America

and that you take that obligation freely and without any mental reservation or purpose of evasion. And I am afraid we are evading our most fundamental responsibilities.

So I don't have any illusions that this speech is going to change everybody's mind, but I would just start the dialogue. What is it going to take for you to say enough is enough? I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from New Jersey.

Mr. BOOKER. Mr. President, I had a sleepless night last night as I put together in my mind where I think we are as a nation right now. We are a nation that, looking across our great land, showed unequivocally that we are in crisis. We are in a constitutional crisis.

From people in our communities to people in this body, we are seeing grotesque—grotesque—attacks on our most sacred constitutional principles.

As I sat last night, I found myself scrolling through words of our Founding Fathers, and something Madison said really stuck out to me: that power needs to be checked; power needs to be balanced; power derives its right from the consent of the governed, but power itself does not self-correct.

I look at what is happening from the executive branch and see over and over again grotesque violations of our Constitution, and this body is doing nothing. The list of what is happening is clear. It is actually making headlines. It is not something that can be ignored.

When you see the President of the United States taking power from the people, taking power from the executive, resisting the power of the judiciary, breaking the rule of law and nothing happens, it reminds me of Frederick Douglass: Find out just what a people will submit to, and that is the exact amount of injustice that will be heaped upon them.

Well, what are the constitutional ruptures we are seeing so clearly right now? Well, we have seen them with the President's grift, graft, and corruption.

I said this to some of my colleagues earlier: If a headline had appeared a few decades ago of a President of the United States and a sheik coming together days before he ascends to the Presidency, where that sheik is giving him tens of millions of dollars in what amounts to a direct payout, enriching him and his family in a trumped-up crypto scheme—that is clearly seen by our Founders as a breach of the Constitution in a clause called the emoluments clause.

This President is using his position to profit off of as he oversees foreign policy, and we are seeing leaders come to him and give him millions of dollars, as they have foreign policy considerations before them. That is a rupture of the Constitution.

What is another example? We are literally seeing people in the streets in Minnesota, exercising their constitu-

tional right to protest, their constitutional right of speech, their constitutional right to hold law enforcement accountable, for doing nothing wrong but filming law enforcement—how many of us have seen the videos of people filming law enforcement and getting beaten, getting literally kicked, getting handcuffed, being put in jail, or the worst of all constitutional violations is when you attack someone's life, as we saw with Alex Pretti being murdered.

We see more ruptures to our Constitution—not just the oppression of the basic rights of our people but that other sacrosanct right that our Founders saw when it comes to the right to vote.

We have a President saying literally that the Constitution should not apply, that we should federalize elections. You see the President sending his Justice Department not to investigate the last election or the election before that—not the election he won but going back to 2020's election and seizing private voting records that belong to the State, in a claim that has been proven wrong over and over again that there was some kind of election fraud—the Big Lie, as it is called. That, too, is a rupture of our Constitution.

He is violating voting rights. He is violating speech rights. He is violating the freedom to protest your government. He is violating the emoluments clause. He is violating the powers of the legislative branch as he stops funding that was approved in a bipartisan way in this body, like he just did in my State with the biggest infrastructure project there is.

Again and again and again, this President is violating our Constitution.

From, literally, agents masked jumping out of unmarked cars, going into our churches, going into our schools, this President violates our Constitution over and over and over again.

But here is a truth spoken when constitutional rights were violated against an activist named Angela Davis—that this body is now seeing clearly what James Baldwin wrote. You see, the truth of our land has always been “injustice anywhere is a threat to justice everywhere,” as Martin Luther King says. As the great Langston Hughes wrote in poetry, “There's a dream in the land, with its back against the wall . . . To save the dream for one,” you must save the dream “for all.”

Well, here are the rights. Here is the sacrosanct document that we swear oaths to—the Constitution. Here is the truth that the injustices you are seeing and the violations will be visited upon this body, because, as James Baldwin wrote so clearly, if they come for you in the morning, they are going to come for me at night.

Well, we have now seen, last night, that they are coming for Members of this body, and no, I am not talking about House Members like LAMONICA MCIVER, who has been thrown out, handcuffed, and is on trial right now.

No, I am not talking about ADAM SCHIFF, who was investigated for trumped-up charges. No, I am not talking about ALEX PADILLA, who was thrown to the ground and handcuffed in a Federal building. No, I am talking about my colleagues ELISSA SLOTKIN and MARK KELLY, who literally quoted military manuals that say it is illegal to follow unjust and illegal laws—that they have a right to not follow unjust, illegal orders—literally quoting what is the law of the land.

And what did this out-of-control Executive do? What did this out-of-control Executive do—an Executive that has already reached and taken away the power of the purse; an Executive that has already violated court orders that we have seen come from the highest office in the land, the Supreme Court; an Executive who has violated the emoluments clause; a President who brags about taking away States' rights to control their own elections; a President that has violated the law, time and time again? What did he do with his Justice Department? He called together a grand jury, used officials from our Justice Department that should be keeping us safe—used them to go after two Members of this body in an attempt to criminally charge them for their constitutional rights, protected in the Constitution, the speech and debate clause.

There are books that have been written—from “On Tyranny” to “How Democracies Die”—long before this administration, that predicted that this country's real threat will not be from some foreign enemy; it will be from internal corruption that goes unchecked—that this Nation's real threat is not from any adversary that cannot beat this Nation, this mighty country. The real threat to this Nation is when the Constitution we swear an oath to is eroded and the people with the power to stop it do nothing.

That is how great nations have fallen in the past, not from those who violate the Constitution, who violate the rule of law, who violate the freedom of the people. Nations fall when the people that have the power to do something about it remain silent, sit on the sidelines, remain quiet, or submit to the will of an out-of-control Executive.

The road to hell is paved with people who have the power to stop bad things from happening but say nothing. Our constitutional norms, the laws of our land, and the principles upon which we stand are being violated every week in our Nation. Americans are being swept up off of our streets. Americans' freedom of speech, Americans' privacy, the lives of American citizens are being taken—

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator's time is expired.

Mr. BOOKER. Even people in the Senate being arrested, and so now I say unequivocally—

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator's time is expired.

Mr. BOOKER. I ask unanimous consent for 2 more minutes. Is there an objection?

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there an objection?

Without objection, it is so ordered.

Mr. BOOKER. In this body, I see cowardice now. I see people afraid that the President will retaliate against them if they stand up and say something.

Well, Thomas Jefferson said clearly: When the people are afraid of government, there is tyranny. When the government is afraid of the people, there is liberty.

We have a President that calls people up and threatens to run primaries against my colleagues. We have billionaires that say: I will put \$21 million in opposition if you don't submit to the unconstitutional actions of the Executive.

Two of our colleagues, arrested for their free speech—a grand jury summoned to try to arrest them for their free speech, and I hear silence.

We are in a constitutional crisis. The silence is complicity. The failure to stand up and speak up is an insult to our ancestry. We are in a moment of crisis. I fear for this body. I fear for this institution. I fear for our Constitution.

But I still have faith in the people. We can stop this erosion of our constitutional norms. We can stop this democratic backsliding. We can protect our rights and our values. But more people need to speak up. And it is a shame upon this body that those who have power and position now do nothing.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Connecticut.

Mr. MURPHY. Mr. President, the tendency here in the Senate often, when Democrats are lodging a complaint about Donald Trump, is for our Republican colleagues to issue an argumentative equivalency: Well, Donald Trump did this, but so did Joe Biden. Donald Trump did that, but Joe Biden did this.

We are at a moment today, though, in which there is no argument of equivalency. And, in fact, over and over again in the past year, we have seen threats to our democracy that have no historical precedent.

We must be able to agree that never before in the history of the Senate has a President of the United States sought to jail Members of this body based upon their political opposition to the President of the United States.

All that our colleagues did was record a video in which they simply repeated the law of the land, the existing military code. They said things into a camera that the current Secretary of Defense has said himself, almost verbatim.

But because he was reciting, because she was reciting a portion of the military code that the President objects to, because it was inherently a criticism of the President, they are now facing down possible indictment.

It doesn't really matter that the grand jury refused to indict because, if they continue to come back over and over again for an indictment, they will likely find, at some point, some compliant grand jury, and we will find our colleagues headed to jail simply for exercising their free speech.

Never before in the history of our country has something like this happened. And I understand that for all of us who have grown up in a relatively safe and secure American democracy, contested by foreign adversaries but never under any real threat that we were going to lose the democracy from within, we have come to believe some sense of inevitability about the survivability of American democracy.

But every civilization, every form of government, has an expiration date. Every attempt at republicanism or democracy, over the course of this globe's history, has ended, and ours will end at some point. Our job as Senators, whether you have an "R" after your name or a "D" after your name is to make sure that that end doesn't happen on our watch.

And at some point, you have to look at the series of exceptional, unprecedented events that have happened in the last year and see them as part of an unprecedented, ahistorical pattern.

I agree with my colleagues. Long ago, in my mind, we crossed the redline. But think about it, if the shoe were on the other foot. I want my Republican colleagues to think about what you would say if a Democratic President opened up a criminal investigation into the Chairman of the Federal Reserve simply over a dispute over interest rate policy.

What would my Republican colleagues say if a Democratic President deployed the National Guard against a Republican State like Texas or Louisiana? Would our Republican colleagues think it was a redline if Sean Hannity was taken down, off the air, by a Democratic President's FCC? What would Republicans say?

Would it be a confrontation with American democracy if journalists were removed from a Democratic President's Pentagon because of their critical stories about the Democratic administration's policy?

Would Republicans think there was a problem if universities were denied funding because they weren't hiring enough liberal, leftwing professors? How about if a Democratic President confiscated ballots in one of your States so as to prove that Donald Trump didn't really win the election—that it was fraudulent?

Or what if he indicted or attempted to indict two of your Members, two Republicans, simply because they had raised their voices in objection to a Democratic President's policies?

We all know the answer to every single one of those questions. If a Democratic President had done any of those things, you would be shutting down the U.S. Senate. You would be labeling

each and every one of them as a potentially existential threat to our democracy, and you would use every lever available to you to try to confront that abuse of power.

There is no equivalency argument. President Biden didn't do any of the things that I just listed. And, yes, I know my Republican colleagues have objections about the way that he used the Department of Justice, objections about the things he said about Republicans, but never, never were Republican Senators facing a grand jury, the threat of indictment hanging over their heads simply because they spoke truth that a Democratic President objected to.

At some point, this democracy will die, and our purpose here is to improve the quality of life for our constituents but to protect the democracy at all costs. There has to be a bipartisan response to the broad abuses of power but, specifically, right now, to the fact that two of our colleagues are on the verge of being arrested by this President simply based on their political opposition to the President.

This is a moment where we could decide to agree. Not everything has to be skins and shirts. Not everything that we think has to automatically be wrong. We could very easily decide this week that it is not acceptable for the President of the United States to attempt to throw into jail his political opponents in the Senate and in the House.

And maybe that could provide a springboard for us to decide that there are other abuses of Presidential authority that may, in the long run, harm both Republican and Democratic interests but fundamentally harm the health of our democracy, and that we could join together in league against as well.

This is a moment of test for the Senate. I agree with my colleague Senator SCHATZ. This is a moment that could break this institution permanently if it is only Democrats standing up here and defending our colleagues.

It should matter first that they are Senators, that they were elected by the people of their State to represent Republicans and Democrats in their State. It should matter second the party that is listed after their name.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. SCHMITT). The Senator from Louisiana. Mr. KENNEDY. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent for an additional 15 minutes to make my remarks.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

APPROPRIATIONS

Mr. KENNEDY. Mr. President, I want to spend a few minutes talking about a couple of different topics.

First, I want to try to explain to the American people what is going on around here. Some people are going to try to tell you American people that what we are engaged in is a rational discussion of how to use scarce taxpayer dollars to fund the Department

of Homeland Security. That is not true. I wish it were.

The Department of Homeland Security is about to shut down. We don't know how to get it back open. What does that mean? It means ICE will be shut down. We have some ideas about how to keep that operating. They have enough money. It means TSA will be shut down. They are not going to be paid. That will impact airport travel. The Coast Guard will be shut down. FEMA—God help us if we have a natural disaster—it will be shut down.

What is about to happen is top-of-the-list, king-of-the-hill, A-No. 1 stupid. And it is happening not just because of policy, it is happening because of raw, gut politics. If you could see what I see, your gag reflex would be permanently triggered.

Here is what is going on: The Karen wing of the Democratic Party is in control of the Democratic Party and the Karen wing of the Democratic Party—not all Democrats, but there is clearly a Karen wing; sometimes I call them the loon wing—they have gone to Minority Leader JEFFRIES and my friend Senator SCHUMER and said: Don't you vote for that Homeland Security bill.

Why? Because the Karen wing of the Democratic Party wants to defund ICE.

We have seen this vampire movie before. The Karen wing of the Democratic Party also wanted us to defund the police. How did that work out for us? Criminals are still laughing. Now, they want to defund ICE.

Senator SCHUMER and Minority Leader JEFFRIES—two good men—they made a bunch of unreasonable demands that no person with a brain above a single-cell organism would vote for. It would put handcuffs on ICE. That is just a fact and they know that. I am not going to vote for them. I am certainly not going to vote for them with a gun to my head.

But I will tell you the reality. We could go to Senator SCHUMER and the minority leader in the House and say: OK. We accept every one of your conditions. The Democrats still are not going to vote to keep DHS open. I mean, I don't blame Senator SCHUMER for trying, but he is kind of wandering around here like one of those Roombas. He looks like a man who has lost his luggage at the airport. I mean, he is making these demands, and if we accepted them—we are not—but if we did, he couldn't deliver the votes because nobody on my side of the aisle wants to defund ICE, and that is what this is all about.

Some of my colleagues are trying to pretty it up. Lots of play-acting. They might be a little late for getting their name in for the Academy Awards, but maybe next year. They are trying to muddy the water and make it look deep, like we are having this discussion about efficiencies at the Department of Homeland Security.

Nope.

Very simple. The Karen wing of the Democratic Party has told every single

Democrat: If you don't vote to shut down DHS and if you do vote to fund ICE, we will punish you politically the rest of your natural lives.

That is why we are about to have a shutdown. This stuff isn't complicated. Here is what I think most Americans believe: Illegal immigration is illegal.

Duh.

If none of us is above the law—I believe that, and I bet you believe that—if no one is above the law, how come people in our country illegally are above the law? Immigration statutes are not some second-tier laws that you can violate without consequence. It is the law. If you don't like it, change it.

I believe in enforcing our immigration laws. Now, how you enforce them matters. By God, you better believe it matters. Those laws have got to be enforced in conformity with equal protection and with due process and in accordance with standards set forth by the U.S. Supreme Court—I think it was 1968 and a very famous case called *Terry v. Ohio*. A cop can't stop you unless that cop has reasonable suspicion—not probable cause, reasonable suspicion—to believe that you have committed, are committing, or are about to commit a crime. It is not subjective. It is an objective standard.

Our cops—including, but not limited to our ICE officers—have to follow it. Now, you can protest. That is fine. That is your right to protest. You don't have a right to protest violently. You don't have the right to harass an ICE officer. You don't have the right to spit in his face. You don't have a right to threaten his children. You don't have a right to get his home address and go to his house and try to harass his family. You don't have the right to block the streets so the ICE officer can't get through. You don't have the right to kick out a cop's taillight. You don't have the right to go burn Christmas trees.

You have the right to protest, but not violently because you know what? Two reasons: Violence undermines the morality that you say your movement is built upon. Dr. King knew that. That is why he wanted nonviolent protests. Gandhi knew that. President Mandela knew that in South Africa. Violence undermines the morality that you say your movement is built on.

Now, there is a second reason that you can't protest violently. It is against the law, and it is bone-deep, down-to-the-marrow stupid. If you act like a butthead with a cop or an ICE officer, it is not going to end well. It is not going to end well.

Here is a little tip; it is free. Cops will leave you alone unless you do illegal stuff, and that is what this debate is all about.

I hope it gets worked out. I don't want to see flights stop. I don't want to see FEMA not be able to respond. I don't want to see the Coast Guard have to shut down. But the Karen wing of the Democratic Party is the cause of this, and they are going to have to ac-

cept the fact that the law is the law or they are going to have to get the votes to change it because the American people—the American people—see immigration like they see the front door of their home.

Most Americans lock their front door at night. Why do they do that? They don't lock their front door at night because they hate everybody on the outside. They lock the front door at night because they love the people on the inside and they want to know who is coming into and out of their home. That is the way the American people see our borders.

Legal immigration—great, we admit more people. More of our world's neighbors come to America and become part of us every year than any other country, and the whole world knows it. That is why everybody wants to come here. When is the last time you heard somebody trying to sneak into China? They want to come here. It is called legal immigration.

But you can't jump the line. You have to fill out the forms and be properly vetted. You can't just come in. President Biden didn't follow the law. That is why we are in this mess today. We don't know how many people he let in. I am not saying they were all bad people. I don't know them. That is the point. We don't know who they are. I don't even know the number—anywhere from 8 million to 15 million. Some of them were bad people. But we don't have the slightest idea who they are, and we don't know where they are. That is why we have the rule of law. And that is why we have ICE, and that is what is going on.

KREWE OF CARROLLTON

Mr. President, the second thing I want to talk about—I want to choose my words carefully here because I love Louisiana. Louisiana is a great State. I think God blessed Louisiana, and having blessed us once, God blessed us twice. We are located at the top of the gulf coast. Those of you who have been there know we are in the middle of the gulf's south. We straddle one of the mightiest rivers in the entire world. We have more oil and gas than most nations. We are experts in things like petrochemical manufacturing, oil and gas exploration, aquaculture, agriculture, education, healthcare. I could keep going—timber production.

My people are God-fearing. They are hard-working, and they are fun-loving. We are right next door to Texas. Texas gets a lot of good publicity. More power to them. But don't forget this: Texas is 5½ times bigger than Louisiana. We are 10½ times more interesting than they are.

So I love Louisiana. But sometimes, some of my people do dumb things. We are all human. But something just happened at Mardi Gras that turned my stomach.

Let me say that I love New Orleans. I used to live in New Orleans. I practiced law in New Orleans. I met my wife in New Orleans. I raised my son

for the first couple of years of his life in New Orleans. It is a wonderful city, and we have this tradition called Mardi Gras. It is not just 1 day; it is like several weeks, and people from the entire world come to celebrate this. Name me another city—any city—that just shuts down the entire city for 1 day in the middle of the week to just enjoy life. We celebrate together. Every race, every religion, every socioeconomic class—we are all together.

We have parades, and these floats are big floats. You know what I mean if you have been to New Orleans and have seen Mardi Gras, but if you haven't, these floats are big puppies. They are anywhere from, I don't know, 30- to 60-feet long, and they are tall; they are anywhere from 13 to 18 feet. And krewe members—each parade is organized by what is called a krewe. It is like a club. The krewe members ride on the floats. They throw beads and they throw toys and some of them throw coconuts to the crowd; and the crowds are lined up by the side of the street—8, 10, 12 feet deep—all flavors of humanity.

Throw me something, Mister.

Throw me something, Mister.

But if you are a float rider—I have only done it once—one of the first things you are taught is to be careful because these beads—maybe a single strand of beads is not that dangerous, but a lot of people on the floats throw beads in groups, and a coconut, whether it is a single coconut or several, I can tell you, are mighty missiles; so you are taught to be careful where you throw, and you try to throw it to people when they see it coming because, otherwise, if you get hit in the face with a bunch of beads or a coconut, you are going to get hurt; you can lose an eye. I have had it happen to me. It is dangerous, and they teach the float riders this.

Now, we have a lot of cops. We have to borrow some cops from some other counties—we call them parishes—to come help us because there are some jackaloons who misbehave at the parades, so we have a lot of our cops out. And I think it was this past weekend—I want to get the name right—that we had the Krewe of Carrollton that sponsored a float. They are wonderful people on the Krewe of Carrollton. It is one of the oldest krewes that we have. But there were some knuckleheads on one of those floats, and they were taking bunches of beads and trying to hurt the cops with them.

Now, the cops are not looking at the floats. The cops are looking at the crowds. The cops are watching the people to make sure they don't have too many cocktails and try to run in between floats and get run over, and the cops are watching the children because we have a lot of our kids—we bring a lot of our kids—so the cops are not looking. They are not going: Throw me something, Mister. They are doing their job. And 41 people on one of the Krewe of Carrollton floats were throwing beads and toys and other stuff and

were trying to hit the cops in the face. And it wasn't just one or two. It was disgraceful. The police had to shut down the parade. To their credit, they shut her down, and they pulled all 41 people off this float and said: You are out of here.

The cops did the right thing. It is embarrassing for me to have to say this, that this happened in my State, in my city, but it did.

Now, the mayor has issued a statement.

Thank you, Mayor.

I haven't heard the city council say a word—not a peep. That doesn't mean they haven't, and I apologize if I have missed it.

It is no secret that many of my people in New Orleans think that cops are a bigger problem than criminals. This is America, and you can believe what you want. A lot of people—we went through the “defund the police” jackassery, and a lot of my people in New Orleans—it is a sanctuary city. I know they say they are not, but most of my local law enforcement officials don't cooperate with ICE. They think the borders ought to be wide open. I don't. It is against the law. But this is America, and they can believe that—but you can't hurt cops. These 41 people, after receiving due process, if they did this, shouldn't just be disciplined with, “Oh, you can't ride next year.” They need to prosecute them, and the people of New Orleans need to demand it.

Acts have consequences, and you don't have the right to hurt cops just because you don't like them. I have said this many, many times. I get in trouble every time, but I believe it. If you hate cops just because they are cops, the next time you get in trouble, have at it. Call a crackhead, and see what happens. See if they will protect you.

So I am sorry this happened. I want to apologize to the people—to the good people—of New Orleans for these 41 skilletheades who did this, allegedly. I want to apologize to the people of America who have read about this and who saw it and who came down to love on my city some, but I don't want to ever see this happen again. Every one of those 41 people ought to be prosecuted, and they need to hide their heads in a bag for their entire prison sentences.

I suggest the absence of a quorum.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will call the roll.

The senior assistant legislative clerk proceeded to call the roll.

Mr. WYDEN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the order for the quorum call be rescinded.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

H.J. RES. 142

Mr. WYDEN. Mr. President, in a little bit, the Senate is going to decide whether or not to interfere with the tax policy decisions made by the elected representatives of the 700,000 people who live in the Nation's Capital. My view is, leave DC alone.

There are a lot of very good reasons to oppose this resolution. For one, anybody who listens to debates here in the Congress hears an awful lot of talk from the other side about States' rights—the importance of making policy decisions at the State and local level. This resolution is just another example of my Republican colleagues totally junking that proposition altogether to trample on the rights and priorities of people they don't even represent.

Second, if the Senate passes this resolution, it is going to mess up the tax filing season for thousands and thousands of residents of the city. The DC government is going to have to spend millions fixing that mess over the course of several months. So you can forget about all the speeches about good government and fiscal discipline when it comes to this resolution. It is undemocratic and wasteful.

And third—and here is the stunner—if the Senate passes this resolution, it would throw out two big anti-poverty programs that the DC area is implementing: a brand new child tax credit and a big expansion of DC's earned income tax credit. So the end effect here is thousands more kids living in poverty and higher rates of poverty overall in the Nation's Capital.

The elected representatives in DC looked at the city's big economic challenges—challenges made much worse by the Trump administration—and then they decided to shore up the city's fiscal health and bring down poverty at the same time.

I ask my colleagues on the other side: Who are you to overrule them?

Let's remember, if Congress sits back and leaves the District of Columbia alone, absolutely nothing changes for us, and absolutely nothing changes for the people we represent at home.

When it comes to making life better for our constituents, this is literally a waste of time. All this resolution does is stick it to a bunch of kids and families living in poverty, meddle with democracy in a city of 700,000 people, and waste millions of dollars by creating bureaucratic headaches out of thin air.

I urge my colleagues strongly to oppose this resolution.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Maryland.

Ms. ALSOBROOKS. Mr. President, I stand here in opposition to H.J. Res. 142.

DC passed a law last summer decoupling from certain tax provisions of the One Big Beautiful Bill Act. This decision was a targeted and time-limited move, instituted for 225 days, to evaluate revenue impact and determine which changes could be incorporated in a fiscally responsible manner.

DC's decoupling also does not alter or eliminate any Federal tax benefits enacted by Congress. Their law applies only to District taxes.

And it is not an action solely taken by DC. In fact, at least 13 States have

taken similar steps, and roughly 20 States require legislative review before implementation, rather than automatically adopting Tax Code changes.

And while some States decoupled entirely for 2025, DC only decoupled from 13 of the 84 tax provisions, with the possibility that DC could still implement some of what they decoupled from once they have finalized their review and determined the fiscal impact.

These moves are standard in State tax administration. They are consistent with States accounting for situations unique to them and their residents, making sure that implementation happens smoothly. They are done to make sure that taxpayers and the governments alike have some measure of certainty.

This resolution of disapproval would do just the opposite. It would cause significant uncertainty and chaos—not for the Federal Government. This resolution would have no effect on the Federal Government or Federal operations. The chaos would all be placed on DC.

This resolution would literally change the rules in the middle of the game, while taxpayers have already started filing returns. It would require revising tax forms and systems and could force taxpayers to refile returns. It would create confusion for families, businesses, and tax professionals. The chaos would result in a revenue loss of \$600 million over the next 4 years.

Because DC's law funds the District child tax credit and enhancements to DC's earned income tax credit, this resolution would hurt DC's admirable and groundbreaking effort to address child poverty and provide a boost to low-income residents.

And the fallout would not only impact businesses in DC but also spread to businesses in surrounding States like mine.

Adopting this resolution of disapproval would make us agents of chaos, and we would be breaking decades of precedent to do it. Congress has rarely, if ever, overturned District laws through disapproval resolutions, and Congress has never before reversed a District revenue-raising measure.

Our action would be so rare and so chaotic that it would have a damaging effect on DC's bond rating. Credit rating agencies have warned that congressional interference in local revenue decisions can weaken DC's credit standing and increase borrowing costs.

This goes against why we are here. We are not here to cause economic instability and hurt taxpayers. We are here to help.

This isn't about party line or ideology. DC's independent, nonpartisan chief financial officer has raised serious concerns about the instability that this would cause. DC's business community strongly opposes the resolution. Hospitals, realtors, builders, hotels, and major employers aren't making ideological calls, but pleas for certainty.

And every other State represented here, red and blue, including those

which went further in their own tax determinations, would be watching us set a new precedent—the possibility of their informed judgment being overriden by unnecessary Federal overreach, inviting chaos across their State lines.

For these reasons, I urge all of my colleagues today to join me in voting against this resolution.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. MULLIN). The Senator from Virginia.

Mr. KAINE. Mr. President, I rise today—and I know other colleagues have done the same—to talk about H.J. Res. 142, the resolution we will be voting on later. It is a resolution that would overturn a recent law passed by the DC City Council regarding local taxes.

I care a lot about this not just because Virginia is a neighbor to DC. But I have been a mayor and a Governor and dealt with local and State tax issues and the interplay between those issues and Federal taxation.

Last year, this body, with colleagues across the aisle carrying the ball, passed a large reconciliation bill, which included numerous changes to the Federal Tax Code. Now, everyone here is aware of this fact: that our system of federalism that is ingrained in our Constitution only gives us, in this body, authority over Federal taxes. The reconciliation bill didn't and couldn't change Missouri's State income tax, Virginia's State income tax, Oklahoma's State income tax, or local property taxes for cities in those States.

Some States, when there is Federal tax legislation that is passed, choose to align their State and local tax policies directly with Federal tax policy. That is called conformity. You make a change to the Internal Revenue Code, and some States choose—and it is their choice—to conform their own State tax code and even local tax codes with the Federal Tax Code. But other States choose—and, again, this is a choice—to decouple all or parts of their tax code. They may accept most of the Federal changes but decide to go their own direction in a couple of areas.

The important part is that this is part of a system of federalism, and it is a choice that States and localities get to make.

Blue and red States have made decisions to decouple in the aftermath of dealing with the reconciliation bill from last year. Alabama is a very red State. They decided to decouple their State tax system from some of the provisions in the reconciliation bill. My State, Virginia, made that decision. So did California. Altogether, now 19 States have affirmatively chosen to decouple some portion of their tax code from the tax changes that were made in the reconciliation bill. Another 20 to 30 States haven't yet made that determination; their State legislatures are grappling with it right now.

Look, if Kansas decides to lower State taxes for millionaires in a way

that Democrats disagree with, I can't, as a U.S. Senator, introduce and pass a bill that would stop them and force them to use that funding, say, for local schools instead. That is not in my power.

But because of the Home Rule Act, Congress has the ability to intercede in local laws passed by the District of Columbia. We could argue about whether that is a good idea or not. I actually think, as a former mayor and Governor, we shouldn't be interceding. The District of Columbia elects a city government—a Mayor and a city council—and we should in almost all instances, I believe, respect the wishes of those who live in DC and not impose our values on them—those of us who live in Virginia or Oklahoma or other States. I think that is the right rule, and I have long been a supporter of the District of Columbia having both self-government and representation.

The DC Home Rule Act was intended to serve as a pathway to allow them more freedom and authority to self-govern in relation to local affairs. It was a dramatic improvement over what came before. Specifically, it established the Mayoral position, a city council, and neighborhood commissioners that provide residents with direct representation on matters of local government.

Since the Home Rule Act was passed more than 50 years ago in 1973, Congress has respected the District of Columbia's authority and autonomy and rarely used this tool to overturn and nullify local matters. In fact, there have been only four instances in which this law has been invoked, and I believe this is the first time it has been invoked to challenge DC decisions about their own local taxes.

Remember, DC is not making a decision about the Federal Tax Code; they are making a decision about their own local taxes in a city council that is made up of people who have been elected by DC residents.

If we pass the resolution that is before the body, we would be telling the city that they have to adopt tax policies that have nothing to do with what their constituents, who elected their city council, want.

This would be about local taxes, not Federal taxes. DC residents have to pay Federal taxes in accord with the laws we pass here. So the matter we are contemplating on the floor is just interfering with DC's local taxes. We would be blowing a \$600 million hole in the District of Columbia's budget if we pass this.

Again, everyone in this body, all 100 Senators—we live elsewhere. We live elsewhere, but we would be blowing a \$600 million hole in the budget for the people who live in the District of Columbia if we pass this.

What did DC do? DC decided that they didn't want to conform their tax code to allow certain forms of accelerated depreciation for investments. Alabama actually made the same choice.

They didn't conform their tax code over a similar part of the tax code.

What did DC do instead? Instead of allowing this accelerated depreciation, DC decided that they would give a child tax credit to DC families. They viewed that as a more important thing to do with their local tax code than to do accelerated depreciation. I think that is a choice that makes perfect sense to me, and it certainly made sense to DC voters.

So the impact of this will not only be to blow a hole in the budget and to, mid-tax season, create chaos; it will also be to take away an important priority whereby DC has decided that they want to put dollars in the pockets of families with children to help them with the expenses of raising a child. This will cause confusion and cost the city millions in additional expenses in addition to the revenue effect.

I see my colleague from Virginia is on the floor, so I want to allow him to go quickly, but I do want to read a letter that has been written to the Senate by the DC business leadership. This is from the DC business and civic community—the Federal City Council, the Greater Washington Board of Trade, DC Chamber of Commerce, Apartment & Office Building Association, DC Association of REALTORS, D.C. Hospital Association, the building authority, Association of REALTORS, Hotel Association—a broad cross-section of the DC business community—and they have written a letter to us saying the following:

We write you, in unison, as representatives of the District of Columbia's business organizations, urging you to oppose the Joint Resolution of Disapproval H.J. Res. 142 . . . that would reverse the District's decision to decouple the local tax code from some provisions of the One Big Beautiful Bill Act.

A reversal of decoupling would create chaos in the middle of tax filing season. The District has already begun accepting and processing returns. It would take the DC government and private vendors months to adjust local tax administration. Filing deadlines would have to be pushed back to the Fall of 2026.

Local tax code decoupling from the federal tax code is not unique. Many states have also voted to decouple from provisions in the One Big Beautiful Bill Act, as they have many times in the past in response to federal tax changes.

I read the letter from the business community because I want to make clear to people: This is not just parents who want the child tax credit so that they can better afford to raise their children; it is also the business community in DC.

Those of us who live elsewhere have the ability to affect tax policy at the State and local level in our own communities. We shouldn't impose our values over the DC residents, who have elected a Mayor and city council who have made tax policy for them just as our own local and State officials made tax policy for us.

For that reason—both to not blow a hole in the DC budget, to respect the wishes of DC residents, to respect the

need for a child tax credit to support families, and to respect the wishes of the DC business community—I ask my colleagues to oppose the resolution.

With that, Mr. President, I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Virginia.

Mr. WARNER. Mr. President, I thank my friend the Senator from Virginia. He has laid out the elements, a lot of the tax reasons and business reasons.

I am going to be relatively brief since I know the floor got backed up today and I am imposing my time on the Senator from North Dakota.

I have a little unique view on this because I actually think I live closer to the District than anybody else, of the 535 Members of Congress. So my neighbors, my friends, my constituents work, visit, travel through the District all the time. Senator KAINE went through how this is going to hurt the District. I echo all of that. But it is going to hurt the region. It is going to hurt Virginia. It is going to hurt Maryland.

While I was going to go through all of the same details on decoupling and the 19 issues, I will move away from that and echo everything he said.

But I guess what I want to just spend a couple of minutes on is, why in the heck has the Trump administration been hitting the District of Columbia so unrelentingly?

Let's look back. Just as downtown was starting to recover from the pandemic, President Trump and DOGE began a wholesale assault on the Federal workforce. Thousands of Federal workers—people who go to local restaurants, go to DC businesses—were fired by the President or forced to take a buyout early.

We have seen as well that the President has taken a blowtorch to Washington's cultural treasures when he unlawfully—and I say this as a member of the Kennedy Center board—when he unlawfully put his name on the Kennedy Center and then acted surprised when groups around the country, artists around the country, said “I am not going to go to the Trump-Kennedy or the Kennedy-Trump Center” and started canceling their engagements. Then out of the blue comes a decision to shut down the Kennedy Center for 2 years—again, hurting not only the District but the whole region.

For those of us who visited the White House as tourists or as Senators, even under President Trump, where the East Wing—a stately East Wing—once stood, there is now a giant hole with a potential ballroom that I imagine, at the end of the day, may make the cost overruns at the Fed look tiny in comparison, at least on a percentage basis.

We saw last year, with the big bill—I will not call it by its chosen name—that the President and this administration have done so much to hurt the folks in DC at risk. You know, 38 percent of DC residents get their healthcare through Medicaid—more

than one in every three DC residents. Yet the Medicaid cuts that will come, interestingly enough, in November—after the elections—will literally put thousands and thousands of those residents off their healthcare.

Instead of allowing the District, as the Senator from Virginia said, to put that into child tax credits or other choices—with their own money—instead, the President has taken this money, frankly, for tax cuts for the wealthiest.

Now I won't go through all the details again, but \$658 million of DC residents' money paid in local taxes should not be taken away from the District. Remember, this comes on top of almost another billion dollars that the House tried to take away as well.

So why would this Congress arbitrarily just blow a big budget hole in the District's budget? Truth is, this city has already been under unrelenting assault by this administration. Matter of fact, as Senator KAINE said: So many—if this goes through—the amount of bureaucracy in terms of re-filing their taxes puts another burden as well.

So I join my friend Senator KAINE and I think all of us who care deeply about this region, this community. Please, let's deal with our own States. Let's not meddle in the District's business. Let's not grab close to \$700 million of DC taxes and punish this community one more time. I hope we are a better institution than that.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from North Dakota.

CRACK THE CODE 2.0

Mr. HOEVEN. Mr. President, I come to the floor today to discuss how in North Dakota we are building on the pro-energy policies included in the Working Families Tax Cut Act through an initiative that we call Crack the Code 2.0.

This effort is about strengthening our Nation's energy security, keeping electricity reliable and affordable, and ensuring that America remains energy dominant for generations to come.

More than 20 years ago during my time as Governor, North Dakota cracked the code for the first time and unleashed the shale oil revolution in the Bakken formation in North Dakota. This success story didn't happen in a vacuum.

We established the State's oil and gas research council. We worked with the North Dakota Geological Survey to identify new recoverable energy reserves. We put in place the legal, tax, and regulatory framework needed to encourage innovation and attract investment. This empowered oil producers to deploy the latest and greatest technologies to unlock energy reserves once thought unreachable.

This success transformed North Dakota into one of the top energy producing States in the Nation and helped make the United States the world's largest oil and gas producer. Today, we are working to crack the code again.

Through Crack the Code 2.0, we are bringing together our oil and coal industries by leveraging enhanced oil recovery—or EOR—using captured CO₂ from North Dakota's coal-fired powerplants to increase production from the Bakken oil formation.

This approach brings together two of our Nation's most abundant and strategic energy assets, our coal resources and our oil reserves, to achieve three goals:

First, double the oil recovery rate in the Bakken—double the oil recovery rate; extend the life of our baseload coal-fired powerplants; and deliver more affordable, reliable energy to American consumers.

Enhanced oil recovery is a proven technology that injects CO₂ to produce oil that would otherwise remain trapped underground. For the past 25 years, Dakota Gasification Company has captured and transported CO₂ for enhanced oil recovery in the Canadian Weyburn field. Matter of fact, I turned the crank on that pipeline back when we first started the project.

Now, we are working to advance EOR in unconventional shale formations like in the Bakken. And the Working Families Tax Cut Act provides the policy foundation to expand EOR opportunities in shale plays like the Bakken.

We worked with Senator BARRASSO and others, including the Presiding Officer, to ensure that the law aligns 45Q tax credits and properly recognizes that the utilization of captured CO₂ will work for EOR. Producers are recovering only between 5 to 10 percent of the oil in the Bakken and other shale plays, meaning billions of barrels remain untapped. The Bakken has already produced more than 5 billion barrels of oil, and enhanced oil recovery could unlock at least another 5 billion barrels of oil.

That is more than doubling the amount of recoverable oil from one of our most important energy formations. Doing so will help increase our energy independence and lower costs for American families.

To continue this effort, we convened a strategy session last year with Energy Secretary Chris Wright and North Dakota's energy leaders to develop our game plan for Crack the Code 2.0. Secretary Wright already knows North Dakota well, having pioneered technologies there that unlock the shale revolution in the Bakken.

Moving forward, we are working on a \$171 million effort with Secretary Wright, industry partners, and our State on a large-scale pilot project to advance the technical and commercial viability of EOR in the Bakken.

Crack the Code 2.0 is also about keeping the lights on and strengthening our electric grid especially as electricity demand continues to soar in the United States. North Dakota's coal-fired powerplants can provide a reliable supply of CO₂ that could be captured and put to productive use for EOR, creating a new revenue stream that helps keep

our powerplants operating long into the future.

This is vital because we can count on our baseload coal-fired powerplants to provide reliable electricity available 24 hours a day and in every type of weather conditions. This is not simply good for North Dakota; it is critical for the United States.

Every additional barrel produced at home reduces dependence on foreign sources, particularly from OPEC and adversaries like Iran or Russia. Every megawatt of reliable baseload power protects grid reliability and affordability.

Ultimately, energy is the key input to economic activity and greatly impacts our quality of life. And our Nation is fortunate to have abundant reserves of coal, oil, and natural gas. The first effort to crack the code on the Bakken helped make our Nation a global energy powerhouse and strengthened America's geopolitical standing.

Crack the Code 2.0 builds on this legacy, once again harnessing American innovation and unlocking energy resources that will support our economic and national security for decades to come.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Maryland.

Mr. VAN HOLLEN. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent to speak 10 minutes beyond my original time.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

H.J. RES. 142

Mr. VAN HOLLEN. Mr. President, so this is a really embarrassing moment for the U.S. Senate. It is a gross, gratuitous assault on the people of the District of Columbia, the people who live in our Nation's Capital.

And also, as I listen to the rhetoric around this, it is actually one of the most dishonest arguments I have heard in the U.S. Senate for a long time. That is saying a lot.

I also want to make clear from the outset that at a time when Americans in every State in the Union are feeling squeezed by costs and rising prices, this doesn't do a thing for any of the constituents of any Senator in this U.S. Senate—not a thing.

And it doesn't do a damn thing for the Federal budget. What it does is pretend to say that you are protecting the people of the District of Columbia because you are assuring that they will get the benefit of the President Trump so-called Big Beautiful Bill.

So with everything happening in this country, what we are doing here or what is being attempted here is to micromanage the government of the District of Columbia. This has nothing to do with Federal taxes—nothing.

The people of the District of Columbia are going to get the same Federal income tax form as people in every part of the country. I have the form right here that the people of the District of Columbia will fill out. It is a

1040. It has also got the additional deductions.

It has all the deductions that are in the so-called Big Beautiful Bill. They have got no tax on tips, no tax on overtime. The list goes on—qualified passenger vehicle loan interest deduction. So people who live in the District of Columbia will get this Federal tax form for their Federal taxes.

We can't change the Federal Tax Code for the people of the District of Columbia. They are going to do exactly what everybody else in the United States is doing.

And yet there are some who are pretending that somehow this is an effort to ensure that the people of the District of Columbia get the benefits of the changes to the Federal Tax Code. They are going to get whatever benefits people think are available under the Federal Tax Code.

The author of this resolution, who is on the Senate floor, has said:

... the D.C. Council's recent move that prevents federal tax laws under President Trump's Working Families Tax Cuts from going into effect for district residents.

That is not true. District residents are going to get the same Federal tax form as the constituents of every Senator in this body. Congressman GILL, one of the supporters of this resolution in the House says:

The DC Council's actions would block DC residents ... from receiving these Federal tax credits ... and from keeping their hard-earned money in their wallets.

Not true. Not true. They pay the same Federal income taxes and have the same Federal tax deductions as every other person in the country.

House Speaker JOHNSON said:

If this act were to become local law, D.C. residents would be prevented from claiming no tax on tips, no tax on overtime, the increased standard deduction, and so much more.

Not true. They are going to fill out the same Federal tax form as everybody else in the United States of America. So this is an example of complete false and deceptive advertising. What it is attempting to do, in reality, is not deny the District of Columbia benefits under the Federal Tax Code as they fill out their Federal tax forms, it is to prevent the people from the District of Columbia, when it comes to their local tax code, from having the autonomy that all of our jurisdictions have.

That is what it does. And the people of the District of Columbia, through their elected representatives, chose, with respect to their local tax law, to make some different decisions than under the Federal Tax Code. So, for example, they restored the District of Columbia's local child tax credit, and they increased the District of Columbia's existing earned income tax credit. In fact, they adopted 84 of the provisions that were passed through from the Federal cut. Just 13 of the 84 provisions were changed as a matter of local DC law.

So, for example, they decided that they could not afford to immediately

implement the ability of companies to fully expense their R&D costs. They concluded, they did an analysis that if you adopted that Federal provision and you put that also in your DC tax code, that the people of the District of Columbia—the District of Columbia would lose \$170 million.

As I said, they did choose to enhance their child tax credit, and so if you actually vote for this resolution on the floor of the Senate, you are going to increase taxes on 78,000 children. Families that represent 78,000 children in the District of Columbia are going to see their taxes go up if you pass this Republican resolution.

And, in fact, by increasing the child tax credit and taking measures on the earned income tax credit as a matter of local DC tax law, they are reducing poverty in the United States by 20 percent. So if you actually vote to overturn that, you are going to increase poverty in our Nation's Capital by 20 percent. It is insane what they are proposing.

So like many States, and I am going to point out some of the other States that decouple from the Federal Tax Code when it comes to their State or local taxes—like many States what the District of Columbia wanted to do was to at least temporarily decouple so that they could examine what impact the Federal tax law changes would have if they incorporated them directly into their local tax system. And they are not alone in doing that.

In fact, at least 13 States, represented by U.S. Senators in this body, have decoupled from some of the Republicans' reconciliation bill, tax bill. Those include the States of Alabama, Michigan, Illinois, and Virginia. And additionally, there are about 20 States, including Kentucky, Ohio, and Wisconsin, that do not automatically adopt changes to the Federal Tax Code as part of their State tax code. My State of Maryland doesn't automatically do it. Indiana doesn't do it.

In fact, if you look through the various States, you will find that many do not do it. Let's look at Alabama. It is under Republican control right now. They voted to actively decouple their State tax provisions from the Federal tax provisions. I don't see any Senator here on the floor trying to undo the State of Alabama's tax code.

Let's look at Kentucky law, and I am reading directly out of their statute.

FEDERAL TAX LAW CHANGES—Recent federal income tax changes were enacted after Kentucky's conformity date set forth in KRS 141.010(21).

Listen to this:

As a result, these federal changes do not apply to Kentucky returns. Items such as qualified tips, overtime income, and car loan interest are not deductible on the Kentucky return.

That is what the State of Kentucky is saying. Now, I am reading here from Senator SCOTT's office press release.

It reads: "Sen. Rick Scott Leads Resolution Overruling D.C.'s Move to Deny

Families and Businesses Trump's Historic Tax Cuts."

Again, that is simply not true with respect to Federal taxes. The District of Columbia can't change the 1040s, and they haven't tried.

But if you want to take this headline, you should add some other jurisdictions to this. So, for example, where is Alabama? Where is Kentucky? And the gross hypocrisy of Members of the Senate trying to change the law, the local tax law of the District of Columbia, duly enacted by their council and the Mayor, and not say a thing about States, including Republican States that have decoupled as well on certain provisions, is jaw-dropping.

It is also going to create havoc. And I want to emphasize the point that people have already begun to pay their—fulfill their forms, both the 1040s, which mirror exactly the Federal tax law, but also their DC tax forms.

And so if we pass this legislation, it is going to create absolute havoc in the District of Columbia, which is why the Chamber of Commerce of the District of Columbia is against it; firefighters are against it; the Mayor is against it. The DC Police are for this, but I want you to think about this: Our States make changes to their tax law. People come before the State legislatures, they argue for a change or against a change, and the State legislatures listen and they make the decisions. And that is what DC did.

And as I said, they chose to increase the child tax credit. You are going to take it away. They chose to reduce poverty in the District of Columbia. We are going to choose to increase poverty if we adopt this.

So there has been a lot of misinformation about this. And I just hope that before the final vote on final passage on this, people recognize that the headlines here have been incredibly deceptive because, I want to emphasize, again, this doesn't change one dime when it comes to Federal tax law. It is not going to have a single impact on the Federal budget.

It is not going to benefit anybody's constituents from this body—nobody's. It is going to hurt kids in the District of Columbia, and it is going to do to the people of the District of Columbia what we would never do to any of our own State legislatures, which is to decide that we are going to somehow throw out their State tax codes and substitute our own judgment instead.

As I said, this is really, really insane, and the way it has been marketed has been deceptive. And so I hope colleagues will look really closely at what we are about to vote on because it has come up very quickly, under expedited procedure. The Senate didn't even have to take this up.

I urge my colleagues to oppose this measure.

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. MORENO). The Senator from Florida.

Mr. SCOTT of Florida. I rise today to fight for working families and busi-

nesses. Congress is DC's legislative body. It says so right there in the Constitution, article I, section 8, clause 17 reads:

[The Congress shall have Power . . .] To exercise exclusive Legislation in all Cases whatsoever, over such District . . . as may . . . become the Seat of Government of the United States.

This means we have a constitutional responsibility to fight for those living here in our Nation's Capital, just like any legislator should fight for the people living in their State. That is why I am bringing this resolution to the floor today.

The DC City Council has decided to deny the people of DC the benefits we passed in President Trump's Working Families Tax Cuts Act. That is absolutely absurd.

These tax cuts, like the no tax on tips, no tax on overtime, and the senior tax deduction are especially helpful to families struggling to get by and those starting out, trying to make a better life for themselves.

It helps the thousands of service workers here in DC, the law enforcement that protects us every day, and the grandparents who are watching their grandkids while their children are at work. It lets them keep more of their hard-earned money. But the DC Council has decided to benefit from these people instead of helping them. They have decided they deserve these people's money more than the people do. This isn't right. Not only does this hurt people by preventing them from keeping more of their hard-earned wages, but it also hurts the economy. And it will end up hurting the city as a whole.

When I was Governor of Florida, I cut taxes over 100 times through tax cuts just like the ones in the Working Families Tax Cuts Act. As a result, we turned the Florida economy around. We added nearly 1.7 million private sector jobs. We paid down a third of the State's debt and actually invested a record amount back into communities and public services.

Instead of people leaving the State to find a job that allowed them to support their families and live their American dreams, families started coming to Florida to do just that. By cutting taxes and regulations and letting Americans keep more of their hard-earned money, we can turn this economy around just like we did in Florida. That is exactly what President Trump and Republicans are trying to do.

I meet with businesses and hard-working Floridians often. They talk about the impact no tax on tips and no tax on overtime are already having.

They talk about how they are able to plan for expansions and more hiring, creating more jobs that would support families and give back to their communities. This is the kind of growth and support that the DC Council has denied its citizens and small businesses. Biden's and Democrats' inflation-causing policies are still being felt, especially by those who are already struggling to make ends meet.

President Trump and Republicans are doing all we can to make things better, affordable, and lower costs for these American families. We do that by cutting taxes and regulations, not by denying people more of the money they have earned.

My resolution would reject this policy that would crush American families, workers, and businesses.

I urge my colleagues to do our constitutional duty to the people of DC and support this resolution.

DISAPPROVING THE ACTION OF THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA COUNCIL IN APPROVING THE D.C. INCOME AND FRANCHISE TAX CONFORMITY AND REVISION TEMPORARY AMENDMENT ACT OF 2025—Motion to Proceed

Mr. SCOTT of Florida. I move to proceed to Calendar No. 315, H.J. Res. 142. The PRESIDING OFFICER. The clerk will report.

The legislative clerk read as follows:

Motion to proceed to Calendar No. 315, H.J. Res. 142, a joint resolution disapproving the action of the District of Columbia Council in approving the D.C. Income and Franchise Tax Conformity and Revision Temporary Amendment Act of 2025.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The question is on agreeing to the motion.

Mr. SCOTT of Florida. I ask for the yeas and nays.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there a sufficient second?

There appears to be a sufficient second.

The clerk will call the roll.

The bill clerk called the roll.

Mr. BARRASSO. The following Senators are necessarily absent: the Senator from Wisconsin (Mr. JOHNSON) and the Senator from Kentucky (Mr. MCCONNELL).

Mr. DURBIN. I announce that the Senator from Washington (Ms. CANTWELL) is necessarily absent.

The result was announced—yeas 51, nays 46, as follows:

[Rollcall Vote No. 36 Leg.]

YEAS—51

Banks	Fischer	Moreno
Barrasso	Graham	Mullin
Blackburn	Grassley	Murkowski
Boozman	Hagerty	Paul
Britt	Hawley	Ricketts
Budd	Hoeven	Risch
Capito	Husted	Rounds
Cassidy	Hyde-Smith	Schmitt
Collins	Justice	Scott (FL)
Cornyn	Kennedy	Scott (SC)
Cotton	Lankford	Sheehy
Cramer	Lee	Sullivan
Crapo	Lummis	Thune
Cruz	Marshall	Tillis
Curtis	McCormick	Tuberville
Daines	Moody	Wicker
Ernst	Moran	Young

NAYS—46

Alsobrooks	Durbin	Kelly
Baldwin	Fetterman	Kim
Bennet	Gallego	King
Blumenthal	Gillibrand	Klobuchar
Blunt Rochester	Hassan	Lujan
Booker	Heinrich	Markey
Coons	Hickenlooper	Merkley
Cortez Masto	Hirono	Murphy
Duckworth	Kaine	Murray

Ossoff	Schiff	Wanock
Padilla	Schumer	Warren
Peters	Shaheen	Welch
Reed	Slotkin	Whitehouse
Rosen	Smith	Wyden
Sanders	Van Hollen	
Schatz	Warner	

NOT VOTING—3

Cantwell	Johnson	McConnell
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The motion was agreed to.

DISAPPROVING THE ACTION OF THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA COUNCIL IN APPROVING THE D.C. INCOME AND FRANCHISE TAX CONFORMITY AND REVISION TEMPORARY AMENDMENT ACT OF 2025

The PRESIDING OFFICER (Mr. JUSTICE). The clerk will report the joint resolution by title.

The senior assistant legislative clerk read as follows:

A joint resolution (H.J. Res. 142) disapproving the action of the District of Columbia Council in approving the D.C. Income and Franchise Tax Conformity and Revision Temporary Amendment Act of 2025.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Massachusetts.

UNANIMOUS CONSENT REQUEST—S. RES. 605

Mr. MARKEY. Mr. President, I rise today because, once again, the sitting President of the United States has threatened something antithetical to our democracy, something patently unconstitutional and unlawful, something that should give every single American pause. Donald Trump has now suggested that he might nationalize our elections. Trump has suggested that the Federal executive branch should take over elections, which, under our Constitution, belong to the States.

So let me be clear. This is not a policy disagreement. This is not a gray area. This is not a novel constitutional question. This is, flatly, outright, unquestionably, unconstitutional. The Framers could not have been more clear. Article I, section 4 of the Constitution places the times, the places, and the manner of Federal elections in the hands of the States, not in the hands of the President, not the White House, not in an Executive order. There is no clause in the Constitution or law on the books—none—that allows a President to commandeer State election systems—no emergency power, no implied authority, no “because I just say so.” The President’s role is to faithfully execute the laws, not to rewrite the Constitution when the facts or the voters displease him.

Yet here we are. Donald Trump’s dangerous threat rests on a familiar and thoroughly discredited premise that American elections are rigged, fraudulent, or illegitimate. That claim has been examined exhaustively and has been rejected everywhere it has been tested. State election officials—Republicans and Democrats alike—certified the results of the 2020 Presidential election. Courts across the country rejected claims of widespread

fraud. Federal judges appointed by Presidents of both parties dismissed these cases for a lack of evidence.

There was no stolen election. There was no massive fraud. There was no justification, then or now, for the Federal seizure of elections. To suggest otherwise is not really wrong; it is reckless. And it is exclusively intended, ultimately, for the President to take over the elections in November of this year so he can rig the elections so that Democrats cannot win the House and Senate. That is what is at the heart of what the President is trying to do.

What is most alarming is not just that Donald Trump spoke those words, but that so many congressional Republicans have refused to say plainly what the Constitution requires. Silence in the face of an unconstitutional power grab is not neutrality. It is acquiescence to the undermining of the U.S. Constitution. Our system of government depends on elected officials who are willing to say no, especially to a President of their own party when the Constitution is at stake.

The Founders divided power deliberately. They placed elections close to the people. They rejected centralized control because they understood that democracy cannot survive when the Executive controls the ballot.

That principle is not optional. It is structural. It is foundational. It is what the Founding Fathers built into the system to make sure that we did not have a King, that we did not have a Monarch. They built it in this way so that the representative government would be selected at the local level, that the elections would be conducted at the local level—no taxation without representation.

They were fighting to create a House and Senate. They were fighting to put checks on King George. They were fighting to make sure that ultimately no latter-day King George—King Donald—could emerge that would then seek to impose his will on the people.

And that is why we have a Senate. That is why we have a House of Representatives—no taxation without representation—ensuring that each community, each State, has their own representatives selected in elections conducted by the voters in that State, by the leaders in that State.

And if the President were to attempt by order, directive, or coercion to nationalize or commandeer State-run elections, that action would be unconstitutional; it would be illegal; and it would be without effect. It would be a violation of the Constitution.

And let me be clear about one final point: Such a brazen attempt would not merely be unlawful; it would also be impeachable. A President who seeks to seize control of elections is attacking the constitutional order itself, and that is precisely the kind of abuse of power for which impeachment exists, not as a partisan weapon but as a constitutional safeguard against the usurpation of the electoral process in our

country by a would-be King, Donald Trump.

That is what they were protecting against. They anticipated, in drafting the Constitution, the emergence of Donald Trump, the emergence of someone who said we should nationalize the elections, the emergence of someone who said that he could invoke the Insurgency act in order to put marines—an army—on the streets of America during election times in order to serve the will of the President so that he would not have the checks and balances of the leaders of the other party being able to control the gavels to be able to subpoena him.

So in a moment, I will seek unanimous consent to pass my resolution expressing the sense of the Senate on these indisputable points. President Trump cannot nationalize our Federal elections. Our Constitution prohibits it.

Our Constitution was established in order to make sure that a President cannot subvert elections at the State level. And if he tried to, he would be committing an impeachable offense against the Constitution of the United States, and he would have to have been tried then in the House and the Senate on that impeachable offense.

This resolution draws a bright line. It affirms what should never need reaffirming, that elections belong to the States, the Constitution belongs to the people, and no President—ever—stands above either.

The Senate should speak with one voice on this question tonight. The Constitution demands the Senate speak with one voice tonight. Democracy requires that the Senate speak with one voice tonight, that it is an impeachable offense to nationalize elections which the Constitution requires be conducted at the State level.

So with that, Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that the Senate proceed to the immediate consideration of S. Res. 605; that the resolution be agreed to, the preamble be agreed to, and the motions to reconsider be considered made and laid upon the table.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there an objection?

The Senator from Florida.

Mr. SCOTT of Florida. Reserving the right to object.

Mr. President, I rise today to object to the motion made by my colleague from Massachusetts.

We don't need to nationalize our elections. My Republican colleagues and I have been fighting Democrats' attempts to nationalize our elections for years now.

The States have the ability to run elections. My State of Florida is actually a leader in election security and timeliness to the point that my last election was called within minutes of polls closing.

My colleagues are only bringing this to the floor as an excuse to score political points by attacking President

Trump. President Trump and Republicans are working to deliver on our promises to the American people: securing our border, protecting communities and elections, and bringing down the cost of living despite Democrats fighting us on every turn. This is just another example of Democrat distraction, not serious policy, and for that reason I object.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The objection is heard.

The Senator from Florida.

Mr. SCOTT of Florida. If my colleague from western Massachusetts wants to defend democracy and protect elections, I offer him an alternative that I, and a majority of Americans, would support. There should be some commonsense, national standards in place to ensure Americans know their elections are free and fair and that their votes are not diluted. That includes requiring voter ID, something 83 percent of Americans support.

You need an ID to board an airplane, buy certain medicines, apply for jobs and bank accounts, check into hotels, rent a car, donate blood, and purchase a lottery ticket. Why should voting in our elections have a lower verification standard than purchasing a lottery ticket? Surely, we can also agree that requiring proof of citizenship makes sense. And if a State has a noncitizen on the voter rolls, they should be removed.

Now, the minority leader thinks that is racist to make people prove citizenship to vote. Just remember, every Member of this body and all of our friends in the House had to prove their citizenship to take office. Yes, even my colleague from Massachusetts had to prove he was an American citizen to take his seat in the U.S. Senate and represent the good people of his State.

So are the requirements for being elected to the U.S. Congress racist? I cannot imagine the Senator from Massachusetts believes that to be true. We are all here to represent U.S. citizens, and we should be certain that it is only U.S. citizens who are able to cast a vote for any of us to be here.

The SAVE America Act puts these commonsense ideas into place to make our elections more secure and fair. I invite my colleagues to support my UC and pass the SAVE America Act. Why wouldn't we want to make certain that elections in the United States of America are free and fair?

President Trump and the American people are all on board with the SAVE America Act. The House will pass it shortly. We can get this done today and deliver for the American people.

Passing the SAVE America Act is an essential step to our democracy, ensuring free and fair elections nationwide. We must get it done.

Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that upon receipt from the House, that the Senate proceed to the immediate consideration of the House message to accompany S. 1383; further, that the Senate concur in the House

amendment, and that the motion to reconsider be made and laid upon the table.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Is there objection?

Mr. MARKEY. Reserving the right to object.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Massachusetts.

Mr. MARKEY. The objection we just heard to my resolution proves exactly why this resolution that we should be debating is absolutely necessary in order to ensure that President Trump does not, in fact, nationalize—or attempt to nationalize our elections.

And this unanimous consent request is not about the SAVE Act. It is not about voter registration policy. It is not about partisan election administration debates. It is about something far more fundamental: whether the President of the United States may unilaterally nationalize elections that the Constitution places squarely in the hands of the States. Those are separate issues and no amount of legislative deflection can change that.

The SAVE Act that the gentleman from Florida is speaking to right now is a policy proposal, one that many of us oppose because it would impose rigid documentation requirements, disenfranchise eligible voters, burden State election officials, and do nothing—nothing—to address a problem that does not meaningfully exist.

But today, the resolution I am bringing out is not about that legislation. It is about constitutional limits on Presidential power. No act of Congress—the SAVE Act or otherwise—would give a President authority to seize control of State-run elections. That power does not exist; it cannot be created; and it cannot be exercised by Executive fiat.

So let us not confuse the issue, and let us not allow anyone to dodge it. The President suggested nationalizing elections. That suggestion is unconstitutional; it is illegal; and if acted upon, it would be grounds for impeachment. The Senate should be able to say that clearly without diversion, without delay, and without changing the subject.

I urge my colleagues: Do not silence or allow procedural maneuvering to excuse an assault on the very Constitution itself, and that is what the motion from the Senator from Florida is intended to achieve, and therefore, I object.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The objection is heard.

The Senator from Florida.

Mr. SCOTT of Florida. While I am clearly disappointed, this is the most commonsense bill there is.

So none of us get to vote for the President of France. I would vote for Macron, but I don't get to. Nobody that is not a U.S. citizen should be voting in our elections.

And we have to use ID for everything: Board a plane, get a lottery ticket, go to a doctor, they ask you for your ID. This is common sense. We don't want

any fraud in our elections. All we say is just show your ID when you go vote, make sure you are a citizen to register, show your ID to vote.

So I am disappointed that my colleague doesn't support this. I can't understand why he wouldn't support some commonsense standard like this, but I am going to keep working, and we are going to get this passed.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Senator from Vermont.

DEPARTMENT OF HOMELAND SECURITY

Mr. WELCH. Mr. President, we are 1 year into President Donald Trump's second term and 1 year into Secretary Kristi Noem's tenure as head of the Department of Homeland Security, which includes Immigration and Customs Enforcement, or ICE. It is time for us to assess and state with clarity what that 1 year has brought us.

First of all, the deportation policy is not now about border security—not now. The border is secure, and that is a good thing. Migrant crossings into the United States from Mexico are at their lowest level since 1970.

In August of 2024, during President Biden's administration, there were 107,000 encounters at the southern border, but in August of 2025, there were only 9,000. The border is much more secure. I support that. We must maintain it, and we will.

So is the deportation policy now about deporting criminals—something we support? There is evidence, and the evidence of what the policy is about comes from a Department of Homeland Security report itself. What it says is that 14 percent—only 14 percent—of the people who have been deported are dangerous criminals. No objection to deporting criminals, but that it is only 14 percent shows that the real purpose is to inflict on this country a policy of mass deportation.

And the Trump administration is as good as its word. From day one, with Stephen Miller, it has announced its intention to conduct mass deportation in the United States. It set quotas. It has moved away from focusing on people with serious criminal convictions, and instead, it is focused on getting the highest number of arrests and deportations as possible, up to 3,000 a day.

Homeland Security got \$75 billion from Congress—not from votes on our side. But it was really what allowed for this mass roundup of people from workplaces, from farms, from schools—all in service of a political agenda that is not about protecting Americans but is serving the political interests of the President and the fiendish design of Stephen Miller, with the implementation of a reckless Kristi Noem.

So if only 14 percent of those people deported are dangerous criminals, what are the others? It is about detaining and attempting to deport students who are here legally but said things that the President and the administration didn't like on a campus, folks who spoke out about the war in Gaza: Mohsen Mahdawi from Vermont,

Mahmoud Khalil from Columbia in New York City.

It is about deporting a student who wrote an article in a student newspaper criticizing the Israeli Government. It is about ripping a preschooler—preschooler—1,300 miles away from his home to sit in a detention facility, and it is about using him as bait to get to his family. That is happening.

It is about detaining a U.S. citizen at gunpoint, on that person's front porch, without any warrant to go there and then forcing him to go outside in sub-freezing weather wearing nothing but his underwear.

It is about detaining a churchgoer delivering groceries to his neighbors in freezing temperatures, and it is about denying him the necessary medication he needed after he had a kidney transplant, while he was in custody.

It is about a legal permanent resident, Donna Hughes-Brown. She was locked up for 143 days, threatened with deportation, because she did do something wrong: She bounced two checks that totaled 75 bucks over 10 years ago.

It is about Steven Tendo from Vermont, an asylum seeker and a pastor. He was arrested and detained outside the medical center in Shelburne where he works, and he said it was done brutally and it was done at gunpoint. This is not a threatening man. He is currently now being denied medication for his diabetes.

ICE is in such a rush to meet its quotas set by Secretary Noem and Mr. Miller that they are literally grabbing anyone and everyone they set their eyes on. What is their accent? What is their color? Where are they located? And ICE does not care who gets hurt in the process.

Wilmer Chavarria is a U.S. citizen, and he is the superintendent in the Winooski School District in Vermont. He was detained and questioned for hours by agents in Texas. His technology was seized and searched. He described this as “the definition of psychological terror.”

A 21-year-old man protesting in California was blinded in his left eye. He told the AP after this he was “just glad” to be “alive to tell my story.”

A pastor in Chicago, a reverend, was praying out loud at a protest, and an agent shot multiple rounds of pepper balls in his face, and he was sprayed by more pepper spray. It was indiscriminate and really vicious.

So far in 2026, ICE agents have shot eight people. These shootings happened in Minnesota and across the United States: Arizona, California, Oregon, Maryland, and Illinois. Officers fired on at least nine people who were in their cars, much like the horrible case of Renee Good. Ms. Good, as America all knows, was a 37-year-old mother, and Alex Pretti was a 37-year-old VA nurse. They were killed in Minnesota. We all saw it. No justification whatsoever.

We have seen massive ICE deployments in Minnesota and elsewhere: Washington, DC; Illinois; California.

These ICE expeditions, with massive numbers of people coming in, are interfering with local law enforcement and creating real terror in the communities.

ICE has raided schools and farms and workplaces, including in my State of Vermont, that sow fear and chaos on farms like the Pleasant Valley Farm in Berkshire and construction sites in Hardwick, VT.

DHS is also rounding up so many people, they literally don't have places to put them. For the first time in our history, more than 70,000 people are in ICE detention. That is an increase of 75 percent from the previous year. Not surprisingly, the conditions are deplorable. There was no preplanning of how to accommodate the people that the government was taking into custody. Detainees are fed food laced with worms. These are all documented facts. It is not a political argument. This is what is happening. Many places have toilets that don't flush.

In a detention center in El Paso, a man named Geraldo Lunas Campos was choked by an officer, and he died. A teen was beat up by officers and now has hearing loss. Just this week, NBC reported that an 18-month-old baby who was detained in south Texas was rushed to a hospital and treated for pneumonia, COVID-19, and RSV in serious and severe respiratory distress. She was described as being at the brink of dying.

Thirty-five people died in custody last year, and at least 6 died in detention centers in January of this year alone.

ICE is in such a hurry that many of the officers don't get adequate training. Their identities are concealed. Most disturbingly, ICE and Kristi Noem accept no responsibility for the actions of their officers.

We are discussing reforms now in Congress, and the basic reforms that should be made are that any Federal Agency, including ICE, should have to abide by the standards that apply in Alabama or in Vermont to our local law enforcement agencies, where there is training, where there is accountability, where there are body cameras, where there are mechanisms in place for training, supervision, and accountability.

But the real question, in my view, is this: Do we want to support a policy of mass roundups? That is the policy of the administration right now. When it comes to the question of border security, yes. When it comes to the question of deporting criminals, yes. But mass roundups with untrained people that are meeting quotas and where we have seen the violent overreactions in many cases; where we are seeing suffering inflicted on people who are in detention because there is no capacity to provide humane treatment to the people taken into custody by the government; where we have seen the havoc in communities where there are raids on our farms that need the migrant

labor and there are raids in our construction sites; where, when there is an influx of thousands of agents from ICE, it totally disrupts local law enforcement; and where so many of these people who are being rounded up are not a threat to our safety—are not a threat to our safety—what is the benefit to the American people? What is the price that our communities are paying? And what is our responsibility as a U.S. Senate to open our eyes and candidly assess what is the impact of a mass deportation policy?

My view is that we have an opportunity to move beyond what has been incredibly partisan rhetoric about the immigration issue. The reason we have the opportunity is because there is now bipartisan agreement about a secure border. There is now bipartisan agreement about deporting criminals.

Isn't it time for us to have the discussion about legal ways to have an immigration policy that is safe and secure and benefits the American people, as immigration has benefited us from the onset of our history?

I yield the floor.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The great Senator from Alabama.

UNANIMOUS CONSENT AGREEMENT—READING OF WASHINGTON'S FAREWELL ADDRESS

Mrs. BRITT. Mr. President, I ask unanimous consent that notwithstanding the order of January 24, 1901, the traditional reading of Washington's Farewell Address take place on Monday, February 23, 2026, following the prayer and Pledge of Allegiance to the flag.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

APPOINTMENT OF SENATOR KAINÉ TO READ WASHINGTON'S FAREWELL ADDRESS

The PRESIDING OFFICER. The Chair, on behalf of the Vice President, pursuant to the order of the Senate of January 24, 1901, as modified by the order of February 11, 2026, appoints the Senator from Virginia, Mr. KAINÉ, to read Washington's Farewell Address on Monday, February 23, 2026.

MORNING BUSINESS

TRIBUTE TO VICE ADMIRAL NANCY HANN

Mr. REED. Mr. President, I rise today to recognize Vice Admiral Nancy Hann upon her retirement from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration after nearly 30 years of distinguished service to our Nation.

Vice Admiral Hann's career reflects the highest traditions of uniformed service: professional excellence, operational expertise, and an unwavering commitment to the workforce and mis-

sion. She began her career as a fisheries observer, and after commissioning in the NOAA Corps, she built her leadership through hands-on operational service as a deck officer at sea, a pilot in NOAA aircraft, and a flight meteorologist supporting missions critical to environmental intelligence and public safety.

As a NOAA pilot and flight meteorologist, Vice Admiral Hann flew demanding missions in support of hurricane forecasting, marine mammal research, and environmental response, working alongside scientists and crews in some of the most challenging operational environments NOAA faces. Those experiences shaped a leader grounded in real-world operations and the people who carry them out.

She went on to serve in a wide range of senior operational and management roles, including commanding officer of the NOAA Aircraft Operations Center, senior leadership positions within the NOAA Corps and the Office of Marine and Aviation Operations, and NOAA liaison to U.S. Pacific Command. Most recently, she served as Director of the NOAA Commissioned Officer Corps and Deputy Under Secretary for Operations, overseeing NOAA's ships, aircraft, uncrewed systems, diving programs, and small boats worldwide.

Through these senior roles, Vice Admiral Hann's leadership also had a lasting impact in Rhode Island. She was instrumental in supporting NOAA's Atlantic Fleet and advancing the relocation of the Marine Operations Center—Atlantic to Newport, reinforcing the Ocean State's role as a hub for maritime operations and strengthening NOAA's operational readiness.

A true trailblazer, Vice Admiral Hann became the first woman to attain the rank of vice admiral—one of only three officers promoted to that rank in NOAA Corps history—and served as the first and only commissioned officer to act as NOAA Administrator. She did not simply break barriers; she built pathways, expanding opportunity and strengthening the professional culture for those who followed.

Throughout her career, Vice Admiral Hann championed inclusion, mentorship, and workforce development. She has emphasized that leadership is about removing obstacles so others can succeed, and she consistently worked to create environments where people could thrive and do their best work. Her efforts helped prepare the next generation of NOAA scientists, pilots, engineers, and mariners to carry forward the Agency's vital mission.

As Vice Admiral Hann concludes her career, the Nation owes her a deep debt of gratitude. I ask my colleagues to join me in thanking Vice Admiral Nancy Hann for her extraordinary service and in congratulating her on a well-earned retirement.

ADDITIONAL STATEMENTS

TRIBUTE TO WINTON P. LOFTON, SR.

• Mr. CASSIDY. Mr. President, I want to recognize Winton P. Lofton, Sr., a proud resident of Winnsboro, LA, who will turn 100 years old on February 17.

Winton grew up in Franklin Parish and answered the call to service at just 17 years old, enlisting in the U.S. Navy during World War II. He served for 6 years, traveling tens of thousands of miles from home. Winton is now the sole surviving World War II veteran in Franklin Parish, a living reminder of all the great men and women who fought for our country and secured our freedom.

Since returning home, Winton has devoted his life to his community and his church. He and his wife Marie have helped build churches across the country and remain pillars of their local faith community. A devout Southern Baptist, Winton continues to pray every day for our country and its leadership.

I am told he is still driving at 100 years young, and that his faith, discipline, and love of country remain as strong as ever.

Winton, thank you for your service. You make Louisiana proud. Happy birthday.●

TRIBUTE TO PERRY AUSTIN, LINDA ELLEN PRICE, AND CRAIG REYNOLDS

• Mr. TUBERVILLE. Mr. President, I would like to honor three Alabama artists whose artwork is currently displayed in my office here in Washington, DC: Perry Austin of Sylacauga, AL; Linda Ellen Price of Springville, AL; Craig Reynolds of Gadsden, AL. Their works reflect the rich artistic talent of Alabama and serve as a visual representation of the State's natural beauty, heritage, and culture.

These pieces, graciously loaned by the artists, are prominently displayed in my front office, where they are viewed by thousands of constituents and visitors who enter my office each year. The artwork has been widely admired and frequently complimented, contributing to a welcoming and representative space that highlights some of Alabama's most talented artists.

Perry Austin, a native of Sylacauga, AL, is well known for his landscape paintings. A successful professional career. He is a member of the American Impressionist Society and Oil Painters of America and was among the original founders of the Plein Air Painters of the Southeast in 2001. His painting "Tensaw" displayed in the Russell Senate Office Building, depicts the Tensaw River as it flows through southern Alabama. Executed in oil on linen, the work captures the region's geography through a thoughtful balance of warm and cool tones.

Linda Ellen Price, of Springville, AL, is known for her expressive style and

quick brushwork. Her artwork, “Alabama Camellia” represents Alabama’s State flower and reflects its cultural significance across the State. The Camellia is an icon of Alabama’s heritage and is prominently featured in public gardens, festivals, and residential landscapes. Ms. Price’s work captures this symbolism with clarity and elegance.

Craig Reynolds, of Gadsden, AL, is recognized for his plein air and studio oil paintings of landscapes, rural scenes and nature. He began painting professionally in 1984 and has worked as a full-time artist since 2005. His piece “Alabama Snow” is the largest artwork on display in my office. The painting portrays cotton fields commonly found in northern Alabama beneath a clear blue sky, offering a distinctive view of the State’s agricultural landscape.

Collectively, these artists have made a meaningful contribution—not only to my office, but to the State of Alabama—by allowing their work to be displayed on Capitol Hill. Their generosity and artistic excellence help ensure that Alabama is represented not only through public service and policy, but through creativity and culture. Without a doubt, Mr. Austin, Ms. Price, and Mr. Reynolds are truly some of Alabama’s finest. I am honored to have their pieces in my office.●

MESSAGES FROM THE PRESIDENT

Messages from the President of the United States were communicated to the Senate by Mr. Hanley, one of his secretaries.

EXECUTIVE MESSAGES REFERRED

As in executive session the Presiding Officer laid before the Senate messages from the President of the United States submitting sundry nominations which were referred to the appropriate committees.

(The messages received today are printed at the end of the Senate proceedings.)

PRESIDENTIAL MESSAGE

NOTICE OF THE REASONS FOR ACTION TO ADJUST IMPORTS OF PROCESSED CRITICAL MINERALS AND THEIR DERIVATIVE PRODUCTS (PCMDPS) SO THAT SUCH IMPORTS WILL NOT THREATEN TO IMPAIR THE NATIONAL SECURITY OF THE UNITED STATES IN RELATION TO PROCLAMATION 11001 OF JANUARY 14, 2026—PM 49

The PRESIDING OFFICER laid before the Senate the following message from the President of the United States, together with an accompanying report; which was referred to the Committee on Finance:

To the Congress of the United States:

Consistent with applicable law, including section 232(c)(2) of the Trade

Expansion Act of 1962, as amended (19 U.S.C. 1862(c)(2)) (section 232), I am providing notice of the reasons why I have decided to take action to adjust imports of processed critical minerals and their derivative products (PCMDPs) so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

On October 24, 2025, the Secretary of Commerce (Secretary), in accordance with section 232, transmitted to me a report on his investigation into the effects of imports of PCMDPs on the national security of the United States. Based on the facts considered in that investigation, the Secretary found and advised me of his opinion that PCMDPs are being imported into the United States in such quantities and under such circumstances as to threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In Proclamation 11001 of January 14, 2026 (Adjusting Imports of Processed Critical Minerals and Their Derivative Products Into The United States) (Proclamation), after considering the Secretary’s report, the factors in section 232(d) (19 U.S.C. 1862(d)), and other relevant factors and information, I concurred with the Secretary’s finding that PCMDPs are being imported into the United States in quantities and under circumstances that threaten to impair the national security of the United States. In my judgment, and in light of the Secretary’s report, the factors in section 232(d), and other relevant factors and information, I determined that it is necessary and appropriate to direct negotiations of agreements to address the national security threat. In the Proclamation, I also noted that depending on the status or outcome of those negotiations, I may take other measures to adjust the imports of PCMDPs to address the national security threat.

I am enclosing a copy of the Proclamation that I have issued. The Proclamation further explains the circumstances underlying the threat to impair the national security of the United States posed by imports of PCMDPs, and the actions taken in the Proclamation to eliminate that threat.

DONALD J. TRUMP.

THE WHITE HOUSE, February 11, 2026.

NOTICE OF THE REASONS FOR ACTION TO ADJUST IMPORTS OF MEDIUM- AND HEAVY-DUTY VEHICLES (MHDVS), AND MEDIUM- AND HEAVY-DUTY VEHICLE PARTS (MHDVPS), AND BUSES SO THAT SUCH IMPORTS WILL NOT THREATEN TO IMPAIR THE NATIONAL SECURITY OF THE UNITED STATES IN RELATION TO PROCLAMATION 10984 OF OCTOBER 17, 2025—PM 50

The PRESIDING OFFICER laid before the Senate the following message from the President of the United States, together with an accompanying report and papers; which was referred to the Committee on Finance:

To the Congress of the United States:

Consistent with applicable law, including section 232(c)(2) of the Trade Expansion Act of 1962, as amended (19 U.S.C. 1862(c)(2)) (section 232), I am providing notice of the reasons why I have decided to take action to adjust imports of medium- and heavy-duty vehicles (MHDVs), and medium- and heavy-duty vehicle parts (MHDVPS), and buses so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In September 2025, the Secretary of Commerce (Secretary), in accordance with section 232, transmitted to me a report on his investigation into the effects of imports of MHDVs, MHDVPS, and buses on the national security of the United States. Based on the facts considered in that investigation, the Secretary found and advised me of his opinion that MHDVs, MHDVPS, and buses are being imported into the United States in such quantities and under such circumstances as to threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In Proclamation 10984 of October 17, 2025 (Adjusting Imports of Medium- and Heavy-Duty Vehicles, Medium- and Heavy-Duty Vehicle Parts, and Buses Into the United States) (Proclamation), after considering the Secretary’s report, the factors in section 232(d) (19 U.S.C. 1862 (d)), and other relevant factors and information, I concurred with the Secretary’s finding that MHDVs, MHDVPS, and buses are being imported into the United States in quantities and under circumstances that threaten to impair the national security of the United States. In my judgment, and in light of the Secretary’s report, the factors in section 232(d), and other relevant factors and information, I determined that it is necessary and appropriate to impose tariffs on certain imports of MHDVs, MHDVPS, and buses.

I am enclosing a copy of the Proclamation that I have issued. The Proclamation further explains the circumstances underlying the threat to impair the national security of the United States posed by imports of MHDVs, MHDVPS, and buses and the actions taken in the Proclamation to eliminate that threat.

DONALD J. TRUMP.

THE WHITE HOUSE, February 11, 2026.

NOTICE OF THE REASONS FOR ACTION TO ADJUST IMPORTS OF SEMICONDUCTORS, SEMICONDUCTOR MANUFACTURING EQUIPMENT, AND THEIR DERIVATIVE PRODUCTS SO THAT SUCH IMPORTS WILL NOT THREATEN TO IMPAIR THE NATIONAL SECURITY OF THE UNITED STATES IN RELATION TO PROCLAMATION 11002 OF JANUARY 14, 2026—PM 51

The PRESIDING OFFICER laid before the Senate the following message from the President of the United States, together with an accompanying report and papers; which was referred to the Committee on Finance:

To the Congress of the United States:

Consistent with applicable law, including section 232(c)(2) of the Trade Expansion Act of 1962, as amended (19 U.S.C. 1862(c)(2)) (section 232), I am providing notice of the reasons why I have decided to take action to adjust imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

On December 22, 2025, the Secretary of Commerce (Secretary), in accordance with section 232, transmitted to me a report on his investigation into the effects of imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products on the national security of the United States. Based on the facts considered in that investigation, the Secretary found and advised me of his opinion that semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products are being imported into the United States in such quantities and under such circumstances as to threaten to impair the national security of the United States.

In Proclamation 11002 of January 14, 2026 (Adjusting Imports of Semiconductors, Semiconductor Manufacturing Equipment, and Their Derivative Products Into The United States) (Proclamation), after considering the Secretary's report, the factors in section 232(d) (19 U.S.C. 1862(d)), and other relevant factors and information, among other things, I concurred with the Secretary's finding that semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivatives are being imported into the United States in quantities and under circumstances that threaten to impair the national security of the United States. In my judgment, and in light of the Secretary's report, the factors in section 232(d), and other relevant factors and information, I determined that it is necessary and appropriate to direct negotiations of agreements to address the national security threat. In the Proclamation, I also noted that depending on the status or resolution of those negotiations, I may take other measures to adjust the imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivatives to address the national security threat. I also determined that it is necessary and appropriate to impose an immediate *ad valorem* duty rate on the import of certain advanced computing chips and certain derivative products to address the national security threat found in the Proclamation.

I am enclosing a copy of the Proclamation that I have issued. The Proclamation further explains the circumstances underlying the threat to impair the national security of the United States posed by imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products, and the actions taken in

the Proclamation to eliminate that threat.

DONALD J. TRUMP.
THE WHITE HOUSE, February 11, 2026.

MESSAGE FROM THE HOUSE

At 2:43 p.m., a message from the House of Representatives, delivered by Mrs. Alli, one of its reading clerks, announced that the House has passed the following bill, without amendment:

S. 3705. An act to provide for the creation of a congressional time capsule in commemoration of the semiquincentennial of the United States, and for other purposes.

The message also announced that the House has passed the following bills, in which it requests the concurrence of the Senate:

H.R. 1531. An act to direct certain financial regulators to exclude representatives of the People's Republic of China from certain banking organizations upon notice of certain threats or danger, and for other purposes.

H.R. 3190. An act to amend the Burma Unified through Rigorous Military Accountability Act of 2022 to extend the sunset, to require a determination with respect to the imposition of sanctions on certain persons of Burma, and for other purposes.

H.R. 3390. An act to amend the Federal Reserve Act to require the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System to carry out a review of discount window operations and to implement improvements to such operations, and for other purposes.

H.R. 3682. An act to amend the Financial Stability Act of 2010 to require the Financial Stability Oversight Council to consider alternative approaches before determining that a U.S. nonbank financial company shall be supervised by the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, and for other purposes.

H.R. 6644. An act to increase the supply of housing in America, and for other purposes.

The message further announced that the House has agreed to the following concurrent resolution, in which it requests the concurrence of the Senate:

H. Con. Res. 74. Concurrent resolution providing for a joint session of Congress to receive a message from the President.

MEASURES REFERRED

The following bills were read the first and the second times by unanimous consent, and referred as indicated:

H.R. 1531. An act to direct certain financial regulators to exclude representatives of the People's Republic of China from certain banking organizations upon notice of certain threats or danger, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

H.R. 3190. An act to amend the Burma Unified through Rigorous Military Accountability Act of 2022 to extend the sunset, to require a determination with respect to the imposition of sanctions on certain persons of Burma, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

H.R. 3390. An act to amend the Federal Reserve Act to require the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System to carry out a review of discount window operations and to implement improvements to such operations, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

H.R. 3682. An act to amend the Financial Stability Act of 2010 to require the Financial

Stability Oversight Council to consider alternative approaches before determining that a U.S. nonbank financial company shall be supervised by the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EXECUTIVE AND OTHER COMMUNICATIONS

The following communications were laid before the Senate, together with accompanying papers, reports, and documents, and were referred as indicated:

EC-2757. A communication from the Deputy General Counsel, Office of General Counsel, Department of Education, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled "William D. Ford Federal Direct Loan (Direct Loan) Program" (RIN1840-AA28) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on February 10, 2026; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

EC-2758. A communication from the Director, Administrative Office of the United States Courts, transmitting, pursuant to law, a report on applications for delayed-notice search warrants and extensions during fiscal year 2025; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

EC-2759. A communication from the Senior Attorney Advisor, Federal Protective Service, Department of Homeland Security, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled "Protection of Federal Property; Technical Amendment" (RIN1601-AB17) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on February 11, 2026; to the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

EC-2760. A communication from the Assistant to the Board, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled "Rescission of Principles for Climate-Related Financial Risk Management for Large Financial Institutions" (RIN3064-ZA32) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on February 11, 2026; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

EC-2761. A communication from the Acting Branch Supervisor of the Regulatory Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled "Chlorate; Exemption from the Requirement of a Pesticide Tolerance" (FRL No. 13148-01-OCSP) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on February 9, 2026; to the Committee on Agriculture, Nutrition, and Forestry.

EC-2762. A communication from the Acting Branch Supervisor of the Regulatory Management Division, Environmental Protection Agency, transmitting, pursuant to law, the report of a rule entitled "PDHP 68949; Exemption from the Requirement of a Tolerance" (FRL No. 13197-01-OCSP) received in the Office of the President of the Senate on February 9, 2026; to the Committee on Agriculture, Nutrition, and Forestry.

EC-2763. A communication from the Assistant Secretary for Legislation, Department of Health and Human Services, transmitting, pursuant to law, a report entitled "Maternal, Infant, and Early Childhood Home Visiting Program"; to the Committee on Finance.

EC-2764. A communication from the Inspector General, Department of Health and Human Services, transmitting, pursuant to law, a report entitled "Total Medicare Part B Spending on Lab Tests Rose in 2024, Driven by Increased Spending on Genetic Test"; to the Committee on Finance.

REPORTS OF COMMITTEES

The following reports of committees were submitted:

By Mr. CRUZ, from the Committee on Commerce, Science, and Transportation, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute:

S. 2975. A bill to amend title 49, United States Code, to enhance the safety of pipeline transportation, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-102).

By Mr. LEE, from the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources, with an amendment:

S. 362. A bill to allow certain Federal minerals to be mined consistent with the Bull Mountains Mining Plan Modification, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-103).

By Mr. LEE, from the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources, without amendment:

S. 472. A bill to amend the Omnibus Parks and Public Lands Management Act of 1996 to provide for the establishment of a Ski Area Fee Retention Account, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-104).

S. 544. A bill to provide for the location of multiple hardrock mining mill sites, to establish the Abandoned Hardrock Mine Fund, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-105).

By Mr. LEE, from the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute and an amendment to the title:

S. 714. A bill to amend the Energy Act of 2020 to include critical materials in the definition of critical mineral, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-106).

By Mr. LEE, from the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources, without amendment:

S. 909. A bill to authorize the Secretary of the Interior to convey certain land to La Paz County, Arizona, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-107).

S. 1453. A bill to confirm the use of certain non-Federal land in Salt Lake City, Utah, for public purposes, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-108).

By Mr. LEE, from the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources:

Report to accompany H.R. 1043, An act to direct the Secretary of the Interior to convey certain Federal land in Arizona to La Paz County, Arizona, and for other purposes (Rept. No. 119-109).

INTRODUCTION OF BILLS AND JOINT RESOLUTIONS

The following bills and joint resolutions were introduced, read the first and second times by unanimous consent, and referred as indicated:

By Mr. GRASSLEY (for himself, Mr. TILLIS, Mr. KENNEDY, and Mr. CORNYN):

S. 3826. A bill to amend title 28, United States Code, to increase transparency and oversight of third-party litigation funding in certain actions, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. SCHIFF (for himself, Mrs. GILLIBRAND, Mr. BLUMENTHAL, and Mr. MERKLEY):

S. 3827. A bill to modify reporting value categories for financial disclosure reports required under chapter 131 of title 5, United States Code; to the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

By Mr. LUJAN (for himself and Mr. SCOTT of South Carolina):

S. 3828. A bill to accelerate the development, demonstration, and deployment of advanced technologies and innovative solu-

tions that support the environmental clean-up missions of the Department of Energy, help prevent the future generation and accumulation of nuclear waste from both current and anticipated future nuclear activities, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources.

By Ms. WARREN (for herself, Mr. BLUMENTHAL, Mr. MARKEY, Mr. MERKLEY, and Mr. WELCH):

S. 3829. A bill to prevent exploitative private equity practices, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. BUDD (for himself, Mr. KIM, Mr. KENNEDY, and Ms. ALSOBROOKS):

S. 3830. A bill to amend the Federal Deposit Insurance Act to permit Federal banking agencies to examine qualifying insured depository institutions with under \$6,000,000,000 in total assets not less than once during each 18-month period, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

By Mr. GALLEGO (for himself and Mr. ROUNDS):

S. 3831. A bill to amend the Securities and Exchange Act of 1934 to require issuers with a multi-class stock structure to make certain disclosures in any proxy or consent solicitation material, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

By Ms. ROSEN (for herself and Mr. CURTIS):

S. 3832. A bill to amend the Small Business Act to include requirements relating to apprenticeship program assistance for small business development centers, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Small Business and Entrepreneurship.

By Mr. WELCH (for himself, Mr. SCHUMER, Mr. SANDERS, and Mrs. GILLIBRAND):

S. 3833. A bill to amend the Federal Water Pollution Control Act to provide for the selection of a fiscal agent for the Patrick Leahy Lake Champlain Basin Program, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Environment and Public Works.

By Mr. DAINES (for himself and Ms. SMITH):

S. 3834. A bill to amend title XVIII of the Social Security Act to expand the scope of practitioners eligible for payment for telehealth services under the Medicare program, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. MCCORMICK (for himself and Mr. FETTERMAN):

S. 3835. A bill to designate the facility of the United States Postal Service located at 10 East Main Street in Mahaffey, Pennsylvania, as the "Robert Allen Bishop, Sr., Post Office Building"; to the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

By Ms. LUMMIS:

S. 3836. A bill to amend the Clean Air Act to clarify standards for emissions emanating from outside of the United States, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Environment and Public Works.

By Ms. ERNST:

S. 3837. A bill to designate the clinic of the Department of Veterans Affairs in Des Moines, Iowa, as the "Staff Sergeant Edgar Torres-Tovar VA Clinic" and to designate the community-based outpatient clinic of the Department in Marshalltown, Iowa, as the "Staff Sergeant William Nathaniel Howard VA Clinic"; to the Committee on Veterans' Affairs.

By Mr. SCHUMER (for himself and Mr. SCHIFF):

S. 3838. A bill to require the Comptroller General of the United States to conduct an audit of a United States and Venezuela energy deal, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

By Mr. COTTON:

S. 3839. A bill to protect the reliability of the electric grid by preempting certain State climate mandates, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources.

By Mr. PADILLA:

S. 3840. A bill to provide for the designation of areas as Health Investment Zones to reduce health disparities and improve health outcomes in such areas, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. CASSIDY (for himself and Mr. WHITEHOUSE):

S. 3841. A bill to amend the Tariff Act of 1930 to modify the determination of transaction value for customs valuation; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. MARSHALL (for himself and Mrs. GILLIBRAND):

S. 3842. A bill to amend the Child Nutrition Act of 1966 to permit video or telephone certifications under the special supplemental nutrition program for women, infants, and children, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Agriculture, Nutrition, and Forestry.

By Mrs. MOODY:

S. 3843. A bill to amend the Federal Crop Insurance Act to direct the Federal Crop Insurance Corporation to conduct research and development on frost or cold weather insurance, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Agriculture, Nutrition, and Forestry.

By Ms. ALSOBROOKS (for herself, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, Mr. WARNER, and Mr. PADILLA):

S. 3844. A bill to require the Comptroller General of the United States to conduct a study of the impact of Federal reductions in force on State and local governments, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs.

By Mr. YOUNG (for himself, Ms. HASSAN, Mr. TILLIS, Mr. KAINE, and Mr. HICKENLOOPER):

S. 3845. A bill to establish and expand child care programs for parents who work non-traditional hours, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Mr. BUDD (for himself, Mr. CASSIDY, and Mr. HUSTED):

S. 3846. A bill to amend the Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act regarding employer-directed skills development, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

By Mr. DURBIN (for himself, Mr. REED, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, Ms. WARREN, Mr. WHITEHOUSE, Mr. BLUMENTHAL, Ms. DUCKWORTH, Ms. HIRONO, Mr. SANDERS, and Ms. BALDWIN):

S. 3847. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to modify the rules relating to inverted corporations; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. SCOTT of South Carolina:

S. 3848. A bill to amend title XVIII of the Social Security Act to require the Secretary of Health and Human Services to publish information on expenditures under the Medicare program, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

By Mr. CRUZ (for himself and Mrs. BRITT):

S. 3849. A bill to amend the Electronic Fund Transfer Act to adjust certain thresholds for inflation; to the Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs.

By Mr. WYDEN (for himself and Ms. LUMMIS):

S. 3850. A bill to regulate monitoring of electronic communications between an incarcerated person in a Bureau of Prisons facility and that person's attorney or other

legal representative, and for other purposes; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Ms. HIRONO:

S. 3851. A bill to amend the Food, Agriculture, Conservation, and Trade Act of 1990 to ensure adequate staffing and resources for the Institute of Tropical Forestry and the Institute of Pacific Islands Forestry; to the Committee on Agriculture, Nutrition, and Forestry.

By Mr. HAWLEY (for himself and Mr. BLUMENTHAL):

S. 3852. A bill to impose certain requirements on data centers to ensure the prioritization of residential ratepayers, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Energy and Natural Resources.

By Mr. PAUL (for himself and Mr. LEE):

S. 3853. A bill to amend the Public Health Service Act to end the liability shield for vaccine manufacturers, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions.

SUBMISSION OF CONCURRENT AND SENATE RESOLUTIONS

The following concurrent resolutions and Senate resolutions were read, and referred (or acted upon), as indicated:

By Mr. MARKEY (for himself, Mr. MERKLEY, Ms. WARREN, Ms. HIRONO, Mr. WYDEN, Mr. HEINRICH, Mr. PADILLA, Mr. SANDERS, and Mr. WELCH):

S. Res. 604. A resolution recognizing that it is the duty of the Federal Government to develop and implement a Transgender Bill of Rights to protect and codify the rights of transgender and nonbinary people under the law and ensure their access to medical care, shelter, safety, and economic security; to the Committee on the Judiciary.

By Mr. MARKEY (for himself, Mr. BLUMENTHAL, and Mr. SCHIFF):

S. Res. 605. A resolution denouncing statements by President Donald J. Trump that he may "nationalize," commandeer, or otherwise assume direct control over elections; to the Committee on Rules and Administration.

By Mr. LANKFORD (for himself, Mrs. SHAHEEN, Mr. BOOKER, Mr. BOOZMAN, Mrs. BRITT, Mr. BUDD, Mrs. CAPITO, Mr. CRAMER, Mr. CRUZ, Ms. ERNST, Mrs. FISCHER, Mr. GRASSLEY, Mr. HOEVEN, Mr. KAINE, Mr. MERKLEY, Mr. MULLIN, Mr. RICKETTS, Ms. ROSEN, Mr. SULLIVAN, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, Mr. SCHUMER, Mr. MCCONNELL, Mr. COTTON, Mr. KIM, and Mr. DURBIN):

S. Res. 606. A resolution condemning the Government of Iran for its suppression of the right of Iranians to peacefully assemble; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

ADDITIONAL COSPONSORS

S. 119

At the request of Mr. RISCH, the names of the Senator from Louisiana (Mr. CASSIDY) and the Senator from South Carolina (Mr. GRAHAM) were added as cosponsors of S. 119, a bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to discontinue the collection by the Federal Government of firearm transaction records of discontinued firearms businesses, to require the destruction of such already collected records, and for other purposes.

S. 345

At the request of Mr. LEE, the name of the Senator from South Carolina

(Mr. GRAHAM) was added as a cosponsor of S. 345, a bill to provide that silencers be treated the same as firearms accessories.

S. 405

At the request of Mr. TUBERVILLE, the name of the Senator from Florida (Mr. SCOTT) was added as a cosponsor of S. 405, a bill to modify eligibility requirements for amateur sports governing organizations.

S. 645

At the request of Mrs. FISCHER, the names of the Senator from New York (Mrs. GILLIBRAND) and the Senator from New Mexico (Mr. HEINRICH) were added as cosponsors of S. 645, a bill to award a Congressional Gold Medal, collectively, to the individuals and communities who volunteered or donated items to the North Platte Canteen in North Platte, Nebraska, during World War II from December 25, 1941, to April 1, 1946.

S. 761

At the request of Ms. MURKOWSKI, the name of the Senator from Arizona (Mr. GALLEGOS) was added as a cosponsor of S. 761, a bill to establish the Truth and Healing Commission on Indian Boarding School Policies in the United States, and for other purposes.

S. 766

At the request of Ms. ERNST, the name of the Senator from Florida (Mr. SCOTT) was added as a cosponsor of S. 766, a bill to require an annual report of taxpayer-funded projects that are over budget and behind schedule.

S. 921

At the request of Mr. BANKS, the name of the Senator from Washington (Ms. CANTWELL) was added as a cosponsor of S. 921, a bill to direct the Secretary of Health and Human Services to issue guidance on whether hospital emergency departments should implement fentanyl testing as a routine procedure for patients experiencing an overdose, and for other purposes.

S. 1847

At the request of Mr. PAUL, the name of the Senator from Indiana (Mr. BANKS) was added as a cosponsor of S. 1847, a bill to amend the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 to clarify the treatment of certain association health plans as employers, and for other purposes.

S. 2376

At the request of Mr. CRUZ, the name of the Senator from Alabama (Mrs. BRITT) was added as a cosponsor of S. 2376, a bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to include rioting in the definition of racketeering activity.

S. 2667

At the request of Mr. BOOKER, the name of the Senator from Maine (Mr. KING) was added as a cosponsor of S. 2667, a bill to prevent violence in the West Bank and authorize the imposition of sanctions with respect to any foreign person endangering United States national security and undermining prospects for a two-state solu-

tion by committing illegal violent acts.

S. 2761

At the request of Mr. TILLIS, the names of the Senator from Utah (Mr. CURTIS) and the Senator from New Hampshire (Mrs. SHAHEEN) were added as cosponsors of S. 2761, a bill to amend title XVIII of the Social Security Act to provide long-term stability for Medicare beneficiary access to clinical diagnostic laboratory tests by improving the accuracy of, and feasibility of data collection for, the private payor-based fee schedule payment rates applied under the Medicare program for such tests, and for other purposes.

S. 3085

At the request of Mr. RISCH, the name of the Senator from Texas (Mr. CORNYN) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3085, a bill to ensure that certain operations, functions, and services of the Federal Government relating to enforcement of firearms laws and firearm export licensing continue during a lapse in appropriations.

S. 3267

At the request of Ms. COLLINS, the names of the Senator from North Carolina (Mr. TILLIS) and the Senator from Montana (Mr. DAINES) were added as cosponsors of S. 3267, a bill to amend title XVIII of the Social Security Act to provide for Medicare coverage of blood-based dementia screening tests.

S. 3346

At the request of Mr. BOOKER, the name of the Senator from New Mexico (Mr. HEINRICH) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3346, a bill to establish a special registration under the Controlled Substances Act for schedule I eligible investigational drugs under the Federal Right to Try law.

S. 3394

At the request of Mr. GRASSLEY, the names of the Senator from Florida (Mrs. MOODY), the Senator from Nevada (Ms. CORTEZ MASTO) and the Senator from Pennsylvania (Mr. FETTERMAN) were added as cosponsors of S. 3394, a bill to direct the United States Sentencing Commission to amend the sentencing guideline relating to child sexual abuse material.

S. 3397

At the request of Mr. GRASSLEY, the names of the Senator from Florida (Mrs. MOODY) and the Senator from Tennessee (Mrs. BLACKBURN) were added as cosponsors of S. 3397, a bill to make coercion of children to commit harm a criminal offense, and for other purposes.

S. 3626

At the request of Mrs. SHAHEEN, the names of the Senator from Pennsylvania (Mr. FETTERMAN) and the Senator from West Virginia (Mrs. CAPITO) were added as cosponsors of S. 3626, a bill to amend title 5, United States Code, to improve recruitment and retention of Federal correctional officers, and for other purposes.

S. 3663

At the request of Mr. COONS, the name of the Senator from Vermont

(Mr. WELCH) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3663, a bill to amend title 18, United States Code, to modify delayed notice requirements, and for other purposes.

S. 3752

At the request of Mr. LEE, the names of the Senator from Iowa (Ms. ERNST), the Senator from Iowa (Mr. GRASSLEY), the Senator from Louisiana (Mr. CASSIDY), the Senator from Utah (Mr. CURTIS) and the Senator from Mississippi (Mrs. HYDE-SMITH) were added as cosponsors of S. 3752, a bill to amend the National Voter Registration Act of 1993 to require proof of United States citizenship to register an individual to vote in elections for Federal office, and for other purposes.

S. 3805

At the request of Mr. GRAHAM, the names of the Senator from Texas (Mr. CORNYN) and the Senator from Louisiana (Mr. KENNEDY) were added as cosponsors of S. 3805, a bill to amend chapter 93 of title 18, United States Code, to prohibit obstruction of immigration laws by official interference.

S. 3817

At the request of Mr. WYDEN, the name of the Senator from Rhode Island (Mr. WHITEHOUSE) was added as a cosponsor of S. 3817, a bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to impose a tax on damages received by certain officers of the United States on account of any civil action filed against the United States, and for other purposes.

S. RES. 547

At the request of Mr. RICKETTS, the names of the Senator from Indiana (Mr. BANKS) and the Senator from New Jersey (Mr. KIM) were added as cosponsors of S. Res. 547, a resolution expressing unwavering support for the United States-Japan alliance in response to political, economic and military pressure by the People's Republic of China.

STATEMENTS ON INTRODUCED BILLS AND JOINT RESOLUTIONS

By Mr. SCHUMER (for himself and Mr. SCHIFF):

S. 3838. A bill to require the Comptroller General of the United States to conduct an audit of a United States and Venezuela energy deal, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Foreign Relations.

S. 3838

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the "Venezuela Oil Proceeds Transparency Act".

SEC. 2. FINDINGS.

Congress finds that—

(1) on January 6, 2026, President Trump announced a United States-Venezuela energy deal under which the United States will market and sell Venezuelan oil and deposit proceeds into "U.S.-controlled" accounts;

(2) according to the fact sheet of the Department of Energy issued on January 7, 2026, on the United States-Venezuela energy deal—

(A) the Federal Government has engaged commodity marketers and banks to execute and provide financial support for the crude oil and crude products sales;

(B) all proceeds from the sale of Venezuelan crude oil and oil products will first settle in United States controlled accounts at foreign banks "to guarantee the legitimacy and integrity of the ultimate distribution of proceeds"; and

(C) the funds will be disbursed "for the benefit of the American people and the Venezuelan people at the discretion of the U.S. government" and will continue indefinitely;

(3) under the United States-Venezuela energy deal, the United States is selectively rolling back sanctions to enable the transport and sale of Venezuelan crude and oil products to global markets, and the Office of Foreign Assets Control of the Department of the Treasury is also issuing new licenses for certain companies to import and export Venezuelan oil; and

(4) during testimony to the Committee on Foreign Relations of the Senate on January 28, 2026, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said there were plans for an "audit process" to review expenditures from an account in Qatar set up under the United States-Venezuela energy deal, but Secretary Rubio added that "We haven't finalized what that audit process would be."

SEC. 3. GAO AUDIT.

(a) IN GENERAL.—Not later than 30 days after the date of enactment of this Act, the Comptroller General of the United States (referred to in this section as the "Comptroller General") shall initiate an audit of the United States-Venezuela energy deal announced on January 6, 2026, including the activities of the Department of State, the Department of Energy, the Department of the Treasury, and any other Federal Government agencies, employees, or contractors or entities funded by the United States involved in implementing the deal.

(b) INTERIM BRIEFING.—Not later than 30 days after the date on which the audit required under subsection (a) is completed, the Comptroller General shall provide to the chair and ranking member of each committee and subcommittee of jurisdiction in the House of Representatives and the Senate a briefing on preliminary findings, scope, and any identified risks of fraud, abuse, or conflicts of interest identified while conducting the audit.

(c) NOTICE OF NONCOMPLIANCE.—In carrying out this section, the Comptroller General shall notify the chair and ranking member of each committee and subcommittee of jurisdiction in the House of Representatives and the Senate as soon as practicable if the Comptroller General determines that access to information has been unreasonably delayed or denied by any Federal department, agency, employee, or contractor or entity funded by the United States involved in implementing the United States-Venezuela energy deal described in subsection (a).

(d) REPORT.—

(1) IN GENERAL.—Not later than 90 days after the date on which the audit required under subsection (a) is completed, the Comptroller General shall—

(A) submit to Congress a report on that audit, which shall include—

(i) a detailed description of the findings and conclusions of the Comptroller General with respect to the audit that is the subject of the report; and

(ii) recommendations for legislative or administrative action, as the Comptroller General determines to be appropriate; and

(B) make the report available to—

(i) the Speaker of the House of Representatives;

(ii) the majority and minority leaders of the House of Representatives;

(iii) the majority and minority leaders of the Senate;

(iv) the chair and ranking member of each committee and subcommittee of jurisdiction in the House of Representatives and the Senate; and

(v) any Member of Congress who requests the report.

(2) FORM.—The report required under paragraph (1) shall be submitted in unclassified form, but may include a classified annex.

By Mr. PADILLA:

S. 3840. A bill to provide for the designation of areas as Health Investment Zones to reduce health disparities and improve health outcomes in such areas, and for other purposes; to the Committee on Finance.

Mr. PADILLA. Mr. President, I rise to introduce the Health Investment Zones Act of 2026. This legislation would designate health investment zones for 10 years in areas with large health disparities based on income, life expectancy, provider shortages, and align tax, grant, loan-repayment, and Medicare incentives to expand services where they are needed most.

This bill would establish health investment zones, HIZs, in areas with significant health disparities, offering incentives like expanded tax credits for employers and workers, grants for health projects, and loan repayment for healthcare professionals serving in these zones. It supports initiatives such as mobile clinics and wellness programs and provides Medicare bonuses for services delivered in HIZs. The bill focuses on improving outcomes for conditions like diabetes, cardiovascular disease, and maternal health, with a 10-year report to measure progress in health, access, and cost reductions.

Many communities face preventable gaps in health care access that lead to higher emergency room use, more hospital admissions, and rising costs. Establishing 10-year health investment zones will help close these gaps and ensure that underserved areas receive the consistent, affordable, and high-quality care they need.

By Mr. DURBIN (for himself, Mr. REED, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, Ms. WARREN, Mr. WHITEHOUSE, Mr. BLUMENTHAL, Ms. DUCKWORTH, Ms. HIRONO, Mr. SANDERS, and Ms. BALDWIN):

S. 3847. A bill to amend the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 to modify the rules relating to inverted corporations; to the Committee on Finance.

S. 3847

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the United States of America in Congress assembled,

SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.

This Act may be cited as the "Stop Corporate Inversions Act of 2026".

SEC. 2. MODIFICATIONS TO RULES RELATING TO INVERTED CORPORATIONS.

(a) IN GENERAL.—Subsection (b) of section 7874 of the Internal Revenue Code of 1986 is amended to read as follows:

“(b) INVERTED CORPORATIONS TREATED AS DOMESTIC CORPORATIONS.—

“(1) IN GENERAL.—Notwithstanding section 7701(a)(4), a foreign corporation shall be treated for purposes of this title as a domestic corporation if—

“(A) such corporation would be a surrogate foreign corporation if subsection (a)(2) were applied by substituting ‘80 percent’ for ‘60 percent’, or

“(B) such corporation is an inverted domestic corporation.

“(2) INVERTED DOMESTIC CORPORATION.—For purposes of this subsection, a foreign corporation shall be treated as an inverted domestic corporation if, pursuant to a plan (or a series of related transactions)—

“(A) the entity completes after May 8, 2014, the direct or indirect acquisition of—

“(i) substantially all of the properties held directly or indirectly by a domestic corporation, or

“(ii) substantially all of the assets of, or substantially all of the properties constituting a trade or business of, a domestic partnership, and

“(B) after the acquisition, either—

“(i) more than 50 percent of the stock (by vote or value) of the entity is held—

“(I) in the case of an acquisition with respect to a domestic corporation, by former shareholders of the domestic corporation by reason of holding stock in the domestic corporation, or

“(II) in the case of an acquisition with respect to a domestic partnership, by former partners of the domestic partnership by reason of holding a capital or profits interest in the domestic partnership, or

“(ii) the management and control of the expanded affiliated group which includes the entity occurs, directly or indirectly, primarily within the United States, and such expanded affiliated group has significant domestic business activities.

“(3) EXCEPTION FOR CORPORATIONS WITH SUBSTANTIAL BUSINESS ACTIVITIES IN FOREIGN COUNTRY OF ORGANIZATION.—A foreign corporation described in paragraph (2) shall not be treated as an inverted domestic corporation if after the acquisition the expanded affiliated group which includes the entity has substantial business activities in the foreign country in which or under the law of which the entity is created or organized when compared to the total business activities of such expanded affiliated group. For purposes of subsection (a)(2)(B)(iii) and the preceding sentence, the term ‘substantial business activities’ shall have the meaning given such term under regulations in effect on January 18, 2017, except that the Secretary may issue regulations increasing the threshold percent in any of the tests under such regulations for determining if business activities constitute substantial business activities for purposes of this paragraph.

“(4) MANAGEMENT AND CONTROL.—For purposes of paragraph (2)(B)(ii)—

“(A) IN GENERAL.—The Secretary shall prescribe regulations for purposes of determining cases in which the management and control of an expanded affiliated group is to be treated as occurring, directly or indirectly, primarily within the United States. The regulations prescribed under the preceding sentence shall apply to periods after May 8, 2014.

“(B) EXECUTIVE OFFICERS AND SENIOR MANAGEMENT.—Such regulations shall provide that the management and control of an expanded affiliated group shall be treated as occurring, directly or indirectly, primarily within the United States if substantially all of the executive officers and senior management of the expanded affiliated group who exercise day-to-day responsibility for making decisions involving strategic, financial,

and operational policies of the expanded affiliated group are based or primarily located within the United States. Individuals who in fact exercise such day-to-day responsibilities shall be treated as executive officers and senior management regardless of their title.

“(5) SIGNIFICANT DOMESTIC BUSINESS ACTIVITIES.—For purposes of paragraph (2)(B)(ii), an expanded affiliated group has significant domestic business activities if at least 25 percent of—

“(A) the employees of the group are based in the United States,

“(B) the employee compensation incurred by the group is incurred with respect to employees based in the United States,

“(C) the assets of the group are located in the United States, or

“(D) the income of the group is derived in the United States,

determined in the same manner as such determinations are made for purposes of determining substantial business activities under regulations referred to in paragraph (3) as in effect on January 18, 2017, but applied by treating all references in such regulations to ‘foreign country’ and ‘relevant foreign country’ as references to ‘the United States’. The Secretary may issue regulations decreasing the threshold percent in any of the tests under such regulations for determining if business activities constitute significant domestic business activities for purposes of this paragraph.”.

(b) CONFORMING AMENDMENTS.—

(1) Clause (i) of section 7874(a)(2)(B) of such Code is amended by striking “after March 4, 2003,” and inserting “after March 4, 2003, and before May 8, 2014.”.

(2) Subsection (c) of section 7874 of such Code is amended—

(A) in paragraph (2)—

(i) by striking “subsection (a)(2)(B)(ii)” and inserting “subsections (a)(2)(B)(i) and (b)(2)(B)(i)”; and

(ii) by inserting “or (b)(2)(A)” after “(a)(2)(B)(i)” in subparagraph (B);

(B) in paragraph (3), by inserting “or (b)(2)(B)(i), as the case may be,” after “(a)(2)(B)(ii)”; and

(C) in paragraph (5), by striking “subsection (a)(2)(B)(ii)” and inserting “subsections (a)(2)(B)(i) and (b)(2)(B)(i)”; and

(D) in paragraph (6), by inserting “or inverted domestic corporation, as the case may be,” after “surrogate foreign corporation”.

(c) EFFECTIVE DATE.—The amendments made by this section shall apply to taxable years ending after May 8, 2014.

SUBMITTED RESOLUTIONS

SENATE RESOLUTION 604—RECOGNIZING THAT IT IS THE DUTY OF THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT TO DEVELOP AND IMPLEMENT A TRANSGENDER BILL OF RIGHTS TO PROTECT AND CODIFY THE RIGHTS OF TRANSGENDER AND NONBINARY PEOPLE UNDER THE LAW AND ENSURE THEIR ACCESS TO MEDICAL CARE, SHELTER, SAFETY, AND ECONOMIC SECURITY

Mr. MARKEY (for himself, Mr. MERKLEY, Ms. WARREN, Ms. HIRONO, Mr. WYDEN, Mr. HEINRICH, Mr. PADILLA, Mr. SANDERS, and Mr. WELCH) submitted the following resolution; which was referred to the Committee on the Judiciary:

S. RES. 604

Whereas an estimated 1,600,000 transgender adults live in the United States;

Whereas title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (42 U.S.C. 2000e et seq.) requires equal treatment under the law regardless of sex;

Whereas the Supreme Court of the United States affirmed in *Bostock v. Clayton County*, 140 S. Ct. 1731 (2020) that Federal protection against discrimination on the basis of sex includes protection from discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity;

Whereas several Federal courts have correctly concluded that discrimination against transgender people because of their sex and gender identity violates title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 (20 U.S.C. 1681 et seq.), section 1557 of the Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act (42 U.S.C. 18116), and the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States;

Whereas, despite the protections against discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity, transgender people still experience discrimination in—

- (1) medical care;
- (2) employment;
- (3) housing;
- (4) education;
- (5) lending; and
- (6) other basic necessities;

Whereas President Trump has issued several executive orders that attempt to unlawfully discriminate against transgender people;

Whereas anti-trans individuals strive to deprive transgender and nonbinary people of access to gender affirming care, despite the overwhelming consensus of the medical community that gender-affirming care is essential, safe, and life-saving health care;

Whereas the provision of best-practice, age-appropriate, gender-affirming health care is endorsed by major medical associations such as the American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry, the American Academy of Family Physicians, the American Academy of Nursing, the American Academy of Pediatrics, the American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists, the American College of Physicians, the American Counseling Association, the American Heart Association, the American Medical Association, the American Nurses Association, the American Osteopathic Association, the American Psychiatric Association, the American Psychological Association, the American Public Health Association, the Endocrine Society, the National Association of Nurse Practitioners in Women's Health, the Pediatric Endocrine Society, the Society for Adolescent Health and Medicine, the World Medical Association, and the World Professional Association for Transgender Health;

Whereas transgender and nonbinary people—

(1) face significant barriers to legal recognition of their truest selves on government-issued documentation and identification that reflects their gender;

(2) experience disproportionately high rates of poverty, homelessness, violence, and suicide due to discrimination and persecution; and

(3) are especially vulnerable to violence and abuse and are often deprived of gender-affirming resources and health care while detained in jails, prisons, and immigration detention centers; and

Whereas transgender and nonbinary people—

(1) make unique, valuable contributions to American society and culture worth honoring and celebrating;

(2) have existed throughout history across the globe, demonstrating resilience, bravery, and authenticity; and

(3) are parents, siblings, children, chosen family, and friends deserving of human dignity and support: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That it is the sense of the Senate that—

(1) the Federal Government has a duty to protect the rights of transgender and nonbinary people by implementing a “Transgender Bill of Rights” that includes—

(A) ensuring that transgender and nonbinary people have equal access to services and public accommodations that align with their gender identity by—

(i) amending the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (42 U.S.C. 2000a et seq.) to prohibit discrimination on the basis of sex, including gender identity and sex characteristics, in public accommodations and federally funded programs and activities;

(ii) expanding the definition of public accommodation to address the full range of places and services that members of the general public utilize;

(iii) explicitly clarifying that it is illegal to discriminate on the basis of sex, including gender identity or sex characteristics, in public accommodations and services on religious grounds; and

(iv) amending Federal law to ensure that it protects students from discrimination based on sex, including gender identity and sex characteristics, thus guaranteeing the right of students to participate, free from discrimination, including harassment and sexual violence, in all areas of school life, including in classes, extracurriculars (including athletics), access to facilities, and other school activities;

(B) clarifying and reaffirming the right to bodily autonomy and health care for transgender and nonbinary people by—

(i) enforcing prohibitions against discrimination in the provision of health care on the basis of sex, including on the basis of actual or perceived gender identity or sex characteristics;

(ii) eliminating unnecessary governmental restrictions on the provision of, and access to, gender-affirming medical care and counseling for transgender and nonbinary adults and adolescents;

(iii) ensuring that health care providers that follow recognized standards of care for transgender and nonbinary people are not targeted for criminal or civil penalties, or for professional discipline;

(iv) protecting children against forceful removal from supportive homes;

(v) protecting providers of gender-affirming care, reproductive health care, and abortion health care from threats and acts of violence related to their work;

(vi) expanding access to competent health care providers serving transgender and nonbinary patients, including by recruiting and training more health care providers to provide appropriate care;

(vii) expanding telehealth access to provide patients in rural and other underserved locations better access to health care services;

(viii) codifying the right to abortion and reproductive health care, such as contraceptives and assistive reproductive technology, for everyone, including transgender and nonbinary people;

(ix) banning the performing of nonconsensual surgeries that violate medical ethics and the human rights of intersex children and infants;

(x) banning conversion practices and other abusive and torturous pseudo-medical treatments that are overwhelmingly rejected by every major medical organization as lacking efficacy and carrying significant risks of harm;

(xi) protecting providers of gender-affirming care from specious consumer and medical

fraud accusations based on their provision of medically necessary care; and

(xii) ensuring that the Sexual & Gender Minority Research Office of the National Institutes of Health is re-opened and remains operational;

(C) ensuring transgender and nonbinary people can care for themselves and their families by fully codifying the judgment of the Supreme Court in *Bostock v. Clayton County*, 140 S. Ct. 1731 (2020) by—

(i) eliminating hiring and employment discrimination and workforce exclusion by amending title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (42 U.S.C. 2000e et seq.) to explicitly clarify that employers may not discriminate on the basis of actual or perceived gender identity or sex characteristics;

(ii) amending the Fair Housing Act (42 U.S.C. 3601 et seq.) to explicitly clarify that it prohibits all forms of sex discrimination, including on the basis of gender identity or sex characteristics; and

(iii) amending the Equal Credit Opportunity Act (15 U.S.C. 1691 et seq.) to explicitly clarify that it prohibits all forms of sex discrimination, including on the basis of gender identity or sex characteristics;

(D) providing accessible avenues for legal recognition of transgender and nonbinary identities and guaranteeing full participation in civil life by—

(i) eliminating Federal gender identification requirements on government documents that are unnecessary to determine the identity of the holder or are otherwise irrelevant to the purpose of the document;

(ii) eliminating burdensome barriers to, or prohibitions on, updating sex and names on passports, Social Security cards, and other forms of Federal Government identification and records, permitting, where possible, changes on self-attestation alone;

(iii) requiring that an “X” marker be available on Federal Government identification and records that require gender;

(iv) requiring States to permit voters to update their name and gender on their voter registration and vote on the same day of Federal elections;

(v) making explicit that existing Federal statutes prohibiting sex discrimination in jury service also prohibit discrimination based on gender identity and sex characteristics;

(vi) eliminating anti-trans bias in the immigration system, including the asylum process, by requiring culturally competent training for adjudicators and ensuring that gender identity and sex characteristics are not used to the detriment of individuals in immigration proceedings;

(vii) ensuring that dedicated and capable transgender and nonbinary servicemembers can continue to serve proudly and openly in the Armed Forces;

(viii) requiring the TRICARE program (as defined in section 1072 of title 10, United States Code) and the Department of Veterans Affairs to pay for gender-affirming health care; and

(ix) requiring a review of military discharges for transgender and nonbinary veterans, and reclassification of discharge status and code, to ensure the patriotism and sacrifices of transgender and nonbinary servicemembers is respected above partisan politics;

(E) strengthening the safety of transgender and nonbinary people by—

(i) investing in community services to prevent intimate partner, family, and community violence against transgender and nonbinary people and expand services for transgender and nonbinary survivors;

(ii) investing in mental health services and suicide prevention programs designed for transgender and nonbinary people;

(iii) ensuring robust regulations and procedures that affirm that claims for immigration relief or asylum based on persecution related to gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, and sex characteristics are protected grounds in the context of asylum adjudications;

(iv) ensuring housing assignments for transgender and nonbinary people in government custody are based on their safety needs and providing individual housing determinations that incorporate assessments by qualified caseworkers and the assessment of the individual of their safety needs;

(v) prohibiting involuntary solitary or administrative confinement of a transgender or nonbinary individual because of their gender identity; and

(vi) exploring policies and practices that improve the safety of transgender and nonbinary individuals incarcerated in jails, prisons, and immigration detention facilities and ensuring that those populations of transgender and nonbinary individuals have access to gender-affirming care, appropriate services, and commissary items consistent with their gender identity; and

(F) actively enforcing the civil rights of transgender and nonbinary people by all government agencies including by—

(i) requiring the Attorney General to designate a liaison within the Civil Rights Division of the Department of Justice whose job is dedicated to advising on and overseeing enforcement of the civil rights of transgender and nonbinary people; and

(ii) appropriating the funds necessary to fully staff and support the enforcement of these rights across agencies;

(2) to carry out the goals in this resolution, Federal agencies must collect gender identity and sex characteristics information on a voluntary, confidential basis solely for equity and public health purposes in key Federal surveys;

(3) the Federal Government must make an ongoing commitment to the rights of transgender and nonbinary people;

(4) policies concerning transgender rights must be led and informed by transgender communities, in particular Black and Indigenous women who face heightened risk of violence, poverty, discrimination, and other harm due to their intersecting identities; and

(5) the actions listed in this resolution are only the first steps toward transgender equality.

SENATE RESOLUTION 605—DENOUNCING STATEMENTS BY PRESIDENT DONALD J. TRUMP THAT HE MAY “NATIONALIZE,” COMMANDEER, OR OTHERWISE ASSUME DIRECT CONTROL OVER ELECTIONS

Mr. MARKEY (for himself, Mr. BLUMENTHAL, and Mr. SCHIFF) submitted the following resolution; which was referred to the Committee on Rules and Administration:

S. RES. 605

Whereas the Constitution of the United States vests primary authority over the times, places, and manner of Federal elections in the legislatures of the several States and Congress, and does not assign to the President any power to directly control or administer elections;

Whereas section 4 of article I of the Constitution of the United States provides that “The Times, Places and Manner of holding Elections for Senators and Representatives, shall be prescribed in each State by the Legislature thereof; but Congress may at any

time by Law make or alter such Regulations,” underscoring State control over electoral administration;

Whereas public statements by President Donald J. Trump urging members of one political party to “take over the voting” and calling for Republicans to “nationalize the voting,” including a Federal takeover of election processes in “at least many, 15 places,” represent a proposal that would require the Federal executive branch to displace the constitutionally assigned role of State and local authorities in administering elections;

Whereas the Constitution’s framework reflects a fundamental structural commitment to federalism and to the separation of powers between the legislative, executive, and judicial branches, with States primarily responsible for regulating elections, subject to guardrails by Congress;

Whereas repeated claims that the 2020 presidential election was “rigged” or marked by widespread, systemic fraud have been rejected by Federal law enforcement and intelligence agencies in the first Trump Administration, State election officials, courts, and independent fact-checking, and have no credible evidentiary basis;

Whereas any attempt by the President to exercise unilateral authority over the conduct of Federal elections, absent a clear grant of constitutional or statutory power by Congress, would be illegal, unconstitutional, and without lawful effect;

Whereas the President has a constitutional obligation to “take Care that the Laws be faithfully executed,” not to disregard the constitutional order or to pursue actions that usurp powers reserved to the States or to Congress; and

Whereas the Senate affirms that preserving the constitutional allocation of powers over elections is essential to the integrity of the Republic, the rule of law, and the public’s confidence in democratic self-government: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Senate—

(1) finds that the Constitution of the United States entrusts the primary oversight and administration of Federal elections to State and local authorities and Congress;

(2) rejects any suggestion that the President of the United States may lawfully “nationalize,” commandeer, or otherwise assume direct control over elections;

(3) renounces any effort by the President to exercise such authority, absent explicit constitutional or statutory grant, as antithetical to the Constitution, unlawful, and without effect;

(4) expresses its grave concern that public advocacy of unconstitutional power by the President undermines foundational principles of federalism, threatens the rule of law, and erodes public trust in the democratic process; and

(5) maintains that should the President attempt to implement or execute measures that unconstitutionally infringe on the constitutional prerogatives of the States or contrary to the laws enacted by Congress, such conduct would constitute grounds for impeachment and removal from office under article II of the Constitution.

SENATE RESOLUTION 606—CONDEMNING THE GOVERNMENT OF IRAN FOR ITS SUPPRESSION OF THE RIGHT OF IRANIANS TO PEACEFULLY ASSEMBLE

Mr. LANKFORD (for himself, Mrs. SHAHEEN, Mr. BOOKER, Mr. BOOZMAN, Mrs. BRITT, Mr. BUDD, Mrs. CAPITO, Mr.

CRAMER, Mr. CRUZ, Ms. ERNST, Mrs. FISCHER, Mr. GRASSLEY, Mr. HOEVEN, Mr. KAINE, Mr. MERKLEY, Mr. MULLIN, Mr. RICKETTS, Ms. ROSEN, Mr. SULLIVAN, Mr. VAN HOLLEN, Mr. SCHUMER, Mr. MCCONNELL, Mr. COTTON, Mr. KIM, and Mr. DURBIN) submitted the following resolution; which was referred to the Committee on Foreign Relations:

S. RES. 606

Whereas, on December 28, 2025, protests began in Iran in response to enduring economic hardship;

Whereas, in December 2025, the annual inflation rate in Iran reached 42.2 percent;

Whereas, on December 29, 2025, the Iranian rial hit a record low of 1,430,000 Iranian rials per one United States dollar, further causing economic strife for everyday Iranians;

Whereas the protests have spread throughout Iran’s capital of Tehran, all 31 provinces of Iran, and at least 100 other cities and towns nationwide in the country’s largest protests since 2022;

Whereas the first deaths were recorded on January 1, 2026, when at least seven protestors were shot and killed;

Whereas, on January 3, 2026, Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei said that “rioters must be put in their place;”

Whereas, beginning on January 8, 2026, the Iranian regime implemented near-total internet blackouts across the country, including both intranet access and external internet access as well as cellular services;

Whereas the Iranian regime uses censorship and internet blackouts as a tool of repression against the Iranian people;

Whereas the United States has long supported tools to ensure Iranians have access to the means to circumvent the censorship of the regime and access to news and information free of the regime’s interference, including through the Open Technology Fund, Radio Farda, and the Middle East Broadcasting Networks;

Whereas, on January 10, 2026, the Attorney General of Iran, Mohammad Movahedi Azad, said that anyone taking part in protests and those who “helped rioters” would be considered an “enemy of God,” a capital offense in Iran;

Whereas, as of February 10, 2026, there have been at least 6,126 deaths, with credible reporting of up to 30,000 deaths, including 86 children and 49 civilians who were not demonstrating, and 41,800 arrests of protestors have been reported;

Whereas hospitals, medical centers, and morgues have been overwhelmed with injured and dead protestors;

Whereas medical professionals inside Iran have reported receiving hundreds of patients who were injured by live rounds of ammunition from security forces;

Whereas Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei holds ultimate authority over Iran’s security agencies and has overseen and orchestrated countless human rights violations against Iranian citizens and dissidents since 1989;

Whereas the Iranian regime has used its security forces to crack down on protests through violent means, including through extrajudicial killings—

(1) in 1999, when at least three students were killed, several students disappeared, and at least 1,500 people were arrested following passage by the Iranian Parliament of censorship legislation and the subsequent closure of a reformist newspaper;

(2) in 2009, when dozens of people were killed and opposition candidates were arrested following protests over fraudulent elections;

(3) in 2017, when protests began as a result of increasing food prices and the deepening economic crisis, resulting in 20 deaths and hundreds of arrests;

(4) in 2019, when Iranian security forces killed approximately 1,500 people and detained 8,600 in response to protests over fuel; and

(5) in 2022, when more than 500 protestors were killed and 22,000 were detained after Mahsa Amini died while in the custody of the Morality Police after being detained for wearing a hijab “improperly,” prompting thousands of women to lead the Women, Life, Freedom effort in the streets of Iran;

Whereas the regime has a history of disproportionately cracking down on religious and ethnic minorities, including Christians, Baha’is, Zoroastrians, Jews, Sunnis, agnostics and Kurds;

Whereas Iranian civilians’ unprecedented nationwide protests and bravery, confronted with the regime’s unprecedented widespread extrajudicial killing of thousands and disruption of all electronic communication, have profoundly destabilized the country and constitute changed conditions in Iran;

Whereas the regime continues to persecute citizens who it disagrees with by using criminal statutes like “insulting the Prophet,” “insulting Islam,” “rebellion against God,” and “corruption on earth;”

Whereas the Government of Iran continues to attempt to suppress protestors, including through means of—

- (1) extrajudicial killings;
- (2) forced disappearances;
- (3) torture;
- (4) sexual and gender-based violence;
- (5) arbitrary detention and imprisonment;
- (6) severe restrictions on free expression,
- (7) internet blackouts, censorship, and prohibition of virtual private networks;
- (8) criminalization of libel; and
- (9) severe restrictions of religious freedom;

and Whereas the people of Iran have continued to fight for their basic human rights in the face of violence and oppression: Now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Senate—

(1) strongly condemns the Government of Iran’s continued killing of protestors and bystanders;

(2) condemns the Government of Iran for its suppression of Iranians’ basic human rights, including their right to peacefully assemble;

(3) commends the courage of the Iranian people to protest amid increased and harsh persecution from the Government of Iran;

(4) calls on the Government of Iran to hold free and fair elections and allow the people of Iran to determine their own future; and

(5) supports the calls of the Iranian people to bring human rights violators to justice.

AMENDMENTS SUBMITTED AND PROPOSED

SA 4296. Mr. GRAHAM submitted an amendment intended to be proposed by him to the bill H.R. 7147, making further consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes; which was ordered to lie on the table.

TEXT OF AMENDMENTS

SA 4296. Mr. GRAHAM submitted an amendment intended to be proposed by him to the bill H.R. 7147, making further consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and for other purposes; which was ordered to lie on the table; as follows:

At the appropriate place, insert the following:

SEC. ____ OBSTRUCTION OF IMMIGRATION LAWS BY OFFICIAL INTERFERENCE.

(a) IN GENERAL.—Chapter 93 of title 18, United States Code, is amended by adding at the end the following:

“§ 1925. Obstruction of immigration laws by official interference

“(a) DEFINITIONS.—In this section—

“(1) the term ‘criminal alien’ means an alien (as defined in section 101(a) of the Immigration and Nationality Act (8 U.S.C. 1001(a))) who has been charged with or convicted of a crime under Federal or State law; “(2) the terms ‘Federal sex offense’ and ‘minor’ have the meanings given such terms in section 3559(e)(2);

“(3) the term ‘immigration laws’ has the meaning given that term in section 101(a) of the Immigration and Nationality Act (8 U.S.C. 1101(a));

“(4) the term ‘reasonable advance notice’, with respect to the release of a criminal alien, means notice regarding the scheduled release date and time of the criminal alien that is provided as early as practicable and, unless impossible, at least 48 hours prior to release;

“(5) the term ‘responsible executive official’, with respect to a law, regulation, policy, practice, or action, means the most senior executive official of a State or unit of government charged with overseeing execution of the law, regulation, policy, practice, or action.

“(6) the term ‘serious violent felony’ has the meaning given that term in section 3559(c)(2);

“(7) the terms ‘State’ and ‘unit of local government’ have the meanings given such terms in section 901(a) of the Omnibus Crime Control and Safe Streets Act of 1968 (34 U.S.C. 10251(a)); and

“(8) the term ‘State sex offense’ means a State or Military sex offense (as defined in section 3559(e)(2)) that is an offense under State law.

“(b) PROHIBITED CONDUCT.—It shall be unlawful for any responsible executive official of a State or unit of local government, acting under color of law, to knowingly prohibit, limit, or restrict compliance with any formal request under the immigration laws by the Department of Homeland Security for reasonable advance notice regarding the release of a criminal alien, including through establishing, directing, implementing, or enforcing any pertinent law, regulation, policy, practice, or action.

“(c) PENALTIES.—A person who violates subsection (b)—

“(1) if the violation results in the release from custody of a criminal alien who has been charged with or convicted of an offense consisting of murder, rape, or a Federal sex offense or State sex offense against a minor, shall be fined under this title, imprisoned for not less than 10 years and not more than 25 years, or both;

“(2) if the violation results in the release from custody of a criminal alien who has been charged with or convicted of an offense that is a serious violent felony, shall be fined under this title, imprisoned for not less than 5 years and not more than 10 years, or both; or

“(3) if the violation results in the release from custody of a criminal alien who has been charged with or convicted of any other Federal or State criminal offense, shall be fined under this title, imprisoned for not less than 30 days and not more than 6 months, or both.”

(b) SEVERABILITY CLAUSE.—If any provision of this section, an amendment made by this section, or the application of such a provi-

sion or amendment to any particular person or circumstance is held invalid, the remaining provisions of this section and the amendments made by this section, and the application of such remaining provisions and amendments to any other person or circumstance, shall not be affected thereby.

(c) TECHNICAL AND CONFORMING AMENDMENT.—The table of sections for chapter 93 of title 18, United States Code, is amended by adding at the end the following:

“1925. Obstruction of immigration laws by official interference.”

AUTHORITY FOR COMMITTEES TO MEET

Mr. THUNE. Mr. President, I have four requests for committees to meet during today’s session of the Senate. They have the approval of the Majority and Minority Leaders.

Pursuant to Rule XXVI, paragraph 5(a), of the Standing Rules of the Senate, the following committees are authorized to meet during today’s session of the Senate:

COMMITTEE ON VETERANS’ AFFAIRS

The Committee on Veterans’ Affairs is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Wednesday, February 11, 2026, at 3 p.m., to conduct a hearing.

SPECIAL COMMITTEE ON AGING

The Special Committee on Aging is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Wednesday, February 11, 2026, at 3:30 p.m., to conduct a hearing.

SELECT COMMITTEE ON INTELLIGENCE

The Select Committee on Intelligence is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Wednesday, February 11, 2026, at 3 p.m., to conduct a closed briefing.

SUBCOMMITTEE ON PERSONNEL

The Subcommittee on Personnel of the Committee on Armed Services is authorized to meet during the session of the Senate on Wednesday, February 11, 2026, at 3 p.m., to conduct a hearing.

ORDERS FOR THURSDAY, FEBRUARY 12, 2026

Mrs. BRITT. I ask unanimous consent that when the Senate completes its business today, it stand adjourned until 11 a.m. on Thursday, February 12; that following the prayer and pledge, the Journal of proceedings be approved to date, the morning hour be deemed expired, the time for the two leaders be reserved for their use later in the day, morning business be closed, and notwithstanding rule XXII, the Senate resume consideration of Calendar No. 315, H.J. Res. 142, and the Senate vote on passage at 12 noon; further, that upon disposition of the joint resolution, the Senate resume consideration of the motion to proceed to Calendar No. 311, H.R. 7147, and that there be 30 minutes of debate, equally divided between the two leaders or their designees, and the Senate vote on the motion to invoke cloture following the use or yielding back of that time.

The PRESIDING OFFICER. Without objection, it is so ordered.

ADJOURNMENT UNTIL 11 A.M. TOMORROW

Mrs. BRITT. Mr. President, if there is no further business to come before the Senate, I ask that it stand adjourned under the previous order.

There being no objection, the Senate, at 7:01 p.m., adjourned until Thursday, February 12, 2026, at 11 a.m.

NOMINATIONS

Executive nominations received by the Senate:

DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE

GEORGE KELESIS, OF NEVADA, TO BE UNITED STATES ATTORNEY FOR THE DISTRICT OF NEVADA FOR THE TERM OF FOUR YEARS, VICE JASON M. FRIERSON.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

CATHERINE DILLON, OF MARYLAND, TO BE ASSISTANT SECRETARY OF STATE (EDUCATIONAL AND CULTURAL AFFAIRS), VICE LEE SATTERFIELD, RESIGNED.

DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR

WILLIAM HAGUE, OF WASHINGTON, TO BE AN ASSISTANT SECRETARY OF THE INTERIOR, VICE CARMEN G. CANTOR, RESIGNED.

DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY

KYLE HAUSTVEIT, OF NORTH DAKOTA, TO BE UNDER SECRETARY OF ENERGY, VICE PRESTON GRIFFITH, RESIGNED.

DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE

STEVEN LEWIS, OF MISSOURI, TO BE UNITED STATES MARSHAL FOR THE EASTERN DISTRICT OF MISSOURI, FOR THE TERM OF FOUR YEARS, VICE JOHN D. JORDAN, TERM EXPIRED.

DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR

KEVIN LILLY, OF TEXAS, TO BE ASSISTANT SECRETARY FOR FISH AND WILDLIFE, VICE SHANNON ANEAL ESTENOZ, RESIGNED.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

ASEL ROBERTS, OF VIRGINIA, TO BE AMBASSADOR EXTRAORDINARY AND PLENIPOTENTIARY OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA TO THE REPUBLIC OF SLOVENIA.

CONSUMER PRODUCT SAFETY COMMISSION

KAREN SESSIONS, OF TEXAS, TO BE A COMMISSIONER OF THE CONSUMER PRODUCT SAFETY COMMISSION FOR A TERM OF SEVEN YEARS FROM OCTOBER 27, 2025, VICE MARY T. BOYLE, TERM EXPIRED.

DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR

SCOTT SOCHA, OF NEW YORK, TO BE DIRECTOR OF THE NATIONAL PARK SERVICE, VICE CHARLES F. SAMS III, RESIGNED.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

TODD STEGGERDA, OF VIRGINIA, TO BE REPRESENTATIVE OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA TO THE OFFICE OF THE UNITED NATIONS AND OTHER INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS IN GENEVA, WITH THE RANK OF AMBASSADOR.

FEDERAL ELECTION COMMISSION

ASHLEY STOW, OF TEXAS, TO BE A MEMBER OF THE FEDERAL ELECTION COMMISSION FOR A TERM EXPIRING APRIL 30, 2029, VICE JAMES E. TRAINOR III, TERM EXPIRED.

ANDREW WOODSON, OF VIRGINIA, TO BE A MEMBER OF THE FEDERAL ELECTION COMMISSION FOR A TERM EXPIRING APRIL 30, 2031, VICE ALLEN DICKERSON, TERM EXPIRED.

IN THE AIR FORCE

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE TO THE GRADE INDICATED UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be major general

BRIG. GEN. ERICA R. AUSTIN

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE UNITED STATES AIR FORCE TO THE GRADE INDICATED UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 9435:

To be brigadier general

COL. JAMES M. VALPIANI

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR TEMPORARY APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 605:

To be lieutenant colonel

JOHN I. ALORA

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR TEMPORARY APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 605:

To be colonel

PETER J. DYRUD

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be colonel

ERICA E. TORTELLA

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

ANDRE L. MOONEY
PHILIP P. SPITZER

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

MEGAN E. GAGNON

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

THOMAS J. ALFORD
GARRETT M. CONDON
WESLEY K. DUNCAN
ERIC C. FRANCUM
JASON A. REDING
JOSEPH A. SMIGA
MATTHEW D. VANMAASDAM

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

JAYDEE A. BURNS

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

KURT L. KAISER
JEREMIAH J. MCLENDON
SHANE W. OWEN

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

LISA A. BALLAS
ERIC A. BALLEW
CHADD W. BLOOMSTINE
BRANDON L. BROWN
DEVON M. BURTON
STEVEN L. BURTON
GABRIEL I. CHAVARRIA
LANCE E. FERGUSON
STEVEN C. FOWLER
KIEL R. GILLILAND
BRYAN W. GRANGER
THOMAS B. HAMILTON III
LUKE R. HAYWAS
JASON T. HELMICK
JEREMY L. HOLT
DUSTIN G. JOHNSON
SRIRAM KRISHNAN
EDWARD T. LENNON
BENJAMIN N. MATHIAS
MILLARD MATTHEWS III
PETE J. MCCORMICK
BROUGH L. MCDONALD
BRIAN G. MCGINNIS
RAPHAEL E. MICHEL
PATRICK R. OMALLEY
ADAM P. PAULY
OLAYANJU A. POPOOLA
DEREK M. PORTLOCK
CHRISTOPHER A. PUCCIA
TIMOTHY M. RAY
JUSTIN R. REYNOLDS
TRAVIS R. RHODE
RICHARD V. ROBICHAUD
MICHAEL R. RUBELING
ERIC D. SCHARNOWSKI
PHILIP A. SCHREDL
WILLIAM S. SILENCE
JILL N. SLIGER
MARK P. SMITH
KALLEEN H. STEELE
GINA M. STRAMAGLIO
JOHN R. TICE
KEVIN J. TRACY
BUSCH VOIGTS III
GREGORY M. WATSON
CHRISTOPHER D. ZAREMSKI
BRADLEY R. ZIMMERMAN

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

DANAH L. AUTRY
COLEEN A. BARNETT

RICO J. M. CICERO
BRANDI N. COLLEN
CLAUDE T. DALLAS
ELIZABETH J. EMMONS
MELISSA Z. GREENE
MARGARET M. F. HOTCHKIN
MARK E. JOHNSON
BRIAN J. LOFTUS
JESS C. LOZANO
MICHAEL A. MAISE
DANIEL E. NOYER
DAVID G. SIMONS, JR.
KATHLEEN D. STEFANICH
CINDY N. H. STOROY
HAROLD A. TONGSON
JOHN J. VALDES III

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

MICHELLE J. BISHOP
JEREMIAH J. FLERCHINGER
OLEN T. FREEMAN
RAYMUND H. GALDIANO
PAULINE N. HARKE
JOHN J. HOFFMANN
TIMOTHY W. JOHANSEN
RANDY P. JONES
JAMES S. KEOHANE
MARNEE A. C. LOSURDO
DANIEL LUNSFORD
MICHAEL T. MCFARLAND
ERNEST F. MOORE
IAN V. PHILLIPS
KARLA K. RUIZSCHULTZ
GEORGE D. SOTELO
PHILIP A. SPENCER
MYA J. STIERWALT
MICHAEL D. TROYER, JR.
CASSONDRA A. WALKER
LINDSEY H. WILKINSON
MARESA Y. ZORRILLA

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

JESSE D. CASH
SONJA R. DEMUTH
HEIDI R. HARKINS
SIUL MICHEL
APRIL K. REVETERIANO
LISA T. SEYMOUR

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

TARIN C. GRISWOLD
TAL M. ZIV

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

JENNIFER M. CONK
JEREMY J. FRANKE
ADAM P. GOOBIC
JONATHAN P. MAJO
GINA G. MCCLEERY
NOAH J. MERICA/JONES
ERIK P. SOLVERSON
KATHERINE L. STOWE
MARIA M. VASILE

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

DANIELLE D. POYANT

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

THOMAS M. BEACHKOFISKY
ANDREA J. BLAKE
AMANDA C. BOONE
SHAWN S. CARTER
ROBERT M. DEWITT
IVAN P. EDWARDS
RAUL R. MONTIAGUE
MICHAEL C. OTT
COURTNEY W. RIDNER
BRIAN S. SMITH

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

AARON J. HAYES

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

CAROLE S. LOWE
REBECCA S. NEITZKE
JUSTIN B. PERKINS
JOSHUA D. WYTE

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

JENNIFER L. LEACH

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

JILL E. BURKETT
EMILY N. DERRY
LISA E. DONOVAN
LISA M. HAIK
SHELLI J. HUNTER
ERIC D. MILLER
FRED A. POUNDS, JR.
LAURA K. RHODA
GREGORY S. SELL

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

ALEXANDER L. BINGCANG
ANTHONY P. GADDI
JASON C. MCCARTHY
NATHAN B. MILLER
PETER T. TRAN

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

DENNIS B. BOURDO II
STEPHANIE M. BRUSHETT
RACHEL E. COPELAND
MELISSA D. DAVIS
DAVID B. FRANKLIN
DANIEL E. TOOCHECK
CARIST L. WASHINGTON

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE RESERVE OF THE AIR FORCE UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 12203:

To be colonel

STEPHEN B. CARLTON
JAMI N. FERNANDEZ
TYLER A. GRUNEWALD
CLEVELAND HAYES II

IN THE ARMY

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT AS PERMANENT PROFESSOR AT THE UNITED STATES MILITARY ACADEMY AND APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES ARMY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTIONS 7433(B) AND 7436(A):

To be colonel

VICTOR A. JAFFETT

IN THE NAVY

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be lieutenant commander

JERRAD W. DENNEY

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR TEMPORARY APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 605:

To be lieutenant commander

THOMAS W. ADAIR
KIRSTIN E. ANDERSON
CONNOR P. BAILEY
JOHN A. BANTLE
TRAVIS L. BECK
GORDON H. BEVILLE
ALEXANDER G. BEZAITIS
JOHN W. BLAHUTA
LIAM F. CAMPBELL
MARK DRIVER
NICHOLAS L. FALATKO
JACOB P. FALTEMIER
NATHAN D. GLOWACKI
JOSEPH H. GRAYBEAL
COLIN M. HANLEY
BARRY F. HINEY
MATTHEW W. HUFF
KENNETH C. JENKINS
VINCENT A. KAHNKE
TYLER T. KIRSCH
KYLE A. KOSINSKI
IAN A. MACLEOD
CRYSTAN S. MCLYMORE
ELBERTON A. MIXON
JOHN P. MORRISON
JEREMY L. OCHS
JOSEPH T. PISCOPO
MICHAEL T. PISCOPO
DEREK A. POMER
KEVIN D. PORTER
DAVID P. PRY
LOGAN W. SELLERS
CHRISTOPHER S. SIMMONS
JAMES P. TALISSE
BRYAN TIERNEY
ELIZABETH M. WABEKE
COLIN W. WATSON

YUJI A. WILLIAMS
FRANK R. ZIMMERMAN IV

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR TEMPORARY APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 605:

To be commander

RICHARD E. ARTHUR II
HERNAN R. BORJA
LARRY W. BUCKNER II
GEORGE L. DAY II
JEREMIAH B. EDWARDS
CHRISTOPHER L. HEVEY
THOMAS P. MACNEIL
KATHERINE Y. MANN
JULIO C. MIRANDA
JOEL R. NELSON
BENJAMIN J. REED
ROBERT J. SQUIRES
JANET S. VONEIFF
DAVID B. WELBORN
MICHAEL S. WILLIAMS

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR TEMPORARY APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 605:

To be captain

JAMESON R. ADLER
MATTHEW R. BRADEN
BRIAN M. IRISH
JORDAN W. KELLY
ANDREW G. LICHTENSTEIN
MICHAEL L. LINN
RYAN D. MCGINN

JACOB M. MONTTOYA
GARRETT T. PANKOW

THE FOLLOWING NAMED INDIVIDUAL FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE REGULAR NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 531:

To be lieutenant commander

M L. ATTEBERY

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICERS FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be lieutenant commander

RICHARD J. CURLEY
HARRISON H. HALEY
BRENDAN J. TOUREK

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be commander

NATHAN T. COURIC

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be commander

BARBARA J. COLBERG

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be captain

GARY W. FOSHEE

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be captain

JESS A. VAUGHT

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be captain

JOHN H. ROSS

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT TO THE GRADE INDICATED IN THE UNITED STATES NAVY UNDER TITLE 10, U.S.C., SECTION 624:

To be captain

JOHN D. MORRIS IV

IN THE COAST GUARD

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE UNITED STATES COAST GUARD TO THE GRADE INDICATED UNDER TITLE 14, U.S.C., SECTION 2121(E):

To be captain

JON M. KREISCHER

THE FOLLOWING NAMED OFFICER FOR APPOINTMENT IN THE UNITED STATES COAST GUARD TO THE GRADE INDICATED UNDER TITLE 14, U.S.C., SECTION 2121(E):

To be captain

JESSE M. MILLARD

EXTENSIONS OF REMARKS

TRIBUTE TO BRIGADIER GENERAL AIDA "TERRI" BORRAS

HON. CHRISSE HOULAHAN

OF PENNSYLVANIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Ms. HOULAHAN. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to congratulate Brigadier General Aida "Terri" Borras on her retirement from the U.S. Army. Brigadier General Borras' forty-one year career has been characterized by exceptionally meritorious service while serving in positions of increasing responsibility, culminating as the Assistant Deputy Chief of Staff (Intelligence) for Headquarters Department of the Army G2. Born in Puerto Rico and raised in New York, Brigadier General Borras' distinguished service has impacted the lives of countless Soldiers and their families.

Borras enlisted in the Army in 1985. During her enlisted career, she served as an intelligence Soldier in the Combined Field Army (Republic of Korea-U.S.), the 96th Civil Affairs Battalion (Airborne), the 1st Special Operations Command (Airborne), the Special Forces Command (Airborne), and participated in combat operations during Operation Just Cause. In 1992, she was selected for the Army's Green to Gold Program and graduated two years later from The George Washington University and received her commission as a second lieutenant in the Military Intelligence Corps in 1994.

Her command assignments include: Platoon Leader, Delta Company, 629th Military Intelligence Battalion (CEWI), Maryland National Guard; Company Commander, Headquarters and Headquarters Company, INSCOM Support Battalion (Provisional); Battalion Commander, Army Reserve Element at the 1st Information Operations Command (Land); Battalion Commander, North Central Army Reserve Intelligence Support Center; Brigade Commander, Army Reserve Operational Activity; Commanding General, Military Intelligence Readiness Command; and Deputy Commanding General, Southern European Task Force Africa.

Staff assignments include: Intelligence Watch Officer, Joint Analysis Center; Joint Information Operations Planner on the Multi-national Force—Iraq staff during Operation Iraqi Freedom; Director, Army Reserve G-39 (Cyber and Information Operations Directorate) on the Office of the Chief, Army Reserve; and Director, Commander's Action Group for the Commanding General, United States Army Reserve Command.

I thank Terri for her distinguished service, and her professionalism and passion for service in every role she has filled throughout her prestigious career. Part of what makes the U.S. military the greatest in the world is that servicemembers like Terri voluntarily dedicate their lives to serve and sacrifice for this country. I also want to thank her husband Patrick and her children, Sean, Liam, Conor, Eion and Siannen, for their unwavering support. I wish

Terri and her family all the best in what I hope to be a restful and enjoyable future.

PERSONAL EXPLANATION

HON. NANCY PELOSI

OF CALIFORNIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Ms. PELOSI. Mr. Speaker, I missed votes due to a previously scheduled speaking engagement in recognition of America250 at Loyola Marymount University. Had I been present, I would have voted YEA on Roll Call No. 57, and YEA on Roll Call No. 58.

WAR CRIMINAL PUTIN SHOULD APOLOGIZE

HON. JOE WILSON

OF SOUTH CAROLINA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. WILSON of South Carolina. Mr. Speaker, war criminal Putin should apologize for his January 29th, 2026 phone call pledge to President Donald Trump to avoid destroying utilities in Ukraine, while Putin accelerates attacks to freeze Ukrainians, as Stalin starved Ukrainians.

Putin should apologize to courageous First Lady Melania Trump for keeping kidnapped Ukrainian children to 'Putinize' them, as Hitler kidnapped Polish children to Germany.

Putin should apologize to Trump envoy Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner for endless meetings in Moscow, Doha, Abu Dhabi, Miami, Vienna, and New York as Putin restocks Iranian drones, Chinese Communist Party missiles, and North Korean troops.

The war continues as dictators with rule of gun invade democracies with rule of law—February 24, 2022 into Ukraine; and October 7, 2023 into Israel.

In conclusion, God bless our troops as the global war on terrorism continues. Trump is reinstituting peace through strength, revealing war criminal Putin lies, insulting Trump and mocking Trump with murderous attacks this week in Ukraine, freezing civilians to death with no electricity, heat, or water.

HONORING THE 2025 FELLOWS OF THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF INVENTORS

HON. KATHY CASTOR

OF FLORIDA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Ms. CASTOR of Florida. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the 169 inventors who will be inducted as the 2025 Fellows of the National Academy of Inventors (NAI). An induction

ceremony will take place on June 4, 2026, in Los Angeles, California to celebrate these distinguished inventors and their incredible accomplishments. The ceremony will be presided over by Dr. Paul R. Sanberg, FNAI. To be named as a Fellow, these individuals were nominated by their peers and underwent a review process by the NAI Selection Committee, which ultimately deemed their innovations as making a significant impact on the quality of life, economic development and the welfare of their communities, the residents of Florida and the United States.

The NAI Fellow program has 2,253 Fellows worldwide representing more than 300 prestigious universities and governmental and non-profit research institutes. Collectively, the Fellows hold more than 86,000 issued U.S. patents, which have generated over 20,000 licensed technologies and 4,000 companies, and created more than 1.4 million jobs. In addition, over \$3.8 trillion in revenue has been generated based on NAI Fellow discoveries.

Among NAI fellows, there are more than 170 presidents and senior leaders of research universities and nonprofit research institutes, over 796 members of the National Academies of Sciences, Engineering and Medicine, about 60 inductees of the National Inventors Hall of Fame, 76 recipients of the U.S. National Medal of Technology and Innovation and U.S. National Medal of Science, and 59 Nobel Laureates, among other awards and distinctions.

Founded by Dr. Paul R. Sanberg at the University of South Florida in 2010, the NAI's mission is to recognize and encourage inventors with patents issued from the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office, enhance the visibility of academic technology and innovation, encourage the disclosure of intellectual property, educate, and mentor innovative students and translate the inventions of its members to benefit Florida and communities all throughout the United States.

Mr. Speaker, on behalf of my neighbors in Tampa Bay and the citizens of Florida, I am proud to honor the 2025 Fellows of the National Academy of Inventors for this outstanding achievement. We must commend these inventors for their invaluable contributions to society, which continually propel us forward. May their example inspire future generations to pursue their own paths of discovery and innovation, ensuring a bright and innovative future for us all. I include in the RECORD the following list of the names of the 2025 NAI Fellows Class:

Reza Abdolvand, University of Central Florida; Gregory Abowd, Northeastern University; Anant Agarwal, The Ohio State University; Ali AL-Marzouqi, United Arab Emirates University; Mansoor Amiji, Northeastern University; Ana Claudia Arias, University of California, Berkeley; Aravind Asokan, Duke University; Gregory Auner, Wayne State University; Jennifer Avari Silva, Washington University in St. Louis; Ahmad Bahai, Massachusetts Institute of Technology; Hua "Kevin" Bai, The University of Tennessee, Knoxville; David Baker, University of Washington; Sathy Balu-iyer, University at Buffalo, The State University

• This "bullet" symbol identifies statements or insertions which are not spoken by a Member of the Senate on the floor.

Matter set in this typeface indicates words inserted or appended, rather than spoken, by a Member of the House on the floor.

of New York; Dafna Bari Sagi, NYU Langone Health; Matthew Barth, University of California, Riverside; Haim Bau, University of Pennsylvania; Magdy Bayoumi, University of Louisiana at Lafayette; Zdenek Bazant, Northwestern University; Rohit Bhargava, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign; Suresh Bhargava, Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology; Stephan Biller, Purdue University; Christian Bréchet, University of South Florida; Igal Brenner, Sandia National Laboratories; Robert Brown, Case Western Reserve University; J. Quincy Brown, Tulane University; Louis Brus, Columbia University; Carol Carter, Stony Brook University; Chan-Byoung Chae, Yonsei University; Krishnendu Chakrabarty, Arizona State University; Joseph Chang, Nanyang Technological University, Singapore; Goutam Chattopadhyay, California Institute of Technology & NASA Jet Propulsion Lab; Eugene Chen, Colorado State University; Ji-Xin Cheng, Boston University; Gari Clifford, Emory University; Gloria Coruzzi, New York University; Sheng Dai, Oak Ridge National Laboratory & University of Tennessee, Knoxville; James Dalton, Louisiana State University; Kapil Dandekar, Drexel University; Sylvia Daunert, University of Miami; David Deamer, University of California, Santa Cruz; André DeHon, University of Pennsylvania; Zhiqun (Daniel) Deng, Pacific Northwest National Laboratory; Tomas Diaz de la Rubia, The University of Arizona; Deepakraj Divan, Georgia Institute of Technology; Ravi Droopad, Texas State University; Tal Dvir, Tel Aviv University; Maher ElKady, University of California, Los Angeles; Omolola Eniola-Adefeso, University of Illinois at Chicago; Hongyou Fan, Sandia National Laboratories; Shanhui Fan, Stanford University; Omar Farha, Northwestern University; Benny Freeman, The University of Texas at Austin; Tahir Ghani, University of California, Berkeley; Swaroop Ghosh, The Pennsylvania State University; Barney Graham, Morehouse School of Medicine; Rasim Guldiken, Oklahoma State University; Jay Guo, University of Michigan; Satyandra Gupta, University of Southern California; Vineet Gupta, University of Texas Medical Branch; Hossam Haick, Technion—Israel Institute of Technology; Eva Harth, University of Houston; David Haussler, University of California, Santa Cruz; Donald Haynie, Centers for Disease Control; Abdelsalam Sumi Helal, University of Florida; Yehia Ibrahim, Pacific Northwest National Laboratory; Erick Iezzi, U.S. Naval Research Laboratory; Ehsan Jabbarzadeh, University of South Carolina; Yali Jia, Oregon Health & Science University; Eugene John, University of Texas at San Antonio; Darren Johnson, University of Oregon; Emil Jovanov, The University of Alabama in Huntsville; Tibor Juhasz, University of California, Irvine; Raghu Kalluri, The University of Texas MD Anderson Cancer Center; Dilhan M. Kalyon, Stevens Institute of Technology; Raghuraman Kannan, University of Missouri-Columbia; Mark Kelley, Indiana University; John Kellum, University of Pittsburgh; Michael Koeris, U.S. Department of War—Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency; Elisa Konofagou, Columbia University; Rosa Krajmalnik-Brown, Arizona State University; Florian Krammer, Icahn School of Medicine at Mount Sinai; Yue Kuo, Texas A&M University & National Yang Ming Chiao Tung University; Jih-Sheng “Jason” Lai, Virginia Tech; Carlito Lebrilla, University of California, Davis; Jean-Pierre Leburton, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign; Jason Lewis, Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center; Guoqiang Li, Louisiana State University; Jenshan Lin, National Science Foundation; Lih-Yuan Lin, University of Washington; Stuart Lipton,

The Scripps Research Institute; Bin Liu, National University of Singapore; Jun O. Liu, Johns Hopkins University; Ping Liu, University of California, San Diego; Yan-Fei Liu, Queen's University; Leslie M. Loew, University of Connecticut; Boon Thau Loo, University of Pennsylvania; Dusan Losic, Adelaide University; Jian Lu, City University of Hong Kong; Na (Luna) Lu, Purdue University; Daniel Ludois, University of Wisconsin-Madison; Alan Luo, The Ohio State University; Barbara Lyons, Lawrence Technological University; Chris Malachowsky, NVIDIA & University of Florida; Heidi M. Mansour, Florida International University; H. Alan Mantooth, University of Arkansas; David Martin, University of Delaware; Prasant Mohapatra, University of South Florida; Yaakov Nahmias, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem; Arokia Nathan, University of Cambridge; Maiken Nedergaard, University of Rochester; Daniel Nelson, University of Maryland, College Park; Henry Nguyen, University of Missouri-Columbia; David Nolte, Purdue University; John O' Shea, National Institutes of Health; Subba Reddy Palli, University of Kentucky; Bernhard Palsson, University of California, San Diego; Dipanjan Pan, The Pennsylvania State University; Marios-Christos Papaefthymiou, University of California, Irvine; Nikolaos Papanikolopoulos, University of Minnesota; Chandrakant D. Patel, Hewlett-Packard & University of South Florida; Stacey Patterson, Florida State University; Sanjoy Paul, Rice University; Dehua Pei, The Ohio State University; Danyll J. Pines, University of Maryland, College Park; Kevin W. Plaxco, University of California, Santa Barbara; Marc Porter, The University of Utah; George Prendergast, Lankenau Institute for Medical Research; Shashank Priya, University of Minnesota; Eric Prossnitz, The University of New Mexico; Alfredo Quinones-Hinojosa, Mayo Clinic; Sdriyasa Raghavan, University of Maryland, College Park; Barry Rand, Princeton University; Arijit Raychowdhury, Georgia Institute of Technology; Jochen Reiser, University of Texas Medical Branch; Shunlin Ren, Virginia Commonwealth University; C. Patrick Reynolds, Texas Tech University Health Sciences Center; R. Michael Roe, North Carolina State University; Steven Rosenberg, National Institutes of Health; Todd Rosengwt, Baylor College of Medicine; Joe Ruscito, Medical University of South Carolina; John Ruter, University of Georgia; Alan Saltiel, University of California, San Diego; Paul Santene, University of Toronto; Marios Savvides, Carnegie Mellon University; Patrick Schnable, Iowa State University; Mark Schoenfish, The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill; John Schroeder, Texas Tech University; Mathias Schubert, University of Nebraska-Lincoln; James Schwob, Tufts University; Mohamed Seleem, Virginia Tech; Mark Sheplak, University of Florida; James Simon, Rutgers, The State University of New Jersey; Dennis Slamon, University of California, Los Angeles; Barbara Slusher, Johns Hopkins University; J. Cory Smart, Georgetown University; Stuart Smith, The University of North Carolina at Charlotte; Gurindar Sohi, University of Wisconsin-Madison; Stephen Soper, University of Kansas; Timothy A. Springer, Harvard University; Mircea Stan, University of Virginia; Hung-Jue Sue, Texas A&M University; Shang-Hua Teng, University of Southern California; Kevin J. Tracey, The Feinstein Institutes for Medical Research; Philip R. Troyk, Illinois Institute of Technology; Chad A. Ulven, North Dakota State University; Kripa K. Varanasi, Massachusetts Institute of Technology; Jesse Wainright, Case Western Reserve University; Andrew Wang, The University of Texas Southwestern Medical

Center; Yan Wang, Worcester Polytechnic Institute; Adam Wax, Duke University; Rob Webster, Vanderbilt University; John Weidner, University of Cincinnati; David C. Weindorf, Georgia Southern University; Muthu B.J. Wijesundara, The University of Texas at Arlington; Tien Yin Wong, Tsinghua University; Tzong-Lin Wu, National Taiwan University; Cheryl Xu, North Carolina State University; Yajun Yan, University of Georgia; Lan Yang, Washington University in St. Louis; Yasha Yi, University of Michigan; Richard Zare, Stanford University; Wen Zhang, New Jersey Institute of Technology; Otto Zhou, The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill; and Zi-Qiang Zhu, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University.

HONORING THE SKANNER AND ITS LEGACY

HON. MAXINE DEXTER

OF OREGON

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Ms. DEXTER. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the legacy of an Oregon institution, Portland's Black-owned newspaper, *The Skanner*, which ceased production on January 30, 2026, after 50 years of journalistic excellence.

Since 1975, *The Skanner* has been providing important news and information, covering city, state, and national issues, interviews with political candidates, and never shrinking from holding public officials accountable. An irreplaceable cornerstone of Oregon's news environment, *The Skanner* became the largest Black newspaper in the Pacific Northwest.

Founded by Bernie Foster and Bobbie Dore Foster, *The Skanner* was created to reach and uplift Black Portlanders through community-centered journalism. The paper was built on the conviction that authentic storytelling comes from within the community itself. As Bobbie Foster has often shared, the legacy of *The Skanner* lies in fostering pride in Black business ownership, strengthening engagement with local journalism, and providing news that reflects the voices, values, and perspectives of the community.

Over its time in print, *The Skanner* was instrumental in the renaming of Union Avenue in the 1980s and 1990s to be called Martin Luther King, Jr., Boulevard. Additionally, articles published by the paper in 2015 led to Henry Lincoln Johnson, a World War I hero, posthumously receiving the Congressional Medal of Honor.

As a former student journalist, I know how powerful local reporting is. It informs. It connects. It brings to light stories that would otherwise be left in darkness. *The Skanner* faithfully served the Pacific Northwest for 50 years, and its absence will be deeply felt.

I thank the journalists, editors, photographers, and staff—past and present—for their service to our state and commitment to the pursuit of justice.

RECOGNIZING MRS. MARY EDITH BROWN COLEMAN'S 109TH BIRTHDAY

HON. FRANK J. MRVAN

OF INDIANA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. MRVAN. Mr. Speaker, it is with great respect that I rise to congratulate Mrs. Mary Edith Brown Coleman as she celebrates her 109th birthday on February 13, 2026. Edith will gather with her friends and family in Schererville to commemorate this significant milestone.

Edith Brown was born on February 13, 1917, in Muskogee, Oklahoma. She was one of four children born to Luther Albert Brown and Dora Rozolia Draper Brown. Her family went on to live in Kansas City, Kansas, and after her parents passed Edith moved to the south side of Chicago, Illinois, to live with her aunt. In 1940, Edith met her husband, the late William Henry Coleman, and relocated to Gary's Midtown neighborhood.

Edith is an accomplished scholar, having earned both a Bachelor of Science and Master of Science in education at Indiana University in Bloomington. After graduating, Edith pursued a career in the teaching profession where she went on to enrich the lives of thousands of young minds. For over 27 years, Edith taught students at Frederick Douglass Elementary School. She also helped connect students with scholarships through her involvement with the Women's Association of the Northwest Indiana Symphony Society and the American Association of University Women.

Outside of the classroom, Edith is an active member of the Gary community, holding memberships in the Red Hat Society and the Sigma Gamma Rho Sorority, Inc. She is well known for her involvement with her church, the First Church of God in Gary. In 2023, Edith was recognized by the First Church of God in Gary for her lifetime of dedicated service to the community. For over seven decades Edith has served her church in several roles, including teaching Sunday School, serving as Director of the Daily Vacation Bible School, holding memberships in the local and national Missionary Societies, singing in the church choir, serving as a deaconess, and teaching a manners class for young children.

Mr. Speaker, Edith has always given her time and efforts selflessly to the youth and the community in Northwest Indiana throughout her illustrious life. For her dedication to academic success and her commitment to empowering youth with the skills and knowledge to thrive, Edith is worthy of the highest praise. Mr. Speaker, I respectfully ask that you and my other distinguished colleagues join me in wishing Mary Edith Brown Coleman a very happy 109th birthday.

HONORING IMELDA SALAZAR

HON. MIKE QUIGLEY

OF ILLINOIS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. QUIGLEY. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Imelda Salazar, community organizer and champion of economic justice.

Imelda has been organizing communities in Chicago for twenty years. Fueled by her faith and dedication to service, I was privileged to meet her while handing out food during the pandemic. She has a deep gift for understanding people and bringing cultures together.

Hundreds of families in Chicago have safe homes to raise their families in because of her. Neighborhoods are safer and schools are better because of her tireless advocacy. My staff and I are better at our jobs because of her dedicated service to educating us on the communities she has dedicated her life to.

During the most difficult of circumstances, she has never failed to remind us all to find joy within each other. Chicago, Illinois and the United States is better because of her service.

Mr. Speaker, I ask everyone to join me in recognizing Imelda Salazar for her service in pursuit of equity in our communities.

HONORING THE LIFE OF
DEMARIOUS "LEONE" ALLISON
GRIFFIS

HON. EARL L. "BUDDY" CARTER

OF GEORGIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. CARTER of Georgia. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor the life of Demarious "Leone" Allison Griffis, who passed away on February 5, 2026.

We are deeply saddened by her passing but are comforted by her strong faith and the meaningful life she lived.

Born in June of 1945 in Mobile, Alabama, Ms. Griffis grew up helping her family run their two restaurants, "The Stateline Drive-in," and "The Red Pig."

She loved making everyone's favorite dishes and comfort meals, and, through this, learned the value of hard work and serving others first.

Ms. Griffis worked for many years at Container Corporation before embracing her favorite role as "Nana" to her many grandchildren and great-grandchildren.

She was a faithful and active member of First Assembly of God in Fernandina and lived her devotion every day.

Ms. Griffis taught her grandchildren and great-grandchildren the importance of faith and trusting in the Lord, spending plenty of time creating memories, like teaching them to fish and drive.

She will be deeply missed, but her love and legacy of kindness and compassion will live on.

RECOGNIZING THE SERVICE OF
KATHRYN ANGELL

HON. JANICE D. SCHAKOWSKY

OF ILLINOIS

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Ms. SCHAKOWSKY. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize Kathryn Angell, a dedicated public servant who has spent years serving the residents of Illinois' 9th Congressional District with skill, compassion, and professionalism.

Kathryn has been a member of my staff since January 2022, after having previously served with distinction as an intern in the office. From her earliest days here, she demonstrated a deep commitment to public service and a genuine concern for the people who turned to our office for help.

In her role as a Constituent Advocate, Kathryn handled a wide range of complex and often deeply personal issues, including IRS cases, housing matters, student loan concerns, and many other challenges faced by families across the district. She approached each case with patience and determination, understanding that for many constituents, reaching out to a congressional office comes at a moment of frustration or hardship. Kathryn worked tirelessly to navigate federal agencies that can be difficult to access and slow to respond, and she never lost sight of the human impact of her work.

Constituents benefited not only from her knowledge, but from her persistence and her willingness to see cases through to resolution. My staff and I could always trust that Kathryn's work would be handled with care, diligence, and respect for the people we serve.

Over the years, Kathryn earned a strong reputation as a thoughtful, responsive, and reliable member of my team. She coordinated the office's participation in the Congressional App Challenge, engaging with high school students across the district as they learned to code and develop their first apps. Kathryn was also deeply involved in the office's congressional outreach efforts, regularly representing the office at community events and neighborhood office hours throughout the district.

As Kathryn leaves the office to pursue new opportunities, I want to express my sincere gratitude for her service. While we will miss her greatly, I am confident that she will continue to use her talents and experience to make a positive difference in the lives of others. Her experience in this office has prepared her well for whatever path she chooses to pursue next, and I am confident she will excel in any role she undertakes. I wish her every success in her future endeavors.

HONORING THE SERVICE OF
MICHAEL FINE

HON. MARK TAKANO

OF CALIFORNIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. TAKANO. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor an individual whose steady leadership, unwavering integrity, and unmatched expertise have strengthened the fiscal health of California's public education system. For more than four decades, Michael Fine has served as a guardian of public trust, ensuring that schools, county offices of education, and community colleges are positioned to make sound, transparent, and equitable financial decisions for the benefit of every student.

Mr. Fine's career spans a broad and distinguished range of roles, beginning in private-sector finance before moving into public education, where he served as a chief business official, deputy superintendent, and interim superintendent in districts of varying size and complexity, including the Riverside Unified

School District. These roles shaped his understanding of how governance, community expectations, and financial stewardship intersect, and they helped build the pragmatic, student-centered approach that has defined his leadership.

In 2015, Mr. Fine joined the Fiscal Crisis and Management Assistance Team as its chief administrative officer. Two years later, he became FCMAT's chief executive officer, leading the organization through a period of extraordinary growth, innovation, and modernization. Under his direction, FCMAT strengthened its statewide role as California's foremost fiscal oversight and assistance agency, supporting TK–14 institutions with tools, training, and expert guidance that have become indispensable across the state.

During his tenure, Mr. Fine oversaw the expansion and refinement of FCMAT's fiscal tools, including updates to the multiyear financial projection software, enhancements to the fiscal health risk analyses, and improvements to charter school oversight guidance. He championed increased clarity, accessibility, and transparency in all FCMAT products, ensuring that leaders—from superintendents to school board members to chief business officials—could rely on timely, accurate information to guide their decisions.

Mr. Fine also strengthened FCMAT's essential role in California's system of fiscal oversight under Assembly Bill 1200. His clear, data-driven communication with state agencies, county offices, and local educational leaders has been crucial in responding to structural deficits, declining enrollment, and rising pension, benefit, and operating costs. He is widely recognized for his candor, clarity, and willingness to address complex issues head-on, always with the goal of supporting stability and avoiding harm to students.

A defining aspect of Mr. Fine's legacy is his deep commitment to developing the next generation of fiscal and operational leaders. Under his leadership, the CBO Mentor Program expanded, diversified, and strengthened pathways for emerging leaders in both K–12 and community college systems. His belief that strong fiscal systems depend on strong people has shaped FCMAT's culture and helped elevate the value of professional learning statewide.

Within FCMAT, Mr. Fine fostered a culture rooted in collaboration, excellence, and public service. He cultivated a team of analysts, data specialists, and operational experts whose work is respected across the state. Colleagues consistently describe him as principled, steady, and deeply dedicated to the mission of supporting sound governance and fiscal solvency throughout California's education system.

Beyond his professional accomplishments, Mr. Fine is a devoted husband, father, and community member. His service on local boards, commissions, and philanthropic organizations reflects the same commitment to public well-being that has guided his professional life. His belief in the power of strong, well-managed public institutions has been a constant throughout his career.

As Mr. Fine prepares to retire in 2026, his impact on California's schools and colleges will endure far beyond his tenure. The systems he strengthened, the leaders he mentored, and the culture of integrity he championed at FCMAT will continue to sup-

port stable, transparent, student-centered decision-making across the state for years to come.

I ask my colleagues to join me in recognizing Michael Fine for his extraordinary service, his steady leadership, and his enduring contributions to California's students, families, and communities. His work has safeguarded the fiscal health of our education system and strengthened the foundation upon which our public schools depend.

HONORING AMY EMERICK CLERKIN

HON. ADELITA S. GRIJALVA

OF ARIZONA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mrs. GRIJALVA. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Amy Emerick Clerkin who has served as a dedicated staffer in the House of Representatives for 20 years.

I have known Amy for many years. She worked for my father, the late Congressman Raúl M. Grijalva, for two decades, including 16 years as his chief of staff. Throughout this time, she served as a trusted leader with the heart of a true public servant.

She has navigated the late-night votes, the procedural labyrinths, and the political systems that change in a moment's notice. And she has done it with a steady purpose that never makes the headlines but keeps the whole thing standing. She fought for wins both big and small, weathered the chaos, and held on to her sense of mission. Politics can be chaotic, but she is a calm, steady, and thoughtful leader.

In addition to leading my father's congressional office, Amy served as an advisor to the Congressional Progressive Caucus, where she spearheaded efforts to raise the Caucus's national profile, and build its power and influence within Congress.

Amy connected with people across roles, perspectives, and ideologies to make Congress a better institution. She approaches everyone with respect and a genuine interest in finding common ground. Colleagues and stakeholders readily engage with her because they trust her judgment and integrity. She has thoughtfully guided other congressional staff as they navigate the contours of policymaking.

Throughout her time on Capitol Hill, Amy dedicated herself to an office and the policies that seek to provide opportunities, resources and basic equity to communities in need. She never took the easy road or wavered in this dedication.

Amy's capabilities helped my father achieve a lasting impact for Arizona. We are thankful for her service to this great institution and for her 20 years of service to the people of Arizona.

EXPOSING ORGANIZED ANTISEMITIC NETWORK

HON. JOE WILSON

OF SOUTH CAROLINA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. WILSON of South Carolina. Mr. Speaker, it is sad but true that antisemitic hatred of

Jews has developed across America supported by well-funded networks of protestors. The highly respected former Attorney General of Virginia, Jason Miyares, has been courageous to expose the threats to free speech in an article of Follow the Money published today by the Jewish Insider, researched by Marc Rod. I include in the RECORD the article:

Jason Miyares alleges 'very organized' and well-funded network propping up antisemitic activity.

Former Virginia Attorney General Jason Miyares on Tuesday laid out what he said was a coordinated network funneling U.S. funds to terrorist groups abroad and bringing foreign money into the U.S. to incite anti-Israel protests.

The former attorney general, who in his previous role sought to expose the financial records of American Muslims for Palestine, seemingly referring to ongoing litigation, that 'allegedly, a good number of charitable organizations and networks of them' funnel money both from the United States to terrorist proxies in the Middle East, as well as from overseas into campus protests.

'They're very organized, they're funded,' Miyares, a Republican, said at a George Washington University Program on Extremism conference on antisemitism. 'You could see it as a huge network, a huge network that is nationwide, of different entities funneling money in, in my opinion, to form a dissent on these college campuses and give people then the license and the permission to push rampant antisemitism.'

He said that there was clear proof that the protests were orchestrated, pointing to an incident at Virginia Commonwealth University where a large protest 'seemingly sprung out overnight,' where demonstrators arrived with premade barriers and signs, as well as full tactical gear and makeshift bear spray grenades, and coached other demonstrators on how to attack police.

Miyares said that he became particularly passionate about pursuing antisemitism as attorney general during a trip to Israel shortly after the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks, when he visited the site of some of Hamas' massacres. On the way home from the trip, he saw news coverage of protests on U.S. campuses of protestors waving Hamas flags and shouting Hamas slogans. 'It really struck me in my core. How in the world did we get this inverted?' Miyares said.

He highlighted one story of meeting a Jewish student who had spoken out against a Boycott, Divestment and Sanctions resolution at his university, and returned to a sign on his dorm room door that read, 'if you open your mouth again, we will finish what the Final Solution started.'

The student's roommate, a German Jewish exchange student, ultimately decided to leave the school and the country entirely. Miyares alleged that the school knew who left the sign but didn't act until Miyares had a 'very, very frank, direct conversation' with the college president.

'Students feel intimidated and at times scared to speak out, and so it requires college administrators to give them that space and give them that ability, that they actually can share what they're experiencing,' Miyares said.

HONORING LARRY STANTON WIESE

HON. BEN CLINE

OF VIRGINIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. CLINE. Mr. Speaker, I rise to honor Larry Stanton Wiese. Larry graduated in 1990

with honors from Midwestern State University in Wichita Falls, Texas, with a Bachelor of Arts degree in Political Science.

He graduated from Oklahoma City University School of Law in 1995 with a Juris Doctor and is admitted to practice law in the Commonwealth of Virginia and the District of Columbia. He currently serves the Order as the Executive Director and General Counsel. He also serves as President of the Fraternity Housing Corporation and President of the Kappa Alpha Order Educational Foundation.

Larry was initiated into Kappa Alpha Order while attending Midwestern State University by the Gamma Omega Chapter on January 23, 1987. While an undergraduate member, he served his chapter as both president and vice president. Following graduation, Larry served Kappa Alpha Order for one year as an Educational Leadership Consultant and as deputy province commander in Texas. He re-joined the staff of Kappa Alpha Order in July of 1995, as assistant executive director. He was named interim executive director in November of that year, and his official appointment was finalized on February 15, 1996, 30 years ago this year.

In this now 30th year, more than 70,000 of the Order's approximate 188,000 initiates have joined during Larry's tenure. KA is reaching all-time membership highs, all-time GPA marks for all undergraduate chapters, and record-setting fundraising for scholarships, leadership education, and internships. Leadership education programs have been revolutionized and are best-in-class across the fraternity and sorority world. Health and safety education continues to be at the forefront of all educational initiatives.

Larry is a past president and a former member of the board of directors for the Fraternity Executives Association. He is also a founder, past president, and board member of the Fraternity and Sorority Political Action Committee and founder and past President of the Fraternity and Sorority Action Fund. Larry also serves as the Fraternity Executives Association Liaison and board member for the Southeastern Greek Leadership Association (SGLA).

He is a former vice-chair for the Non-Profit Organizations Committee of the Torts and Insurance Practice Section of the American Bar Association, and a former Vice President of the Rockbridge County, Virginia Bar Association. He is president and board member of the Lexington Downtown Development Association. He is president of the Historic Lexington Foundation and is a member of the American Society of Association Executives and the Association of Fundraising Professionals. Larry is currently serving as Treasurer of the Girl Scouts of Virginia Skyline Council.

Larry is married to Dr. Dawn Wiese, a member of Delta Delta Delta. Their marriage ceremony was held on the grounds and gardens of Mulberry Hill on June 25, 2011. Dawn is a past board member of the Girl Scouts of Virginia Skyline Council, Chair of the Virginia Lewis and Clark Legacy Trail, Board member of Algernon Sydney Sullivan Foundation, Board Member of the Fraternity and Sorority Action Fund, Chief Operating Officer of FRMT, Ltd, and part-time faculty in the Department of Economics and Business at Virginia Military Institute. Their daughter, Jillian, is a 2022 graduate of Kenyon College (with honors) in Economics and Russian and where she was initiated into Alpha Sigma Tau sorority. Jillian

currently works in Washington, D.C. in government consulting.

HONORING CHIEF MIKE LORENZ

HON. NORMA J. TORRES

OF CALIFORNIA

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mrs. TORRES of California. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to honor Chief Mike Lorenz and to commend him for his 28 years of service to the Ontario Police Department in my congressional district as he retires on February 18, 2026.

Chief Lorenz is a graduate of West Covina High School and California Coast University, where he earned his Bachelor of Science in Criminal Justice.

As a young adult, he honorably served our Nation in the United States Air Force from July 1993 to June 1997. Late in 1997, Chief Lorenz attended the 130th basic training academy at the San Bernardino Sheriff's Academy. During his time at the academy, he was hired by the City of Ontario, where he became a patrol officer in March of 1998.

Over the past 28 years he has served Ontario's Police Department in various capacities: Patrol, Narcotics, Gang Violence Suppression Unit, Field Training Program, Multi-Enforcement Team, and SWAT. For four years, he served Ontario as a task force officer with the California Department of Justice (DOJ) Bureau of Narcotic Enforcement (BNE) Clandestine Laboratory Team, where he targeted labs producing methamphetamine and phencyclidine (PCP).

Chief Lorenz's remarkable career is marked by the several supervisory and command positions he has held in Patrol Operations, East Area Command, SWAT/Crisis Negotiations, Community Oriented Problem Solving/Multi-Enforcement Team (COPS/MET), Gang Suppression Unit, K9 and Interdiction, and Captain in Field Operations.

Before his time as Chief, he served as the Deputy Chief for two and a half years. After being promoted, Lorenz was sworn in as Chief of the Ontario Police Department in 2020.

For his remarkable career and outstanding service, it is my honor to recognize Chief Mike Lorenz ahead of his retirement from the Ontario Police Department. His commitment to our community and Nation is worthy of the highest commendation.

RECOGNIZING TERRI JUDAH

HON. GABE VASQUEZ

OF NEW MEXICO

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

Wednesday, February 11, 2026

Mr. VASQUEZ. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to recognize Terri Judah for her outstanding contributions to Carlsbad, New Mexico. Terri is a community leader who has devoted her time and effort to feeding New Mexico's families and working for New Mexico's children for over two decades.

Terri gets a profound sense of joy from helping those in need and has organized an annual Thanksgiving food drive for over twenty years. The food drive started two decades ago

when Terri partnered with her daughters' Girl Scout troop to create 19 food baskets to deliver to families in need. Driven by Terri's enthusiasm and hard work, the food drive blossomed over time to include help from hundreds of volunteers in the community, including Girl Scout troops, sports teams, students, and local businesses. The Thanksgiving food drive now feeds hundreds of families each year and fed over 300 families last year.

The continued success of this food drive requires extensive dedication, compassion, and community support. In the weeks and months leading up to Thanksgiving, Terri starts setting up donation sites throughout town, storing donations, and coordinating volunteers to assemble baskets and deliveries. The entire community truly rallies around Terri and steps up to ensure families will not go hungry in the holiday season.

Terri also created Operation Hope—a project where she collects and restores used items such as furniture, clothes, and toys, to give to any family that reaches out for assistance. Terri began this effort when she learned that one of her former students was living hand to mouth, and she decided she could not sit idly by. She jumped into action, collecting items that could help her student's family live a little more comfortably and continues to offer support to any family that asks for help.

Above all her impactful work, Terri is a proud wife, mom, grandma, and friend to all. She has also taught kindergarten in Carlsbad Public Schools for the past twenty-five years. She is a beloved teacher, and her students are forever known as "Judah's Jaguars". She truly does it all.

On behalf of the people of New Mexico's 2nd Congressional District, I would like to thank Terri for her commitment to helping those less fortunate and ensuring her neighbors are fed during the holiday season. She exemplifies the best that New Mexico has to offer, and we are extremely proud of her incredible work.

SENATE COMMITTEE MEETINGS

Title IV of Senate Resolution 4, agreed to by the Senate of February 4, 1977, calls for establishment of a system for a computerized schedule of all meetings and hearings of Senate committees, subcommittees, joint committees, and committees of conference. This title requires all such committees to notify the Office of the Senate Daily Digest—designated by the Rules Committee—of the time, place and purpose of the meetings, when scheduled and any cancellations or changes in the meetings as they occur.

As an additional procedure along with the computerization of this information, the Office of the Senate Daily Digest will prepare this information for printing in the Extensions of Remarks section of the CONGRESSIONAL RECORD on Monday and Wednesday of each week.

Meetings scheduled for Thursday, February 12, 2026 may be found in the Daily Digest of today's RECORD.

Daily Digest

Senate

Chamber Action

Routine Proceedings, pages S559–S585

Measures Introduced: Twenty-eight bills and three resolutions were introduced, as follows: S. 3826–3853, and S. Res. 604–606. **Pages S577–78**

Measures Reported:

S. 2975, to amend title 49, United States Code, to enhance the safety of pipeline transportation, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute. (S. Rept. No. 119–102)

S. 362, to allow certain Federal minerals to be mined consistent with the Bull Mountains Mining Plan Modification, with an amendment. (S. Rept. No. 119–103)

S. 472, to amend the Omnibus Parks and Public Lands Management Act of 1996 to provide for the establishment of a Ski Area Fee Retention Account. (S. Rept. No. 119–104)

S. 544, to provide for the location of multiple hardrock mining mill sites, to establish the Abandoned Hardrock Mine Fund. (S. Rept. No. 119–105)

S. 714, to amend the Energy Act of 2020 to include critical materials in the definition of critical mineral, with an amendment in the nature of a substitute. (S. Rept. No. 119–106)

S. 909, to authorize the Secretary of the Interior to convey certain land to La Paz County, Arizona. (S. Rept. No. 119–107)

S. 1453, to confirm the use of certain non-Federal land in Salt Lake City, Utah, for public purposes. (S. Rept. No. 119–108)

Report to accompany H.R. 1043, to direct the Secretary of the Interior to convey certain Federal land in Arizona to La Paz County, Arizona. (S. Rept. No. 119–109) **Page S577**

Measures Considered:

Department of Homeland Security Appropriations Act: Senate continued consideration of the motion to proceed to consideration of H.R. 7147, making further consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026. **Pages S559–71**

D.C. Income and Franchise Tax Conformity And Revision Temporary Amendment Act—Agree-

ment: Senate began consideration of H.J. Res. 142, disapproving the action of the District of Columbia Council in approving the D.C. Income and Franchise Tax Conformity and Revision Temporary Amendment Act of 2025, after agreeing to the motion to proceed. **Pages S571–74**

During consideration of this measure today, Senate also took the following action:

By 51 yeas to 46 nays (Vote No. 36), Senate agreed to the motion to proceed to consideration of the joint resolution. **Page S571**

A unanimous-consent agreement was reached providing that at approximately 11 a.m., on Thursday, February 12, 2026, notwithstanding Rule XXII, Senate continue consideration of the joint resolution, and vote on passage at 12:00 noon; that upon disposition of the joint resolution, Senate resume consideration of the motion to proceed to consideration of H.R. 7147, making further consolidated appropriations for the fiscal year ending September 30, 2026, and that there be 30 minutes of debate equally divided between the two Leaders or their designees, and Senate vote on the motion to invoke cloture following the use or yielding back of that time. **Page S583**

Appointments:

Washington's Farewell Address: The Chair, on behalf of the Vice President, pursuant to the order of the Senate of January 24, 1901, as modified by the order of February 11, 2026, appointed Senator Kaine to read Washington's Farewell Address on Monday, February 23, 2026. **Page S574**

Washington's Farewell Address—Agreement: A unanimous-consent agreement was reached providing that notwithstanding the order of January 24, 1901, the traditional reading of Washington's Farewell Address take place on Monday, February 23, 2026, following the prayer and Pledge of Allegiance to the flag. **Page S574**

Message from the President: Senate received the following messages from the President of the United States:

Transmitting, pursuant to law, a notice of the reasons for action to adjust imports of processed critical

minerals and their derivative products (PCMDPs) so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States in relation to Proclamation 11001 of January 14, 2026; which was referred to the Committee on Finance. (PM–49)

Page S575

Transmitting, pursuant to law, a notice of the reasons for action to adjust imports of medium-and heavy-duty vehicles (MHDVs), and medium-and heavy-duty vehicle parts (MHDVPs), and buses so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States in relation to Proclamation 10984 of October 17, 2025; which was referred to the Committee on Finance. (PM–50)

Page S575

Transmitting, pursuant to law, a notice of the reasons for action to adjust imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States in relation to Proclamation 11002 of January 14, 2026; which was referred to the Committee on Finance. (PM–51)

Pages S575–76

Nominations Received: Senate received the following nominations:

George Kelesis, of Nevada, to be United States Attorney for the District of Nevada for the term of four years.

Catherine Dillon, of Maryland, to be an Assistant Secretary of State (Educational and Cultural Affairs).

William Hague, of Washington, to be an Assistant Secretary of the Interior.

Kyle Haustveit, of North Dakota, to be Under Secretary of Energy.

Steven Lewis, of Missouri, to be United States Marshal for the Eastern District of Missouri, for the term of four years.

Kevin Lilly, of Texas, to be Assistant Secretary for Fish and Wildlife.

Asel Roberts, of Virginia, to be Ambassador to the Republic of Slovenia.

Karen Sessions, of Texas, to be a Commissioner of the Consumer Product Safety Commission for a term of seven years from October 27, 2025.

Scott Socha, of New York, to be Director of the National Park Service.

Todd Steggerda, of Virginia, to be Representative of the United States of America to the Office of the United Nations and Other International Organizations in Geneva, with the rank of Ambassador.

Ashley Stow, of Texas, to be a Member of the Federal Election Commission for a term expiring April 30, 2029.

Andrew Woodson, of Virginia, to be a Member of the Federal Election Commission for a term expiring April 30, 2031.

2 Air Force nominations in the rank of general.

Routine lists in the Air Force, Army, Coast Guard, and Navy.

Pages S583–85

Messages from the House:

Page S576

Measures Referred:

Page S576

Executive Communications:

Pages S576–77

Additional Cosponsors:

Pages S578–79

Statements on Introduced Bills/Resolutions:

Pages S579–82

Additional Statements:

Pages S574–75

Amendments Submitted:

Pages S582–83

Authorities for Committees to Meet:

Page S583

Record Votes: One record vote was taken today. (Total—36)

Page S571

Adjournment: Senate convened at 2 p.m. and adjourned at 7:01 p.m., until 11 a.m. on Thursday, February 12, 2026. (For Senate's program, see the remarks of the Acting Majority Leader in today's Record on page S583.)

Committee Meetings

(Committees not listed did not meet)

SERVICEMEMBER AND FAMILY QUALITY OF LIFE

Committee on Armed Services: Subcommittee on Personnel concluded a hearing to examine the Senior Enlisted Leaders on servicemember and family quality of life, after receiving testimony from David L. Isom, USN, Senior Enlisted Advisor to the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, The Joint Staff, Sergeant Major Michael R. Weimer, USA, Master Chief Petty Officer John Perryman, USN, Sergeant Major Carlos A. Ruiz, USMC, Chief Master Sergeant David R. Wolfe, USAF, and Chief Master Sergeant John F. Bentivegna, USSF, all of the Department of Defense.

VA HEALTH CARE SYSTEM

Committee on Veterans' Affairs: Committee concluded a hearing to examine building a 21st century VA health care system, focusing on assessing the next generation of VA's community care network, after receiving testimony from Richard Topping, Assistant Secretary for Management and Chief Financial Officer, and Alicia Skolrood, Executive Director and Integrated External Networks, Office of Integrated Veteran Care, Veterans Health Administration, and Leigh Ann Searight, Deputy Assistant Inspector General, Office of Audits and Evaluations, all of the Department of Veterans Affairs.

INTELLIGENCE

Select Committee on Intelligence: Committee met in closed session to receive a briefing on certain intelligence matters from officials of the intelligence community.

MEDICINE

Special Committee on Aging: Committee concluded a hearing to examine how Washington's rules drove

physicians out of medicine, after receiving testimony from Alma Littles, Florida State University College of Medicine, Tallahassee; Lee S. Gross, Epiphany Health—Direct Primary Care, North Port, Florida; Jeffrey Smith, Medical Group Management Association, Statesville, North Carolina; and J. Corey Feist, Dr. Lorna Breen Heroes' Foundation, Charlottesville, Virginia.

House of Representatives

Chamber Action

Public Bills and Resolutions Introduced: 39 public bills, H.R. 7481–7519; and 3 resolutions, H. Res. 1058–1060 were introduced. **Pages H2185–87**

Additional Cosponsors: **Pages H2187–88**

Reports Filed: Reports were filed today as follows:

H. Res. 1057, providing for consideration of the bill (S. 1383) to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access, and for other purposes; providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 2189) to modernize Federal firearms laws to account for advancements in technology and less-than-lethal weapons, and for other purposes; providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 261) to amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit requiring an authorization for the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have previously been authorized by a Federal or State agency; providing for consideration of the bill (H.R. 3617) to amend the Department of Energy Organization Act to secure the supply of critical energy resources, including critical minerals and other materials, and for other purposes; and waiving a requirement of clause 6(a) of rule XIII with respect to consideration of certain resolutions reported from the Committee on Rules (H. Rept. 119–493);

H.R. 3495, to amend the Fair Labor Standards Act of 1938 to clarify the definition of employee as it relates to direct sellers and real estate agents, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–494); and

H.R. 6472, to amend the Higher Education Act of 1965 to provide for in-state tuition rates for certain residents of Guam, the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, American Samoa, and the

United States Virgin Islands, and for other purposes, with an amendment (H. Rept. 119–495).

Pages H2184–85

Speaker: Read a letter from the Speaker wherein he appointed Representative Evans (CO) to act as Speaker pro tempore for today. **Page H2121**

Recess: The House recessed at 4:55 p.m. and reconvened at 5:16 p.m. **Page H2167**

Securing America's Critical Minerals Supply Act: The House passed H.R. 3617, to amend the Department of Energy Organization Act to secure the supply of critical energy resources, including critical minerals and other materials, by a ye-a-and-nay vote of 223 yeas to 206 nays, Roll No. 64.

Pages H2150–54, H2167–68

Rejected the Landsman motion to recommit the bill to the Committee on Energy and Commerce by a ye-a-and-nay vote of 214 yeas to 215 nays, Roll No. 63.

Pages H2154, H2167–68

Pursuant to the Rule, the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Energy and Commerce now printed in the bill shall be considered as adopted. **Page H2150**

H. Res. 1057, as amended, the rule providing for consideration of the bills (S. 1383), (H.R. 2189), (H.R. 261), and (H.R. 3617) was agreed to by a recorded vote of 216 yeas to 215 noes, Roll No. 62, after the previous question was ordered by a ye-a-and-nay vote of 216 yeas to 214 nays, Roll No. 61.

Pages H2121–38

Relating to a national emergency by the President on February 1, 2025: The House passed H.J. Res. 72, relating to a national emergency by the President on February 1, 2025, by a ye-a-and-nay vote of 219 yeas to 211 nays, Roll No. 65.

Pages H2154–61, H2169

Undersea Cable Protection Act: The House passed H.R. 261, to amend the National Marine Sanctuaries

Act to prohibit requiring an authorization for the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have previously been authorized by a Federal or State agency, by a ye-and-nay vote of 218 yeas to 212 nays, Roll No. 67.

Pages H2161–66, H2169–71

Agreed to amend the title so as to read: “To amend the National Marine Sanctuaries Act to prohibit the Secretary of Commerce from prohibiting, or requiring any permit or other authorization for, the installation, continued presence, operation, maintenance, repair, or recovery of undersea fiber optic cables in a national marine sanctuary if such activities have been authorized by a Federal or State agency.”.

Pages H2170–71

Rejected the Carbajal motion to recommit the bill to the Committee on Natural Resources by a ye-and-nay vote of 214 yeas to 216 nays, Roll No. 66.

Pages H2166, H2169–70

Pursuant to the Rule, the amendment in the nature of a substitute recommended by the Committee on Natural Resources now printed in the bill shall be considered as adopted.

Page H2162

H. Res. 1057, as amended, the rule providing for consideration of the bills (S. 1383), (H.R. 2189), (H.R. 261), and (H.R. 3617) was agreed to by a recorded vote of 216 yeas to 215 noes, Roll No. 62, after the previous question was ordered by a ye-and-nay vote of 216 yeas to 214 nays, Roll No. 61.

Pages H2121–38

Veterans Accessibility Advisory Committee Act: The House passed S. 1383, to establish the Veterans Advisory Committee on Equal Access, by a ye-and-nay vote of 218 yeas to 213 nays, Roll No. 69.

Pages H2171–72

Rejected the Morelle motion to commit the bill to the Committee on House Administration, by a ye-and-nay vote of 214 yeas to 217 nays, Roll No. 68.

Pages H2149, H2171

Pursuant to the Rule, an amendment in the nature of a substitute consisting of the text of Rules Committee Print 119–19, modified by the amendment printed in the report of the Committee on Rules accompanying this resolution, shall be considered as adopted.

Pages H2138–41

H. Res. 1057, as amended, the rule providing for consideration of the bills (S. 1383), (H.R. 2189), (H.R. 261), and (H.R. 3617) was agreed to by a recorded vote of 216 yeas to 215 noes, Roll No. 62, after the previous question was ordered by a ye-and-nay vote of 216 yeas to 214 nays, Roll No. 61.

Pages H2121–38

Authorizing the use of Emancipation Hall in the Capitol Visitor Center for a ceremony as part of

the commemoration of the days of remembrance of victims of the Holocaust: The House agreed to discharge from committee and agree to H. Con. Res. 72, authorizing the use of Emancipation Hall in the Capitol Visitor Center for a ceremony as part of the commemoration of the days of remembrance of victims of the Holocaust.

Page H2172

Meeting Hour: Agreed by unanimous consent that when the House adjourns today, it adjourn to meet at 9 a.m. tomorrow, February 12th.

Page H2172

Presidential Messages: Read a message from the President transmitting a notification of the reasons why he has decided to take action to adjust imports of processed critical minerals and their derivative products (PCMDPs) so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States—referred to the Committee on Ways and Means and ordered to be printed (H. Doc. 119–134).

Page H2166

Read a message from the President transmitting a notification of the reasons why he has decided to take action to adjust imports of medium and heavy-duty vehicles (MHDVs), and medium- and heavy-duty vehicle parts (MHDVPs), and buses so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States—referred to the Committee on Ways and Means and ordered to be printed (H. Doc. 119–135).

Pages H2166–67

Read a message from the President transmitting a notification of the reasons why he has decided to take action to adjust imports of semiconductors, semiconductor manufacturing equipment, and their derivative products so that such imports will not threaten to impair the national security of the United States—referred to the Committee on Ways and Means and ordered to be printed (H. Doc. 119–136).

Page H2167

Quorum Calls—Votes: Eight ye-and-nay votes and one recorded vote developed during the proceedings of today and appear on pages H2137–38, H2138, H2167–68, H2168, H2169, H2169–70, H2170, H2171, and H2171–72.

Adjournment: The House met at 11 a.m. and adjourned at 8:14 p.m.

Committee Meetings

POTENTIAL DEPARTMENT OF HOMELAND SECURITY SHUTDOWN IMPACTS

Committee on Appropriations: Subcommittee on Homeland Security held a hearing entitled “Potential DHS Shutdown Impacts”. Testimony was heard from Admiral Thomas Allan, Vice Commandant, U.S. Coast Guard; Matthew Quinn, Deputy Director, U.S. Secret Service; and the following Department of

Homeland Security officials: Madhu Gottumukkala, Acting Director, Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency; Ha Nguyen McNeill, Acting Administrator, Transportation Security Administration; and Gregg Phillips, Associate Administrator, Office of Response and Recovery, Federal Emergency Management Agency.

BUILDING AN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE-READY AMERICA: SAFER WORKPLACES THROUGH SMARTER TECHNOLOGY

Committee on Education and the Workforce: Subcommittee on Workforce Protections held a hearing entitled “Building an AI-Ready America: Safer Workplaces Through Smarter Technology”. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

LOWERING HEALTH CARE COSTS FOR ALL AMERICANS: AN EXAMINATION OF THE PRESCRIPTION DRUG SUPPLY CHAIN

Committee on Energy and Commerce: Subcommittee on Health held a hearing entitled “Lowering Health Care Costs for All Americans: An Examination of the Prescription Drug Supply Chain”. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

OVERSIGHT OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE COMMISSION

Committee on Financial Services: Full Committee held a hearing entitled “Oversight of the Securities and Exchange Commission”. Testimony was heard from Paul Atkins, Chairman, U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission.

HOMEOWNERSHIP AND THE ROLE OF THE SECONDARY MORTGAGE MARKET

Committee on Financial Services: Subcommittee on Housing and Insurance held a hearing entitled “Homeownership and the Role of the Secondary Mortgage Market”. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

SOUTH ASIA: U.S. FOREIGN POLICY IN THE REGION

Committee on Foreign Affairs: South and Central Asia Subcommittee held a hearing entitled “South Asia: U.S. Foreign Policy in the Region”. Testimony was heard from S. Paul Kapur, Assistant Secretary, Bureau of South and Central Asian Affairs, Department of State.

SURVEYING THE THREAT OF AGROTERRORISM, PART II: ASSESSING FEDERAL GOVERNMENT EFFORTS

Committee on Homeland Security: Subcommittee on Emergency Management and Technology held a hearing entitled “Surveying the Threat of

Agroterrorism, Part II: Assessing Federal Government Efforts”. Testimony was heard from Matt Allen, Director, Office of Homeland Security, Department of Agriculture; and the following Department of Homeland Security officials: Suzette Kelly, Acting Executive Director, Agriculture Programs and Trade Liaison; Jeff Cooper, Program Manager, Science and Technology Directorate; and Ashley Grant, Senior Health Security and Biodefense Advisor, Office of Health Security.

OVERSIGHT OF THE DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE

Committee on the Judiciary: Full Committee held a hearing entitled “Oversight of the Department of Justice”. Testimony was heard from Pamela J. Bondi, Attorney General, Department of Justice.

MISCELLANEOUS MEASURES

Committee on Natural Resources: Full Committee held a markup on H.R. 5497, the “Apostle Islands National Park and Preserve Act”; H.R. 6300, the “Grasslands Grazing Act of 2025”; H.R. 755, the “Critical Mineral Consistency Act of 2025”; H.R. 1352, to designate the General George C. Marshall House, in the Commonwealth of Virginia, as an affiliated area of the National Park System, and for other purposes; H.R. 1945, the “America’s National Churchill Museum National Historic Landmark Act”; H.R. 2196, to provide for an extension of the legislative authority of the National Emergency Medical Services Memorial Foundation to establish a commemorative work in the District of Columbia and its environs; H.R. 3706, the “SUSHI Act”; H.R. 3922, the “Cross-Boundary Wildfire Solutions Act”; H.R. 4463, to amend the Catawba Indian Tribe of South Carolina Land Claims Settlement Act of 1993; H.R. 4671, the “Ensuring Casualty Assistance for our Firefighters Act”; H.R. 5419, the “Enhancing Administrative Reviews for Broadband Deployment Act”; and H.R. 6380, the “Chiricahua National Park Act”. H.R. 5497, H.R. 6300, H.R. 755, H.R. 1352, H.R. 2196, H.R. 3706, H.R. 3922, H.R. 5419, and H.R. 6380 were ordered reported, as amended. H.R. 1945, H.R. 4463, and H.R. 4671 were ordered reported, without amendment.

ACCELERATING PROGRESS: U.S. SURFACE TRANSPORTATION RESEARCH

Committee on Science, Space, and Technology: Subcommittee on Research and Technology held a hearing entitled “Accelerating Progress: U.S. Surface Transportation Research”. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

MISCELLANEOUS MEASURES

Committee on Small Business: Full Committee held a markup on H.R. 7401, the “Small Business Lending Fraud Prevention Act”; H.R. 7396, the “Native American Entrepreneurial Opportunity Act”; and H.R. 7412, the “Put America on Commission Act of 2026”. H.R. 7401, H.R. 7396, and H.R. 7412 were ordered reported, without amendment.

MISCELLANEOUS MEASURES

Committee on Transportation and Infrastructure: Full Committee held a markup on H.R. 7376, the “Local Water Protection Act”; H.R. 7342, the “Made in America Jobs Act of 2026”; H.R. 7388, the “Smart Space Act of 2026”; and H. Con. Res. 73, authorizing the use of the Capitol Grounds for the National Peace Officers’ Memorial Service and the National Honor Guard and Pipe Band Exhibition. H.R. 7342 and H.R. 7388 were ordered reported, as amended. H.R. 7376 and H. Con. Res. 73 were ordered reported, without amendment.

**OPPORTUNITIES WITH VETERANS
HEALTH ADMINISTRATION
REORGANIZATION**

Committee on Veterans’ Affairs: Full Committee held a hearing entitled “Opportunities with VHA Reorganization”. Testimony was heard from Douglas A. Collins, Secretary, Department of Veterans Affairs.

**LIES, LAWFARE, AND LEVERAGE: THE
CHINESE COMMUNIST PARTY’S
GASLIGHTING AND MANIPULATION TO
MARGINALIZE TAIWAN**

Select Committee on the Strategic Competition Between the United States and the Chinese Communist Party: Full Committee held a hearing entitled “Lies, Lawfare, and Leverage: The CCP’s Gaslighting and Manipulation to Marginalize Taiwan”. Testimony was heard from public witnesses.

Joint Meetings

GEORGIA

Commission on Security and Cooperation in Europe: Commission received a briefing on the Georgian dream’s escalating crackdown on dissent from Claire Kaiser, McLarty Associates; Laura Thornton, McCain Institute; and Olesya Vartanyan, George Mason University.

NEW PUBLIC LAWS

(For last listing of Public Laws, see DAILY DIGEST, p. D168)

S. 269, to improve coordination between Federal and State agencies and the Do Not Pay working sys-

tem. Signed on February 10, 2026. (Public Law 119–77)

**COMMITTEE MEETINGS FOR THURSDAY,
FEBRUARY 12, 2026**

(Committee meetings are open unless otherwise indicated)

Senate

Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs: to hold oversight hearings to examine the Securities and Exchange Commission, 10 a.m., SD–538.

Committee on Commerce, Science, and Transportation: business meeting to consider S. 71, to require Amtrak to install baby changing tables in bathrooms on passenger rail cars, S. 1898, to establish a demonstration program for the active remediation of orbital debris and to require the development of uniform orbital debris standard practices in order to support a safe and sustainable orbital environment, S. 2585, to modernize and improve the Broadband Funding Map in order to promote the most efficient use of Federal funds for broadband deployment, S. 3199, to establish a multi-stakeholder advisory committee tasked with providing detailed recommendations to address challenges to transmitting geolocation information with calls to the 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline, S. 3266, to support the athletic programs of the United States Merchant Marine Academy, S. 3468, to establish a national programmable cloud laboratories network to enhance research efficiency, innovation, and collaboration, S. 3639, to expedite processing of satellite and space licenses, S. 3700, to establish an expert review panel to make recommendations for a comprehensive agency-wide safety management system at the FAA, and routine lists in the Coast Guard; to be immediately followed by a hearing to examine the NTSB final report on the DCA midair collision, 10 a.m., SR–253.

Committee on Energy and Natural Resources: Subcommittee on Public Lands, Forests, and Mining, to hold hearings to examine S. 462, to provide for economic development and conservation in Washoe County, Nevada, S. 1349, to withdraw the National Forest System land in the Ruby Mountains subdistrict of the Humboldt-Toiyabe National Forest and the National Wildlife Refuge System land in Ruby Lake National Wildlife Refuge, Elko and White Pine Counties, Nevada, from operation under the mineral leasing laws, S. 1464, to withdraw certain Bureau of Land Management land from mineral development, S. 1497, to amend the John D. Dingell, Jr. Conservation, Management, and Recreation Act to establish the Cerro de la Olla Wilderness in the Rio Grande del Norte National Monument and to modify the boundary of the Rio Grande del Norte National Monument, S. 1981, to require the Secretary of Agriculture and the Secretary of the Interior to utilize grazing for wildfire risk reduction, S. 2417, to direct the Secretary of Agriculture to issue a special use permit with respect to the maintaining of a flagpole bearing the flag of the United States at Kyhv Peak Lookout Point, Utah, S. 2554, to provide for the recognition of certain Alaska Native communities and the

settlement of certain claims under the Alaska Native Claims Settlement Act, S. 2754, to direct the Secretary of Agriculture to convey to the City of Ouray, Colorado, certain land managed by the Forest Service, together with a reservoir, S. 2787, to amend the Federal Land Policy and Management Act of 1976 to ensure that ranchers who have grazing agreements on national grasslands are treated the same as permittees on other Federal land, S. 2860, to unleash United States offshore critical minerals and resources, S. 2968, to ensure access to certain public land, S. 3004, to direct the Secretary of the Interior to convey certain Bureau of Land Management land to the city of Price, Utah, S. 3082, to prohibit oil and natural gas exploration, development, and production in certain areas of the outer Continental Shelf off the coast of Florida, Georgia, and South Carolina, S. 3493, to provide for the conveyance of certain Federal land in Carson City, Nevada, S. 3526, to provide for the protection of and investment in certain Federal land in the State of California, S. 3527, to release from wilderness study area designation certain land in the State of Montana, to improve the management of that land, S. 3695, to amend Public Law 96-586 to modernize the authority of the Forest Service to acquire and administer land under that Act, H.R. 204, to require that the Secretary of Agriculture and the Secretary of the Interior submit accurate reports regarding hazardous fuels reduction activities, H.R. 677, to establish a process to expedite the review of appeals of certain decisions by the Department of the Interior, H.R. 952, to convey the reversionary interest of the United States in certain land in Sacramento, California, H.R. 1829, to require the Secretary of Agriculture to convey certain lands within the Apache-Sitgreaves National Forest, H.R. 3872, to amend the Mineral Leasing Act for Acquired Lands to make that Act applicable to hardrock minerals, H.R. 3937, to provide for the conveyance of certain Federal land in Chequamegon-Nicolet National Forest, 10 a.m., SD-366.

Committee on Finance: to hold hearings to examine the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement, focusing on evaluating North American competitiveness, 10 a.m., SD-215.

Committee on Foreign Relations: to hold hearings to examine the nominations of Wesley Brooks, of Florida, to be

Assistant Secretary for Oceans and International Environmental and Scientific Affairs, Jeremy Carl, of Montana, to be an Assistant Secretary (International Organizations), and William Long, of Missouri, to be Ambassador to the Republic of Iceland, all of the Department of State, and Robert Sweeney, of Texas, to be United States Director of the Asian Development Bank, with the rank of Ambassador, 10:30 a.m., SD-419.

Committee on Health, Education, Labor, and Pensions: to hold hearings to examine preventing fraud in child care assistance programs, 10 a.m., SD-430.

Committee on Homeland Security and Governmental Affairs: to hold an oversight hearing, 9 a.m., SD-342.

Committee on the Judiciary: business meeting to consider H.R. 6719, to prohibit threats to a minor, S. 3398, to amend title 18, United States Code, to criminalize intentional threats to distribute child sexual abuse material, and to provide appropriate penalties for the use of child sexual abuse material to extort or coerce victims, S. 3397, to make coercion of children to commit harm a criminal offense, S. 3394, to direct the United States Sentencing Commission to amend the sentencing guideline relating to child sexual abuse material, S. 3798, to amend title 18, United States Code, to establish criminal offenses with respect to violations involving ATMs, regardless of whether the ATM is located on the physical premises of a financial institution, and the nomination of Gregory Gilmore, to be United States Attorney for the Central District of Illinois for the term of four years, 10:15 a.m., SH-216.

House

Committee on Veterans' Affairs, Full Committee, markup on H.R. 6047, the "Sharri Briley and Eric Edmundson Veterans Benefits Expansion Act of 2026"; H.R. 3726, the "Fisher House Availability Act of 2025"; H.R. 3482, the "Veterans Community Care Scheduling Improvement Act"; H.R. 785, the "Representing our Seniors at VA Act of 2025"; and H.R. 2148, the "Veteran Caregiver Reeducation, Reemployment, and Retirement Act", 9 a.m., 360 Cannon.

Next Meeting of the SENATE

11 a.m., Thursday, February 12

Next Meeting of the HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

9 a.m., Thursday, February 12

Senate Chamber

Program for Thursday: Senate will continue consideration of H.J. Res. 142, D.C. Income and Franchise Tax Conformity and Revision Temporary Amendment Act, and vote on passage thereon at 12:00 noon.

Following disposition of H.J. Res. 142, Senate will resume consideration of the motion to proceed to consideration of H.R. 7147, Department of Homeland Security Appropriations Act, and after a period of debate, vote on the motion to invoke cloture thereon.

Additional roll call votes are expected during Thursday's session of the Senate.

House Chamber

Program for Thursday: Consideration of H.R. 2189—Law-Enforcement Innovate to De-Escalate Act.

Extensions of Remarks, as inserted in this issue

HOUSE

Carter, Earl L. "Buddy", Ga., E129
Castor, Kathy, Fla., E127
Cline, Ben, Va., E130
Dexter, Maxine, Ore., E128

Grijalva, Adelita S., Ariz., E130
Houlahan, Chrissy, Pa., E127
Mrvan, Frank J., Ind., E129
Pelosi, Nancy, Calif., E127
Quigley, Mike, Ill., E129
Schakowsky, Janice D., Ill., E129

Takano, Mark, Calif., E129
Torres, Norma J., Calif., E131
Vasquez, Gabe, N.M., E131
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Congressional Record

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